



Tina4 for PHP Developers

Zero Dependencies, 55 Features, Built for AI

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The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework

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Getting Started with Tina4 PHP

1. What Is Tina4 PHP

Tina4 PHP is a batteries-included web framework for PHP 8.1+ with zero runtime dependencies. One Composer package. Routing, an ORM, a template engine, authentication, queues, WebSocket, and 70 other features -- all written in-house, none pulled from the PHP ecosystem. You install Tina4 itself via Composer, but that is the entire supply chain.

It belongs to the Tina4 family: four identical frameworks in Python, PHP, Ruby, and Node.js. Learn one, know all four. Same project structure. Same template syntax. Same CLI commands. Same `.env` variables.

Tina4 PHP follows PHP conventions. Method names are `camelCase` -- `fetchOne()`, `softDelete()`, `hasMany()`. Class names are `PascalCase`. Constants are `UPPER_SNAKE_CASE`.

By the end of this chapter you will have a working project with an API endpoint and a rendered HTML page.

2. Prerequisites and Installation

What You Need

Four things. Nothing exotic.

- **PHP 8.1 or later** -- check with:

```
php -v
```

You should see output like:

```
PHP 8.3.4 (cli) (built: Feb 13 2026 09:27:45) (NTS)
Copyright (c) The PHP Group
Zend Engine v4.3.4, Copyright (c) Zend Technologies
    with Zend OPcache v8.3.4, Copyright (c), by Zend Technologies
```

If you see a version lower than 8.1, upgrade PHP first.

- **Composer** -- PHP's package manager. Check with:

```
composer --version
```

You should see:

```
Composer version 2.7.2 2024-03-11 17:12:18
```

If Composer is not installed, get it from <https://getcomposer.org>.

- **The Tina4 CLI** -- a Rust-based binary that manages all four Tina4 frameworks:

The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework

macOS (Homebrew):

```
brew install tina4stack/tap/tina4
```

Linux / macOS (install script):

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/tina4stack/tina4/main/install.sh | bash
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
irm https://raw.githubusercontent.com/tina4stack/tina4/main/install.ps1 | iex
```

Verify:

```
tina4 --version
```

```
tina4 0.1.0
```

- **Required PHP extensions** -- these ship with most PHP installations:
- `ext-json` (bundled since PHP 8.0)
- `ext-mbstring`
- `ext-openssl`
- `ext-sqlite3` (for the default SQLite database)
- `ext-fileinfo`

Check:

```
php -m | grep -E "json|mbstring|openssl|sqlite3|fileinfo"
```

```
fileinfo
json
mbstring
openssl
sqlite3
```

If any are missing, install them via your OS package manager (e.g., `apt install php8.3-mbstring` on Ubuntu).

Creating a New Project

One command. The CLI scaffolds everything.

```
tina4 init php my-store
```

- Initialising php project at ./my-store
- Checking php runtime...
 - ✓ php found
- Checking package manager...
 - ✓ composer found
 - ✓ Created directory ./my-store
- Scaffolding php project...
 - ✓ Created directory structure
 - ✓ Created .env
 - ✓ Created index.php
 - ✓ Created .gitignore
 - ✓ Created composer.json
- Installing dependencies...
 - ✓ Dependencies installed

The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework

✓ Project created at ./my-store

Next steps:

```
cd ./my-store
tina4 serve
```

Install the PHP dependencies:

```
cd my-store
composer install
```

Installing dependencies from lock file

- Installing tina4/tina4-php (v3.2.2): Extracting archive

Generating autoload files

1 package installed

One package. No dependency tree. No version conflicts. Just [tina4/tina4-php](#).

Starting the Dev Server

```
tina4 serve
```

```
_____ _
|_ _ _(_)_ _ _ _ _| || | | | | |
| | | | '_ \ / _ `| || |
| | | | | | (| | _ _|
|_| |_| | |_\__,_| |_|
```

Tina4 PHP v3.2.2

Server running at <http://0.0.0.0:7145>

Debug mode: ON

Press Ctrl+C to stop

Open your browser to <http://localhost:7145>. The Tina4 welcome page appears.

Hit the health check:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/health
```

```
{
  "status": "ok",
  "uptime_seconds": 12,
  "version": "3.2.2",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

The server is running. Time to write code.

Note: No database exists yet. The SQLite file ([data/app.db](#)) is created automatically the first time your code opens a database connection -- for example, when you configure [TINA4_DATABASE_URL](#) in [.env](#) and run a query or migration. Until then, the [data/](#) directory remains empty.

3. Project Structure Walkthrough

Here is what [tina4 init](#) created:

```
my-store/
```

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```

■■■■ .env                # Your configuration (gitignored)
■■■■ .gitignore          # Pre-configured
■■■■ index.php           # Application entry point
■■■■ composer.json       # Composer package definition
■■■■ vendor/             # Composer packages (after composer install)
■■■■ src/
■   ■■■■ routes/        # Your route handlers go here
■   ■■■■ orm/           # Your ORM model classes go here
■   ■■■■ templates/     # Frond/Twig templates
■   ■■■■ public/        # Static files (CSS, JS, images)
■   ■   ■■■■ js/
■   ■   ■■■■ css/
■   ■   ■■■■ images/
■   ■■■■ scss/           # SCSS source files (compiled to CSS)
■■■■ migrations/        # SQL migration files
■■■■ data/              # SQLite databases (gitignored)
■■■■ logs/              # Log files (gitignored)

```

***Note:** The scaffold creates empty directories. Files like `tina4.css`, `frond.js`, and error templates become available at runtime through the `tina4/tina4-php` Composer package -- they are not copied into your project.*

Five directories matter:

- `src/routes/` -- Every `.php` file here is auto-loaded at startup. Route definitions go here. Subdirectories are fine.
- `src/orm/` -- Every `.php` file here is auto-loaded. ORM model classes go here.
- `src/templates/` -- Frond (Tina4's built-in template engine -- see [Chapter 4: Templates](#)) looks here when you call `$response->render("my-page.html", $data)`.
- `src/public/` -- Files served directly. `src/public/images/logo.png` becomes `/images/logo.png`.
- `data/` -- Where the SQLite database lives once created. Gitignored. The `data/` directory starts empty; the database file (e.g., `app.db`) is created automatically on the first database connection.

4. Your First Route

Create `src/routes/greeting.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/greeting/{name}", function ($request, $response) {
    $name = $request->params["name"];
    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Hello, " . $name . "!",
        "timestamp" => date("c")
    ]);
});

```

Save the file. The dev server picks it up. No restart needed if live reload is active. Otherwise, restart with `tina4 serve`.

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***Cross-language note.** PHP, Ruby, and Node read path parameters from `$request->params` / `request.params` / `req.params`. Python passes them as function arguments instead. Same concept, two shapes — pick the chapter that matches your runtime.*

Test It

```
http://localhost:7145/api/greeting/Alice

{
  "message": "Hello, Alice!",
  "timestamp": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00"
}
```

Or with curl:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/api/greeting/Alice

{"message":"Hello, Alice!","timestamp":"2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00"}
```

The browser pretty-prints. Curl shows compact JSON. Force pretty output with `?pretty=true`:

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greeting/Alice?pretty=true"

{
  "message": "Hello, Alice!",
  "timestamp": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00"
}
```

Understanding What Happened

Five things, in order:

- You created a file in `src/routes/`. Tina4 discovered it at startup.
- `Router::get("/api/greeting/{name}", ...)` registered a GET route with a path parameter `{name}`.
- A request arrived at `/api/greeting/Alice`. The router matched the pattern. Your handler ran.
- `$request->params["name"]` extracted `"Alice"` from the URL.
- `$response->json(...)` serialized the array to JSON, set `Content-Type: application/json`, and returned `200 OK`.

No base controller. No service provider. No bootstrapping ritual.

Adding More HTTP Methods

Update `src/routes/greeting.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/greeting/{name}", function ($request, $response) {
    $name = $request->params["name"];
    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Hello, " . $name . "!",
        "timestamp" => date("c")
    ]);
});
```

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```
});

Router::post("/api/greeting", function ($request, $response) {
    $name = $request->body["name"] ?? "World";
    $language = $request->body["language"] ?? "en";

    $greetings = [
        "en" => "Hello",
        "es" => "Hola",
        "fr" => "Bonjour",
        "de" => "Hallo",
        "ja" => "Konnichiwa"
    ];

    $greeting = $greetings[$language] ?? $greetings["en"];

    return $response->json([
        "message" => $greeting . ", " . $name . "!",
        "language" => $language
    ], 201);
})->noAuth();
```

::: tip Why `->noAuth()`? Tina4 secures `POST`, `PUT`, `PATCH`, and `DELETE` routes by default — they require a valid bearer token. For public, untyped examples like this one, chain `->noAuth()` to disable that check. In production, remove `->noAuth()` and send an `Authorization: Bearer <token>` header instead. See [Authentication](#) for token issuance. :::

Test the POST endpoint:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/greeting \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Carlos", "language": "es"}'

{"message": "Hola, Carlos!", "language": "es"}
```

Status code: `201 Created`. The second argument to `$response->json()` sets it. For a typed, self-documenting alternative, pass an HTTP constant:

```
return $response->json($data, \Tina4\HTTP_CREATED);
```

Tina4 ships a full set of HTTP constants (`HTTP_OK`, `HTTP_BAD_REQUEST`, `HTTP_NOT_FOUND`, `HTTP_UNAUTHORIZED`, `HTTP_UNPROCESSABLE`, etc.) and content-type constants (`APPLICATION_JSON`, `APPLICATION_XML`, `TEXT_HTML`). The three-argument response form lets you set both at once:

```
return $response("<error/>", \Tina4\HTTP_BAD_REQUEST, \Tina4\APPLICATION_XML);
```

5. Your First Template

Tina4 uses **FronD** -- a zero-dependency, Twig-compatible template engine built from scratch. If you know Twig, Jinja2, or Nunjucks, this will feel familiar.

Create a Base Layout

Create `src/templates/base.html`:

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```

<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}My Store{% endblock %}</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
  <style>
    body { font-family: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif; }
    .container { max-width: 960px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 20px; }
    .product-card { border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 8px; padding: 16px; margin: 8px 0; }
    .product-card h3 { margin-top: 0; }
    .price { color: #2d8f2d; font-weight: bold; font-size: 1.2em; }
    .badge { display: inline-block; padding: 2px 8px; border-radius: 4px; font-size: 0.8em; }
    .badge-success { background: #d4edda; color: #155724; }
    .badge-danger { background: #f8d7da; color: #721c24; }
    nav { background: #333; color: white; padding: 12px 20px; }
    nav a { color: white; text-decoration: none; margin-right: 16px; }
  </style>
</head>
<body>
  <nav>
    <a href="/">Home</a>
    <a href="/products">Products</a>
  </nav>
  <div class="container">
    {% block content %}{% endblock %}
  </div>
  <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
</body>
</html>

```

Two blocks: **title** and **content**. Child templates override what they need. The rest stays.

Create a Product Listing Page

Create `src/templates/products.html`:

```

{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}Products - My Store{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  <h1>Our Products</h1>
  <p>Showing {{ products | length }} product{{ products | length != 1 ? "s" : "" }}</p>

  {% if products | length > 0 %}
    {% for product in products %}
      <div class="product-card">
        <h3>{{ product.name }}</h3>
        <p>{{ product.description }}</p>
        <p class="price">${{ product.price | number_format(2) }}</p>
        {% if product.in_stock %}
          <span class="badge badge-success">In Stock</span>
        {% else %}
          <span class="badge badge-danger">Out of Stock</span>
        {% endif %}
      </div>
    {% if not loop.last %}
      <# Don't add separator after the last item #>
    {% endif %}
  {% endif %}

```

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```

        {% endif %}
    </div>
    {% endfor %}
    {% else %}
    <p>No products available at the moment.</p>
    {% endif %}
{% endblock %}

```

Create the Route That Renders the Template

Create `src/routes/pages.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $products = [
        [
            "name" => "Wireless Keyboard",
            "description" => "Ergonomic wireless keyboard with backlit keys.",
            "price" => 79.99,
            "in_stock" => true
        ],
        [
            "name" => "USB-C Hub",
            "description" => "7-port USB-C hub with HDMI, SD card reader, and Ethernet.",
            "price" => 49.99,
            "in_stock" => true
        ],
        [
            "name" => "Monitor Stand",
            "description" => "Adjustable aluminum monitor stand with cable management.",
            "price" => 129.99,
            "in_stock" => false
        ],
        [
            "name" => "Mechanical Mouse",
            "description" => "High-precision wireless mouse with 16,000 DPI sensor.",
            "price" => 59.99,
            "in_stock" => true
        ]
    ];

    return $response->render("products.html", ["products" => $products]);
});

```

See It in the Browser

Open <http://localhost:7145/products>. You see:

- A dark navigation bar with "Home" and "Products" links
- The heading "Our Products"
- A subheading: "Showing 4 products"
- Four product cards. Name, description, price, stock badge.
- The Monitor Stand shows a red "Out of Stock" badge
- The other three show green "In Stock" badges

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How Template Rendering Works

The chain is short:

- `$response->render("products.html", ["products" => $products])` tells Frond to render `src/templates/products.html`.
- Frond sees `{% extends "base.html" %}` and loads the base template.
- The `{% block content %}` in `products.html` replaces the same block in `base.html`.
- `{{ product.name }}` outputs the value, auto-escaped for HTML safety.
- `{{ product.price | number_format(2) }}` formats the number with 2 decimal places.
- `{% for product in products %}` loops through the array.
- `{% if product.in_stock %}` renders the correct badge.
- `{{ products | length }}` returns the count.

About tina4css

The `tina4.css` file is Tina4's built-in CSS utility framework. Layout utilities, typography, common UI patterns -- no Bootstrap or Tailwind required. It ships with every scaffolded project. Nothing to download.

6. Understanding .env

Open `.env` at the project root:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
```

That is likely everything. The scaffold creates a minimal `.env` with debug mode enabled. Everything else uses sensible defaults.

The defaults that matter for development:

Variable	Default Value	What It Does
<code>TINA4_PORT</code>	<code>7145</code>	Server port
<code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code>	<code>sqlite:///data/app.db</code>	SQLite database path (created on first connection)
<code>TINA4_LOG_LEVEL</code>	<code>ALL</code>	All log messages output
<code>CORS_ORIGINS</code>	<code>*</code>	All origins allowed
<code>TINA4_RATE_LIMIT</code>	<code>60</code>	60 requests per minute per IP

Log levels control how much output Tina4 produces:

Level	Behaviour
-------	-----------

ALL / DEBUG	Full verbose output. DevReload active (live-reload, error overlay).
INFO	Standard logging. Startup messages, request summaries.
WARNING	Warnings and errors only.
ERROR	Errors only. Minimal output.

Set `TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=DEBUG` during development for maximum visibility. Use `WARNING` or `ERROR` in production.

To change the port, use the CLI flag or `.env`:

```
tina4 serve --port 8080
```

Or add it to your `.env` file:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
TINA4_PORT=8080
```

Restart the server. It runs on port 8080.

How port resolution works: The Rust CLI (`tina4 serve`) determines the port using this priority order:

- **CLI flag** (highest priority): `tina4 serve --port 8080`
- **.env file:** `TINA4_PORT=8080`
- **Environment variable:** `PORT=8080`
- **Framework default** (PHP: 7145, Python: 7146, Ruby: 7147, Node.js: 7148)

The CLI reads your `.env` file and checks for `TINA4_PORT` (and falls back to `PORT`). The resolved port is passed to the PHP server. All three methods work -- use whichever fits your workflow.

Disable the browser auto-open

By default, `tina4 serve` opens your browser each time the server restarts. If you save files often, this gets annoying. Add this to `.env` to keep the browser out of your way:

```
TINA4_NO_BROWSER=true
```

For the complete `.env` reference, see [Environment Variables](#).

7. The Dev Dashboard

With `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in your `.env`, Tina4 provides a built-in development dashboard. No additional environment variables are needed.

Restart and navigate to:

```
http://localhost:7145/__dev_____
```

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The dashboard opens. Six panels. Each one saves you from adding print statements:

- **System Overview** -- framework version, PHP version, uptime, memory usage, database status
- **Request Inspector** -- recent HTTP requests with method, path, status, duration, request ID. Click any request for full headers, body, database queries, and template renders.
- **Error Log** -- unhandled exceptions with stack traces and occurrence counts
- **Queue Manager** -- pending, reserved, failed, dead-letter messages
- **WebSocket Monitor** -- active WebSocket connections with metadata
- **Routes** -- all registered routes with methods, paths, and middleware

When you visit any HTML page (like [/products](#)), a **debug overlay** appears at the bottom:

- Request details (method, URL, duration)
- Database queries executed (with timing)
- Template renders (with timing)
- Session data
- Recent log entries

This overlay exists only when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. Production never sees it.

8. Manual Setup (No CLI)

The `tina4` CLI creates the project for you. But if you start from an empty folder — just Composer and a text editor — here is the minimum you need.

Step 1: Install the Package

```
composer require tina4stack/tina4php
```

Step 2: Create `index.php`

This is the entry point. Create a file called `index.php` in your project root:

```
<?php
require_once './vendor/autoload.php';

$app = new \Tina4\App(basePath: __DIR__, development: true);
$app->start();

// Dispatch when running under PHP built-in server
if (php_sapi_name() === "cli-server") {
    $response = \Tina4\Router::dispatch(new \Tina4\Request(), new \Tina4\Response());
    http_response_code($response->getStatusCode());
    foreach ($response->getHeaders() as $name => $value) {
        header("$name: $value");
    }
    echo $response->getBody();
}
```

The **App** class boots the framework. The **cli-server** block handles routing when you run PHP's built-in web server.

Step 3: Create the Folder Structure

Tina4 expects this layout:

```
my-project/
├── index.php
├── .env
├── vendor/
├── src/
│   ├── routes/      # Route files go here
│   ├── templates/   # Twig templates go here
│   └── public/       # Static files (CSS, JS, images)
```

Create the directories:

```
mkdir -p src/routes src/templates src/public
```

Step 4: Create **.env**

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
```

Step 5: Run It

```
tina4 serve
```

The server starts on **http://localhost:7145**. You should see the Tina4 welcome page. From here, add route files in **src/routes/** and templates in **src/templates/** — the same way as a CLI-scaffolded project.

***Note:** Tina4 PHP refuses to start without the Rust CLI. To bypass it (for example inside a Docker image that already wraps the framework) set **TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true** in **.env** and run the framework's bundled server entry directly. The legacy **php -S localhost:7145 index.php** does **not** wire up the dev watcher, SCSS compilation, or WebSocket dev-reload bridge.*

9. Request & Response Fundamentals

Before jumping into the exercises, let's consolidate how route handlers work in Tina4 PHP. Every handler receives two arguments: **\$request** (what the client sent) and **\$response** (what you send back). Here is the complete picture.

Reading Query Parameters

Query parameters are the key-value pairs after the **?** in a URL. Access them through **\$request->query**:

```
// URL: /api/search?q=laptop&page=2
$request->query["q"]           // "laptop"
$request->query["page"]        // "2" (always a string)
$request->query["sort"] ?? "name" // "name" (default -- param was not sent)
```

`$request->params` is reserved for **route path parameters** (see next section). Don't mix them up.

Reading URL Path Parameters

Route patterns like `/users/{id}` capture segments of the URL. Access them through `$request->params`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/users/{id:int}/posts/{slug}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"]; // 5 (int, because of :int)
    $slug = $request->params["slug"]; // "hello-world" (string)
    return $response->json(["user_id" => $id, "slug" => $slug]);
});
```

The `{id:int}` syntax tells Tina4 to convert the value to an integer. Without `:int`, it stays a string.

Reading the Request Body

POST, PUT, and PATCH requests carry a body. Tina4 parses JSON bodies into an associative array automatically (as long as the client sends `Content-Type: application/json`):

```
Router::post("/api/items", function ($request, $response) {
    $name = $request->body["name"] ?? "";
    $price = $request->body["price"] ?? 0;
    return $response->json(["received_name" => $name, "received_price" => $price]);
})->noAuth();
```

Reading Headers

Headers are available as an associative array with their original casing:

```
$contentType = $request->headers["Content-Type"] ?? "not set";
$authToken = $request->headers["Authorization"] ?? "";
$custom = $request->headers["X-Custom-Header"] ?? "";
```

Sending JSON Responses

`$response->json()` converts an array to JSON and sets the correct `Content-Type`. Pass a status code as the second argument:

```
return $response->json(["id" => 1, "name" => "Widget"]); // 200 OK (default)
return $response->json(["id" => 1, "name" => "Widget"], 201); // 201 Created
return $response->json(["error" => "Not found"], 404); // 404 Not Found
```

Sending HTML / Template Responses

`$response->render()` renders a Frond template from `src/templates/` and passes data to it:

```
return $response->render("products.html", ["products" => $productList, "title" => "Our Products"];
```

For raw HTML without a template file:

```
return $response->html("<h1>Hello</h1><p>This works too.</p>");
```

Status Codes

The most common status codes you will use:

Code	Meaning	When to Use
200	OK	Successful GET (default)
201	Created	Successful POST that created something
400	Bad Request	Client sent invalid input
404	Not Found	Resource does not exist
500	Internal Server Error	Something broke on the server

Worked Example: A Complete Route File

Here is a full route file that ties everything together. It builds a small book lookup API with query parameters, path parameters, JSON responses, and proper status codes. Read through it before attempting the exercises -- it is your reference.

Create `src/routes/books.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

// In-memory data store
$books = [
    ["id" => 1, "title" => "Dune", "author" => "Frank Herbert", "year" => 1965],
    ["id" => 2, "title" => "Neuromancer", "author" => "William Gibson", "year" => 1984],
    ["id" => 3, "title" => "Snow Crash", "author" => "Neal Stephenson", "year" => 1992]
];

Router::get("/api/books", function ($request, $response) use (&$books) {
    // List all books. Supports ?author= filter and ?sort=year.
    $author = $request->query["author"] ?? "";
    $sortBy = $request->query["sort"] ?? "";

    $result = $books;

    // Filter by author if the query param is present
    if ($author !== "") {
        $result = array_values(array_filter($result, function ($b) use ($author) {
            return stripos($b["author"], $author) !== false;
        }));
    }

    // Sort by year if requested
    if ($sortBy === "year") {
        usort($result, fn($a, $b) => $a["year"] <=> $b["year"]);
    }

    return $response->json(["books" => $result, "count" => count($result)]);
});
```



```

Router::get("/api/books/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) use (&$books) {
    // Get a single book by ID. Returns 404 if not found.
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $book = null;

    foreach ($books as $b) {
        if ($b["id"] === $id) {
            $book = $b;
            break;
        }
    }

    if ($book === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Book with id {$id} not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json($book);
});

Router::post("/api/books", function ($request, $response) use (&$books) {
    // Create a new book from the JSON body. Returns 201 on success.
    $title = $request->body["title"] ?? "";
    $author = $request->body["author"] ?? "";
    $year = $request->body["year"] ?? 0;

    if ($title === "" || $author === "") {
        return $response->json(["error" => "title and author are required"], 400);
    }

    $maxId = max(array_column($books, "id"));
    $newBook = [
        "id" => $maxId + 1,
        "title" => $title,
        "author" => $author,
        "year" => $year
    ];
    $books[] = $newBook;

    return $response->json($newBook, \Tina4\HTTP_CREATED);
})->noAuth();

```

⋮ tip Public endpoints vs secured endpoints **POST**, **PUT**, **PATCH**, and **DELETE** are secured by default. Every example in this chapter uses `->noAuth()` so the `curl` commands work without a token. For real applications, remove `->noAuth()` and send an **Authorization: Bearer <token>** header -- see [Authentication](#). ⋮

Test it:

```

# List all books
curl http://localhost:7145/api/books

# Filter by author
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/books?author=gibson"

# Sort by year
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/books?sort=year"

# Get a single book
curl http://localhost:7145/api/books/2

```

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```
# Get a book that does not exist (returns 404)
curl http://localhost:7145/api/books/99

# Create a new book
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/books \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"title": "Foundation", "author": "Isaac Asimov", "year": 1951}'
```

This example covers every building block the exercises use: reading query parameters, reading path parameters, reading the request body, returning JSON with different status codes, and handling missing data. Refer back to it as you work through the exercises below.

10. Exercise: Greeting API + Product List Template

Build both features from scratch. No peeking at the examples above.

Exercise Part A: Greeting API

Create an API endpoint at **GET /api/greet** that:

- Accepts a query parameter **name** (e.g., **/api/greet?name=Sarah**)
- Defaults to **"Stranger"** if **name** is missing
- Returns JSON:

```
{
  "greeting": "Welcome, Sarah!",
  "time_of_day": "afternoon"
}
```

- Calculates **time_of_day** from the server's current hour:
- 5:00 - 11:59 = "morning"
- 12:00 - 16:59 = "afternoon"
- 17:00 - 20:59 = "evening"
- 21:00 - 4:59 = "night"

Test your endpoint with:

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greet?name=Sarah"
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greet"
```

Exercise Part B: Product List Page

Create a page at **GET /store** that:

- Displays at least 5 products (hardcoded)
- Each product has: name, category, price, and a boolean **featured** flag
- Featured products are visually distinct (different background, border, or badge)
- The page shows total product count and featured count
- Uses template inheritance -- a layout template and a page template that extends it

- Includes `tina4.css` and `frond.js`

Your products data:

```
$products = [
  ["name" => "Espresso Machine", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 299.99, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "featured" => false],
  ["name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Noise-Canceling Headphones", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 199.99, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Water Bottle", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 24.99, "featured" => false]
];
```

Expected browser output:

- Page titled "Our Store"
- Text: "5 products, 3 featured"
- Product cards with name, category, price, and a "Featured" badge on highlighted items
- Featured products have a distinct visual style

11. Solutions

Solution A: Greeting API

Create `src/routes/greet.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/greet", function ($request, $response) {
    $name = $request->query["name"] ?? "Stranger";
    $hour = (int) date("G");

    if ($hour >= 5 && $hour < 12) {
        $timeOfDay = "morning";
    } elseif ($hour >= 12 && $hour < 17) {
        $timeOfDay = "afternoon";
    } elseif ($hour >= 17 && $hour < 21) {
        $timeOfDay = "evening";
    } else {
        $timeOfDay = "night";
    }

    return $response->json([
        "greeting" => "Welcome, " . $name . "!",
        "time_of_day" => $timeOfDay
    ]);
});
```

Test:

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greet?name=Sarah"
{"greeting":"Welcome, Sarah!","time_of_day":"afternoon"}

curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greet"
```

```
{"greeting":"Welcome, Stranger!","time_of_day":"afternoon"}
```

Solution B: Product List Page

Create `src/templates/store-layout.html`:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}Store{% endblock %}</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
  <style>
    body { font-family: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif; }
    .container { max-width: 960px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 20px; }
    header { background: #1a1a2e; color: white; padding: 16px 20px; }
    header h1 { margin: 0; }
    .stats { color: #888; margin: 8px 0 20px; }
    .product-grid { display: grid; gap: 16px; }
    .product-card { background: white; border: 2px solid #e0e0e0; border-radius: 8px; padding: 16px; }
    .product-card.featured { border-color: #ffc107; background: #fffdf0; }
    .product-name { font-size: 1.2em; font-weight: bold; margin: 0 0 4px; }
    .product-category { color: #666; font-size: 0.9em; }
    .product-price { color: #2d8f2d; font-weight: bold; font-size: 1.1em; margin-top: 8px; }
    .featured-badge { background: #ffc107; color: #333; padding: 2px 8px; border-radius: 4px; }
  </style>
</head>
<body>
  <header>
    <h1>{% block header %}Store{% endblock %}</h1>
  </header>
  <div class="container">
    {% block content %}{% endblock %}
  </div>
  <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

Create `src/templates/store.html`:

```
{% extends "store-layout.html" %}

{% block title %}Our Store{% endblock %}
{% block header %}Our Store{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  <p class="stats">{{ products | length }} products, {{ featured_count }} featured</p>

  <div class="product-grid">
    {% for product in products %}
      <div class="product-card{{ product.featured ? ' featured' : '' }}">
        <p class="product-name">
          {{ product.name }}
          {% if product.featured %}
            <span class="featured-badge">Featured</span>
          {% endif %}
        </p>
        <p class="product-category">{{ product.category }}</p>
        <p class="product-price">${{ product.price | number_format(2) }}</p>
      </div>
    {% endfor %}
  </div>
</block content %>
```

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```

        </div>
    {% endfor %}
</div>
{% endblock %}

```

Create `src/routes/store.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/store", function ($request, $response) {
    $products = [
        ["name" => "Espresso Machine", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 299.99, "featured" => true],
        ["name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "featured" => false],
        ["name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "featured" => true],
        ["name" => "Noise-Canceling Headphones", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 199.99, "featured" => true],
        ["name" => "Water Bottle", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 24.99, "featured" => false],
    ];

    $featuredCount = count(array_filter($products, fn($p) => $p["featured"]));

    return $response->render("store.html", [
        "products" => $products,
        "featured_count" => $featuredCount
    ]);
});

```

Open <http://localhost:7145/store>. You see:

- A dark header reading "Our Store"
- Text: "5 products, 3 featured"
- Five product cards in a grid
- Three cards (Espresso Machine, Standing Desk, Noise-Canceling Headphones) have a yellow border, light yellow background, and a "Featured" badge
- Two cards (Yoga Mat, Water Bottle) have a white background with gray border
- Each card shows name, category, and price formatted to two decimal places

12. Gotchas

1. File not auto-discovered

Problem: You created a route file but the URL returns 404.

Cause: The file is not in `src/routes/`. It must be inside `src/routes/` (or a subdirectory), and the filename must end with `.php`.

Fix: Move the file to `src/routes/your-file.php`. Restart the server.

2. "Class not found" errors

Problem: `Class 'Tina4\Route' not found` or similar.

Cause: Missing `use` statement or ~~stale autoload.~~

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Fix: Start the file with `<?php` and include `use Tina4\Router;`. Run `composer dump-autoload` if the error persists.

3. JSON response shows HTML

Problem: Your JSON endpoint returns HTML.

Cause: You returned a string instead of using `$response->json()`. Plain strings are treated as HTML.

Fix: Use `$response->json($data)` for JSON endpoints. Never `echo json_encode($data)`.

4. Template not found

Problem: Template "my-page.html" not found.

Cause: The file is not in `src/templates/`, or the filename has a typo.

Fix: Check that the file exists at `src/templates/my-page.html`. The name in `$response->render()` is relative to `src/templates/`.

5. Port already in use

Problem: Error: Address already in use (port 7145).

Cause: Another process occupies port 7145.

Fix: Stop the other process, or change the port:

```
TINA4_PORT=8080
```

Or use the CLI flag: `tina4 serve --port 8080`.

6. Changes not reflected

Problem: You edited a file but the browser shows the old version.

Cause: Live reload may not be active. Browser caching can serve stale content.

Fix: Hard-refresh (`Ctrl+Shift+R` or `Cmd+Shift+R`). If that fails, restart the dev server.

7. .env not loaded

Problem: Environment variables have no effect.

Cause: The `.env` file must be at the project root (same directory as `composer.json`). A subdirectory will not work.

Fix: Move `.env` to the project root.

8. Debug mode in production

Problem: Your production site shows stack traces and query details.

Cause: `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in production.

Fix: Set `TINA4_DEBUG=false` in your production `.env`. This hides debug information, enables HTML minification, and activates `.broken` file health checks.

</div>

Routing

1. How Routing Works in Tina4

A URL arrives. The framework finds the function that handles it. The function runs. The result goes back. That mapping -- URL to code -- is routing.

In Tina4, routes live in PHP files inside `src/routes/`. Every `.php` file in that directory (and its subdirectories) is auto-loaded at startup. No registration file. No central config. Drop a file in. It works.

The simplest possible route:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/hello", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["message" => "Hello, World!"]);
});
```

Save that as `src/routes/hello.php`. Start the server. Visit <http://localhost:7145/hello>:

```
{"message": "Hello, World!"}
```

One line registers the route. One line handles the request.

2. HTTP Methods

Five methods. Five static calls on the `Route` class.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["action" => "list all products"]);
});

Router::post("/products", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["action" => "create a product"], 201);
})->noAuth();

Router::put("/products/{id}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    return $response->json(["action" => "replace product " . $id]);
})->noAuth();

Router::patch("/products/{id}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    return $response->json(["action" => "update product " . $id]);
})->noAuth();

Router::delete("/products/{id}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
```

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```
    return $response->json(["action" => "delete product " . $id]);
  }->noAuth();
```

Default auth policy. **POST**, **PUT**, **PATCH**, and **DELETE** are secured by default in Tina4 — without `->noAuth()` the examples below return **401 Unauthorized**. In production leave the defaults alone and send an **Authorization: Bearer <token>** header on write requests. For these Getting Started examples we chain `->noAuth()` so `curl` works without setting up auth first.

Test each one:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/products
{"action":"list all products"}

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/products \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Widget"}'
{"action":"create a product"}

curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/products/42
{"action":"replace product 42"}

curl -X PATCH http://localhost:7145/products/42
{"action":"update product 42"}

curl -X DELETE http://localhost:7145/products/42
{"action":"delete product 42"}
```

GET reads. **POST** creates. **PUT** replaces. **PATCH** patches. **DELETE** removes. REST convention. Predictable API.

HEAD and OPTIONS — automatic, no boilerplate

Tina4 handles **HEAD** and **OPTIONS** for you. **You don't register them.** They follow from your `Router::get(...)` / `Router::post(...)` / etc. routes:

- **HEAD** is identical to **GET** except the response carries no body (RFC 9110 §9.3.2). Every **GET** route automatically responds to **HEAD** — the framework strips the response body on the way out and preserves **Content-Length** pointing at the byte count the equivalent **GET** would have sent. Cache validators, link checkers, and uptime probes work without you writing anything.
- **OPTIONS** on any registered path returns **204 No Content** with an **Allow:** header listing every method the path supports (RFC 9110 §9.3.7).
- **Wrong method on an existing path** returns **405 Method Not Allowed** with the same **Allow:** header (RFC 9110 §15.5.6 + §10.2.1). Sending **PUT** to a **GET**-only route used to return **404** — semantically wrong and confusing for link checkers. Now you get a real **405**.
- **TRACE** and **CONNECT** are rejected with **405** (security default for origin servers).

```
# HEAD on a GET route – same headers, empty body
curl -sI http://localhost:7145/products
# HTTP/1.1 200 OK
# Content-Type: application/json
# Content-Length: 33
```

```
# OPTIONS – discover what the path supports
curl -sI -X OPTIONS http://localhost:7145/products
# HTTP/1.1 204 No Content
# Allow: GET, POST, HEAD, OPTIONS

# Wrong method – clear 405 with Allow header
curl -sI -X PUT http://localhost:7145/products
# HTTP/1.1 405 Method Not Allowed
# Allow: GET, POST, HEAD, OPTIONS
```

Explicit `Router::head()` and `Router::options()` registration

The automatic behaviour is enough for 95% of apps. When you need custom HEAD or OPTIONS handlers, register them explicitly:

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

// HEAD handler that doesn't run the full GET body – useful for
// expensive endpoints where the client only needs to check existence
// or read validators (ETag, Last-Modified).
Router::head("/expensive/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $response->header("ETag", computeEtag($request->params["id"]));
    return $response;
});

// OPTIONS handler that returns more than just Allow – for example
// a discovery endpoint.
Router::options("/api/discovery", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    return $response->json(["version" => "v1", "endpoints" => [...]]);
});
```

The framework still strips the response body for **HEAD** handlers (RFC 9110 §9.3.2 is a MUST), so you can't accidentally leak content even if your handler returns a body.

3. Path Parameters

Curly braces capture values from the URL.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/users/{id}/posts/{postId}", function ($request, $response) {
    $userId = $request->params["id"];
    $postId = $request->params["postId"];

    return $response->json([
        "user_id" => $userId,
        "post_id" => $postId
    ]);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/users/5/posts/99

{"user_id":"5", "post_id":"99"}
```

Notice: `user_id` came back as the string `"5"`, not the integer `5`. Path parameters are strings by default.

***Auto-casting:** Tina4 automatically casts path parameter values that are purely numeric to integers. For example, requesting `/users/42/posts/99` will give you `$request->params["id"]` as the integer `42` and `$request->params["postId"]` as the integer `99` -- no explicit `:int` type hint required. The `:int` type hint adds validation (rejecting non-numeric values with a 404), but the auto-casting happens regardless.*

Typed Parameters

Add a colon and a type to enforce constraints:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/orders/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"]; // This is now an integer
    return $response->json([
        "order_id" => $id,
        "type" => gettype($id)
    ]);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/orders/42

{"order_id":42,"type":"integer"}
```

Pass a non-integer and the route does not match. A 404 comes back instead:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/orders/abc

{"error":"Not found","path":"/orders/abc","status":404}
```

Supported types:

Type	Matches	Auto-cast	Example
<code>int</code>	Digits only	Integer	<code>{id:int}</code> matches <code>42</code> but not <code>abc</code>
<code>float</code>	Decimal numbers	Float	<code>{price:float}</code> matches <code>19.99</code>
<code>path</code>	All remaining path segments (catch-all)	String	<code>{slug:path}</code> matches <code>docs/api/auth</code>
<code>alpha</code>	Letters only	String	<code>{slug:alpha}</code> matches <code>hello</code> but not <code>hello123</code>
<code>alphanumeric</code>	Letters and digits	String	<code>{code:alphanumeric}</code> matches <code>abc123</code>

The `{name}` form (no type) matches any single path segment and returns it as a string.

Typed Parameters in Action

Here is a complete example showing the most commonly used typed parameters together:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

// Integer parameter -- only digits match, auto-cast to integer
Router::get("/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"]; // integer, e.g. 42
    return $response->json([
        "product_id" => $id,
        "type" => gettype($id)
    ]);
});

// Float parameter -- decimal numbers, auto-cast to float
Router::get("/products/{id:int}/price/{price:float}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $price = $request->params["price"];
    return $response->json([
        "product_id" => $id,
        "price" => $price,
        "type" => gettype($price)
    ]);
});

// Path parameter -- catch-all, captures remaining segments as a string
Router::get("/files/{filepath:path}", function ($request, $response) {
    $filepath = $request->params["filepath"];
    // filepath could be "images/photos/cat.jpg"
    return $response->json([
        "filepath" => $filepath,
        "type" => gettype($filepath)
    ]);
});

# Integer route -- matches digits, returns an integer
curl http://localhost:7145/products/42

{"product_id":42,"type":"integer"}

# Integer route -- non-integer gives a 404
curl http://localhost:7145/products/abc

{"error":"Not found","path":"/products/abc","status":404}

# Path catch-all -- captures everything after /files/
curl http://localhost:7145/files/images/photos/cat.jpg

{"filepath":"images/photos/cat.jpg","type":"string"}
```

The `:int` and `:float` types act as both a constraint and a converter. If the URL segment does not match the expected pattern, the route is skipped entirely and Tina4 moves on to the next registered route (or returns 404 if nothing matches). The `:path` type is greedy -- it consumes all remaining segments, making it ideal for file paths and documentation URLs.

4. Query Parameters

Key-value pairs after the `?` in a URL. Access them through `$request->params`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/search", function ($request, $response) {
    $q = $request->params["q"] ?? "";
    $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);
    $limit = (int) ($request->params["limit"] ?? 10);

    return $response->json([
        "query" => $q,
        "page" => $page,
        "limit" => $limit,
        "offset" => ($page - 1) * $limit
    ]);
});

curl "http://localhost:7145/search?q=keyboard&page=2&limit=20"

{"query":"keyboard","page":2,"limit":20,"offset":20}
```

Missing query parameters do not exist in the array. Always use the null coalescing operator (`??`) for defaults.

5. Route Groups

Shared prefix. No repetition.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::group("/api/v1", function () {

    Router::get("/users", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["users" => []]);
    });

    Router::get("/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $id = $request->params["id"];
        return $response->json(["user" => ["id" => $id, "name" => "Alice"]]);
    });

    Router::post("/users", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["created" => true], 201);
    });

    Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["products" => []]);
    });
});
```

These register as `/api/v1/users`, `/api/v1/users/{id}`, and `/api/v1/products`. Short paths inside the group. Tina4 prepends the prefix.

```
curl http://localhost:7145/api/v1/users
{"users":[]}

curl http://localhost:7145/api/v1/products
{"products":[]}
```

Groups nest:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::group("/api", function () {
    Router::group("/v1", function () {
        Router::get("/status", function ($request, $response) {
            return $response->json(["version" => "1.0"]);
        });
    });

    Router::group("/v2", function () {
        Router::get("/status", function ($request, $response) {
            return $response->json(["version" => "2.0"]);
        });
    });
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/v1/status
{"version":"1.0"}

curl http://localhost:7145/api/v2/status
{"version":"2.0"}
```

6. Middleware

Code that runs before or after your handler. Authentication, logging, rate limiting, input validation -- anything that should apply to multiple routes without polluting each handler.

Middleware on a Single Route

Pass the middleware name as the third argument:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

function logRequest($request, $response, $next) {
    $start = microtime(true);
    error_log "[" . date("Y-m-d H:i:s") . "] " . $request->method . " " . $request->path);

    $result = $next($request, $response);

    $duration = round((microtime(true) - $start) * 1000, 2);
    error_log(" Completed in " . $duration . "ms");

    return $result;
}
```

```
Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["data" => [1, 2, 3]]);
}, "logRequest");
```

The middleware receives `$request`, `$response`, and `$next`. Call `$next($request, $response)` to continue to the handler. Skip the call and the handler never runs -- the chain stops cold.

Blocking Middleware

A gate that checks for an API key:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

function requireApiKey($request, $response, $next) {
    $apiKey = $request->headers["X-API-Key"] ?? "";

    if ($apiKey !== "my-secret-key") {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid API key"], 401);
    }

    return $next($request, $response);
}

Router::get("/api/secret", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["secret" => "The answer is 42"]);
}, "requireApiKey");

curl http://localhost:7145/api/secret
{"error":"Invalid API key"}
```

Status: **401 Unauthorized**.

```
curl http://localhost:7145/api/secret -H "X-API-Key: my-secret-key"
{"secret":"The answer is 42"}
```

Middleware on a Group

Third argument to `Router::group()`. Every route inside inherits it.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

function requireAuth($request, $response, $next) {
    $token = $request->headers["Authorization"] ?? "";

    if (empty($token)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Authentication required"], 401);
    }

    return $next($request, $response);
}

Router::group("/api/admin", function () {

    Router::get("/dashboard", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["page" => "admin dashboard"]);
    });
```

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```

        Router::get("/users", function ($request, $response) {
            return $response->json(["page" => "user management"]);
        });

    }, "requireAuth");

```

No per-route repetition. The group handles it.

Multiple Middleware

Pass an array. They run in order.

```

Router::get("/api/important", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["data" => "important stuff"]);
}, ["logRequest", "requireApiKey", "requireAuth"]);

```

`logRequest` first, then `requireApiKey`, then `requireAuth`, then the handler. If any middleware skips `$next`, the chain stops there.

7. Route Decorators: `@noauth` and `@secured`

Two annotations for controlling authentication at the route level.

`@noauth` -- Public Routes

When your application has global authentication, `@noauth` exempts specific routes:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::get("/api/public/info", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "app" => "My Store",
        "version" => "1.0.0"
    ]);
});

```

The `@noauth` decorator tells Tina4 to skip authentication for this route, even if global auth middleware is configured.

`@secured` -- Protected GET Routes

`@secured` marks a GET route as requiring authentication:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    // $request->user is populated by the auth middleware
    return $response->json([
        "user" => $request->user
    ]);
});

```

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```
    });  
  });
```

The convention: **POST**, **PUT**, **PATCH**, and **DELETE** routes are secured by default. **GET** routes are public unless you add **@secured**. Reading is open. Writing requires proof.

8. Route Chaining: **secure()** and **cache()**

Routes return a chainable object. Two methods you can call on any route: **secure()** and **cache()**.

secure()

secure() requires a valid bearer token in the **Authorization** header. If the token is missing or invalid, the route returns **401 Unauthorized** without ever reaching your handler:

```
Router::get("/api/account", function ($request, $response) {  
    return $response->json(["account" => $request->user]);  
})->secure();  
  
curl http://localhost:7145/api/account  
# 401 Unauthorized  
  
curl http://localhost:7145/api/account -H "Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGci..."  
# 200 OK
```

This is a lighter alternative to **@secured** -- it works inline without a docblock annotation.

cache()

cache() enables response caching for the route. Once the handler runs and produces a response, subsequent requests to the same URL return the cached result without re-executing the handler:

```
Router::get("/api/catalog", function ($request, $response) {  
    // Expensive database query  
    return $response->json(["products" => $products]);  
})->cache();
```

Chaining Both

Chain **secure()** and **cache()** together on the same route:

```
Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {  
    return $response->json(["data" => $data]);  
})->secure()->cache();
```

This route requires a bearer token and caches the response. Order does not matter -- **->cache()->secure()** produces the same result.

9. Wildcard and Catch-All Routes

Wildcard Routes

Use `{name:path}` at the end of a path to capture everything after it:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/docs/{path:path}", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "section" => "docs",
        "path" => $request->params["path"]
    ]);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/docs/getting-started
{"section":"docs","path":"getting-started"}

curl http://localhost:7145/docs/api/authentication/jwt
{"section":"docs","path":"api/authentication/jwt"}
```

Catch-All Route (Custom 404)

Handle any unmatched URL:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/{path:path}", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "error" => "Page not found",
        "path" => $request->params["path"]
    ], 404);
});
```

Define this last. Tina4 matches routes in registration order -- first match wins. Place this in a file that sorts alphabetically after your other route files, or it will shadow everything.

You can also create a custom 404 template at `src/templates/errors/404.twig`:

```
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}Not Found{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>404 - Page Not Found</h1>
    <p>The page you are looking for does not exist.</p>
    <a href="/">Go back home</a>
{% endblock %}
```

Tina4 uses this template for any unmatched route when the file exists.

10. Route Listing via CLI

Your application grows. You need ~~a map~~. The CLI provides one.

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```
tina4 routes
```

Method	Path	Middleware	Auth
-----	----	-----	----
GET	/hello	-	public
GET	/products	-	public
POST	/products	-	secured
PUT	/products/{id}	-	secured
PATCH	/products/{id}	-	secured
DELETE	/products/{id}	-	secured
GET	/api/v1/users	-	public
GET	/api/v1/users/{id:int}	-	public
POST	/api/v1/users	-	secured
GET	/api/admin/dashboard	requireAuth	public
GET	/api/admin/users	requireAuth	public
GET	/api/public/info	-	@noauth
GET	/api/profile	-	@secured
GET	/search	-	public
GET	/docs/*	-	public

Filter by method:

```
tina4 routes --method POST
```

Method	Path	Middleware	Auth
-----	----	-----	----
POST	/products	-	secured
POST	/api/v1/users	-	secured

Search for a path pattern:

```
tina4 routes --filter users
```

Method	Path	Middleware	Auth
-----	----	-----	----
GET	/api/v1/users	-	public
GET	/api/v1/users/{id:int}	-	public
POST	/api/v1/users	-	secured
GET	/api/admin/users	requireAuth	public

11. Organizing Route Files

Tina4 loads every `.php` file in `src/routes/` recursively. The directory structure is yours to organize. Two common patterns:

Pattern 1: One File Per Resource

```
src/routes/
■■■ products.php    # All product routes
■■■ users.php       # All user routes
■■■ orders.php      # All order routes
■■■ pages.php       # HTML page routes
```

Pattern 2: Subdirectories by Feature

```
src/routes/
├── api/
│   ├── products.php
│   ├── users.php
│   └── orders.php
├── admin/
│   ├── dashboard.php
│   └── settings.php
└── pages/
    ├── home.php
    └── about.php
```

Both work identically. The directory structure has no effect on URL paths -- only the route definitions inside the files matter. Pick whichever pattern keeps your project navigable.

12. Exercise: Build a Full CRUD API for Products

Build a REST API for managing products. All data stored in a PHP array. No database yet -- Chapter 5 handles that.

Requirements

Create `src/routes/product-api.php` with these routes:

Method	Path	Description
GET	<code>/api/products</code>	List all products. Support <code>?category=</code> filter.
GET	<code>/api/products/{id:int}</code>	Get a single product by ID. Return 404 if not found.
POST	<code>/api/products</code>	Create a new product. Return 201.
PUT	<code>/api/products/{id:int}</code>	Replace a product. Return 404 if not found.
DELETE	<code>/api/products/{id:int}</code>	Delete a product. Return 204 with no body.

Each product: `id` (int), `name` (string), `category` (string), `price` (float), `in_stock` (bool).

Seed data:

```
$products = [
    ["id" => 1, "name" => "Wireless Keyboard", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 79.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 2, "name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 3, "name" => "Coffee Grinder", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 49.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 4, "name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 5, "name" => "Running Shoes", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 119.99, "in_stock" => true]
];
```

Test with:

```
# List all
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products

# Filter by category
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products?category=Fitness"

# Get one
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/3

# Create
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/products \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Desk Lamp", "category": "Office", "price": 39.99, "in_stock": true}'

# Update
curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/api/products/3 \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Burr Coffee Grinder", "category": "Kitchen", "price": 59.99, "in_stock": true}'

# Delete
curl -X DELETE http://localhost:7145/api/products/3

# Not found
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/999
```

13. Solution

Create `src/routes/product-api.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

// In-memory product store (resets on server restart)
$products = [
    ["id" => 1, "name" => "Wireless Keyboard", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 79.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 2, "name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 3, "name" => "Coffee Grinder", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 49.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 4, "name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ["id" => 5, "name" => "Running Shoes", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 119.99, "in_stock" => true],
];

$nextId = 6;

// List all products, optionally filter by category
Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) use (&$products) {
    $category = $request->params["category"] ?? null;

    if ($category !== null) {
        $filtered = array_values(array_filter(
            $products,
            fn($p) => strtolower($p["category"]) === strtolower($category)
        ));
        return $response->json(["products" => $filtered, "count" => count($filtered)]);
    }
}
```

```

        return $response->json(["products" => $products, "count" => count($products)]);
    });

// Get a single product by ID
Router::get("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) use (&$products) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    foreach ($products as $product) {
        if ($product["id"] === $id) {
            return $response->json($product);
        }
    }

    return $response->json(["error" => "Product not found", "id" => $id], 404);
});

// Create a new product
Router::post("/api/products", function ($request, $response) use (&$products, &$nextId) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["name"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Name is required"], 400);
    }

    $product = [
        "id" => $nextId++,
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "category" => $body["category"] ?? "Uncategorized",
        "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 0),
        "in_stock" => (bool) ($body["in_stock"] ?? true)
    ];

    $products[] = $product;

    return $response->json($product, 201);
});

// Replace a product
Router::put("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) use (&$products) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    foreach ($products as $index => $product) {
        if ($product["id"] === $id) {
            $products[$index] = [
                "id" => $id,
                "name" => $body["name"] ?? $product["name"],
                "category" => $body["category"] ?? $product["category"],
                "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? $product["price"]),
                "in_stock" => (bool) ($body["in_stock"] ?? $product["in_stock"])
            ];
            return $response->json($products[$index]);
        }
    }

    return $response->json(["error" => "Product not found", "id" => $id], 404);
});

// Delete a product

```

```
Router::delete("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) use (&$products) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    foreach ($products as $index => $product) {
        if ($product["id"] === $id) {
            array_splice($products, $index, 1);
            return $response->json(null, 204);
        }
    }

    return $response->json(["error" => "Product not found", "id" => $id], 404);
});
```

Expected output for the test commands:

List all:

```
{"products":[{"id":1,"name":"Wireless Keyboard","category":"Electronics","price":79.99,"in_stock":true}]}
```

Filter by category:

```
{"products":[{"id":2,"name":"Yoga Mat","category":"Fitness","price":29.99,"in_stock":true},{id":1,"name":"Wireless Keyboard","category":"Electronics","price":79.99,"in_stock":true}]}
```

Get one:

```
{"id":3,"name":"Coffee Grinder","category":"Kitchen","price":49.99,"in_stock":false}
```

Create:

```
{"id":6,"name":"Desk Lamp","category":"Office","price":39.99,"in_stock":true}
```

(Status: **201 Created**)

Update:

```
{"id":3,"name":"Burr Coffee Grinder","category":"Kitchen","price":59.99,"in_stock":true}
```

Delete: empty response with status **204 No Content**.

Not found:

```
{"error":"Product not found","id":999}
```

(Status: **404 Not Found**)

14. Gotchas

1. Trailing Slashes Are Normalised

Tina4 strips trailing slashes automatically. Both `/products` and `/products/` match the same route. You do not need to register both or configure anything — it just works.

2. Parameter Names Must Be Unique in a Path

Problem: `/users/{id}/posts/{id}` produces wrong results -- the second `{id}` overwrites the first.

Fix: Use distinct names: `/users/{userId}/posts/{postId}`.

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3. Method Conflicts

Problem: `Router::get("/items/{id}", ...)` and `Router::get("/items/{action}", ...)` collide. The wrong handler runs.

Cause: Both patterns match `/items/42`. First registration wins.

Fix: Use typed parameters to disambiguate: `Router::get("/items/{id:int}", ...)` matches only integers, leaving `/items/export` free. Or restructure: `/items/{id:int}` and `/items/actions/{action}`.

4. Route Handler Must Return a Response

Problem: The handler runs but the browser shows empty or 500.

Cause: No `return` statement. Without `return`, the handler returns `null`. Tina4 has nothing to send.

Fix: Every handler must return something. `return $response->json(...)`, `return $response->html(...)`, `return $response->render(...)`.

5. Route Files Must Start with `<?php`

Problem: Route file is ignored. No errors. No routes registered.

Cause: Missing PHP opening tag. Without `<?php`, the file is not parsed.

Fix: First line of every route file: `<?php`.

6. Middleware Uses Class-Based Pattern

Problem: Passing a function name string as middleware doesn't work.

Fix: Use class-based middleware with `before*/after*` static methods. See Chapter 10 for the full middleware pattern:

```
class AuthMiddleware {
    public static function beforeAuth($request, $response) {
        if (!$request->headers['authorization']) {
            return [$request, $response->json(["error" => "Unauthorized"], 401)];
        }
        return [$request, $response];
    }
}
Router::use(AuthMiddleware::class);
```

7. Group Prefix Normalisation

Tina4 auto-normalises group prefixes — it prepends `/` if missing and strips trailing slashes. `Router::group("api/v1", ...)` and `Router::group("/api/v1", ...)` both work. However, for clarity, always start with `/`.

Request & Response

1. The Two Objects You Always Get

Every route handler receives two arguments. `$request` carries what the client sent. `$response` builds what goes back. These two objects are the entire HTTP conversation.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/echo", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "method" => $request->method,
        "path" => $request->path,
        "your_ip" => $request->ip
    ]);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/echo

{"method":"GET", "path":"/echo", "your_ip":"127.0.0.1"}
```

The pattern never changes. Read the request. Build the response. Return it.

2. The Request Object

The `$request` object holds everything the client sent. Here is the full inventory.

method

The HTTP method as an uppercase string: "GET", "POST", "PUT", "PATCH", or "DELETE".

```
$request->method // "GET"
```

path

The URL path, stripped of query parameters:

```
// Request to /api/users?page=2
$request->path // "/api/users"
```

params

Path parameters captured from the URL pattern (see Chapter 2):

```
// Route: /users/{id}/posts/{postId}
// Request: /users/5/posts/42
$request->params["id"] // "5" (or 5 if typed as {id:int})
$request->params["postId"] // "42"
```

query

Query string parameters. An associative array:

```
// Request: /search?q=keyboard&page=2&sort=price
$request->query["q"] // "keyboard"
```

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```
$request->query["page"] // "2"
$request->query["sort"] // "price"
```

The `queryParam()` helper provides a default value when a key is missing:

```
$request->queryParam("q") // "keyboard"
$request->queryParam("missing", "N/A") // "N/A"
```

body

The parsed request body. JSON requests become associative arrays. Form submissions contain form fields:

```
// POST with {"name": "Widget", "price": 9.99}
$request->body["name"] // "Widget"
$request->body["price"] // 9.99
```

headers

Request headers as an associative array. Keys are normalised to **lowercase**:

```
$request->headers["content-type"] // "application/json"
$request->headers["authorization"] // "Bearer eyJhbGci..."
$request->headers["x-custom"] // "my-value"
```

The `header()` helper method is the preferred way to read a single header. It accepts any casing and handles the lowercase lookup for you:

```
$request->header("Content-Type") // "application/json"
$request->header("Authorization") // "Bearer eyJhbGci..."
$request->header("X-Custom") // "my-value"
$request->header("Missing") // null
```

ip

The client's IP address:

```
$request->ip // "127.0.0.1"
```

Tina4 respects **X-Forwarded-For** and **X-Real-IP** headers behind a reverse proxy.

cookies

Cookies the client sent:

```
$request->cookies["session_id"] // "abc123"
$request->cookies["preferences"] // "dark-mode"
```

files

Uploaded files (section 7 covers this in detail):

```
$request->files["avatar"] // File object with name, type, size, tmpPath
```

Inspecting the Full Request

A diagnostic route that dumps everything:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/debug/request", function ($request, $response) {
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```

```

        return $response->json([
            "method" => $request->method,
            "path" => $request->path,
            "params" => $request->params,
            "query" => $request->query,
            "body" => $request->body,
            "headers" => $request->headers,
            "ip" => $request->ip,
            "cookies" => $request->cookies
        ]);
    });

curl -X POST "http://localhost:7145/debug/request?page=1" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "X-Custom: hello" \
-d '{"name": "test"}'

{
  "method": "POST",
  "path": "/debug/request",
  "params": {},
  "query": {"page": "1"},
  "body": {"name": "test"},
  "headers": {
    "content-type": "application/json",
    "x-custom": "hello",
    "host": "localhost:7145",
    "user-agent": "curl/8.4.0",
    "accept": "*/*",
    "content-length": "16"
  },
  "ip": "127.0.0.1",
  "cookies": {}
}
---
```

3. The Response Object

The `$response` object shapes what travels back to the client. Every method returns the response object, so calls chain.

`json()` -- JSON Response

The API workhorse. Pass an array. It becomes JSON:

```

return $response->json(["name" => "Alice", "age" => 30]);

{"name":"Alice","age":30}
```

Second argument sets the status code:

```

return $response->json(["id" => 7, "name" => "Widget"], 201);
```

201 Created with the JSON body.

`html()` -- Raw HTML Response

Return raw HTML:

```
return $response->html("<h1>Hello</h1><p>This is HTML.</p>");
```

Sets **Content-Type**: `text/html; charset=utf-8`.

text() -- Plain Text Response

```
return $response->text("Just a plain string.");
```

Sets **Content-Type**: `text/plain; charset=utf-8`.

render() -- Template Response

Render a Frond template with data (Chapter 4 goes deep):

```
return $response->render("products.html", [
    "products" => $products,
    "title" => "Our Products"
]);
```

Tina4 finds the template in `src/templates/`, renders it, returns the HTML.

redirect() -- Redirect Response

Send the client somewhere else:

```
return $response->redirect("/login");
```

302 Found by default. For permanent redirects:

```
return $response->redirect("/new-location", 301);
```

file() -- File Download Response

Push a file to the client:

```
return $response->file("/path/to/report.pdf");
```

Tina4 sets the correct **Content-Type** from the file extension and adds **Content-Disposition** so the browser downloads instead of displaying.

Custom filename:

```
return $response->file("/path/to/report.pdf", "monthly-report-march-2026.pdf");
```

4. Status Codes

Every response method accepts a status code. Here are the ones you reach for most:

Code	Meaning	When to Use
200	OK	Default. Successful GET, PUT, PATCH.
201	Created	Successful POST that created a resource.

204	No Content	Successful DELETE. No body needed.
301	Moved Permanently	URL has permanently changed.
302	Found	Temporary redirect.
400	Bad Request	Invalid input from the client.
401	Unauthorized	Missing or invalid authentication.
403	Forbidden	Authenticated but not allowed.
404	Not Found	Resource does not exist.
409	Conflict	Duplicate or conflicting data.
413	Payload Too Large	Request body or file exceeds the size limit.
422	Unprocessable Entity	Valid JSON but fails business rules.
500	Internal Server Error	Something broke on the server.

You can also chain `status()` explicitly:

```
return $response->status(201)->json(["id" => 7, "created" => true]);
```

Same result as `$response->json(["id" => 7, "created" => true], 201)`. Pick whichever reads cleaner in context.

HTTP Status Constants

Tina4 exports named constants for every status code. Use them instead of raw integers -- the intent reads at a glance and you avoid typos like 419 when you meant 401:

```
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/widgets/{id}", function ($request, $response) {
    $widget = Widget::load(["id" => $request->params["id"]]);

    if (!$widget->exists()) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Widget not found"], \Tina4\HTTP_NOT_FOUND);
    }

    return $response->json($widget->asArray(), \Tina4\HTTP_OK);
});
```

Available constants (all in the `\Tina4` namespace):

Status	Constant	Status	Constant
--------	----------	--------	----------

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200	HTTP_OK	404	HTTP_NOT_FOUND
201	HTTP_CREATED	405	HTTP_METHOD_NOT_ALLOWED
202	HTTP_ACCEPTED	409	HTTP_CONFLICT
204	HTTP_NO_CONTENT	410	HTTP_GONE
301	HTTP_MOVED_PERMANENTLY	422	HTTP_UNPROCESSABLE
302	HTTP_FOUND	429	HTTP_TOO_MANY
304	HTTP_NOT_MODIFIED	500	HTTP_INTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR
400	HTTP_BAD_REQUEST	502	HTTP_BAD_GATEWAY
401	HTTP_UNAUTHORIZED	503	HTTP_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE
403	HTTP_FORBIDDEN	504	HTTP_GATEWAY_TIMEOUT

Content-Type Constants

For non-JSON responses, pair a status constant with a content-type constant. Tina4 also supports a three-argument response form that sets body, status, and content type in one call:

```
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/legacy-feed", function ($request, $response) {
    $xml = "<feed><item>...</item></feed>";
    return $response($xml, \Tina4\HTTP_OK, \Tina4\APPLICATION_XML);
})->noAuth();
```

Content-type constants:

Constant	Value
APPLICATION_JSON	application/json
APPLICATION_XML	application/xml
APPLICATION_FORM	application/x-www-form-urlencoded
APPLICATION_OCTET_STREAM	application/octet-stream
TEXT_HTML	text/html
TEXT_PLAIN	text/plain
TEXT_CSV	text/csv
TEXT_XML	text/xml

Using constants also makes your code grep-friendly -- searching for `HTTP_BAD_REQUEST` across the codebase finds every validation branch, where searching for `400` finds false positives (file sizes, timeouts, anything with the number 400 in it).

5. Custom Headers

Set response headers with `header()`:

```
Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response
        ->header("X-Request-Id", uniqid())
        ->header("X-Rate-Limit-Remaining", "57")
        ->header("Cache-Control", "no-cache")
        ->json(["data" => [1, 2, 3]]);
});

curl -v http://localhost:7145/api/data 2>&1 | grep "< X-"

< X-Request-Id: 65f3a7b8c1234
< X-Rate-Limit-Remaining: 57
```

Convention: **Title-Case** for custom headers. Prefix with **X-**.

CORS Headers

Tina4 handles CORS from `CORS_ORIGINS` in `.env`. The default `*` allows all origins. Lock it down for production:

```
CORS_ORIGINS=https://myapp.com,https://admin.myapp.com
```

Manual CORS headers are rarely needed. They are available when you need them:

```
return $response
    ->header("Access-Control-Allow-Origin", "https://myapp.com")
    ->header("Access-Control-Allow-Methods", "GET, POST, PUT, DELETE")
    ->header("Access-Control-Allow-Headers", "Content-Type, Authorization")
    ->json(["data" => "value"]);
```

6. Cookies

Set cookies on the response:

```
Router::post("/login", function ($request, $response) {
    // After validating credentials...
    return $response
        ->cookie("session_id", "abc123xyz", [
            "httpOnly" => true,
            "secure" => true,
            "sameSite" => "Strict",
            "maxAge" => 3600,          // 1 hour in seconds
            "path" => "/"
        ])
        ->json(["message" => "Logged in"]);
});
```

Cookie options:

Option	Type	Default	Description
<code>httpOnly</code>	bool	<code>false</code>	Invisible to JavaScript
<code>secure</code>	bool	<code>false</code>	HTTPS only
<code>sameSite</code>	string	<code>"Lax"</code>	<code>"Strict"</code> , <code>"Lax"</code> , or <code>"None"</code>
<code>maxAge</code>	int	session	Lifetime in seconds
<code>path</code>	string	<code>"/"</code>	URL path scope
<code>domain</code>	string	current	Domain scope

Read cookies from the request:

```
Router::get("/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    $sessionId = $request->cookies["session_id"] ?? null;

    if ($sessionId === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Not logged in"], 401);
    }

    return $response->json(["session" => $sessionId]);
});
```

Delete a cookie by setting `maxAge` to 0:

```
return $response
    ->cookie("session_id", "", ["maxAge" => 0, "path" => "/"])
    ->json(["message" => "Logged out"]);
```

7. File Uploads

Uploaded files land in `$request->files`. Each file is an object with metadata and a temporary path.

Handling a Single File Upload

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/api/upload", function ($request, $response) {
    if (empty($request->files["image"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "No file uploaded"], 400);
    }

    $file = $request->files["image"];

    return $response->json([
        "name" => $file["filename"],          // "photo.jpg"
        "type" => $file["type"],              // "image/jpeg"
        "size" => $file["size"],              // 245760 (bytes)
        "tmp_path" => $file["tmp_name"]      // Temporary file location
    ]);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/upload \
-F "image=@/path/to/photo.jpg"

{
    "name": "photo.jpg",
    "type": "image/jpeg",
    "size": 245760,
    "tmp_path": "/tmp/tina4_upload_abc123"
}
```

Saving the Uploaded File

The file sits in a temporary location. Move it to permanent storage:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/api/upload", function ($request, $response) {
    if (empty($request->files["image"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "No file uploaded"], 400);
    }

    $file = $request->files["image"];

    // Validate file type
    $allowedTypes = ["image/jpeg", "image/png", "image/gif", "image/webp"];
    if (!in_array($file["type"], $allowedTypes)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid file type. Allowed: JPEG, PNG, GIF, WebP"],
    }

    // Validate file size (max 5MB)
    $maxSize = 5 * 1024 * 1024;
    if ($file["size"] > $maxSize) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "File too large. Maximum size: 5MB"], 400);
    }

    // Generate a unique filename
    $extension = pathinfo($file["filename"], PATHINFO_EXTENSION);
    $filename = uniqid("img_") . "." . $extension;
    $destination = __DIR__ . "/../public/uploads/" . $filename;

```

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```

// Ensure the uploads directory exists
if (!is_dir(dirname($destination))) {
    mkdir(dirname($destination), 0755, true);
}

// Move the file
rename($file["tmp_name"], $destination);

return $response->json([
    "message" => "File uploaded successfully",
    "filename" => $filename,
    "url" => "/uploads/" . $filename,
    "size" => $file["size"]
], 201);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/upload \
-F "image=@/path/to/photo.jpg"

{
    "message": "File uploaded successfully",
    "filename": "img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg",
    "url": "/uploads/img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg",
    "size": 245760
}

```

The file is now available at http://localhost:7145/uploads/img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg.

Handling Multiple Files

When the form uses **multiple** or has multiple file inputs:

```

Router::post("/api/upload-many", function ($request, $response) {
    $results = [];

    foreach ($request->files as $key => $file) {
        $extension = pathinfo($file["filename"], PATHINFO_EXTENSION);
        $filename = uniqid("file_") . "." . $extension;
        $destination = __DIR__ . "/../public/uploads/" . $filename;

        if (!is_dir(dirname($destination))) {
            mkdir(dirname($destination), 0755, true);
        }

        rename($file["tmp_name"], $destination);

        $results[] = [
            "original_name" => $file["filename"],
            "saved_as" => $filename,
            "url" => "/uploads/" . $filename
        ];
    }

    return $response->json(["uploaded" => $results, "count" => count($results)], 201);
});

---
```

8. File Downloads

Send files to the client with `$response->file()`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/reports/{filename}", function ($request, $response) {
    $filename = $request->params["filename"];
    $filepath = __DIR__ . "/../../data/reports/" . $filename;

    if (!file_exists($filepath)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Report not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->file($filepath);
});
```

The browser downloads the file. Tina4 detects the MIME type from the extension and sets headers accordingly.

Force a specific download filename:

```
return $response->file($filepath, "Q1-2026-Sales-Report.pdf");
```

9. Content Negotiation

One endpoint serves multiple formats. The `Accept` header decides which one:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $product = [
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => "Wireless Keyboard",
        "price" => 79.99
    ];

    $accept = $request->header("Accept") ?? "application/json";

    if (strpos($accept, "text/html") !== false) {
        return $response->render("product-detail.html", ["product" => $product]);
    }

    if (strpos($accept, "text/plain") !== false) {
        $text = "Product #" . $id . ": " . $product["name"] . " - $" . $product["price"];
        return $response->text($text);
    }

    // Default: JSON
    return $response->json($product);
});

# JSON (default)
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/1
```

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```

{"id":1,"name":"Wireless Keyboard","price":79.99}

# Plain text
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/1 -H "Accept: text/plain"

Product #1: Wireless Keyboard - $79.99

# HTML (renders the template)
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/1 -H "Accept: text/html"

<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>...rendered template...</html>

---
```

10. Input Validation

Tina4 ships a **Validator** class for declarative input validation. Chain rules. Check the result. When validation fails, `$response->error()` returns a structured error envelope.

The Validator Class

```

use Tina4\Validator;

Router::post("/api/users", function ($request, $response) {
    $v = new Validator($request->body);
    $v->required("name")->required("email")->email("email")->minLength("name", 2);

    if (!$v->isValid()) {
        return $response->error("VALIDATION_FAILED", $v->errors()[0]["message"], 400);
    }

    // proceed with valid data
});
```

The **Validator** takes the request body (an associative array) and exposes chainable methods:

Method	Description
<code>required(field)</code>	Field must be present and non-empty
<code>email(field)</code>	Field must be a valid email address
<code>minLength(field, n)</code>	Field must have at least n characters
<code>maxLength(field, n)</code>	Field must have at most n characters
<code>numeric(field)</code>	Field must be a number
<code>inList(field, values)</code>	Field must be one of the allowed values

Call `$v->isValid()` to check all rules. Call `$v->errors()` to get the list of failures, each with a **field** and **message** key.

The Error Response Envelope

`$response->error()` returns a consistent JSON error envelope:

```

return $response->error("VALIDATION_FAILED", "Name is required", 400);
```

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This produces:

```
{"error": true, "code": "VALIDATION_FAILED", "message": "Name is required", "status": 400}
```

Three arguments: an error code string, a human-readable message, and the HTTP status code. Use this pattern across your API. Consistent error shapes save frontend developers hours of guesswork.

Upload Size Limits

Tina4 enforces a maximum upload size through the `TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE` environment variable. The value is in bytes. Default: `10485760` (10 MB).

```
TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE=10485760
```

A file exceeding this limit triggers a `413 Payload Too Large` response before your handler runs. To allow larger uploads, increase the value in `.env`:

```
TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE=52428800
```

This sets the limit to 50 MB.

11. Exercise: Build an Image Upload API

Two endpoints. One accepts images. The other serves them back.

Requirements

Method	Path	Description
POST	<code>/api/images</code>	Upload an image. Validate type and size. Return the image URL.
GET	<code>/api/images/{filename}</code>	Return the uploaded image file. 404 if not found.

Rules:

- Accept JPEG, PNG, and WebP only
- Maximum file size: 2MB
- Save to `src/public/uploads/` with a unique filename
- Return original filename, saved filename, file size in KB, and URL
- The GET endpoint serves the raw file, not JSON

Test with:

```
# Upload
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/images \
  -F "image=@/path/to/photo.jpg"

# Download
curl http://localhost:7145/api/images/img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg --output downloaded.jpg
```

12. Solution

Create `src/routes/images.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/api/images", function ($request, $response) {
    // Check if a file was uploaded
    if (empty($request->files["image"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "No image file provided. Use field name 'image'."], 400);
    }

    $file = $request->files["image"];

    // Validate file type
    $allowedTypes = ["image/jpeg", "image/png", "image/webp"];
    if (!in_array($file["type"], $allowedTypes)) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Invalid file type",
            "received" => $file["type"],
            "allowed" => $allowedTypes
        ], 400);
    }

    // Validate file size (max 2MB)
    $maxSize = 2 * 1024 * 1024;
    if ($file["size"] > $maxSize) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "File too large",
            "size_bytes" => $file["size"],
            "max_bytes" => $maxSize
        ], 400);
    }

    // Generate unique filename preserving extension
    $extension = pathinfo($file["filename"], PATHINFO_EXTENSION);
    $savedName = uniqid("img_") . "." . strtolower($extension);
    $uploadDir = __DIR__ . "/../public/uploads";
    $destination = $uploadDir . "/" . $savedName;

    // Create uploads directory if it does not exist
    if (!is_dir($uploadDir)) {
        mkdir($uploadDir, 0755, true);
    }

    // Move the uploaded file
    rename($file["tmp_name"], $destination);
}
```

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```

        return $response->json([
            "message" => "Image uploaded successfully",
            "original_name" => $file["filename"],
            "saved_name" => $savedName,
            "size_kb" => round($file["size"] / 1024, 1),
            "type" => $file["type"],
            "url" => "/uploads/" . $savedName
        ], 201);
    });

    Router::get("/api/images/{filename}", function ($request, $response) {
        $filename = $request->params["filename"];

        // Prevent directory traversal
        if (strpos($filename, "..") !== false || strpos($filename, "/") !== false) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid filename"], 400);
        }

        $filepath = __DIR__ . "/../..public/uploads/" . $filename;

        if (!file_exists($filepath)) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Image not found", "filename" => $filename], 404);
        }

        return $response->file($filepath);
    });

```

Expected output for upload:

```

{
  "message": "Image uploaded successfully",
  "original_name": "photo.jpg",
  "saved_name": "img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg",
  "size_kb": 240.0,
  "type": "image/jpeg",
  "url": "/uploads/img_65f3a7b8c1234.jpg"
}

```

(Status: 201 Created)

Expected output for invalid type:

```

{
  "error": "Invalid file type",
  "received": "application/pdf",
  "allowed": ["image/jpeg", "image/png", "image/webp"]
}

```

(Status: 400 Bad Request)

Expected output for file too large:

```

{
  "error": "File too large",
  "size_bytes": 5242880,
  "max_bytes": 2097152
}

```

(Status: 400 Bad Request)

The **GET endpoint** returns the raw image file with the correct **Content-Type** header. The browser renders it. Curl with **--output** saves it to disk.

13. Gotchas

1. Forgetting **return**

Problem: The handler runs (log output confirms it) but the browser gets an empty response or 500.

Cause: `$response->json(...)` without **return**. The response object builds the reply but nobody sends it.

Fix: `return $response->json(...)`. Always.

2. Body Is Null for JSON Requests

Problem: `$request->body` is **null** or empty despite sending JSON.

Cause: Missing **Content-Type: application/json** header. Without it, Tina4 does not parse the body as JSON.

Fix: Include **-H "Content-Type: application/json"** with curl. In JavaScript `fetch()`, set `headers: {"Content-Type": "application/json"}`.

3. Content-Type Mismatch

Problem: `$response->json()` returns HTML, or `$response->html()` returns plain text.

Cause: A middleware or error handler overwrites the response. Or you returned a string instead of using a response method.

Fix: Use `$response->json(...)`, `$response->html(...)`, or another response method. Never **echo** -- it bypasses the response object.

4. File Uploads Return Empty

Problem: `$request->files` is empty despite uploading a file.

Cause: The form lacks **enctype="multipart/form-data"**, or curl uses **-d** instead of **-F**.

Fix: HTML forms: `<form enctype="multipart/form-data">`. Curl: **-F "field=@file.jpg"** (with @), not **-d**.

5. Redirect Loops

Problem: The browser shows "too many redirects."

Cause: Route A redirects to Route B. Route B redirects back to Route A. Common with login guards: `/login` redirects to `/dashboard`, `/dashboard` redirects to `/login` because the user is not authenticated.

Fix: Trace the redirect chain in your browser's network inspector. Make sure the auth check does not redirect authenticated users away from pages they should access.

6. Cookie Not Set

Problem: `$response->cookie(...)` runs but the browser shows no cookie.

Cause: `secure` is `true`. The cookie only travels over HTTPS. Local development uses `http://localhost`. The cookie is silently dropped.

Fix: Set `"secure" => false` during development. Or use `"secure" => ($ENV["TINA4_DEBUG"] ?? "false") !== "true"` to auto-switch.

7. Large Request Body Rejected

Problem: POST requests with large bodies return 413.

Cause: Request body exceeds the configured maximum.

Fix: Increase `TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE` in `.env`. Default is `10mb`. For file upload endpoints, you may need `50mb` or more:

```
TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE=50mb
```

Templates

1. Why Templates

In Chapter 1, `$response->render("products.html", $data)` produced a full HTML page. **FronD** did the rendering -- Tina4's built-in template engine. Zero dependencies. Twig-compatible syntax. If you know Twig, Jinja2, or Nunjucks, you know 90% of FronD.

Templates live in `src/templates/`. Call `$response->render("page.html", $data)`. FronD loads the file, processes tags and expressions, returns final HTML.

This chapter covers every feature. After reading it, you build real pages.

2. Variables and Expressions

Double curly braces output a variable:

```
<h1>Hello, {{ name }}!</h1>
```

Route handler:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/welcome", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->render("welcome.html", [
        "name" => "Alice"
    ]);
});
```

Create `src/templates/welcome.html`:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head><title>Welcome</title></head>
<body>
    <h1>Hello, {{ name }}!</h1>
</body>
</html>
```

Output:

Hello, Alice!

Accessing Nested Data

Dot notation reaches into nested arrays:

```
$data = [
    "user" => [
        "name" => "Alice",
        "email" => "alice@example.com",
        "address" => [
            "city" => "Cape Town",
            "country" => "South Africa"
```

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```

        ]
    ]
};

return $response->render("profile.html", $data);

<p>{{ user.name }} lives in {{ user.address.city }}, {{ user.address.country }}.</p>

```

Output:

Alice lives in Cape Town, South Africa.

Method Calls on Values

When a variable is an object or an array containing a callable, you can call methods directly in dot notation:

```

<p>{{ user.getName() }}</p>
<p>{{ translator.t("welcome_message") }}</p>
<p>{{ cart.total() }}</p>

```

Arguments are passed as normal function arguments. This works on both objects (calls the method) and arrays (calls the callable stored at that key).

Expressions

Basic arithmetic and string concatenation work inside `{{ }}`:

```

<p>Total: ${{ price * quantity }}</p>
<p>Discounted: ${{ price * 0.9 }}</p>
<p>Full name: {{ first_name ~ " " ~ last_name }}</p>

```

The `~` operator concatenates strings.

3. Template Inheritance

The headline feature. Define a base layout once. Extend it everywhere.

Base Layout

Create `src/templates/base.twig`:

```

<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
    <title>{% block title %}My App{% endblock %}</title>
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
    {% block head %}{% endblock %}
</head>
<body>
    <nav>
        <a href="/">Home</a>
        <a href="/about">About</a>
        <a href="/contact">Contact</a>
    </nav>

```

```

<main>
    {% block content %}{% endblock %}
</main>

<footer>
    <p>&copy; 2026 My App. All rights reserved.</p>
</footer>

<script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
{% block scripts %}{% endblock %}
</body>
</html>

```

Four blocks: **title**, **head**, **content**, **scripts**. Child templates override only what they need.

Child Template

Create `src/templates/about.twig`:

```

{% extends "base.twig" %}

{% block title %}About Us{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>About Us</h1>
    <p>We have been building things since {{ founded_year }}.</p>
    <p>Our team has {{ team_size }} members across {{ office_count }} offices.</p>
{% endblock %}

```

Route handler:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/about", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->render("about.twig", [
        "founded_year" => 2020,
        "team_size" => 12,
        "office_count" => 3
    ]);
});

```

Result: A full HTML page with the nav, the "About Us" content, and the footer. The `<title>` reads "About Us". The **head** and **scripts** blocks stay empty because the child did not override them.

Using `{{ parent() }}`

Add to a block instead of replacing it:

```

{% extends "base.twig" %}

{% block head %}
    {{ parent() }}
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/contact-form.css">
{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>Contact Us</h1>
    <form>...</form>

```

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```
{% endblock %}
```

The **head** block now contains everything from the base plus the extra stylesheet.

4. Includes

Break templates into reusable pieces with **{% include %}**:

Create **src/templates/partials/header.twig**:

```
<header>
  <div class="logo">{{ site_name | default("My App") }}</div>
  <nav>
    <a href="/">Home</a>
    <a href="/products">Products</a>
    <a href="/contact">Contact</a>
  </nav>
</header>
```

Create **src/templates/partials/product-card.twig**:

```
<div class="product-card{{ product.featured ? ' featured' : '' }}">
  <h3>{{ product.name }}</h3>
  <p class="price">${{ product.price | number_format(2) }}</p>
  {% if product.in_stock %}
    <span class="badge-success">In Stock</span>
  {% else %}
    <span class="badge-danger">Out of Stock</span>
  {% endif %}
</div>
```

Use them in a page:

```
{% extends "base.twig" %}

{% block content %}
  {% include "partials/header.twig" %}

  <h1>Products</h1>
  {% for product in products %}
    {% include "partials/product-card.twig" %}
  {% endfor %}
{% endblock %}
```

The **product** variable is available inside the included template because it exists in the current scope -- the for loop.

Passing Variables to Includes

Explicit variable passing with **with**:

```
{% include "partials/header.twig" with {"site_name": "Cool Store"} %}
```

Isolate the included template from the parent scope with **only**:

```
{% include "partials/header.twig" with {"site_name": "Cool Store"} only %}
```

With **only**, the included template sees site_name and nothing else.

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5. For Loops

Loop through arrays with `{% for %}`:

```
<ul>
  {% for item in items %}
    <li>{{ item }}</li>
  {% endfor %}
</ul>
```

The `loop` Variable

Inside every for loop, Frond provides a `loop` variable:

Property	Type	Description
<code>loop.index</code>	int	Current iteration (1-based)
<code>loop.index0</code>	int	Current iteration (0-based)
<code>loop.first</code>	bool	True on the first iteration
<code>loop.last</code>	bool	True on the last iteration
<code>loop.length</code>	int	Total number of items
<code>loop.revindex</code>	int	Iterations remaining (1-based)

```
<table>
  <thead>
    <tr><th>#</th><th>Name</th><th>Price</th></tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
    {% for product in products %}
      <tr class="{{ loop.index is odd ? 'row-light' : 'row-dark' }}">
        <td>{{ loop.index }}</td>
        <td>{{ product.name }}</td>
        <td>${{ product.price | number_format(2) }}</td>
      </tr>
    {% endfor %}
  </tbody>
</table>
```

Empty Lists

Handle empty lists with `{% else %}`:

```
{% for product in products %}
  <div class="product-card">
    <h3>{{ product.name }}</h3>
  </div>
{% else %}
  <p>No products found.</p>
{% endfor %}
```

If **products** is empty or undefined, the **else** block renders instead.

Looping Over Key-Value Pairs

```
{% for key, value in metadata %}
    <dt>{{ key }}</dt>
    <dd>{{ value }}</dd>
{% endfor %}
```

6. Conditionals

if / elseif / else

```
{% if user.role == "admin" %}
    <a href="/admin">Admin Panel</a>
{% elseif user.role == "editor" %}
    <a href="/editor">Editor Dashboard</a>
{% else %}
    <a href="/profile">My Profile</a>
{% endif %}
```

Ternary Operator

Inline conditionals:

```
<span class="{{ is_active ? 'text-green' : 'text-gray' }}">
    {{ is_active ? 'Active' : 'Inactive' }}
</span>
```

Testing for Existence

```
{% if error_message is defined %}
    <div class="alert alert-danger">{{ error_message }}</div>
{% endif %}
```

Truthiness

False values: **false**, **null**, **0**, **""** (empty string), **[]** (empty array). Everything else is true.

```
{% if items %}
    <p>{{ items | length }} items found.</p>
{% else %}
    <p>No items.</p>
{% endif %}
```

{% set %} -- Local Variables

Create or update a variable inside a template:

```
{% set greeting = "Hello" %}
{% set full_name = user.first_name ~ " " ~ user.last_name %}
{% set total = price * quantity %}
{% set discount = total - rebate %}

<p>{{ greeting }}, {{ full_name }}!</p>
<p>Total: {{ total }}, After discount: {{ discount }}</p>
```

The `~` operator concatenates strings. Arithmetic operators (`+`, `-`, `*`, `/`, `//`, `%`, `**`) work in `set` and expressions.

When combining filters with arithmetic, assign the filtered values first:

```
{% set dr = account.dr|default(0) %}
{% set cr = account.cr|default(0) %}
{% set balance = dr - cr %}
<p>Balance: {{ balance }}</p>
```

7. Filters

Filters transform values. Apply them with `|`:

```
{{ name | upper }}
```

Complete Filter Reference

String Filters

Filter	Example	Description	
<code>upper</code>	<code>{{ name upper }}</code>	<code>upper</code>	Convert to uppercase
<code>lower</code>	<code>{{ name lower }}</code>	<code>lower</code>	Convert to lowercase
<code>capitalize</code>	<code>{{ name capitalize }}</code>	<code>capitalize</code>	Capitalize first letter
<code>title</code>	<code>{{ name title }}</code>	<code>title</code>	Capitalize each word
<code>trim</code>	<code>{{ name trim }}</code>	<code>trim</code>	Strip leading/trailing whitespace
<code>ltrim</code>	<code>{{ name ltrim }}</code>	<code>ltrim</code>	Strip leading whitespace
<code>rtrim</code>	<code>{{ name rtrim }}</code>	<code>rtrim</code>	Strip trailing whitespace
<code>slug</code>	<code>{{ title slug }}</code>	<code>slug</code>	Convert to URL-friendly slug
<code>wordwrap(80)</code>	<code>{{ text wordwrap(80) }}</code>	<code>wordwrap(80)</code>	Wrap text at N characters
<code>truncate(100)</code>	<code>{{ text truncate(100) }}</code>	<code>truncate(100)</code>	Truncate to N characters with ellipsis
<code>nl2br</code>	<code>{{ text nl2br }}</code>	<code>nl2br</code>	Convert newlines to <code>
</code> tags
<code>striptags</code>	<code>{{ html striptags }}</code>	<code>striptags</code>	Remove all HTML tags
<code>replace("a", "b")</code>	<code>{{ text replace("old", "new") }}</code>	<code>replace("old", "new")</code>	Replace occurrences of a substring

Array Filters

Filter	Example	Description	
length	`{{ items \	length }}`	Count items in array or string length
reverse	`{{ items \	reverse }}`	Reverse order of items
sort	`{{ items \	sort }}`	Sort items ascending
shuffle	`{{ items \	shuffle }}`	Randomly shuffle items
first	`{{ items \	first }}`	Get the first item
last	`{{ items \	last }}`	Get the last item
join(", ")	`{{ items \	join(", ") }}`	Join array items with separator
split(",")	`{{ csv \	split(",") }}`	Split string into array
unique	`{{ items \	unique }}`	Remove duplicate values
filter	`{{ items \	filter }}`	Remove falsy values from array
map("name")	`{{ items \	map("name") }}`	Extract a property from each item
column("name")	`{{ items \	column("name") }}`	Extract a column from array of objects
batch(3)	`{{ items \	batch(3) }}`	Group items into batches of N
slice(0, 3)	`{{ items \	slice(0, 3) }}`	Extract a slice from offset with length

Encoding Filters			
Filter	Example	Description	
escape (e)	`{{ text \	escape }}`	HTML-escape special characters
raw (safe)	`{{ html \	raw }}`	Output without auto-escaping
url_encode	`{{ text \	url_encode }}`	URL-encode a string
base64_encode (base64encode)	`{{ text \	base64_encode }}`	Base64-encode a string
base64_decode (base64decode)	`{{ data \	base64_decode }}`	Base64-decode a string
md5	`{{ text \	md5 }}`	Compute MD5 hash
sha256	`{{ text \	sha256 }}`	Compute SHA-256 hash
Numeric Filters			
Filter	Example	Description	
abs	`{{ num \	abs }}`	Absolute value
round(2)	`{{ price \	round(2) }}`	Round to N decimal places
number_format(2)	`{{ price \	number_format(2) }}`	Format with decimals and thousands separator
int	`{{ val \	int }}`	Cast to integer
float	`{{ val \	float }}`	Cast to float
string	`{{ val \	string }}`	Cast to string
JSON Filters			
Filter	Example	Description	
json_encode	`{{ data \	json_encode }}`	Encode value as JSON string
to_json (tojson)	`{{ data \	to_json }}`	Encode value as JSON string (alias)
json_decode	`{{ str \	json_decode }}`	Decode JSON string to object
js_escape	`{{ text \	js_escape }}`	Escape string for safe use in JavaScript
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Dict Filters

Filter	Example	Description	
<code>keys</code>	<code>{{ obj keys }}</code>	<code>keys</code>	Get dictionary keys as array
<code>values</code>	<code>{{ obj values }}</code>	<code>values</code>	Get dictionary values as array
<code>merge(other)</code>	<code>{{ defaults merge(overrides) }}</code>	<code>merge(overrides)</code>	Merge two dictionaries

Other Filters

Filter	Example	Description	
<code>default("fallback")</code>	<code>{{ name default("Guest") }}</code>	<code>default("Guest")</code>	Fallback when value is empty or undefined
<code>date("Y-m-d")</code>	<code>{{ created date("Y-m-d") }}</code>	<code>date("Y-m-d")</code>	Format a date value
<code>format(val)</code>	<code>{{ "%.2f" format(price) }}</code>	<code>format(price)</code>	Format string with value (sprintf-style)
<code>data_uri</code>	<code>{{ content data_uri }}</code>	<code>data_uri</code>	Convert to a data URI string
<code>dump</code>	<code>{{ var dump }}</code> or <code>{{ dump(var) }}</code>	<code>dump</code> or <code>{{ dump(var) }}</code>	Debug output — gated on <code>TINA4_DEBUG=true</code> (see <i>Dumping Values</i>)
<code>form_token</code>	<code>{{ form_token() }}</code>	Generate a CSRF hidden input with token	
<code>formTokenValue</code>	<code>{{ formTokenValue("context") }}</code>	Return just the raw JWT token string	
<code>to_json</code>	<code>{{ data to_json }}</code>	<code>to_json</code>	JSON-encode a value (safe, no double-escaping)
<code>js_escape</code>	<code>{{ text js_escape }}</code>	<code>js_escape</code>	Escape for safe use in JavaScript strings

Chaining Filters

Left to right:

```
{{ name | trim | lower | capitalize }}  
{# " ALICE SMITH " -> "Alice smith" #}
```

Dumping Values for Debugging

The `dump` helper lets you inspect any variable mid-template. Two interchangeable forms are supported:

```
{{ user | dump }}  
{{ dump($user) }}
```

Both produce the same `<pre>`-wrapped, HTML-escaped `var_dump()` of the value. Handles arrays, objects, class instances, and cyclic references — PHP's `var_dump` prints `*RECURSION*` for back-edges.

```
{{ dump($order) }}
```

```
{# Output: #}
{# <pre>object(Order)#42 (3) {                                #}
{#   ["id"]=> int(42)                                           #}
{#   ["items"]=> array(2) { ... }                               #}
{#   ["total"]=> float(99.99)                                   #}
{# }</pre>                                                    #}
```

dump is gated on `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. In production (env var unset or `false`) **both** the filter and function form silently return an empty string. This prevents accidental leaks of internal state, object shapes, or sensitive values into rendered HTML if a developer leaves a `{{ dump($x) }}` call in a template.

```
# .env - dev
TINA4_DEBUG=true    # dump() outputs the value

# .env - production
TINA4_DEBUG=false   # dump() is a no-op
```

You can rely on this gate for safety, but treat `dump` as a development-only convenience. For structured output in production code paths, use `to_json`.

8. Macros

Macros are reusable template functions. Define once, call many times.

Defining a Macro

Create `src/templates/macros.twig`:

```
{% macro button(text, url, style) %}
    <a href="{{ url | default('#') }}" class="btn btn-{{ style | default('primary') }}">
        {{ text }}
    </a>
{% endmacro %}

{% macro alert(message, type) %}
    <div class="alert alert-{{ type | default('info') }}">
        {{ message }}
    </div>
{% endmacro %}

{% macro input(name, label, type, value) %}
    <div class="form-group">
        <label for="{{ name }}">{{ label | default(name | capitalize) }}</label>
        <input type="{{ type | default('text') }}" id="{{ name }}" name="{{ name }}" value="{{ value }}" />
    </div>
{% endmacro %}
```

Using Macros

Import and use:

```
{% from "macros.twig" import button, alert, input %}

{% extends "base.twig" %}

{% block content %}
    {{ alert("Your profile has been updated.", "success") }}

    <form method="POST" action="/profile">
        {{ input("name", "Full Name", "text", user.name) }}
        {{ input("email", "Email Address", "email", user.email) }}
        {{ input("phone", "Phone Number", "tel", user.phone) }}

        {{ button("Save Changes", "", "primary") }}
        {{ button("Cancel", "/dashboard", "secondary") }}
    </form>
{% endblock %}
```

Output (simplified):

```
<div class="alert alert-success">
    Your profile has been updated.
</div>

<form method="POST" action="/profile">
    <div class="form-group">
        <label for="name">Full Name</label>
        <input type="text" id="name" name="name" value="Alice">
    </div>
    <div class="form-group">
        <label for="email">Email Address</label>
        <input type="email" id="email" name="email" value="alice@example.com">
    </div>
    <div class="form-group">
        <label for="phone">Phone Number</label>
        <input type="tel" id="phone" name="phone" value="">
    </div>

    <a href="#" class="btn btn-primary">Save Changes</a>
    <a href="/dashboard" class="btn btn-secondary">Cancel</a>
</form>
```

9. Special Tags

{% raw %} -- Literal Output

Output literal `{{ }}` or `{% %}` without processing. Essential for Vue.js or Angular templates:

```
{% raw %}
    <div id="app">
        {{ message }}
    </div>
{% endraw %}
```

Outputs the literal text `{{ message }}`.

{% spaceless %} -- Remove Whitespace

Strip whitespace between HTML tags:

```
{% spaceless %}
  <div>
    <span>Hello</span>
  </div>
{% endspaceless %}
```

Output:

```
<div><span>Hello</span></div>
```

Useful for inline elements where whitespace creates unwanted gaps.

{% autoescape %} -- Control Escaping

Override auto-escaping for a block:

```
{% autoescape false %}
  {{ trusted_html }}
{% endautoescape %}
```

Everything inside outputs without HTML escaping. Equivalent to `| raw` on every variable, but more convenient for large blocks of trusted content.

Comments

Template comments are invisible in the output:

```
{# This comment will not appear in the HTML output #}
```

```
{#
  Multi-line comments work too.
  Use them to document template logic.
#}
```

10. tina4css Integration

Every Tina4 project includes `tina4.css` -- a built-in CSS utility framework. Available at </css/tina4.css>. Layout, typography, common UI patterns. No external dependencies.

Include it in your base template:

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
```

Layout Classes

```
<div class="container">
  <div class="row">
    <div class="col-6">Left half</div>
    <div class="col-6">Right half</div>
  </div>
</div>
```

Common Components

```
<!-- Buttons -->
<button class="btn btn-primary">Primary</button>
<button class="btn btn-secondary">Secondary</button>
<button class="btn btn-danger">Danger</button>

<!-- Cards -->
<div class="card">
  <div class="card-header">Title</div>
  <div class="card-body">Content here</div>
  <div class="card-footer">Footer</div>
</div>

<!-- Alerts -->
<div class="alert alert-success">Operation completed.</div>
<div class="alert alert-danger">Something went wrong.</div>
<div class="alert alert-warning">Please review your input.</div>

<!-- Forms -->
<div class="form-group">
  <label for="name">Name</label>
  <input type="text" id="name" class="form-control">
</div>
```

Utility Classes

```
<p class="text-center">Centered text</p>
<p class="text-right">Right-aligned text</p>
<div class="mt-4">Margin top</div>
<div class="p-3">Padding all around</div>
<span class="text-muted">Gray text</span>
<span class="text-primary">Primary color text</span>
```

No Bootstrap. No Tailwind. If you prefer those, swap the `<link>` tag. Tina4 does not care.

11. Exercise: Build a Product Catalog Page

Build a catalog page with a base layout, product cards, category filters, and a reusable card macro.

Requirements

- Create a base layout at `src/templates/catalog-base.twig` with blocks for `title`, `content`, and `scripts`
- Create a macro file at `src/templates/catalog-macros.twig` with:
 - A `productCard(product)` macro that renders a styled card with name, category, price, stock status, and optional featured badge
 - A `categoryFilter(categories, active)` macro that renders filter buttons
- Create a page template at `src/templates/catalog.twig` that:
 - Extends the base layout
 - Uses the macros

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- Shows a heading with total product count
- Shows category filter buttons (All, plus one per unique category)
- Shows product cards in a grid
- Highlights featured products
- Handles empty filter results
- Create a route at **GET /catalog** that accepts an optional **?category=** filter

Data

Use this product list in your route handler:

```
$products = [
  ["name" => "Espresso Machine", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 299.99, "in_stock" => true],
  ["name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "in_stock" => true, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => true, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Blender", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 89.99, "in_stock" => false, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Running Shoes", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 119.99, "in_stock" => true, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Desk Lamp", "category" => "Office", "price" => 39.99, "in_stock" => true, "featured" => true],
  ["name" => "Cast Iron Skillet", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 44.99, "in_stock" => true, "featured" => true]
];
```

Test with:

```
http://localhost:7145/catalog
http://localhost:7145/catalog?category=Kitchen
http://localhost:7145/catalog?category=Fitness
```

12. Solution

Create **src/templates/catalog-base.twig**:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}Product Catalog{% endblock %}</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
  <style>
    body { font-family: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif; margin: 0; padding: 0; }
    .container { max-width: 1000px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 20px; }
    .header { background: #2c3e50; color: white; padding: 20px; margin-bottom: 24px; }
    .header h1 { margin: 0; }
    .header p { margin: 4px 0 0; opacity: 0.8; }
    .filters { margin-bottom: 20px; }
    .filter-btn { display: inline-block; padding: 6px 14px; margin: 0 6px 6px 0; border-radius: 4px; }
    .filter-btn.active { background: #2c3e50; color: white; border-color: #2c3e50; }
    .product-grid { display: grid; grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fill, minmax(280px, 1fr)); }
    .product-card { background: white; border: 2px solid #e9ecef; border-radius: 8px; padding: 10px; }
    .product-card:hover { border-color: #adb5bd; }
    .product-card.featured { border-color: #f39c12; background: #fef9e7; }
    .product-name { font-size: 1.1em; font-weight: 600; margin: 0 0 4px 0; }
    .product-category { font-size: 0.85em; color: #6c757d; margin: 0 0 8px 0; }
```

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```

        .product-price { font-size: 1.2em; font-weight: bold; color: #27ae60; }
        .badge { display: inline-block; padding: 2px 8px; border-radius: 4px; font-size: 0.75em; }
        .badge-featured { background: #f39c12; color: white; }
        .badge-stock { background: #d4edda; color: #155724; }
        .badge-nostock { background: #f8d7da; color: #721c24; }
        .empty-state { text-align: center; padding: 40px; color: #6c757d; }
    </style>
</head>
<body>
    {% block content %}{% endblock %}

    <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
    {% block scripts %}{% endblock %}
</body>
</html>

```

Create `src/templates/catalog-macros.twig`:

```

{% macro productCard(product) %}
    <div class="product-card"{{ product.featured ? ' featured' : '' }}>
        <p class="product-name">
            {{ product.name }}
            {% if product.featured %}
                <span class="badge badge-featured">Featured</span>
            {% endif %}
        </p>
        <p class="product-category">{{ product.category }}</p>
        <p class="product-price">
            ${{ product.price | number_format(2) }}
            {% if product.in_stock %}
                <span class="badge badge-stock">In Stock</span>
            {% else %}
                <span class="badge badge-nostock">Out of Stock</span>
            {% endif %}
        </p>
    </div>
{% endmacro %}

{% macro categoryFilter(categories, active) %}
    <div class="filters">
        <a href="/catalog" class="filter-btn{{ active is not defined or active == '' ? ' active' }}>
            {% for cat in categories %}
                <a href="/catalog?category={{ cat }}" class="filter-btn{{ active == cat ? ' active' }}>
            {% endfor %}
        </div>
{% endmacro %}

```

Create `src/templates/catalog.twig`:

```

{% extends "catalog-base.twig" %}

{% from "catalog-macros.twig" import productCard, categoryFilter %}

{% block title %}{{ active_category | default("All") }} Products - Catalog{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <div class="header">
        <h1>Product Catalog</h1>
        <p>{{ products | length }} product{{ products | length != 1 ? 's' : '' }}{% if active_ca
    </div>

```

```

<div class="container">
    {{ categoryFilter(categories, active_category) }}

    {% if products | length > 0 %}
        <div class="product-grid">
            {% for product in products %}
                {{ productCard(product) }}
            {% endfor %}
        </div>
    {% else %}
        <div class="empty-state">
            <h2>No products found</h2>
            <p>Try a different category or <a href="/catalog">view all products</a>.</p>
        </div>
    {% endif %}
</div>
{% endblock %}

```

Create `src/routes/catalog.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/catalog", function ($request, $response) {
    $allProducts = [
        ["name" => "Espresso Machine", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 299.99, "in_stock" => true, "f
        ["name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "in_stock" => true, "f
        ["name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Office", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => tru
        ["name" => "Blender", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 89.99, "in_stock" => false, "f
        ["name" => "Running Shoes", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 119.99, "in_stock" => tr
        ["name" => "Desk Lamp", "category" => "Office", "price" => 39.99, "in_stock" => true, "f
        ["name" => "Cast Iron Skillet", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 44.99, "in_stock" =>
    ];

    // Get unique categories
    $categories = array_unique(array_column($allProducts, "category"));
    sort($categories);

    // Filter by category if specified
    $activeCategory = $request->params["category"] ?? "";
    if (!empty($activeCategory)) {
        $products = array_values(array_filter(
            $allProducts,
            fn($p) => strtolower($p["category"]) === strtolower($activeCategory)
        ));
    } else {
        $products = $allProducts;
    }

    return $response->render("catalog.twig", [
        "products" => $products,
        "categories" => $categories,
        "active_category" => $activeCategory
    ]);
});

```

Expected browser output for `/catalog`:

- A dark header with "Product Catalog" and "7 products"

- Filter buttons: All (active), Fitness, Kitchen, Office
- A grid of 7 product cards
- Three cards (Espresso Machine, Standing Desk, Desk Lamp) have a gold border and "Featured" badge
- The Blender card shows an "Out of Stock" badge in red

Expected browser output for `/catalog?category=Kitchen`:

- Header shows "3 products in Kitchen"
- The Kitchen filter button is active
- Three cards: Espresso Machine, Blender, Cast Iron Skillet

13. Gotchas

1. `{% extends %}` Must Be the First Tag

Problem: Template inheritance does not work. The page renders without the base layout.

Cause: `{% extends "base.twig" %}` must be the very first tag. Any text, whitespace, or comment before it breaks inheritance.

Fix: Put `{% extends %}` on the absolute first line. Move `{% from %}` imports after it.

2. Undefined Variables Show Nothing

Problem: `{{ username }}` renders as blank instead of an error.

Cause: Frond silently outputs nothing for undefined variables. By design, like Twig. But it hides bugs.

Fix: Use the `default` filter: `{{ username | default("Guest") }}`. Or check with `{% if username is defined %}`.

3. Auto-Escaping Prevents HTML Output

Problem: HTML content like `"<strong>bold</strong>"` appears as literal text.

Cause: Auto-escaping converts `<` to `<`; and `>` to `>`; for security.

Fix: Trusted content: `{{ content | raw }}`. Never use `raw` on user-supplied input.

4. Variable Scope in Includes

Problem: A variable defined inside a `{% for %}` loop is not accessible after the loop ends.

Cause: Loop variables are scoped to the loop. They do not leak.

Fix: Use `{% set %}` before the loop and update inside it. Or restructure to keep all logic within the loop.

5. Macro Arguments Are Positional

Problem: `{{ button("Click", style="danger") }}` does not work.

Cause: Frond macros use positional arguments. Order matters. Keyword arguments are not supported.

Fix: Pass arguments in definition order: `{{ button("Click", "/url", "danger") }}`. For many optional arguments, pass a single object.

6. Template File Extension Does Not Matter

Problem: Unsure whether to use `.html`, `.twig`, or `.tpl`.

Cause: Frond processes any file in `src/templates/` regardless of extension.

Fix: Pick one extension. Be consistent. This book uses `.twig` for templates with Twig syntax and `.html` for simple files. Both work identically.

7. Filters Are Not PHP Functions

Problem: `{{ items | count }}` or `{{ name | strtoupper }}` causes an error.

Cause: Frond filters follow Twig conventions, not PHP function names.

Fix: `{{ items | length }}` not `count`. `{{ name | upper }}` not `strtoupper`. `{{ text | lower }}` not `strtolower`. See the filter table in section 7.

Database

1. From Arrays to Real Data

In Chapters 2 and 3, data lived in PHP arrays. Every server restart wiped the slate. That works for learning routing and responses. Real applications need persistence. This chapter covers Tina4's database layer: raw queries, parameterised queries, transactions, schema inspection, helper methods, migrations, and seeding.

Tina4 supports five database engines: SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server, and Firebird. The API stays identical across all of them. Switch databases by changing one line in `.env`.

2. Connecting to a Database

The Default: SQLite

`tina4 init` creates an empty `data/` directory but does not create a database file. The default `.env` contains:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
```

No explicit `TINA4_DATABASE_URL` means Tina4 defaults to `sqlite:///data/app.db`. The SQLite file is created automatically the first time Tina4 opens a database connection (for example, when you run a query, execute a migration, or the framework initialises the database layer at startup with a `TINA4_DATABASE_URL` configured).

Connection Strings for Other Databases

Set `TINA4_DATABASE_URL` in `.env`:

```
# SQLite (explicit)
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db

# PostgreSQL
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=postgres://localhost:5432/myapp

# MySQL
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=mysql://localhost:3306/myapp

# Microsoft SQL Server
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=mssql://localhost:1433/myapp

# Firebird
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://localhost:3050/path/to/database.fdb
```

Firebird URL Forms

Firebird is the awkward one: every other engine has a server-side database name (`postgres://host:port/dbname`), but Firebird wants either an absolute file path on the server, a Windows drive-letter path, or an alias. The classic URI form needs a double slash to keep the leading `/` of an absolute path through `parse_url`, which is unintuitive.

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Tina4 normalises five equivalent forms. Pick whichever reads best:

```
# Classic double-slash absolute path -- the URL spec way
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@localhost:3050//firebird/data/app.fdb

# Single-slash absolute path -- what most people instinctively type
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@localhost:3050/firebird/data/app.fdb

# Windows drive-letter path (also accepts /C%3A/Data/app.fdb)
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@host:3050/C:/Data/app.fdb

# Firebird alias (single token, no slashes)
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@localhost:3050/employee
```

For ops setups that keep the server URL and database location in separate config layers -- or for Windows backslash paths -- set **TINA4_DATABASE_FIREBIRD_PATH**:

```
TINA4_DATABASE_FIREBIRD_PATH=C:\firebird\data\app.fdb
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@localhost:3050/ignored
```

The env override wins over whatever path is in the URL.

Firebird: Dual-Driver Support

The Firebird adapter works with either the **ibase_*** or **fbird_*** PHP functions. It auto-detects which set is available at connection time. If you have **ext-interbase** installed, it uses **ibase_***. If you have the newer **fbird_*** functions, it uses those instead. No configuration needed -- install whichever extension is available for your platform and the adapter picks it up.

Separate Credentials

Keep credentials out of the connection string. Better for production:

```
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=postgres://localhost:5432/myapp
TINA4_DATABASE_USERNAME=myuser
TINA4_DATABASE_PASSWORD=secretpassword
```

Tina4 merges these at startup. Separate variables take precedence over anything embedded in the URL.

Connection Pooling

For applications that handle many concurrent requests, enable connection pooling with the **pool** parameter:

```
$db = new Database("postgres://localhost/mydb", pool: 5);
```

The **pool** parameter controls how many database connections are maintained:

- **pool: 0** (the default) -- a single connection is used for all queries
- **pool: N** (where $N > 0$) -- N connections are created and rotated round-robin across queries

Pooled connections are thread-safe. Each query is dispatched to the next available connection in the pool. This eliminates contention when multiple route handlers query the database simultaneously.

Verifying the Connection

Update `.env`. Restart. Check:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/health
```

```
{
  "status": "ok",
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "uptime": 3.14,
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

3. Getting the Database Object

Access the database through the global `Tina4\Database` class:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::get("/api/test-db", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $result = $db->fetch("SELECT 1 + 1 AS answer");

    return $response->json($result);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/test-db

{"answer": 2}
```

`Database::getConnection()` returns the active connection. Call `fetch()`, `execute()`, and `fetchOne()` on it.

4. Raw Queries

`fetch()` -- Get Multiple Rows

```
$db = Database::getConnection();

// Returns an array of associative arrays
$products = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products WHERE price > 50");
```

Each row is an associative array:

```
// $products looks like:
[
  ["id" => 1, "name" => "Keyboard", "price" => 79.99],
  ["id" => 4, "name" => "Standing Desk", "price" => 549.99]
]
```

DatabaseResult

`fetch()` returns a `DatabaseResult` object. It behaves like an array but carries extra metadata about the query.

Properties

```
$result = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM users WHERE active = ?", [1]);

$result->records;      // [{"id" => 1, "name" => "Alice"}, {"id" => 2, "name" => "Bob"}]
$result->columns;      // ["id", "name", "email", "active"]
$result->count;        // total number of matching rows
$result->limit;        // query limit (if set)
$result->offset;       // query offset (if set)
```

Iteration

A `DatabaseResult` is iterable. Use it directly in `foreach`:

```
foreach ($result as $user) {
    echo $user["name"];
}
```

Index Access

Access rows by index like a regular array:

```
$firstUser = $result[0];
```

Countable

`count()` works on the result:

```
echo count($result); // number of records in this result set
```

Conversion Methods

```
$result->toJson();      // JSON string of all records
$result->toCsv();        // CSV string with column headers
$result->toArray();      // plain array of associative arrays
$result->toPaginate();   // ["records" => [...], "count" => 42, "limit" => 10, "offset" => 0]
```

`toPaginate()` is designed for building paginated API responses. It bundles the records with the total count, limit, and offset in a single array.

Schema Metadata with `columnInfo()`

`columnInfo()` returns detailed metadata about the columns in the result set. The data is lazy-loaded -- it only queries the database schema when you call the method for the first time:

```
$info = $result->columnInfo();
// [
//     ["name" => "id", "type" => "INTEGER", "size" => null, "decimals" => null, "nullable" => f
//     ["name" => "name", "type" => "TEXT", "size" => null, "decimals" => null, "nullable" => fa
//     ["name" => "email", "type" => "TEXT", "size" => 255, "decimals" => null, "nullable" => tr
//     ...
// ]
```

Each column entry contains:

Field	Description
<code>name</code>	Column name
<code>type</code>	Database type (e.g. <code>INTEGER</code> , <code>TEXT</code> , <code>REAL</code>)
<code>size</code>	Maximum size (or <code>null</code> if not applicable)
<code>decimals</code>	Decimal places (or <code>null</code>)
<code>nullable</code>	Whether the column allows <code>NULL</code>
<code>primary_key</code>	Whether the column is part of the primary key

This is useful for building dynamic forms, generating documentation, or validating data before insert.

fetchOne() -- Get a Single Row

```
$product = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM products WHERE id = 1");
// Returns: ["id" => 1, "name" => "Keyboard", "price" => 79.99]
```

No match returns `null`.

execute() -- Run a Statement

For INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, and DDL -- statements that do not return rows:

```
$db->execute("INSERT INTO products (name, price) VALUES ('Widget', 9.99)");
$db->execute("UPDATE products SET price = 89.99 WHERE id = 1");
$db->execute("DELETE FROM products WHERE id = 5");
$db->execute("CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS logs (id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY, message TEXT, created_at
```

Full Example: A Simple Query Route

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $products = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products ORDER BY name");

    return $response->json([
        "products" => $products,
        "count" => count($products)
    ]);
});
```

```
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products
```

```
{
  "products": [
    {"id": 1, "name": "Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "in_stock": 1},
    {"id": 2, "name": "Mouse", "price": 29.99, "in_stock": 1},
    {"id": 3, "name": "Monitor", "price": 399.99, "in_stock": 0}
  ],
  "count": 3
}
```

```
}
```

```
---
```

5. Parameterised Queries

Never concatenate user input into SQL strings. That is how SQL injection happens:

```
// NEVER do this:
$db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products WHERE name = '" . $userInput . "'");
```

Use parameterised queries instead. Parameters go in the second argument:

```
$db = Database::getConnection();

// Named parameters
$product = $db->fetchOne(
    "SELECT * FROM products WHERE id = :id",
    ["id" => 42]
);

// Positional parameters
$products = $db->fetch(
    "SELECT * FROM products WHERE price BETWEEN ? AND ? ORDER BY price",
    [10.00, 100.00]
);
```

The database driver handles escaping. Your input never touches the SQL string.

A Safe Search Endpoint

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::get("/api/products/search", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $q = $request->params["q"] ?? "";
    $maxPrice = (float) ($request->params["max_price"] ?? 99999);

    if (empty($q)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Query parameter 'q' is required"], 400);
    }

    $products = $db->fetch(
        "SELECT * FROM products WHERE name LIKE :query AND price <= :maxPrice ORDER BY name",
        ["query" => "%" . $q . "%", "maxPrice" => $maxPrice]
    );

    return $response->json([
        "query" => $q,
        "max_price" => $maxPrice,
        "results" => $products,
        "count" => count($products)
    ]);
});

curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search?q=key&max_price=100"
```

```

{
    "query": "key",
    "max_price": 100,
    "results": [
        {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "in_stock": 1}
    ],
    "count": 1
}

```

6. Transactions

Group operations that must succeed or fail as one unit:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::post("/api/orders", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $body = $request->body;

    try {
        $db->startTransaction();

        // Create the order
        $db->execute(
            "INSERT INTO orders (customer_id, total, status) VALUES (:customerId, :total, 'pending')",
            ["customerId" => $body["customer_id"], "total" => $body["total"]]
        );

        // Get the new order ID
        $order = $db->fetchOne("SELECT last_insert_rowid() AS id");
        $orderId = $order["id"];

        // Create order items
        foreach ($body["items"] as $item) {
            $db->execute(
                "INSERT INTO order_items (order_id, product_id, quantity, price) VALUES (:orderId, :productId, :qty, :price)",
                [
                    "orderId" => $orderId,
                    "productId" => $item["product_id"],
                    "qty" => $item["quantity"],
                    "price" => $item["price"]
                ]
            );

            // Decrease stock
            $db->execute(
                "UPDATE products SET stock = stock - :qty WHERE id = :productId",
                ["qty" => $item["quantity"], "productId" => $item["product_id"]]
            );
        }

        $db->commit();

        return $response->json(["order_id" => $orderId, "status" => "created"], 201);
    } catch (\Exception $e) {

```

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```

        $db->rollback();
        return $response->json(["error" => "Order failed: " . $e->getMessage()], 500);
    }
});

```

Any step fails. `rollback()` undoes everything. The database never lands in a half-finished state.

Call `commit()` to save. Forget it and the transaction rolls back when the connection closes.

7. Schema Inspection

Tina4 exposes methods to inspect your database structure at runtime. The `Database` object delegates to the underlying adapter, so these work across all five engines.

`getTables()`

```

$db = Database::getConnection();
$tables = $db->getTables();

```

Returns an array of table names:

```
["orders", "order_items", "products", "users"]
```

`getColumns()`

```
$columns = $db->getColumns("products");
```

Returns column definitions:

```

[
    ["name" => "id", "type" => "INTEGER", "nullable" => false, "primary" => true],
    ["name" => "name", "type" => "TEXT", "nullable" => false, "primary" => false],
    ["name" => "price", "type" => "REAL", "nullable" => true, "primary" => false],
    ["name" => "in_stock", "type" => "INTEGER", "nullable" => true, "primary" => false]
]

```

`tableExists()`

```

if ($db->tableExists("products")) {
    // Table exists, safe to query
}

```

`getDatabaseType()`

```

$engine = $db->getDatabaseType();
// "sqlite", "postgresql", "mysql", "mssql", or "firebird"

```

Returns a lowercase string identifying the active database engine. Use this when you need engine-specific SQL in a multi-database setup.

A Schema Info Endpoint

Combine these methods to build a schema browser:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::get("/api/schema", function ($request, $response) {
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```

```

$db = Database::getConnection();
$tables = $db->getTables();

$schema = [];
foreach ($tables as $table) {
    $schema[$table] = $db->getColumns($table);
}

return $response->json([
    "engine" => $db->getDatabaseType(),
    "tables" => $schema
]);
});

```

Schema inspection powers admin dashboards, migration generators, and dynamic form builders. The database tells you its own structure -- no guesswork required.

8. Batch Operations with `executeMany()`

Insert or update many rows in one call:

```

$db = Database::getConnection();

$products = [
    ["name" => "Widget A", "price" => 9.99],
    ["name" => "Widget B", "price" => 14.99],
    ["name" => "Widget C", "price" => 19.99],
    ["name" => "Widget D", "price" => 24.99]
];

$db->executeMany(
    "INSERT INTO products (name, price) VALUES (:name, :price)",
    $products
);

```

`executeMany()` prepares the statement once and executes it for each item. The SQL is parsed once. Four rows inserted. Much faster than four separate `execute()` calls.

9. Helper Methods: `insert()`, `update()`, `delete()`

Shorthand methods for simple operations. No SQL needed.

insert()

```
$db = Database::getConnection();

// Insert a single row
$db->insert("products", [
    "name" => "Wireless Mouse",
    "price" => 34.99,
    "in_stock" => 1
]);

// Insert multiple rows
$db->insert("products", [
    ["name" => "USB Cable", "price" => 9.99, "in_stock" => 1],
    ["name" => "HDMI Cable", "price" => 14.99, "in_stock" => 1],
    ["name" => "DisplayPort Cable", "price" => 19.99, "in_stock" => 0]
]);
```

update()

```
// Update rows matching a filter
$db->update("products", ["price" => 39.99, "in_stock" => 1], "id = :id", ["id" => 7]);
```

Third argument: WHERE clause. Fourth argument: parameters.

delete()

```
// Delete rows matching a filter
$db->delete("products", "id = :id", ["id" => 7]);
```

These helpers generate SQL for you. Use them for simple CRUD. For joins, subqueries, or aggregations, reach for raw queries.

10. Migrations

Migrations are versioned SQL scripts that evolve your schema over time. Write migration files. Tina4 applies them in order and tracks what has run. No manual **CREATE TABLE** calls against production.

File Naming

Two naming patterns are supported:

- **Sequential:** `000001_create_products_table.sql`
- **Timestamp:** `20260322143000_create_products_table.sql` (YYYYMMDDHHMMSS)

Both work. Pick one pattern and stick with it throughout a project. Do not mix them.

Generating a Migration

```
tina4 generate migration create_products_table
```

```
Created migration: migrations/20260322143000_create_products_table.sql
```

```
Created migration: migrations/20260322143000_create_products_table.down.sql
```

The generator creates two files: the migration itself and a matching `.down.sql` file for rollback.

Writing the Migration

Edit `migrations/20260322143000_create_products_table.sql`:

```
CREATE TABLE products (  
  id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,  
  name TEXT NOT NULL,  
  category TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'Uncategorized',  
  price REAL NOT NULL DEFAULT 0.00,  
  in_stock INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,  
  created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,  
  updated_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP  
);
```

Edit `migrations/20260322143000_create_products_table.down.sql`:

```
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS products;
```

The `.down.sql` file is optional but recommended for production projects. It contains the SQL that reverses the migration.

Running Migrations

```
tina4 migrate  
# or  
tina4php migrate
```

Running migrations...

```
[APPLIED] 20260322143000_create_products_table.sql
```

Migrations complete. 1 applied.

Each call to `tina4 migrate` is a **batch**. All pending migrations applied in a single run share the same batch number. This matters for rollback.

Checking Migration Status

```
tina4php migrate:status
```

Migration	Status	Applied At
-----	-----	-----
20260322143000_create_products_table.sql	applied	2026-03-22 14:30:00
20260322150000_create_orders_table.sql	pending	-

Shows which migrations have been applied and which are still pending.

Rolling Back

```
tina4php migrate:rollback
```

Rolling back last batch...

```
[ROLLED BACK] 20260322150000_create_orders_table.sql
```

Rollback complete. 1 rolled back.

Rollback undoes the entire last batch. It finds each migration's `.down.sql` file and executes it, then removes the tracking records. If you applied three migrations in one `tina4 migrate` call, rollback undoes all three.

The `.down.sql` file must share the exact same base name as the migration. For `20260322150000_create_orders_table.sql`, the down file is `20260322150000_create_orders_table.down.sql`.

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Tracking Table

Tina4 creates a `tina4_migration` table to track applied migrations. The table has four columns:

Column	Type	Description
<code>id</code>	integer	Auto-increment primary key
<code>migration</code>	VARCHAR(255)	The migration filename
<code>batch</code>	integer	Batch number (increments each <code>tina4 migrate</code> run)
<code>applied_at</code>	timestamp	When the migration was applied

You should not modify this table directly, but inspecting it can help debug migration issues.

Advanced SQL: Stored Procedures and Block Comments

The migration runner handles more than simple semicolon-delimited statements. It correctly parses:

- **\$\$ delimited blocks** -- PostgreSQL stored procedures and functions
- **// blocks** -- alternative delimiter blocks
- **/* */ block comments** -- skipped during parsing
- **-- line comments** -- skipped during parsing

A PostgreSQL stored procedure migration works without issues:

```
CREATE OR REPLACE FUNCTION update_modified_column()
RETURNS TRIGGER AS $$
BEGIN
    NEW.updated_at = NOW();
    RETURN NEW;
END;
$$ LANGUAGE plpgsql;

CREATE TRIGGER set_updated_at
BEFORE UPDATE ON products
FOR EACH ROW
EXECUTE FUNCTION update_modified_column();
```

No special configuration needed. The SQL splitter recognises `$$` boundaries and treats the block as a single statement.

A Real Migration Sequence

```
migrations/
■■■ 20260322143000_create_products_table.sql
■■■ 20260322143000_create_products_table.down.sql
■■■ 20260322143100_create_users_table.sql
■■■ 20260322143100_create_users_table.down.sql
■■■ 20260322143200_create_orders_table.sql
■■■ 20260322143200_create_orders_table.down.sql
■■■ 20260322143300_create_order_items_table.sql
■■■ 20260322143300_create_order_items_table.down.sql
■■■ 20260323091500_add_email_index_to_users.sql
```

The index migration without a `.down.sql` -- this is fine. Down migrations are optional. If you roll back and no `.down.sql` exists, the tracking record is removed but no reversal SQL runs.

The index migration:

```
CREATE INDEX idx_users_email ON users (email);
```

Its down file (`20260323091500_add_email_index_to_users.down.sql`), if you choose to create one:

```
DROP INDEX IF EXISTS idx_users_email;
```

Migrations run in filename order. Each runs only once.

11. Query Caching

For read-heavy applications:

```
TINA4_DB_CACHE=true
```

Tina4 caches results of `fetch()` and `fetchOne()` calls. Identical queries with identical parameters return cached results instead of hitting the database.

The cache invalidates when you call `execute()`, `insert()`, `update()`, or `delete()` on the same table.

Per-query control:

```
// Force a fresh query (bypass cache)
$products = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products", [], false); // third arg = use cache

// Clear the entire cache
$db->clearCache();
```

12. Exercise: Build a Notes App

A notes application backed by SQLite. Migration for the table. Full CRUD API.

Requirements

- Create a migration for a `notes` table: _____

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- `id` -- integer, primary key, auto-increment
- `title` -- text, not null
- `content` -- text, not null
- `tag` -- text, default "general"
- `created_at` -- text, default current timestamp
- `updated_at` -- text, default current timestamp
- Build these endpoints:

Method	Path	Description
GET	/api/notes	List all notes. Support <code>?tag=</code> and <code>?search=</code> filters.
GET	/api/notes/{id:int}	Get a single note. 404 if not found.
POST	/api/notes	Create a note. Validate title and content are not empty.
PUT	/api/notes/{id:int}	Update a note. 404 if not found.
DELETE	/api/notes/{id:int}	Delete a note. 204 on success, 404 if not found.

Test with:

```
# Create
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/notes \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"title": "Shopping List", "content": "Milk, eggs, bread", "tag": "personal"}'

# List all
curl http://localhost:7145/api/notes

# Search
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/notes?search=shopping"

# Filter by tag
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/notes?tag=personal"

# Get one
curl http://localhost:7145/api/notes/1

# Update
curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/api/notes/1 \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"title": "Updated Shopping List", "content": "Milk, eggs, bread, butter"}'

# Delete
curl -X DELETE http://localhost:7145/api/notes/1
```

13. Solution

Migration

Generate the migration:

```
tina4 generate migration create_notes_table
```

Edit [migrations/20260322143000_create_notes_table.sql](#):

```
CREATE TABLE notes (  
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,  
    title TEXT NOT NULL,  
    content TEXT NOT NULL,  
    tag TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'general',  
    created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,  
    updated_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP  
);
```

Edit [migrations/20260322143000_create_notes_table.down.sql](#):

```
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS notes;
```

Run it:

```
tina4 migrate
```

Running migrations...

[APPLIED] 20260322143000_create_notes_table.sql

Migrations complete. 1 applied.

Routes

Create [src/routes/notes.php](#):

```
<?php  
use Tina4\Router;  
use Tina4\Database;  
  
// List all notes with optional filters  
Router::get("/api/notes", function ($request, $response) {  
    $db = Database::getConnection();  
  
    $tag = $request->params["tag"] ?? "";  
    $search = $request->params["search"] ?? "";  
  
    $sql = "SELECT * FROM notes";  
    $params = [];  
    $conditions = [];  
  
    if (!empty($tag)) {  
        $conditions[] = "tag = :tag";  
        $params["tag"] = $tag;  
    }  
  
    if (!empty($search)) {  
        $conditions[] = "(title LIKE :search OR content LIKE :search)";  
        $params["search"] = "%" . $search . "%";
```

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```

    }

    if (!empty($conditions)) {
        $sql .= " WHERE " . implode(" AND ", $conditions);
    }

    $sql .= " ORDER BY updated_at DESC";

    $notes = $db->fetch($sql, $params);

    return $response->json([
        "notes" => $notes,
        "count" => count($notes)
    ]);
});

// Get a single note
Router::get("/api/notes/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    $note = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    if ($note === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Note not found", "id" => $id], 404);
    }

    return $response->json($note);
});

// Create a note
Router::post("/api/notes", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $body = $request->body;

    // Validate
    $errors = [];
    if (empty($body["title"])) {
        $errors[] = "Title is required";
    }
    if (empty($body["content"])) {
        $errors[] = "Content is required";
    }
    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response->json(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    $db->execute(
        "INSERT INTO notes (title, content, tag) VALUES (:title, :content, :tag)",
        [
            "title" => $body["title"],
            "content" => $body["content"],
            "tag" => $body["tag"] ?? "general"
        ]
    );

    $note = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE id = last_insert_rowid()");

    return $response->json($note, 201);
});

```

```

});

// Update a note
Router::put("/api/notes/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    $existing = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    if ($existing === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Note not found", "id" => $id], 404);
    }

    $db->execute(
        "UPDATE notes SET title = :title, content = :content, tag = :tag, updated_at = CURRENT_TIMESTAMP" .
        [
            "title" => $body["title"] ?? $existing["title"],
            "content" => $body["content"] ?? $existing["content"],
            "tag" => $body["tag"] ?? $existing["tag"],
            "id" => $id
        ]
    );

    $note = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    return $response->json($note);
});

// Delete a note
Router::delete("/api/notes/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    $existing = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    if ($existing === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Note not found", "id" => $id], 404);
    }

    $db->execute("DELETE FROM notes WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    return $response->json(null, 204);
});

```

Expected output for create:

```

{
  "id": 1,
  "title": "Shopping List",
  "content": "Milk, eggs, bread",
  "tag": "personal",
  "created_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00",
  "updated_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00"
}

```

(Status: 201 Created)

Expected output for list:

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```
{
  "notes": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "title": "Shopping List",
      "content": "Milk, eggs, bread",
      "tag": "personal",
      "created_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00",
      "updated_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00"
    }
  ],
  "count": 1
}
```

Expected output for search:

```
{
  "notes": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "title": "Shopping List",
      "content": "Milk, eggs, bread",
      "tag": "personal",
      "created_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00",
      "updated_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00"
    }
  ],
  "count": 1
}
```

Expected output for validation error:

```
{"errors": ["Title is required", "Content is required"]}
```

(Status: 400 Bad Request)

14. Seeder -- Generating Test Data

Testing with an empty database tells you nothing. Testing with hand-typed rows is slow and brittle. The `FakeData` class generates realistic test data. The `seedTable()` function inserts it in bulk.

FakeData

```
use Tina4\FakeData;

$fake = new FakeData();

$fake->name();           // "Grace Lopez"
$fake->email();           // "bob.anderson@demo.net"
$fake->phone();           // "+1 (547) 382-9104"
$fake->sentence();        // "Magna exercitation lorem ipsum dolor sit amet consectetur."
$fake->paragraph();       // Four sentences of filler text
$fake->integer();         // 7342
$fake->decimal();         // 481.29
$fake->date();            // "2023-07-14"
$fake->uuid();            // "a3f1b2c4-d5e6-f7a8-b9c0-d1e2f3a4b5c6"
$fake->address();         // "742 Oak Ave, Tokyo"
$fake->boolean();         // true
```

Every method draws from built-in word banks. No network calls. No external packages.

Deterministic Output

Pass a seed to get reproducible results. The same seed produces the same sequence every time:

```
$fake = new FakeData(42);
$fake->name();    // Always "Wendy White" with seed 42
$fake->email();    // Always the same email with seed 42
```

Deterministic data means deterministic assertions. This matters for tests.

Seeding a Table

`seedTable()` combines `FakeData` with your database. Pass a field map -- an associative array where each key is a column name and each value is a callable that generates data:

```
use Tina4\FakeData;
use Tina4\Database;
use function Tina4\seedTable;

$db = Database::getConnection();
$fake = new FakeData(1);

seedTable($db, "users", 100, [
    "name" => [$fake, "name"],
    "email" => [$fake, "email"],
    "phone" => [$fake, "phone"],
    "bio" => [$fake, "sentence"],
]);
```

This inserts 100 rows into the `users` table. Each row calls `$fake->name()`, `$fake->email()`, and so on to generate values. The function commits after all rows insert.

Overrides

Static values that apply to every row go in the overrides array:

```
seedTable($db, "users", 50, [
    "name" => [$fake, "name"],
    "email" => [$fake, "email"],
], [
```

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```
        "role" => "member",
        "active" => 1,
    });
```

Every row gets `role = "member"` and `active = 1`. The field map generates the rest.

When to Use It

- Populating a development database with realistic data
- Writing integration tests that need rows in the database
- Load testing with thousands of records
- Demos and screenshots that look real without using real data

15. Gotchas

1. Forgetting commit()

Problem: Queries run inside `startTransaction()`, but changes vanish on the next request.

Cause: No `commit()`. The transaction rolls back when the connection closes.

Fix: Always call `$db->commit()` on success. Use try/catch with `$db->rollback()` in the catch.

2. Connection String Formats

Problem: Database refuses to connect. Cryptic error about the connection string.

Cause: Missing port. A common mistake is `mysql://user:pass@host/db` without the port number.

Fix: Always include the port:

Engine	Default Port
PostgreSQL	5432
MySQL	3306
MSSQL	1433
Firebird	3050
SQLite	(file path, no port)

3. SQLite File Paths

Problem: SQLite creates a new empty database instead of using the existing one.

Cause: Wrong slash count. `sqlite://` (two slashes) instead of `sqlite:///` (three slashes). Or a relative path resolving to the wrong directory.

Fix: Three slashes for a relative path: `sqlite:///data/app.db`. Four slashes for absolute: `sqlite:///var/data/app.db`. The third slash separates the scheme. The fourth starts the absolute path.

4. Parameterised Queries with LIKE

Problem: `WHERE name LIKE :q` with `["q" => "%search%"]` works. `WHERE name LIKE ':%q%'` does not.

Cause: Parameters inside quotes are literal text, not placeholders.

Fix: Put the % wildcards in the parameter value: `["q" => "%" . $search . "%"]`. The SQL should be `WHERE name LIKE :q`.

5. Boolean Values in SQLite

Problem: You insert `true` or `false`. The database stores `1` or `0`. Reading it back gives integers, not booleans.

Cause: SQLite has no native boolean type. Booleans become integers.

Fix: Cast in PHP: `"in_stock" => (bool) $row["in_stock"]`. Or accept that `1` and `0` work as truthy/falsy.

6. Migration Already Applied

Problem: You edited a migration file and ran `tina4 migrate` again. Nothing changed.

Cause: Tina4 tracks applied migrations by filename in the `tina4_migration` table. Once applied, a migration will not run again regardless of content changes.

Fix: Create a new migration for schema changes. Never edit applied migrations. For early development, use `tina4php migrate:rollback` first, then `tina4 migrate` to reapply.

7. Down Migration Not Found During Rollback

Problem: `tina4php migrate:rollback` removes the tracking record but does not reverse the schema change.

Cause: The `.down.sql` file is missing, or its name does not match the migration. For `20260322143000_create_products_table.sql`, the down file must be `20260322143000_create_products_table.down.sql` -- same base name with `.down.sql` appended before the extension.

Fix: Always generate migrations with `tina4 generate migration` which creates both files automatically. If you created migration files manually, add the `.down.sql` file with the exact matching name.

8. fetch() Returns Empty Array, Not Null

Problem: `if ($result === null)` never matches, even when the table is empty.

Cause: `fetch()` always returns an array. Empty result is `[]`, not `null`. Only `fetchOne()` returns `null`.

Fix: Check with `if (empty($result))` or `if (count($result) === 0)`.

ORM

1. From SQL to Objects

The last chapter was raw SQL. It works. It also gets repetitive. Every insert demands an INSERT statement. Every update demands an UPDATE. Every fetch maps column names to array keys. Over and over.

Tina4's ORM turns database rows into PHP objects. Define a model class with properties. The ORM writes the SQL. It stays SQL-first -- you can drop to raw SQL at any moment -- but for the 90% case of CRUD operations, the ORM handles the grunt work.

Picture a blog. Authors, posts, comments. Authors own many posts. Posts own many comments. Comments belong to posts. Modelling these relationships with raw SQL means JOINS and manual foreign key management. The ORM makes this declarative.

ORM at a Glance: Four Languages, One Shape

The ORM does the same job in every Tina4 book. Define a model. Save it. Query it. Each language wears its own clothes — PHP uses typed properties, Python uses field class instances, Ruby uses a DSL, Node uses config objects — but the operations line up. If you know the API in one book, you can read the others.

Defining a Model

The same `Post` model with `id`, `title`, `body`, and `created_at`:

Python — field class instances on the class body:

```
from tina4_python.orm import ORM, IntegerField, StringField, DateTimeField

class Post(ORM):
    table_name = "posts"

    id = IntegerField(primary_key=True, auto_increment=True)
    title = StringField(required=True, max_length=200)
    body = StringField(default="")
    created_at = DateTimeField()
```

PHP — native typed properties:

```
<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Post extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";

    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public string $body = "";
    public string $createdAt;_____
```

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```
}
```

Ruby — class-level DSL declarations:

```
class Post < Tina4::ORM
  table_name "posts"

  integer_field :id, primary_key: true, auto_increment: true
  string_field :title, nullable: false, length: 200
  string_field :body, default: ""
  datetime_field :created_at
end
```

Node.js (TypeScript) — config objects in a `static fields` block:

```
import { BaseModel } from "tina4-nodejs/orm";

export default class Post extends BaseModel {
  static tableName = "posts";
  static fields = {
    id: { type: "integer" as const, primaryKey: true, autoIncrement: true },
    title: { type: "string" as const, required: true, maxLength: 200 },
    body: { type: "string" as const, default: "" },
    createdAt: { type: "datetime" as const },
  };
}
```

Common Query Operations

Same operation, four shapes:

Operation	Python	PHP	Ruby	Node.js
Find by primary key	<code>Post.find_by_id(1)</code>	<code>Post::findById(1)</code>	<code>Post.find_by_id(1)</code>	<code>Post.findById(1)</code>
Filter by attributes	<code>Post.find({ "title": "x" })</code>	<code>Post::find(["title" => "x"])</code>	<code>Post.find({ title: "x" })</code>	<code>Post.find({ title: "x" })</code>
Raw SQL where clause	<code>Post.where("title = ?", ["x"])</code>	<code>(new Post())->where("title = ?", ["x"])</code>	<code>Post.where("title = ?", ["x"])</code>	<code>Post.where("title = ?", ["x"])</code>
Build and save	<code>Post.create(title="x")</code>	<code>Post::create(["title" => "x"])</code>	<code>Post.create({ title: "x" })</code>	<code>Post.create({ title: "x" })</code>
Save an instance	<code>post.save()</code>	<code>\$post->save()</code>	<code>post.save</code>	<code>post.save()</code>
Fetch every row	<code>Post.all()</code>	<code>(new Post())->all()</code>	<code>Post.all</code>	<code>Post.all()</code>

Delete a record	<code>post.delete()</code>	<code>\$post->delete()</code>	<code>post.delete</code>	<code>post.delete()</code>
Count rows	<code>Post.count()</code>	<code>(new Post())->count()</code>	<code>Post.count</code>	<code>Post.count()</code>

A few details worth noting. `find()` takes attribute names and applies the field map; `where()` takes raw SQL and skips translation. PHP needs `(new Post())` for instance methods like `where()` and `all()` — the rest are static. Ruby methods drop the parentheses by convention.

For full detail on field options, relationships, eager loading, soft delete, validation, and Auto-CRUD, read the rest of this chapter — it shows the API for the language of this book.

2. Defining a Model

Create a model file in `src/orm/`. Every `.php` file in that directory is auto-loaded.

Create `src/orm/Note.php`:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Note extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "notes";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";

    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public string $content = "";
    public string $category = "general";
    public bool $pinned = false;
    public string $createdAt;
    public string $updatedAt;
}
```

A complete model. Here is what each piece does:

- `$tableName` -- the database table this model maps to. If omitted, the ORM uses the lowercase class name (e.g. `Contact` maps to `contact`).
- `$primaryKey` -- the primary key column name. Defaults to `"id"` if not specified.
- Each property uses native PHP type hints (`int`, `string`, `float`, `bool`) to define the column type.

Property Types

PHP Type	SQL Type	Description
<code>int</code>	<code>INTEGER</code>	Whole numbers
<code>string</code>	<code>VARCHAR(255)</code>	Text strings
<code>float</code>	<code>REAL / DOUBLE PRECISION</code>	Decimal numbers
<code>bool</code>	<code>INTEGER (0/1)</code>	True/False

For foreign keys, use `int`. There is no separate foreign key type -- the relationship is defined through `$hasMany`, `$hasOne`, and `$belongsTo` array properties instead.

Field Mapping

When your PHP property names do not match the database column names, use `$fieldMapping` to define the translation:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class User extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "user_accounts";
    public array $fieldMapping = [
        "firstName" => "fname",          // PHP property => DB column
        "lastName"  => "lname",
        "emailAddress" => "email",
    ];

    public int $id;
    public string $firstName;
    public string $lastName;
    public string $emailAddress;
}
```

With this mapping, `$user->firstName` reads from and writes to the `fname` column. The ORM handles the conversion in both directions -- on `findById()`, `save()`, `select()`, and `toDict()`. This is useful with legacy databases or third-party schemas where you cannot rename the columns.

autoMap and Case Conversion

The `$autoMap` flag converts camelCase PHP property names to snakecase database column names. This matters in PHP because convention uses camelCase for properties, but most databases use snakecase for columns.

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class User extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "users";
}
```

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```

    public bool $autoMap = true; // firstName <-> first_name

    public int $id;
    public string $firstName; // maps to first_name column
    public string $lastName; // maps to last_name column
    public string $emailAddress; // maps to email_address column
}

```

When `$autoMap` is `true`, the ORM generates the `$fieldMapping` entries from your camelCase properties. Explicit entries in `$fieldMapping` take precedence over auto-generated ones.

3. createTable -- Schema from Models

You can create the database table directly from your model:

```

$note = new Note($db);
$note->createTable([
    'id'          => 'INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT',
    'title'       => 'VARCHAR(200) NOT NULL',
    'content'     => 'TEXT DEFAULT ""',
    'category'    => 'VARCHAR(50) DEFAULT "general"',
    'pinned'      => 'INTEGER DEFAULT 0',
    'created_at'  => 'DATETIME',
    'updated_at'  => 'DATETIME',
]);

```

This generates and runs the CREATE TABLE SQL. It is good for development and testing. For production, use migrations (Chapter 5) for version-controlled schema changes.

If you call `createTable()` with no arguments, it creates a minimal table with just the primary key column.

4. CRUD Operations

save -- Create or Update

```

Router::post("/api/notes", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $note = new Note();
    $note->title = $request->body["title"];
    $note->content = $request->body["content"] ?? "";
    $note->category = $request->body["category"] ?? "general";
    $note->pinned = $request->body["pinned"] ?? false;
    $note->save();

    return $response(["message" => "Note created", "note" => $note->toDict()], 201);
});

```

`save()` detects whether the record is new (INSERT) or existing (UPDATE) based on whether the primary key has a value and whether the record exists in the database. It returns `$this` on success (fluent chaining), or `false` on failure.

create -- Build and Save in One Step

When you have an array of data ready, `create()` builds the model and saves it in one call:

```
$note = Note::create([
    "title"    => "Quick Note",
    "content"  => "Created in one step",
    "category" => "general",
]);
```

`create()` is a static method. It creates a new instance, populates it from the array, calls `save()`, and returns the saved instance.

findById -- Fetch One Record by Primary Key

```
Router::get("/api/notes/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $note = Note::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($note === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Note not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response($note->toDict());
});
```

`findById()` takes a primary key value and returns a model instance, or `null` if no row matches. If soft delete is enabled, it excludes soft-deleted records.

Use `findOrFail()` when you want a `RuntimeException` raised instead of `null`:

```
$note = Note::findOrFail($id); // Throws RuntimeException if not found
```

find -- Query by Filter Array

The `find()` method accepts an associative array of column-value pairs and returns an array of matching records:

```
// Find all notes in the "work" category
$workNotes = Note::find(["category" => "work"]);

// Find with pagination and ordering
$recent = Note::find(["pinned" => true], limit: 10, orderBy: "created_at DESC");

// Find all records (no filter)
$allNotes = Note::find();
```

find() vs where() -- naming convention

The two query methods have a deliberate difference in how they handle column names:

- `find($filter)` uses **PHP property names**. The ORM translates them via `$fieldMapping` or `$autoMap`.
- `where($sql)` uses **raw DB column names** in the SQL string. No translation is done.

```
// find() -- use PHP property names
$accounts = (new Account())->find(["accountNo" => "A001"]); // translates to ACCOUNTNO = ?
```

```
// where() -- use DB column names directly in the SQL
$accounts = (new Account())->where("ACCOUNTNO = ?", ["A001"]); // raw SQL, no translation
```

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***Warning:** Mixing up the two is a common source of bugs. Use `find()` for portability and `where()` when you need full SQL control. Never pass DB column names to `find()`, and never use PHP property names as column names in `where()`.*

where -- Query with SQL Conditions

For more complex queries, `where()` takes a SQL WHERE clause with `?` placeholders:

```
$notes = (new Note())->where("category = ?", ["work"]);
```

delete -- Remove a Record

```
Router::delete("/api/notes/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $note = Note::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($note === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Note not found"], 404);
    }

    $note->delete();

    return $response(null, 204);
});
```

Listing Records

```
Router::get("/api/notes", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $category = $request->query["category"] ?? null;

    if ($category) {
        $notes = (new Note())->where("category = ?", [$category]);
        return $response([
            "notes" => array_map(fn(Note $n) => $n->toDict(), $notes),
            "count" => count($notes),
        ]);
    }

    $notes = (new Note())->all();

    return $response([
        "notes" => array_map(fn(Note $n) => $n->toDict(), $notes),
        "count" => count($notes),
    ]);
});
```

`where()` takes a WHERE clause with `?` placeholders and an array of parameters. It returns an array of model instances. `all()` also returns an array of model instances. Both support pagination:

```
// With pagination
$notes = (new Note())->where("category = ?", ["work"], limit: 20, offset: 40);

// Fetch all with pagination
$result = (new Note())->all(limit: 20, offset: 0);

// SQL-first query -- full control over the SQL
$notes = (new Note())->select(
    "SELECT * FROM notes WHERE pinned = ? ORDER BY created_at DESC",
    [1], limit: 20, offset: 0
```

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```
);
```

selectOne -- Fetch a Single Record by SQL

When you need exactly one record from a custom SQL query:

```
$note = (new Note())->selectOne("SELECT * FROM notes WHERE slug = ?", ["my-note"]);
```

Returns a model instance or **null**.

load -- Populate an Existing Instance

The **load()** method fills an existing model instance from the database:

```
$note = new Note();  
$note->id = 42;  
$note->load(); // Loads data for id=42
```

```
// Or with a filter string  
$note = new Note();  
$note->load("slug = ?", ["my-note"]);
```

Returns **true** if a record was found, **false** otherwise.

count -- Count Records

```
$total = (new Note())->count();  
$workCount = (new Note())->count("category = ?", ["work"]);
```

Respects soft delete -- only counts non-deleted records.

5. toDict, toJson, and Other Serialisation

toDict

Convert a model instance to an associative array (keyed by property names):

```
$note = Note::findById(1);  
  
$data = $note->toDict();  
// ["id" => 1, "title" => "Shopping List", "content" => "Milk, eggs", "category" => "personal",
```

The **\$include** parameter adds relationship data to the output (see Eager Loading below). Pass an array of relationship names:

```
// Include relationships in the dict  
$data = $note->toDict(["comments"]);
```

toJson

Convert directly to a JSON string:

```
$jsonString = $note->toJson();  
// '{"id": 1, "title": "Shopping List", ...}'
```

toArray vs toDict

This distinction matters. `toDict()` returns an associative array with property names as keys. `toArray()` returns an indexed array of values with keys stripped:

```
$note = Note::findById(1);

$note->toDict();
// ["id" => 1, "title" => "Shopping List", "content" => "Milk, eggs"]

$note->toArray();
// [1, "Shopping List", "Milk, eggs"]
```

toObject() -- Returns a stdClass

`toObject()` returns a PHP `stdClass` object, not an array. This differs from `toDict()` which returns an associative array:

```
$user = (new User())->findById(1);

$obj = $user->toObject();
var_dump(is_object($obj)); // bool(true)
echo $obj->name;           // access as object property

$arr = $user->toDict();
var_dump(is_array($arr)); // bool(true)
echo $arr["name"];        // access as array key
```

All Serialisation Methods

Method	Returns	Description
<code>toDict(\$include)</code>	array	Associative array, keyed by PHP property names
<code>toAssoc(\$include)</code>	array	Alias for <code>toDict()</code>
<code>toObject()</code>	stdClass	PHP object (NOT an array) — properties match PHP property names
<code>toJson(\$include)</code>	string	JSON string
<code>toArray()</code>	array	Indexed array of values (no keys)
<code>toList()</code>	array	Alias for <code>toArray()</code>

6. Relationships

\$foreignKeys — Auto-Wired Relationships

Declaring `public array $foreignKeys = ['user_id' => 'User']` on a model automatically wires both sides of the relationship. The declaring model gets a `belongsTo` accessor (the column name with `_id` stripped), and the referenced model gets a `hasMany` accessor (the declaring class name lowercased with `s` appended).

```
<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class User extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "users";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";
}

class Post extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";

    // Auto-wires $post->user (belongs_to) and $user->posts (has_many)
    public array $foreignKeys = [
        'user_id' => 'User',
    ];
}
```

With just the `$foreignKeys` array, both sides are accessible:

```
$post = new Post($db);
$post->load('id = 1');
echo $post->user->name;           // "Alice"

$user = new User($db);
$user->load('id = 1');
foreach ($user->posts as $post) {
    echo $post->title . "\n";
}
```

For a custom `has_many` key, use the extended form:

```
public array $foreignKeys = [
    'user_id' => ['model' => 'User', 'related_name' => 'blog_posts'],
];
// $user->blog_posts instead of $user->posts
```

hasMany

An author has many posts:

Create `src/orm/Author.php`:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;
```

```
class Author extends ORM
```

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```

{
    public string $tableName = "authors";

    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $email;
    public string $bio = "";
    public string $createdAt;
}

```

Create `src/orm/BlogPost.php`:

```

<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class BlogPost extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";

    public int $id;
    public int $authorId;
    public string $title;
    public string $slug;
    public string $content = "";
    public string $status = "draft";
    public string $createdAt;
    public string $updatedAt;
}

```

Now use `hasMany()` to get an author's posts:

```

Router::get("/api/authors/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $author = Author::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($author === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Author not found"], 404);
    }

    $posts = $author->hasMany(BlogPost::class, "author_id");

    $data = $author->toDict();
    $data["posts"] = array_map(fn(BlogPost $p) => $p->toDict(), $posts);

    return $response($data);
});

{
    "id": 1,
    "name": "Alice",
    "email": "alice@example.com",
    "bio": "Tech writer",
    "posts": [
        {"id": 1, "title": "Getting Started with Tina4", "slug": "getting-started", "status": "publi"},
        {"id": 2, "title": "Advanced Routing", "slug": "advanced-routing", "status": "draft"}
    ]
}

```

hasOne

A user has one profile:

```
$profile = $user->hasOne(Profile::class, "user_id");
```

Returns a single model instance or **null**.

belongsTo

A post belongs to an author:

```
Router::get("/api/posts/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $post = BlogPost::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($post === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Post not found"], 404);
    }

    $author = $post->belongsTo(Author::class, "author_id");

    $data = $post->toDict();
    $data["author"] = $author ? $author->toDict() : null;

    return $response($data);
});

{
    "id": 1,
    "authorId": 1,
    "title": "Getting Started with Tina4",
    "slug": "getting-started",
    "content": "...",
    "status": "published",
    "author": {
        "id": 1,
        "name": "Alice",
        "email": "alice@example.com"
    }
}
```

Declarative Relationships

Instead of calling relationship methods in every route, declare them as array properties on the model. Each entry is a two-element array: **[ClassName, foreign_key_column]**.

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Author extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "authors";
    public array $hasMany = [
        ["BlogPost", "author_id"],
    ];

    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $email;
```

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```

}

<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class BlogPost extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";
    public array $hasOne = [
        ["Author", "author_id"],
    ];
    public array $hasMany = [
        ["Comment", "post_id"],
    ];

    public int $id;
    public int $authorId;
    public string $title;
    public string $content = "";
}

```

With declarative relationships, accessing the magic property triggers lazy loading. The property name is the lowercase class name (or the lowercase plural for **hasMany**):

```

$author = (new Author())->findById(1);
$posts  = $author->posts;    // Lazy-loads BlogPost records via the hasMany declaration

$post   = (new BlogPost())->findById(1);
$author = $post->author;     // Lazy-loads the related Author via hasOne

```

7. Eager Loading

Calling relationship methods inside a loop creates the N+1 problem. Load 10 authors. Call **hasMany(BlogPost::class, "author_id")** for each one. That fires 11 queries -- 1 for authors, 10 for posts. The page drags.

The **\$include** parameter on **toDict()** and **selectOne()** solves this. It eager-loads relationships in bulk.

For models with declarative relationships (**\$hasOne**, **\$hasMany**, **\$belongsTo** array properties), pass a list of relationship names:

```

// Eager load posts when serialising an author
$author = Author::findById(1);
$data = $author->toDict(["posts"]);

// Eager load author and comments when serialising a post
$post = BlogPost::findById(1);
$data = $post->toDict(["author", "comments"]);

```

Nested Eager Loading

Dot notation loads multiple levels deep:

```

// Load author with posts, and each post with its comments

```

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```
$data = $author->toDict(["posts", "posts.comments"]);
```

Authors, their posts, and each post's comments. Three queries total instead of hundreds.

toDict with Nested Includes

When eager loading is active, `toDict()` embeds the related data:

```
$post = BlogPost::findById(1);
$data = $post->toDict(["author", "comments"]);

{
  "id": 1,
  "title": "Getting Started with Tina4",
  "author": {
    "id": 1,
    "name": "Alice",
    "email": "alice@example.com"
  },
  "comments": [
    {"id": 1, "body": "Great post!", "authorName": "Bob"}
  ]
}
```

8. Soft Delete

Sometimes a record needs to disappear from queries without leaving the database. Soft delete handles this. The row stays. A flag marks it as deleted. Queries skip it.

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Task extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "tasks";
    public bool $softDelete = true; // Enable soft delete

    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public bool $completed = false;
    public int $isDeleted = 0; // Required for soft delete (0 = active, 1 = deleted)
    public string $createdAt;
}
```

When `$softDelete` is `true`, the ORM changes its behaviour:

- `$task->delete()` sets `is_deleted` to `1` instead of running a DELETE query
- `Task::find()`, `(new Task)->where()`, and `Task::findById()` filter out records where `is_deleted = 1`
- `$task->restore()` sets `is_deleted` back to `0` and makes the record visible again
- `$task->forceDelete()` permanently removes the row from the database
- `(new Task)->withTrashed()` includes soft-deleted records in query results

The soft delete column is `is_deleted` (integer, 0 or 1). There is no `deleted_at` timestamp column -- just the flag.

Deleting and Restoring

```
// Soft delete -- sets is_deleted = 1, row stays in the database
$task = Task::findById(1);
$task->delete();

// Restore -- sets is_deleted = 0, record is visible again
$task->restore();

// Permanently delete -- removes the row, no recovery possible
$task->forceDelete();
```

`restore()` is the inverse of `delete()`. It sets `is_deleted` back to 0 and commits the change. The record reappears in all standard queries.

Including Soft-Deleted Records

Standard queries (`all()`, `where()`, `findById()`) exclude soft-deleted records. When you need to see everything -- for admin dashboards, audit logs, or data recovery -- use `withTrashed()`:

```
// All tasks, including soft-deleted ones
$allTasks = (new Task())->withTrashed();

// Soft-deleted tasks matching a condition
$deletedTasks = (new Task())->withTrashed("completed = ?", [1]);
```

`withTrashed()` accepts the same filter parameters as `where()`. The only difference: it ignores the `is_deleted` filter that standard queries apply.

Counting with Soft Delete

The `count()` method respects soft delete. It only counts non-deleted records:

```
$activeCount = (new Task())->count();
$activeWork = (new Task())->count("category = ?", ["work"]);
```

When to Use Soft Delete

Soft delete suits data that users might want to recover -- emails, documents, user accounts. It also serves audit requirements where regulations demand retention. For temporary data (sessions, cache entries, logs), hard delete keeps the table lean.

9. Auto-CRUD

Writing the same five REST endpoints for every model gets tedious. Auto-CRUD generates them from your model class. Define the model. Register it. Five routes appear.

The autoCrud Flag

The simplest approach -- set `$autoCrud = true` on your model class:

```
<?php
```

```

use Tina4\ORM;

class Note extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "notes";
    public bool $autoCrud = true; // Generates REST endpoints automatically

    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public string $content = "";
}

```

The moment PHP loads this class, the ORM registers it with AutoCrud. Five routes appear.

Manual Registration

You can also register models explicitly using the **AutoCrud** class:

```

use Tina4\AutoCrud;
use Tina4\Database\Database;

$db = Database::create("sqlite:///path/to/app.db");
$crud = new AutoCrud($db);
$crud->register(Note::class);
$crud->generateRoutes();

```

Both approaches produce the same result:

Method	Path	Description
GET	/api/notes	List all with pagination (limit, offset params)
GET	/api/notes/{id}	Get one by primary key
POST	/api/notes	Create a new record
PUT	/api/notes/{id}	Update a record
DELETE	/api/notes/{id}	Delete a record

The endpoint prefix derives from the table name. The **notes** table becomes **/api/notes**. Pass a custom prefix to the **AutoCrud** constructor to change it:

```

$crud = new AutoCrud($db, prefix: "/api/v2");
// Routes: /api/v2/notes, /api/v2/notes/{id}, etc.

```

Auto-Discovering Models

Rather than registering each model by hand, point **discover()** at your models directory. It scans every **.php** file, finds ORM subclasses, and registers them all:

```

use Tina4\AutoCrud;

$crud = new AutoCrud($db);
$crud->discover("src/orm");
$crud->generateRoutes();

```

Every ORM model in **src/orm/** gets five REST endpoints. No route files needed.

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What the Generated Routes Do

GET /api/notes returns paginated results:

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/notes?limit=10&offset=0"
```

```
{
  "data": [
    {"id": 1, "title": "Shopping List", "content": "Milk, eggs", "category": "personal", "pinned": false},
    {"id": 2, "title": "Sprint Plan", "content": "Review backlog", "category": "work", "pinned": true}
  ],
  "total": 2,
  "limit": 10,
  "offset": 0
}
```

POST /api/notes creates a record:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/notes \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"title": "New Note", "content": "Created via auto-CRUD"}'
```

DELETE /api/notes/1 respects soft delete. If the model has `$softDelete = true`, the record is marked deleted instead of removed.

Sorting and Filtering

The list endpoint accepts `sort` and `filter` query parameters:

```
# Sort by name descending, then created_at ascending
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/notes?sort=-name,created_at"

# Filter by column values
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/notes?filter[category]=work"
```

The `-` prefix on a sort field means descending order.

Custom Routes Alongside Auto-CRUD

Custom routes defined in `src/routes/` load before auto-CRUD routes. They take precedence. If you need special logic for one endpoint (custom validation, side effects, complex queries), define that route manually. Auto-CRUD handles the rest.

Introspection

Check which models are registered:

```
$crud = new AutoCrud($db);
$crud->register(Note::class);
$registered = $crud->getModels();
// ["notes" => "Note"]
```

10. Database Connection

Setting the Global Database

The ORM needs a database connection. Three ways to provide one:

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```

use Tina4\ORM;
use Tina4\Database\Database;

// Option 1: Set globally on ORM
$db = Database::create("sqlite:///path/to/app.db");
ORM::setGlobalDb($db);

// Option 2: Set via App
App::setDatabase($db);

// Option 3: Set TINA4_DATABASE_URL in .env (auto-discovered)
// TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///path/to/app.db

```

Once a global database is set, all ORM models resolve it. You can also pass a database adapter to a specific instance:

```
$note = new Note($db);
```

The resolution order is: instance `$_db` -> global `ORM::setGlobalDb()` -> `App::getDatabase()` -> `Database::fromEnv()`. If none is found, the ORM throws a `RuntimeException`.

11. Raw SQL and DatabaseResult

When you drop below the ORM to execute raw SQL, `$db->fetch()` returns a `DatabaseResult` object. This object has a `->records` property containing the rows -- it is **not** a plain array.

```

$result = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM users WHERE active = ?", [1]);

// WRONG -- $result is not an array:
foreach ($result['data'] as $row) { ... }

// RIGHT -- iterate over ->records:
foreach ($result->records as $row) {
    echo $row->name;
}

```

`$result->records` is an array of `stdClass` objects, one per row. Column names map to object properties.

```

// Fetch a single row
$result = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM users WHERE id = ?", [42]);
if (!empty($result->records)) {
    $user = $result->records[0];
    echo $user->email;
}

```

Note: ORM methods (`findById()`, `find()`, `where()`, etc.) return model instances or arrays of model instances -- not `DatabaseResult`. The `DatabaseResult` object only appears when you call `$db->fetch()` directly.

12. Scopes

Scopes are reusable query filters baked into the model. Register them with the `scope()` method, then call them as static methods:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class BlogPost extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";

    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public string $status = "draft";
    public string $createdAt;
}

// Register scopes
(new BlogPost()->scope("published", "status = ?", ["published"]));
(new BlogPost()->scope("drafts", "status = ?", ["draft"]));
```

Use them in your routes:

```
Router::get("/api/posts/published", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $posts = BlogPost::published();
    return $response(["posts" => array_map(fn($p) => $p->toDict(), $posts)]);
});

Router::get("/api/posts/drafts", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $posts = BlogPost::drafts();
    return $response(["posts" => array_map(fn($p) => $p->toDict(), $posts)]);
});
```

Scopes accept `$limit` and `$offset` as arguments:

```
$recentPublished = BlogPost::published(10, 0); // limit 10, offset 0
```

Scopes keep query logic in the model where it belongs. Route handlers stay thin.

13. Input Validation

Override the `validate()` method on your model to add validation rules:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Product extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "products";

    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $sku;
    public float $price;
```

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```

public string $category;

public function validate(): array
{
    $errors = [];

    if (empty($this->name) || strlen($this->name) < 2) {
        $errors[] = "name: Must be at least 2 characters";
    }
    if (strlen($this->name) > 200) {
        $errors[] = "name: Must be at most 200 characters";
    }
    if (!preg_match('/^[A-Z]{2}-\d{4}$/', $this->sku ?? '')) {
        $errors[] = "sku: Must match pattern XX-0000 (e.g., EL-1234)";
    }
    if (($this->price ?? 0) < 0.01 || ($this->price ?? 0) > 999999.99) {
        $errors[] = "price: Must be between 0.01 and 999999.99";
    }
    if (!in_array($this->category ?? '', ["Electronics", "Kitchen", "Office", "Fitness"])) {
        $errors[] = "category: Must be one of: Electronics, Kitchen, Office, Fitness";
    }

    return $errors;
}
}

Router::post("/api/products", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = $request->body["name"] ?? "";
    $product->sku = $request->body["sku"] ?? "";
    $product->price = $request->body["price"] ?? 0;
    $product->category = $request->body["category"] ?? "";

    $errors = $product->validate();
    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    $product->save();
    return $response(["product" => $product->toDict()], 201);
});

```

If validation fails, `validate()` returns an array of error messages:

```

{
    "errors": [
        "name: Must be at least 2 characters",
        "sku: Must match pattern XX-0000 (e.g., EL-1234)",
        "price: Must be between 0.01 and 999999.99",
        "category: Must be one of: Electronics, Kitchen, Office, Fitness"
    ]
}
---

```

14. QueryBuilder Integration

ORM models provide a `query()` static method that returns a `QueryBuilder` pre-configured with the model's table name and database connection. This gives you a fluent API for building complex queries without writing raw SQL:

```
// Fluent query builder from ORM
$results = User::query()
    ->select("id", "name", "email")
    ->where("active = ?", [1])
    ->orderBy("name")
    ->limit(50)
    ->get();

// First matching record
$user = User::query()
    ->where("email = ?", ["alice@example.com"])
    ->first();

// Count
$total = User::query()
    ->where("role = ?", ["admin"])
    ->count();

// Check existence
$exists = User::query()
    ->where("email = ?", ["test@example.com"])
    ->exists();
```

See the [QueryBuilder chapter](#) for the full fluent API including joins, grouping, having, and MongoDB support.

15. Exercise: Build a Blog with Relationships

Build a blog API with authors, posts, and comments.

Requirements

- Create these models:

Author: `id`, `name` (required), `email` (required), `bio`, `created_at`

Post: `id`, `author_id` (integer foreign key), `title` (required, max 300), `slug` (required), `content`, `status` (choices: draft/published/archived, default draft), `created_at`, `updated_at`

Comment: `id`, `post_id` (integer foreign key), `author_name` (required), `author_email` (required), `body` (required, min 5 chars), `created_at`

- Build these endpoints:

Method	Path	Description
POST	<code>/api/authors</code>	Create an author
GET	<code>/api/authors/{id}</code>	Get author with their posts

POST	/api/posts	Create a post (requires author_id)
GET	/api/posts	List published posts with author info
GET	/api/posts/{id}	Get post with author and comments
POST	/api/posts/{id}/comments	Add comment to a post

16. Solution

Create `src/orm/Author.php`:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Author extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "authors";

    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $email;
    public string $bio = "";
    public string $createdAt;

    public function validate(): array
    {
        $errors = [];
        if (empty($this->name) || strlen($this->name) < 2) {
            $errors[] = "name: Must be at least 2 characters";
        }
        if (empty($this->email)) {
            $errors[] = "email: Required";
        }
        return $errors;
    }
}
```

Create `src/orm/BlogPost.php`:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class BlogPost extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "posts";

    public int $id;
    public int $authorId;
}
```

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```

public string $title;
public string $slug;
public string $content = "";
public string $status = "draft";
public string $createdAt;
public string $updatedAt;

public function validate(): array
{
    $errors = [];
    if (empty($this->title)) {
        $errors[] = "title: Required";
    }
    if (strlen($this->title ?? '') > 300) {
        $errors[] = "title: Must be at most 300 characters";
    }
    if (empty($this->slug)) {
        $errors[] = "slug: Required";
    }
    if (!in_array($this->status ?? 'draft', ["draft", "published", "archived"])) {
        $errors[] = "status: Must be one of: draft, published, archived";
    }
    return $errors;
}
}

```

Register a scope for published posts:

```
(new BlogPost())->scope("published", "status = ?", ["published"]);
```

Create [src/orm/Comment.php](#):

```

<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Comment extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "comments";

    public int $id;
    public int $postId;
    public string $authorName;
    public string $authorEmail;
    public string $body;
    public string $createdAt;

    public function validate(): array
    {
        $errors = [];
        if (empty($this->authorName)) {
            $errors[] = "authorName: Required";
        }
        if (empty($this->authorEmail)) {
            $errors[] = "authorEmail: Required";
        }
        if (empty($this->body) || strlen($this->body) < 5) {
            $errors[] = "body: Must be at least 5 characters";
        }
        return $errors;
    }
}

```

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```
}  
}
```

Create `src/routes/blog.php`:

```
<?php  
  
use Tina4\Router;  
use Tina4\Request;  
use Tina4\Response;  
  
Router::post("/api/authors", function (Request $request, Response $response) {  
    $author = new Author();  
    $author->name = $request->body["name"] ?? "";  
    $author->email = $request->body["email"] ?? "";  
    $author->bio = $request->body["bio"] ?? "";  
  
    $errors = $author->validate();  
    if (!empty($errors)) {  
        return $response(["errors" => $errors], 400);  
    }  
  
    $author->save();  
    return $response(["author" => $author->toDict()], 201);  
});  
  
Router::get("/api/authors/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {  
    $author = Author::findById($request->params["id"]);  
  
    if ($author === null) {  
        return $response(["error" => "Author not found"], 404);  
    }  
  
    $posts = $author->hasMany(BlogPost::class, "author_id");  
  
    $data = $author->toDict();  
    $data["posts"] = array_map(fn(BlogPost $p) => $p->toDict(), $posts);  
  
    return $response($data);  
});  
  
Router::post("/api/posts", function (Request $request, Response $response) {  
    $body = $request->body;  
  
    // Verify author exists  
    $author = Author::findById($body["author_id"] ?? 0);  
    if ($author === null) {  
        return $response(["error" => "Author not found"], 404);  
    }  
  
    $post = new BlogPost();  
    $post->authorId = $body["author_id"];  
    $post->title = $body["title"] ?? "";  
    $post->slug = $body["slug"] ?? "";  
    $post->content = $body["content"] ?? "";  
    $post->status = $body["status"] ?? "draft";  
  
    $errors = $post->validate();  
    if (!empty($errors)) {  
        _____  
    }  
});
```

```

        return $response(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    $post->save();
    return $response(["post" => $post->toDict()], 201);
});

Router::get("/api/posts", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $posts = BlogPost::published();
    $data = [];

    foreach ($posts as $p) {
        $postDict = $p->toDict();
        $author = $p->belongsTo(Author::class, "author_id");
        $postDict["author"] = $author ? $author->toDict() : null;
        $data[] = $postDict;
    }

    return $response(["posts" => $data, "count" => count($data)]);
});

Router::get("/api/posts/{id}", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $post = BlogPost::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($post === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Post not found"], 404);
    }

    $author = $post->belongsTo(Author::class, "author_id");
    $comments = $post->hasMany(Comment::class, "post_id");

    $data = $post->toDict();
    $data["author"] = $author ? $author->toDict() : null;
    $data["comments"] = array_map(fn(Comment $c) => $c->toDict(), $comments);
    $data["commentCount"] = count($comments);

    return $response($data);
});

Router::post("/api/posts/{id}/comments", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $post = BlogPost::findById($request->params["id"]);

    if ($post === null) {
        return $response(["error" => "Post not found"], 404);
    }

    $comment = new Comment();
    $comment->postId = (int)$request->params["id"];
    $comment->authorName = $request->body["author_name"] ?? "";
    $comment->authorEmail = $request->body["author_email"] ?? "";
    $comment->body = $request->body["body"] ?? "";

    $errors = $comment->validate();
    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    $comment->save();
    return $response(["comment" => $comment->toDict()], 201);
});

```

```
});
```

17. Gotchas

1. Forgetting to call save()

Problem: You set properties on a model but the database does not change.

Cause: Setting `$note->title = "New Title"` only changes the PHP object. The database remains unchanged until you call `$note->save()`.

Fix: Call `save()` after modifying properties. Check the return value -- `save()` returns `$this` on success and `false` on failure.

2. findById() returns null

Problem: You call `Note::findById($id)` but get `null` instead of a note object.

Cause: `findById()` returns `null` when no row matches the given primary key. If soft delete is enabled, `findById()` also excludes soft-deleted records.

Fix: Check for `null` after `findById()`: `if ($note === null) { return $response(["error" => "Not found"], 404); }`. Use `findOrFail()` if you want a `RuntimeException` raised instead.

3. find() vs findById()

Problem: You call `Note::find(42)` expecting a single record, but get a type error.

Cause: `find()` takes an associative array filter (`find(["id" => 42])`), not a bare primary key value. For single-record lookups by primary key, use `findById(42)`.

Fix: Use `findById($id)` for primary key lookups. Use `find(["column" => $value])` for filter-based queries.

4. Static vs instance methods

Problem: You call `Note::where("category = ?", ["work"])` but get an error.

Cause: `where()`, `all()`, `select()`, `selectOne()`, `count()`, and `withTrashed()` are instance methods. `findById()`, `findOrFail()`, `find()`, `create()`, and `query()` are static methods.

Fix: For instance methods, create an instance first: `(new Note())->where(...)`. Static methods call directly: `Note::findById(...)`.

5. toDict() includes everything

Problem: `$user->toDict()` includes `passwordHash` in the API response.

Cause: `toDict()` includes all fields by default.

Fix: Build the response array manually, omitting sensitive fields: `["id" => $user->id, "name" => $user->name, "email" => $user->email]`. Or create a helper method on

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your model class that returns only safe fields.

6. Validation only runs on validate()

Problem: You call `save()` without calling `validate()` first, and invalid data gets into the database.

Cause: `save()` does not validate. This is by design -- sometimes you need to save partial data or bypass validation for bulk operations.

Fix: Call `$errors = $model->validate()` before `save()` in your route handlers.

7. Soft delete column is *isdeleted*, not *deletedat*

Problem: You add a `deleted_at` timestamp column expecting soft delete to use it.

Cause: Tina4's soft delete uses an `is_deleted` integer column (0 = active, 1 = deleted). It does not use a `deleted_at` timestamp.

Fix: Add an `is_deleted` integer column to your table with a default of 0. Set `$softDelete = true` on the model.

8. N+1 query problem

Problem: Listing 100 authors with their posts runs 101 queries (1 for authors + 100 for posts), and the page loads slowly.

Cause: You call `$author->hasMany(BlogPost::class, "author_id")` inside a loop for each author.

Fix: Use declarative relationships with `$hasMany/$hasOne/$belongsTo` array properties and eager loading via `toDict(["posts"])`. Or fetch all posts in a single query and group them manually.

9. Auto-CRUD endpoint conflicts

Problem: Custom route at `/api/notes/{id}` stops working after registering Auto-CRUD for the Note model.

Cause: Both routes match the same path. The first registered route wins.

Fix: Custom routes in `src/routes/` load before Auto-CRUD routes. They take precedence. If you want different behaviour, use a different path for the custom route.

10. Soft-deleted records appearing in queries

Problem: You soft-deleted a record, but queries still return it.

Cause: Soft delete requires the `$softDelete = true` flag on the model class and an `is_deleted` column in the database table. Without both, soft delete is inactive.

Fix: Verify both the `$softDelete = true` flag and the `is_deleted` column exist. The column stores 0 for active records and 1 for deleted ones.

11. `$db->fetch()` returns `DatabaseResult`, not an array

Problem: You call `$db->fetch(...)` and try to iterate over it as an array, getting a type error or empty results.

Cause: `$db->fetch()` returns a `DatabaseResult` object. The rows are in `$result->records`, not in `$result['data']` or `$result` itself.

Fix: Access `->records`:

```
// WRONG:
foreach ($result['data'] as $row) { ... }

// RIGHT:
foreach ($result->records as $row) { ... }
```

This only applies to raw `$db->fetch()` calls. ORM methods (`findById()`, `find()`, `where()`, etc.) return model instances directly.

QueryBuilder

1. Why a Query Builder?

Chapter 5 used raw SQL strings. Chapter 6 wrapped single-table CRUD in the ORM. Both work. Neither handles the messy middle ground well: multi-table joins, conditional filters, pagination, aggregation. You end up concatenating SQL fragments, juggling parameter arrays, and debugging mismatched question marks.

The QueryBuilder sits between raw SQL and the ORM. It builds SQL programmatically through a fluent, chainable API. Every method returns `$this`, so you compose queries left to right. When you need the SQL string, call `toSql()`. When you need results, call `get()`, `first()`, `count()`, or `exists()`.

No magic. No hidden queries. You see exactly what runs.

2. The Factory: `QueryBuilder::from()`

The constructor is private. You create a QueryBuilder through the static `from()` method:

```
<?php
use Tina4\QueryBuilder;
use Tina4\Database\Database;

$db = Database::create("sqlite:///data/app.db");

$qb = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db);
```

Two arguments:

- `$table` -- The table name. This becomes the `FROM` clause.
- `$db` -- A `DatabaseAdapter` instance. Optional if you only need `toSql()`, required if you call any execution method.

The factory returns a fresh `QueryBuilder` instance. Chain methods directly:

```
$result = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
    ->select("id", "name")
    ->where("active = ?", [1])
    ->get();
```

3. Selecting Columns: `select()`

By default the builder selects all columns (`*`). Narrow the selection with `select()`:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
    ->select("id", "name", "price");
```

Pass column names as separate string arguments. Expressions work too:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "SUM(total) as revenue");
```

If you never call `select()`, the builder uses `SELECT *`.

4. Filtering: `where()`

Add a `WHERE` condition with `where()`:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
->where("active = ?", [1]);
```

The first argument is the SQL condition. Use `?` placeholders for parameter binding. The second argument is an array of values that replace the placeholders in order.

Multiple `where()` Calls

Each call adds an `AND` condition:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->where("price > ?", [10])
->where("category = ?", ["electronics"]);
```

Generates:

```
SELECT * FROM products WHERE price > ? AND category = ?
```

Parameters are accumulated in order: `[10, "electronics"]`.

Conditions Without Parameters

For conditions that do not need binding:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
->where("email IS NOT NULL");
```

The second argument defaults to an empty array.

5. OR Conditions: `orWhere()`

Use `orWhere()` to add an `OR` condition:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->where("category = ?", ["books"])
->orWhere("category = ?", ["music"]);
```

Generates:

```
SELECT * FROM products WHERE category = ? OR category = ?
```

The first condition in the chain never has a connector prefix. The second gets `OR`. If you mix `where()` and `orWhere()`, they appear in order:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->where("active = ?", [1])
->where("price > ?", [5])
```

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```
->orWhere("featured = ?", [1]);
```

Generates:

```
SELECT * FROM products WHERE active = ? AND price > ? OR featured = ?
```

Standard SQL operator precedence applies. If you need grouping, write the grouped condition as a single string:

```
->where("(category = ? OR category = ?)", ["books", "music"])
```

6. Joins: `join()` and `leftJoin()`

Inner Join

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("orders.id", "users.name", "orders.total")
->join("users", "users.id = orders.user_id");
```

Generates:

```
SELECT orders.id, users.name, orders.total FROM orders INNER JOIN users ON users.id = orders.user_id
```

Left Join

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
->select("users.name", "orders.id as order_id")
->leftJoin("orders", "orders.user_id = users.id");
```

Generates:

```
SELECT users.name, orders.id as order_id FROM users LEFT JOIN orders ON orders.user_id = users.id
```

Multiple Joins

Chain as many as you need:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("orders.id", "users.name", "products.name as product")
->join("users", "users.id = orders.user_id")
->join("order_items", "order_items.order_id = orders.id")
->join("products", "products.id = order_items.product_id");
```

Joins appear in the SQL in the order you call them.

7. Grouping: `groupBy()`

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "COUNT(*) as order_count")
->groupBy("customer_id");
```

Generates:

```
SELECT customer_id, COUNT(*) as order_count FROM orders GROUP BY customer_id
```

Call `groupBy()` multiple times for multiple columns:

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```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "status", "COUNT(*) as cnt")
->groupBy("customer_id")
->groupBy("status");
```

Generates:

```
SELECT customer_id, status, COUNT(*) as cnt FROM orders GROUP BY customer_id, status
```

8. Filtering Groups: `having()`

`having()` filters aggregated results. It works like `where()` but applies after **GROUP BY**:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "SUM(total) as revenue")
->groupBy("customer_id")
->having("SUM(total) > ?", [1000]);
```

Generates:

```
SELECT customer_id, SUM(total) as revenue FROM orders GROUP BY customer_id HAVING SUM(total) > ?
```

Multiple `having()` calls are joined with **AND**:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "COUNT(*) as cnt", "SUM(total) as revenue")
->groupBy("customer_id")
->having("COUNT(*) > ?", [5])
->having("SUM(total) > ?", [500]);
```

Generates:

```
... HAVING COUNT(*) > ? AND SUM(total) > ?
```

9. Sorting: `orderBy()`

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->orderBy("price ASC");
```

Pass the column name and direction as a single string. Call multiple times for multi-column sorts:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->orderBy("category ASC")
->orderBy("price DESC");
```

Generates:

```
SELECT * FROM products ORDER BY category ASC, price DESC
```

10. Pagination: `limit()`

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->limit(10);
```

With an offset for pagination:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
->limit(10, 20); // 10 rows, skip 20
```

The first argument is the maximum number of rows. The second is the offset (number of rows to skip). When you call `get()` without ever calling `limit()`, the builder defaults to 100 rows with offset 0.

11. Inspecting the SQL: `toSql()`

`toSql()` returns the constructed SQL string without executing it. Invaluable for debugging:

```
$qb = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
->select("customer_id", "SUM(total) as revenue")
->join("users", "users.id = orders.user_id")
->where("orders.status = ?", ["completed"])
->groupBy("customer_id")
->having("SUM(total) > ?", [1000])
->orderBy("revenue DESC")
->limit(10);
```

```
echo $qb->toSql();
```

Output:

```
SELECT customer_id, SUM(total) as revenue FROM orders INNER JOIN users ON users.id = orders.user_id
```

Note: `toSql()` does not include the `LIMIT/OFFSET` in the SQL string. Those values are passed to the database adapter's `fetch()` method as separate arguments.

`toSql()` does not require a database connection. Use it to build SQL strings for logging, testing, or manual inspection without connecting to a database.

12. Execution Methods

Four methods execute the query against the database. All require a `DatabaseAdapter` passed to `from()`.

`get()` -- Fetch All Matching Rows

```
$result = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
->where("active = ?", [1])
->orderBy("name ASC")
->limit(25)
->get();
```

Returns the raw result from `DatabaseAdapter::fetch()`. Access rows through `$result['data']`:

```
foreach ($result['data'] as $row) {
    echo $row['name'] . "\n";
}
```

first() -- Fetch a Single Row

```
$user = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
    ->where("email = ?", ["alice@example.com"])
    ->first();

if ($user !== null) {
    echo $user['name'];
}
```

Returns an associative array for the first matching row, or `null` if nothing matches. Internally sets the limit to 1.

count() -- Count Matching Rows

```
$total = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
    ->where("status = ?", ["pending"])
    ->count();

echo "Pending orders: {$total}";
```

Returns an integer. Internally replaces your column list with `COUNT(*) as cnt`, executes, and restores the original columns.

exists() -- Check for Any Match

```
$hasAdmin = QueryBuilder::from("users", $db)
    ->where("role = ?", ["admin"])
    ->exists();

if ($hasAdmin) {
    echo "Admin exists";
}
```

Returns a boolean. Calls `count()` internally and checks if the result is greater than zero.

13. Chaining It All Together

Every method returns `$this`. Chain them in any order (though a logical order improves readability):

```
$topCustomers = QueryBuilder::from("orders", $db)
    ->select("users.name", "users.email", "COUNT(*) as order_count", "SUM(orders.total) as total")
    ->join("users", "users.id = orders.user_id")
    ->where("orders.created_at > ?", ["2025-01-01"])
    ->where("orders.status = ?", ["completed"])
    ->groupBy("users.name")
    ->groupBy("users.email")
    ->having("SUM(orders.total) > ?", [500])
    ->orderBy("total_spent DESC")
    ->limit(10)
    ->get();
```

This single chain:

- Joins orders with users.

- Filters to completed orders in 2025.
- Groups by customer.
- Keeps only customers who spent more than 500.
- Sorts by spending, highest first.
- Returns the top 10.

Using QueryBuilder in Routes

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\QueryBuilder;

Router::get("/api/products", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    global $db;

    $qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
        ->select("id", "name", "price", "category")
        ->where("active = ?", [1])
        ->orderBy("name ASC")
        ->limit(50);

    $result = $qb->get();

    return $response($result['data']);
});
```

Dynamic Filters

Build queries conditionally based on request parameters:

```
Router::get("/api/products/search", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    global $db;

    $qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
        ->select("id", "name", "price", "category")
        ->where("active = ?", [1]);

    if (!empty($request->query["category"])) {
        $qb->where("category = ?", [$request->query["category"]]);
    }

    if (!empty($request->query["min_price"])) {
        $qb->where("price >= ?", [(float)$request->query["min_price"]]);
    }

    if (!empty($request->query["max_price"])) {
        $qb->where("price <= ?", [(float)$request->query["max_price"]]);
    }

    $sortBy = $request->query["sort"] ?? "name ASC";
    $qb->orderBy($sortBy);

    $limit = (int)($request->query["limit"] ?? 25);
    $offset = (int)($request->query["page"] ?? 0) * $limit;
    $qb->limit($limit, $offset);
```

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```

        $result = $qb->get();

        return $response($result['data']);
    });

```

This is where the builder shines. Conditional filters with raw SQL require clumsy `if` blocks that splice strings and shuffle parameter arrays. With the builder, each `->where()` call simply appends a condition. No index juggling. No string concatenation.

14. ORM Integration

ORM models can expose a `query()` static method that returns a `QueryBuilder` pre-configured with the model's table and the global database connection:

```

class User extends \Tina4\ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "users";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";

    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $email;
    public bool $active = true;

    public static function query(): QueryBuilder
    {
        global $db;
        return QueryBuilder::from("users", $db);
    }
}

```

Then query through the model:

```

$activeUsers = User::query()
    ->where("active = ?", [1])
    ->orderBy("name ASC")
    ->get();

$count = User::query()
    ->where("role = ?", ["admin"])
    ->count();

$first = User::query()
    ->where("email = ?", ["alice@example.com"])
    ->first();

```

This keeps the ORM for simple CRUD (`save()`, `load()`, `delete()`) and the `QueryBuilder` for complex reads. Both use the same table. Both use parameterised queries. Pick the tool that fits the job.

15. NoSQL: MongoDB Queries

The QueryBuilder can generate MongoDB-compatible query documents with `toMongo()`. This returns an associative array containing the filter, projection, sort, limit, and skip -- ready to pass to the MongoDB PHP driver.

Operator Mapping

SQL Operator	MongoDB Operator
=	Exact match
!=	<code>\$ne</code>
>	<code>\$gt</code>
<	<code>\$lt</code>
>=	<code>\$gte</code>
<=	<code>\$lte</code>
LIKE	<code>\$regex</code>
IN	<code>\$in</code>
IS NULL	<code>\$exists: false</code>
IS NOT NULL	<code>\$exists: true</code>

Example

```
$query = QueryBuilder::from("users")
    ->select("name", "email")
    ->where("age > ?", [25])
    ->where("status = ?", ["active"])
    ->orderBy("name ASC")
    ->limit(10)
    ->offset(5);
```

```
$mongo = $query->toMongo();
```

The returned array:

```
[
    "filter" => ["age" => ['$gt' => 25], "status" => "active"],
    "projection" => ["name" => 1, "email" => 1],
    "sort" => ["name" => 1],
    "limit" => 10,
    "skip" => 5,
]
```

Pass it directly to the MongoDB driver:

```
$collection = $client->selectCollection("mydb", "users");
$cursor = $collection->find(
    $mongo["filter"],
    [
```

```

        "projection" => $mongo["projection"],
        "sort" => $mongo["sort"],
        "limit" => $mongo["limit"],
        "skip" => $mongo["skip"],
    ]
);
---

```

16. Gotchas

No Database Adapter

Calling `get()`, `first()`, `count()`, or `exists()` without a database adapter throws a `RuntimeException`:

```

$qqb = QueryBuilder::from("users"); // no $db
$qqb->get(); // RuntimeException: QueryBuilder: No database adapter provided.

```

Fix: pass a `DatabaseAdapter` as the second argument to `from()`.

Parameter Order Matters

Parameters are accumulated in the order you call `where()`, `orWhere()`, and `having()`. The `?` placeholders in your conditions must align with the parameter arrays you pass:

```

// Correct
->where("price > ? AND price < ?", [10, 100])

// Also correct -- two separate calls
->where("price > ?", [10])
->where("price < ?", [100])

```

Both produce the same result. The second form is easier to read and easier to make conditional.

Default Limit

If you call `get()` without calling `limit()`, the builder defaults to fetching 100 rows with offset 0. This prevents accidental full-table scans on large datasets. Set an explicit `limit()` if you need more:

```

->limit(500) // fetch up to 500 rows

```

`toSql()` Does Not Include LIMIT

The `LIMIT` and `OFFSET` are not part of the SQL string returned by `toSql()`. They are passed as separate arguments to the database adapter's `fetch()` method. This is by design -- different database engines handle pagination differently, and the adapter takes care of the dialect-specific syntax.

`count()` Temporarily Replaces Columns

`count()` swaps your selected columns with `COUNT(*) as cnt` for the query, then restores the original columns. This means calling `toSql()` after `count()` still shows your original columns, not the count expression.

OR Precedence

SQL evaluates **AND** before **OR**. This query:

```
->where("active = ?", [1])
->where("price > ?", [5])
->orWhere("featured = ?", [1])
```

Means **(active = 1 AND price > 5) OR featured = 1**, not **active = 1 AND (price > 5 OR featured = 1)**. If you need the second interpretation, group the condition manually:

```
->where("active = ?", [1])
->where("(price > ? OR featured = ?)", [5, 1])
```

16. Exercise: Product Search API

Build a product search endpoint that uses QueryBuilder for all database access.

Setup

Create the migration file `migrations/003_create_products.sql`:

```
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS products (
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    name VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
    category VARCHAR(100),
    price REAL DEFAULT 0.00,
    active INTEGER DEFAULT 1,
    created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('PHP in Action', 'books', 29.99);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Mechanical Keyboard', 'electronics', 149.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Standing Desk', 'furniture', 499.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('USB-C Hub', 'electronics', 45.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Code Complete', 'books', 35.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Monitor Light', 'electronics', 65.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Desk Mat', 'furniture', 25.00);
INSERT INTO products (name, category, price) VALUES ('Clean Code', 'books', 32.00);
```

The Route

Create `src/routes/productSearch.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\QueryBuilder;

/**
 * @description Search products with filters
 * @tags Products
 * @QueryParam category string Filter by category
 * @QueryParam min_price number Minimum price
 * @QueryParam max_price number Maximum price
 * @QueryParam search string Search by name
```

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```

* @QueryParam sort string Sort field and direction (e.g. "price DESC")
* @QueryParam limit int Results per page (default 10)
* @QueryParam page int Page number (default 0)
* @example /api/products/search?category=books&min_price=20&sort=price ASC
*/
Router::get("/api/products/search", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    global $db;

    try {
        $qb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
            ->select("id", "name", "category", "price")
            ->where("active = ?", [1]);

        // Category filter
        if (!empty($request->query["category"])) {
            $qb->where("category = ?", [$request->query["category"]]);
        }

        // Price range
        if (!empty($request->query["min_price"])) {
            $qb->where("price >= ?", [(float)$request->query["min_price"]]);
        }
        if (!empty($request->query["max_price"])) {
            $qb->where("price <= ?", [(float)$request->query["max_price"]]);
        }

        // Name search
        if (!empty($request->query["search"])) {
            $qb->where("name LIKE ?", ["%" . $request->query["search"] . "%"]);
        }

        // Sorting
        $sort = $request->query["sort"] ?? "name ASC";
        $qb->orderBy($sort);

        // Pagination
        $limit = (int)($request->query["limit"] ?? 10);
        $page = (int)($request->query["page"] ?? 0);
        $qb->limit($limit, $page * $limit);

        // Get total count (separate query)
        $countQb = QueryBuilder::from("products", $db)
            ->where("active = ?", [1]);

        if (!empty($request->query["category"])) {
            $countQb->where("category = ?", [$request->query["category"]]);
        }
        if (!empty($request->query["min_price"])) {
            $countQb->where("price >= ?", [(float)$request->query["min_price"]]);
        }
        if (!empty($request->query["max_price"])) {
            $countQb->where("price <= ?", [(float)$request->query["max_price"]]);
        }
        if (!empty($request->query["search"])) {
            $countQb->where("name LIKE ?", ["%" . $request->query["search"] . "%"]);
        }

        $total = $countQb->count();
        $result = $qb->get();
    }
}

```

```

        return $response([
            "data" => $result['data'] ?? [],
            "total" => $total,
            "page" => $page,
            "limit" => $limit,
            "pages" => ceil($total / $limit),
        ]);
    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        \Tina4\Debug::message($e->getMessage(), TINA4_LOG_ERROR);
        return $response(["error" => "Search failed"], 500);
    }
});

```

Test It

All active products

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search"
```

Books only

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search?category=books"
```

Electronics under \$100

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search?category=electronics&max_price=100"
```

Search by name, sorted by price

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search?search=Code&sort=price%20DESC"
```

Page 2, 3 per page

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/search?limit=3&page=1"
```

Verify the SQL

Add a debug line to inspect what the builder generates:

```
\Tina4\Debug::message("SQL: " . $qb->toSql(), TINA4_LOG_DEBUG);
```

Check the log output. The SQL should match your filters exactly. No extra conditions. No missing joins. What you chain is what you get.

Summary

Method	Purpose	Returns
<code>QueryBuilder::from(\$table, \$db)</code>	Create a builder	<code>QueryBuilder</code>
<code>->select(...\$columns)</code>	Set columns	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->where(\$condition, \$params)</code>	AND filter	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->orWhere(\$condition, \$params)</code>	OR filter	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->join(\$table, \$on)</code>	INNER JOIN	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->leftJoin(\$table, \$on)</code>	LEFT JOIN	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->groupBy(\$column)</code>	GROUP BY	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->having(\$expression, \$params)</code>	HAVING filter	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->orderBy(\$expression)</code>	ORDER BY	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->limit(\$count, \$offset)</code>	LIMIT / OFFSET	<code>\$this</code>
<code>->toSql()</code>	Get SQL string	<code>string</code>
<code>->get()</code>	Fetch rows	<code>mixed</code>
<code>->first()</code>	Fetch one row	<code>?array</code>
<code>->count()</code>	Count rows	<code>int</code>
<code>->exists()</code>	Check existence	<code>bool</code>

Authentication

1. Locking the Door

Every endpoint built so far is public. Anyone with the URL can read, create, update, delete. That works for a tutorial. A real application needs to know who is making a request and whether they are allowed.

This chapter covers Tina4's authentication system: JWT tokens, password hashing, middleware-based route protection, CSRF tokens for forms, and session management.

2. JWT Tokens

Tina4 uses JSON Web Tokens for authentication. A JWT is a signed string containing a payload -- user ID, role, expiry. The server creates it at login. The client sends it with every request. The server verifies it without touching the database.

Generating a Token

```
<?php
use Tina4\Auth;

$payload = [
    "user_id" => 42,
    "email" => "alice@example.com",
    "role" => "admin"
];
```

```
$token = Auth::getToken($payload, $secret);
```

`getToken()` signs the payload with HS256 (HMAC-SHA256) using the provided secret. The `$secret` parameter is **required**. Returns a JWT string:

```
eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MiwiZW1haWwiOiJhbGljZUBleGFtcGxlLmNvbSIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MiwiZW1haWwiOiJhbGljZUBleGFtcGxlLmNvbSIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.
```

Three parts separated by dots: header, payload, signature. The signature ensures the token has not been tampered with.

***Legacy aliases:** `Auth::createToken()` still works as an alias for `Auth::getToken()`. Use the primary name in new code.*

Token Expiry

Tokens expire after 60 minutes by default. Configure in `.env`:

```
TINA4_TOKEN_LIMIT=60
```

Value in **minutes** (default: 60):

Value	Duration
15	15 minutes

60	1 hour (default)
1440	24 hours
10080	7 days

Validating a Token

```
$payload = Auth::validToken($token, $secret);
// Returns the payload array if valid, null if invalid or expired
```

`validToken()` returns the decoded payload on success, not a boolean. This lets you validate and read the token in one step. Returns `null` if the token is invalid or expired.

Legacy alias: `Auth::validateToken()` works the same way.

Reading the Payload

```
$payload = Auth::getPayload($token);
```

Returns the decoded payload **without validation** -- it just decodes the token. Note that `getPayload()` takes only the token string -- no secret is needed because it does not verify the signature:

```
[
    "user_id" => 42,
    "email" => "alice@example.com",
    "role" => "admin",
    "iat" => 1711112600, // issued at (Unix timestamp)
    "exp" => 1711116200 // expires at (Unix timestamp)
]
```

If the token cannot be decoded: `null`.

Important: `getPayload()` does not verify the signature or check expiry. Use `validToken()` when you need to confirm the token is trustworthy.

The Secret Key and Algorithm

Tina4 PHP uses **HS256** (HMAC-SHA256) for JWT signing. It uses only the standard library -- zero external dependencies.

Set the secret key in `.env`:

```
TINA4_SECRET=my-super-secret-key-at-least-32-chars
```

The `$secret` parameter is **required** on `getToken()` and `validToken()`. Pass it explicitly -- there is no automatic fallback. Read it from your `.env` in your route handler:

```
$secret = $_ENV["TINA4_SECRET"] ?? getenv("TINA4_SECRET");
```

`getPayload()` does not take a secret at all -- it decodes without verifying.

Guard this key. Anyone who has it can forge tokens.

3. Password Hashing

Passwords in plain text are a breach waiting to happen. Tina4 provides two functions for secure password handling.

Hashing a Password

```
use Tina4\Auth;

$hash = Auth::hashPassword("my-secure-password");
// Returns: "$2y$10$abc123...long-hash-string..."
```

Uses PBKDF2 from the standard library -- no external dependencies. Each hash includes a random salt. Hashing the same password twice produces different results.

Checking a Password

```
$isCorrect = Auth::checkPassword("my-secure-password", $storedHash);
// true if the password matches
```

Registration Example

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Auth;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["name"]) || empty($body["email"]) || empty($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Name, email, and password are required"], 400);
    }

    if (strlen($body["password"]) < 8) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Password must be at least 8 characters"], 400);
    }

    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $existing = $db->fetchOne("SELECT id FROM users WHERE email = :email", ["email" => $body["email"]]);
    if ($existing !== null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email already registered"], 409);
    }

    $passwordHash = Auth::hashPassword($body["password"]);

    $db->execute(
        "INSERT INTO users (name, email, password_hash) VALUES (:name, :email, :hash)",
        [
            "name" => $body["name"],
            "email" => $body["email"],
            "hash" => $passwordHash
        ]
    );

    $user = $db->fetchOne("SELECT id, name, email FROM users WHERE id = last_insert_rowid()");

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Registration successful",
        "user" => $user
    ], 201);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/register \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

{
  "message": "Registration successful",
  "user": {"id": 1, "name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com"}
}

---
```

4. The Login Flow

Client sends credentials. Server validates them. Server returns a JWT.


```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Auth;
use Tina4\Database;

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/login", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["email"]) || empty($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email and password are required"], 400);
    }

    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $user = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, email, password_hash FROM users WHERE email = :email",
        ["email" => $body["email"]]
    );

    if ($user === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }

    if (!Auth::checkPassword($body["password"], $user["password_hash"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }

    $token = Auth::getToken([
        "user_id" => $user["id"],
        "email" => $user["email"],
        "name" => $user["name"]
    ]);

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Login successful",
        "token" => $token,
        "user" => [
            "id" => $user["id"],
            "name" => $user["name"],
            "email" => $user["email"]
        ]
    ]);
});

```

The `@noauth` annotation is critical. The login endpoint must be public. You cannot require a token to get a token.

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/login \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

{
  "message": "Login successful",
  "token": "eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9...",
  "user": {
    "id": 1,

```

```

        "name": "Alice",
        "email": "alice@example.com"
    }
}

```

The client stores the token and sends it with subsequent requests.

5. Using Tokens in Requests

The token travels in the **Authorization** header with the **Bearer** prefix:

```

curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile \
-H "Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9..."

```

6. Protecting Routes

Auth Middleware

A reusable gate:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Auth;

function authMiddleware($request, $response, $next) {
    $authHeader = $request->header("Authorization") ?? "";

    if (empty($authHeader) || !str_starts_with($authHeader, "Bearer ")) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Authorization header required"], 401);
    }

    $token = substr($authHeader, 7); // Remove "Bearer " prefix

    $payload = Auth::validToken($token);
    if ($payload === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid or expired token"], 401);
    }

    $request->user = $payload; // Attach user data to the request

    return $next($request, $response);
}

```

Applying Middleware to Routes

```

<?php
use Tina4 Router;

Router::get("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "user_id" => $request->user["user_id"],
        "email" => $request->user["email"],
        "name" => $request->user["name"]
    ]);
}, "authMiddleware");

```

```
# Without token -- 401
curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile

{"error": "Authorization header required"}

# With valid token -- 200
curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9..."

{
  "user_id": 1,
  "email": "alice@example.com",
  "name": "Alice"
}
```

Applying Middleware to a Group

```
Router::group("/api/admin", function () {

  Router::get("/stats", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["active_users" => 42]);
  });

  Router::get("/logs", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["logs" => []]);
  });

}, "authMiddleware");
```

Every route in the group requires a valid token.

7. @noauth and @secured Decorators

Two decorators for route-level authentication control. Introduced in Chapter 2. Here they are in context.

@noauth -- Skip Authentication

Public endpoints that bypass global or group-level auth:

```
/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::get("/api/public/health", function ($request, $response) {
  return $response->json(["status" => "ok"]);
});

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/login", function ($request, $response) {
  // Login logic
});

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
```

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```

    // Registration logic
  });

```

@secured -- Require Authentication for GET Routes

POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE are secured by default. GET is public. Use `@secured` to protect a GET route:

```

/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/api/me", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json($request->user);
});

```

Role-Based Authorization

Combine auth middleware with role checks:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Auth;

function requireRole($role) {
    return function ($request, $response, $next) use ($role) {
        $authHeader = $request->header("Authorization") ?? "";
        if (empty($authHeader) || !str_starts_with($authHeader, "Bearer ")) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Authorization required"], 401);
        }

        $token = substr($authHeader, 7);
        $payload = Auth::validToken($token);
        if ($payload === null) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid or expired token"], 401);
        }

        if (($payload["role"] ?? "") !== $role) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Forbidden. Required role: " . $role], 403);
        }

        $request->user = $payload;
        return $next($request, $response);
    };
}

```

`requireRole()` returns a closure. Register the returned function as middleware:

```

$adminOnly = requireRole("admin");

Router::delete("/api/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["deleted" => true]);
}, $adminOnly);

```

8. CSRF Protection

For traditional form-based applications (not SPAs), Tina4 provides CSRF protection.

Generating a Token

Include the CSRF token in every form:

```
<form method="POST" action="/profile/update">
  {{ form_token() }}

  <div class="form-group">
    <label for="name">Name</label>
    <input type="text" name="name" id="name" value="{{ user.name }}">
  </div>

  <button type="submit">Update Profile</button>
</form>
```

`{{ form_token() }}` renders a hidden input:

```
<input type="hidden" name="_token" value="abc123randomtoken456">
```

Validating the Token

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Auth;

Router::post("/profile/update", function ($request, $response) {
    if (!Auth::validateFormToken($request->body["_token"] ?? "")) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid form token. Please refresh and try again."],
    }

    // Process the form...
    return $response->redirect("/profile");
});
```

The token is tied to the user's session and expires after one use. A malicious site cannot forge it.

When to Use CSRF Tokens

Use them for:

- HTML forms submitted by browsers
- POST/PUT/DELETE from server-rendered pages

Skip them for:

- API endpoints using JWT (the Bearer token proves intent)
- SPAs using `fetch()` with custom headers (the `Authorization` header cannot be set by cross-origin forms)

9. Sessions

Server-side sessions store per-user state between requests. Use JWTs for API authentication. Use sessions for stateful web pages.

Session Configuration

Set the backend in `.env`:

```
# File-based sessions (default)
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=file

# Redis
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=redis
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=6379

# MongoDB
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=mongodb
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=27017

# Valkey
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=valkey
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=6379
```

File sessions work out of the box. Redis or Valkey for multi-server production deployments where sessions must be shared across instances.

Using Sessions

Access session data through `$request->session`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/login-form", function ($request, $response) {
    // After validating credentials...
    $request->session["user_id"] = 42;
    $request->session["user_name"] = "Alice";
    $request->session["logged_in"] = true;

    return $response->redirect("/dashboard");
});

Router::get("/dashboard", function ($request, $response) {
    if (empty($request->session["logged_in"])) {
        return $response->redirect("/login");
    }

    return $response->render("dashboard.html", [
        "user_name" => $request->session["user_name"]
    ]);
});

Router::post("/logout", function ($request, $response) {
    $request->session = [];

    return $response->redirect("/login");
});
```

Session Options

```
TINA4_SESSION_TTL=3600          # Expires after 1 hour of inactivity
TINA4_SESSION_NAME=tina4_session # Cookie name for the session ID
```

10. Exercise: Build Login, Register, and Profile

A complete authentication system. Registration, login, profile viewing, password changing.

Requirements

- Create a `users` table migration: `id`, `name`, `email` (unique), `password_hash`, `role` (default "user"), `created_at`
- Build these endpoints:

Method	Path	Auth	Description
POST	<code>/api/register</code>	@noauth	Create account. Validate name, email, password (min 8 chars).
POST	<code>/api/login</code>	@noauth	Login. Return JWT.
GET	<code>/api/profile</code>	secured	Get profile from token.
PUT	<code>/api/profile</code>	secured	Update name and email.
PUT	<code>/api/profile/password</code>	secured	Change password. Require current password.

- Create auth middleware that extracts the user from the JWT and attaches it to `$request->user`.

Test with:

```
# Register
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/register \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

# Login
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/login \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

# Save the token, then:

# Get profile
curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN_HERE"

# Update profile
curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/api/profile \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN_HERE" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Alice Smith"}'

# Change password
curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/api/profile/password \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN_HERE" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"current_password": "securePass123", "new_password": "evenMoreSecure456"}'

# No token (should fail)
curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile

---
```

11. Solution

Migration

Create [migrations/20260322160000_create_auth_users_table.sql](#):

```
-- UP
CREATE TABLE users (
  id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
  name TEXT NOT NULL,
  email TEXT NOT NULL UNIQUE,
  password_hash TEXT NOT NULL,
  role TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'user',
  created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

-- DOWN
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS users;

tina4 migrate
```

Middleware

Create [src/routes/middleware.php](#):

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```

<?php
use Tina4\Auth;

function authMiddleware($request, $response, $next) {
    $authHeader = $request->header("Authorization") ?? "";

    if (empty($authHeader) || !str_starts_with($authHeader, "Bearer ")) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Authorization required. Send: Authorization: Bearer "]);
    }

    $token = substr($authHeader, 7);

    $payload = Auth::validToken($token);
    if ($payload === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid or expired token. Please login again."], 401);
    }

    $request->user = $payload;

    return $next($request, $response);
}

```

Routes

Create `src/routes/auth.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4 Router;
use Tina4 Auth;
use Tina4 Database;

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $errors = [];
    if (empty($body["name"])) $errors[] = "Name is required";
    if (empty($body["email"])) $errors[] = "Email is required";
    if (empty($body["password"])) {
        $errors[] = "Password is required";
    } elseif (strlen($body["password"]) < 8) {
        $errors[] = "Password must be at least 8 characters";
    }

    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response->json(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $existing = $db->fetchOne("SELECT id FROM users WHERE email = :email", ["email" => $body["email"]]);
    if ($existing !== null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email already registered"], 409);
    }

    $hash = Auth::hashPassword($body["password"]);

    $db->execute(

```

```

        "INSERT INTO users (name, email, password_hash) VALUES (:name, :email, :hash)",
        ["name" => $body["name"], "email" => $body["email"], "hash" => $hash]
    );

    $user = $db->fetchOne("SELECT id, name, email, role, created_at FROM users WHERE id = last_id");

    return $response->json(["message" => "Registration successful", "user" => $user], 201);
});

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/login", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body();

    if (empty($body["email"]) || empty($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email and password are required"], 400);
    }

    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $user = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, email, password_hash, role FROM users WHERE email = :email",
        ["email" => $body["email"]]
    );

    if ($user === null || !Auth::checkPassword($body["password"], $user["password_hash"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }

    $token = Auth::getToken([
        "user_id" => $user["id"],
        "email" => $user["email"],
        "name" => $user["name"],
        "role" => $user["role"]
    ]);

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Login successful",
        "token" => $token,
        "user" => ["id" => $user["id"], "name" => $user["name"], "email" => $user["email"], "role" => $user["role"]]
    ]);
});

Router::get("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $user = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, email, role, created_at FROM users WHERE id = :id",
        ["id" => $request->user["user_id"]]
    );

    if ($user === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json($user);
}, "authMiddleware");

```

```

Router::put("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $body = $request->body;
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];

    if (!empty($body["email"])) {
        $existing = $db->fetchOne(
            "SELECT id FROM users WHERE email = :email AND id != :id",
            ["email" => $body["email"], "id" => $userId]
        );
        if ($existing !== null) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Email already in use by another account"], 409);
        }
    }

    $current = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM users WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $userId]);

    $db->execute(
        "UPDATE users SET name = :name, email = :email WHERE id = :id",
        ["name" => $body["name"] ?? $current["name"], "email" => $body["email"] ?? $current["email"], "id" => $userId]
    );

    $updated = $db->fetchOne("SELECT id, name, email, role, created_at FROM users WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $userId]);

    return $response->json(["message" => "Profile updated", "user" => $updated]);
}, "authMiddleware");

Router::put("/api/profile/password", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $body = $request->body;
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];

    if (empty($body["current_password"]) || empty($body["new_password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Current password and new password are required"], 400);
    }

    if (strlen($body["new_password"]) < 8) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "New password must be at least 8 characters"], 400);
    }

    $user = $db->fetchOne("SELECT password_hash FROM users WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $userId]);

    if (!Auth::checkPassword($body["current_password"], $user["password_hash"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Current password is incorrect"], 401);
    }

    $newHash = Auth::hashPassword($body["new_password"]);

    $db->execute("UPDATE users SET password_hash = :hash WHERE id = :id", ["hash" => $newHash, "id" => $userId]);

    return $response->json(["message" => "Password changed successfully"]);
}, "authMiddleware");

```

Expected output for register: 201 Created with user data.

Expected output for login: 200 OK with token and user data.

Expected output for profile without token: 401 Unauthorized.

Expected output for profile with token: 200 OK with user data.

Expected output for wrong current password: 401 Unauthorized.

Expected output for successful password change: {"message":"Password changed successfully"}.

12. Gotchas

1. Token Expiry Confusion

Problem: Tokens that worked yesterday return 401 today.

Cause: Default lifetime is 60 minutes (TINA4_TOKEN_LIMIT=60). After that, the token is invalid.

Fix: Issue a new token at login. For long-lived sessions, use refresh tokens: a short-lived access token (15 minutes) paired with a long-lived refresh token (7 days).

2. Secret Key Management

Problem: Tokens from one server fail on another. Or tokens stop working after deployment.

Cause: Each server generated its own secrets/jwt.key. Or the key was regenerated during deployment.

Fix: Set TINA4_SECRET in .env and use the same value across all servers. Store it in your secrets manager. Not in version control. Key change invalidates all tokens. Users must log in again.

3. CORS with Authentication

Problem: Frontend requests with Authorization header fail with CORS error, even with CORS_ORIGINS=*.

Cause: The browser sends a preflight OPTIONS request. The server must respond with CORS headers including Access-Control-Allow-Headers: Authorization.

Fix: Tina4 handles preflight requests. Verify CORS_ORIGINS is set. Check that middleware is not overriding CORS headers.

4. Storing Tokens in localStorage

Problem: Token stolen via XSS because it lived in localStorage.

Cause: Any JavaScript on the page reads localStorage, including injected scripts.

Fix: Use httpOnly cookies when possible -- invisible to JavaScript. For SPAs that must use localStorage, enforce strict Content Security Policy headers. Sanitize all input.

5. Forgetting @noauth on Login

Problem: Login endpoint returns 401. Cannot log in.

Cause: Global auth middleware blocks the login endpoint. You need a token to get a token. A catch-22.

Fix: Add `@noauth` to login and register routes.

6. Password Hash Column Too Short

Problem: Registration fails with a database error about truncation.

Cause: PBKDF2 hashes can be long. `VARCHAR(50)` truncates them.

Fix: Use `TEXT` for the password hash column. Or at minimum `VARCHAR(255)`.

7. Token in URL Query Parameters

Problem: Tokens in URLs like `/api/profile?token=eyJ...` leak through browser history, server logs, and Referer headers.

Fix: Always send tokens in the `Authorization` header. The only exception: WebSocket connections where the upgrade request cannot carry custom headers. Use a short-lived token for that case.

Sessions & Cookies

1. State in a Stateless World

Your e-commerce site needs a shopping cart that survives page reloads, remembers the user's language, and flashes success messages after form submissions. HTTP has no memory. Every request is independent. Sessions and cookies give the server a way to remember who is asking and what they have been doing.

Chapter 8 introduced sessions for authentication. This chapter goes deeper: session backends, flash messages, cookies, remember-me tokens, and security configuration.

2. How Sessions Work

Sessions are auto-started. Every route handler receives `$request->session` ready to use. No manual setup required.

First visit. No session cookie. Tina4 generates a unique session ID -- a long random string. Stores it in a cookie named `tina4_session` (`HttpOnly`, `SameSite=Lax`). Creates server-side storage keyed by that ID. Every subsequent request carries the cookie. Tina4 looks up the data. Makes it available through `$request->session`.

The flow:

- Browser sends first request (no session cookie)
- Tina4 generates session ID: `abc123def456`
- Tina4 sets cookie: `tina4_session=abc123def456`
- Tina4 creates empty session storage for `abc123def456`
- Browser sends second request with cookie `tina4_session=abc123def456`
- Tina4 loads session data for `abc123def456`
- Your handler reads and writes `$request->session`
- Request ends. Tina4 saves updated session data.

The data lives server-side. The browser holds the session ID. Nothing else.

3. The Session API

Access session data through `$request->session`. It is available in every route handler with zero configuration.

Full API Reference

Method	Description
<code>\$request->session->set(key, value)</code>	Store a value
<code>\$request->session->get(key, default)</code>	Retrieve a value (with optional default)
<code>\$request->session->delete(key)</code>	Remove a key
<code>\$request->session->has(key)</code>	Check if a key exists
<code>\$request->session->clear()</code>	Remove all session data
<code>\$request->session->destroy()</code>	Destroy the session entirely
<code>\$request->session->save()</code>	Persist session data (auto-called after response)
<code>\$request->session->regenerate()</code>	Generate a new session ID, preserve data
<code>\$request->session->flash(key, value)</code>	Set flash data (one-time read)
<code>\$request->session->getFlash(key)</code>	Read and remove flash data
<code>\$request->session->all()</code>	Get all session data as an array

4. File Sessions (Default)

No configuration needed. Sessions stored in files. Works out of the box.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/visit-counter", function ($request, $response) {
    $count = ($request->session->get("visit_count", 0)) + 1;
    $request->session->set("visit_count", $count);

    return $response->json([
        "visit_count" => $count,
        "message" => "You have visited this page " . $count . " time" . ($count === 1 ? "" : "s")
    ]);
});
```

```
curl http://localhost:7145/visit-counter -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt
```

```
{"visit_count":1,"message":"You have visited this page 1 time"}
```

```
curl http://localhost:7145/visit-counter -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt
```

```
{"visit_count":2,"message":"You have visited this page 2 times"}
```

```
curl http://localhost:7145/visit-counter -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt
```

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```
{"visit_count":3,"message":"You have visited this page 3 times"}
```

The **-c** flag saves cookies. The **-b** flag sends them back. This simulates browser behavior.

File sessions work for single-server deployments. Simplest option. No extra software.

5. Redis Sessions

Multiple servers behind a load balancer need a shared session store. Redis is the standard choice.

```
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=redis
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=6379
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PASSWORD=your-redis-password
```

That is the only change. Your code stays identical. `$request->session` works the same whether backed by files, Redis, MongoDB, or Valkey. The storage backend is invisible to your handlers.

Why Redis

- Sessions shared across all server instances
- Sub-millisecond reads and writes
- Built-in key expiry (automatic cleanup)
- No disk I/O

Redis with a Prefix

Sharing a Redis instance with other applications:

```
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=redis
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=6379
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PREFIX=myapp:sess:
```

6. MongoDB Sessions

Already running MongoDB:

```
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=mongodb
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=27017
TINA4_SESSION_MONGO_DB=myapp
TINA4_SESSION_MONGO_COLLECTION=sessions
```

TTL indexes handle expired session cleanup.

7. Valkey Sessions

Valkey is the open-source Redis fork. Wire-compatible. Same client library:

```
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=valkey
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT=6379
```

8. Database Sessions

```
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND=database
```

Stores sessions in the `tina4_session` table using your existing database connection (`TINA4_DATABASE_URL`). The table is auto-created on first use. Works with all 5 database engines (SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, Firebird).

9. Reading and Writing Session Data

A key-value store. Read and write through `$request->session`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

// Write
Router::post("/api/preferences", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $request->session->set("language", $body["language"] ?? "en");
    $request->session->set("theme", $body["theme"] ?? "light");
    $request->session->set("items_per_page", (int) ($body["items_per_page"] ?? 20));

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Preferences saved",
        "preferences" => [
            "language" => $request->session->get("language"),
            "theme" => $request->session->get("theme"),
            "items_per_page" => $request->session->get("items_per_page")
        ]
    ]);
});

// Read
Router::get("/api/preferences", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "language" => $request->session->get("language", "en"),
        "theme" => $request->session->get("theme", "light"),
        "items_per_page" => $request->session->get("items_per_page", 20)
    ]);
});

// Delete a key
Router::delete("/api/preferences/{key}", function ($request, $response) {
    $key = $request->params["key"];
```

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```

$request->session->delete($key);

return $response->json(["message" => "Preference '" . $key . "' removed"]);
});

// Clear everything
Router::post("/api/session/clear", function ($request, $response) {
    $request->session->clear();

    return $response->json(["message" => "Session cleared"]);
});

```

Storing Complex Data

Sessions hold arrays and nested structures:

```

Router::post("/api/cart/add", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $cart = $request->session->get("cart", []);

    $cart[] = [
        "product_id" => (int) $body["product_id"],
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "price" => (float) $body["price"],
        "quantity" => (int) ($body["quantity"] ?? 1),
        "added_at" => date("c")
    ];

    $request->session->set("cart", $cart);

    $total = array_sum(array_map(
        fn($item) => $item["price"] * $item["quantity"],
        $cart
    ));

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Added to cart",
        "cart_items" => count($cart),
        "cart_total" => $total
    ]);
});

```

10. Flash Messages

Session data that lives for one request. Set it before redirecting. Read it on the next request. Gone after that.

The pattern: submit a form, redirect to a success page, show a message that disappears on refresh.

Setting a Flash Message

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/profile/update", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    // Update the profile...

    $request->session->flash("message", "Profile updated successfully");
    $request->session->flash("message_type", "success");

    return $response->redirect("/profile");
});
```

Reading and Clearing

```
Router::get("/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    $flash_message = $request->session->getFlash("message");
    $flash_type = $request->session->getFlash("message_type") ?? "info";

    return $response->render("profile.html", [
        "user" => ["name" => "Alice", "email" => "alice@example.com"],
        "flash_message" => $flash_message,
        "flash_type" => $flash_type
    ]);
});
```

The `getFlash()` method reads the value and removes it in one step. The next request will not see it.

In Templates

```
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block content %}
    {% if flash_message %}
        <div class="alert alert-{{ flash_type }}">
            {{ flash_message }}
        </div>
    {% endif %}

    <h1>Profile</h1>
    <p>Name: {{ user.name }}</p>
    <p>Email: {{ user.email }}</p>
{% endblock %}
```

The alert appears once. Refresh the page. Gone.

11. Setting and Reading Cookies

Cookies live in the browser. Unlike sessions, the data is client-side. Use cookies for non-sensitive preferences that should survive session expiry.

Setting a Cookie

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::post("/api/set-language", function ($request, $response) {
    $language = $request->body["language"] ?? "en";

    $response->setCookie("language", $language, [
        "expires" => time() + (365 * 24 * 60 * 60), // 1 year
        "path" => "/",
        "httpOnly" => false, // JavaScript can read it
        "secure" => false, // true in production
        "sameSite" => "Lax"
    ]);

    return $response->json(["message" => "Language set to " . $language]);
});
```

Reading a Cookie

```
Router::get("/api/get-language", function ($request, $response) {
    $language = $request->cookies["language"] ?? "en";

    return $response->json(["language" => $language]);
});
```

Deleting a Cookie

Set expiry in the past:

```
Router::post("/api/clear-language", function ($request, $response) {
    $response->setCookie("language", "", [
        "expires" => time() - 3600,
        "path" => "/"
    ]);

    return $response->json(["message" => "Language cookie cleared"]);
});
```

When to Use Cookies vs Sessions

Use Cookies For	Use Sessions For
Language preference	Shopping cart contents
Theme (light/dark)	Authentication state
"Remember this device" flag	Flash messages
Analytics consent	Form wizard progress
Non-sensitive, long-lived data	Sensitive, short-lived data

12. Remember Me Functionality

A long-lived cookie re-authenticates users after their session expires.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Auth;
use Tina4\Database;

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/login", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $user = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, email, password_hash FROM users WHERE email = :email",
        ["email" => $body["email"]]
    );

    if ($user === null || !Auth::checkPassword($body["password"], $user["password_hash"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }

    $request->session->set("user_id", $user["id"]);
    $request->session->set("user_name", $user["name"]);

    if (!empty($body["remember_me"])) {
        $rememberToken = bin2hex(random_bytes(32));

        // Store hashed token in database
        $db->execute(
            "UPDATE users SET remember_token = :token WHERE id = :id",
            ["token" => hash("sha256", $rememberToken), "id" => $user["id"]]
        );

        // Set long-lived cookie with unhashed token
        $response->setCookie("remember_me", $rememberToken, [
            "expires" => time() + (30 * 24 * 60 * 60), // 30 days
            "path" => "/",
            "httpOnly" => true,
            "secure" => true,
            "sameSite" => "Lax"
        ]);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Login successful",
        "user" => ["id" => $user["id"], "name" => $user["name"]]
    ]);
});
```

The middleware that checks the cookie:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Database;

function rememberMeMiddleware($request, $response, $next) {
```

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```

    if ($request->session->has("user_id")) {
        return $next($request, $response);
    }

    $rememberToken = $request->cookies["remember_me"] ?? "";

    if (empty($rememberToken)) {
        return $next($request, $response);
    }

    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $hashedToken = hash("sha256", $rememberToken);

    $user = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, email FROM users WHERE remember_token = :token",
        ["token" => $hashedToken]
    );

    if ($user !== null) {
        $request->session->set("user_id", $user["id"]);
        $request->session->set("user_name", $user["name"]);
    }

    return $next($request, $response);
}

```

The flow:

- User logs in with "remember me" checked
- Server stores a hashed token in the database. Sets the raw token in a cookie.
- Session expires.
- User returns. Session empty. Cookie still present.
- Middleware finds the cookie. Looks up the hashed token. Restores the session.
- User is logged in again. No credentials entered.

The database holds the hash. The cookie holds the raw token. If the database is breached, the attacker gets hashes. They cannot forge the cookie.

13. Session Security

Configuration Options

TINA4_SESSION_TTL=3600	# Expires after 1 hour of inactivity
TINA4_SESSION_SECURE=true	# HTTPS only
TINA4_SESSION_HTTPONLY=true	# JavaScript cannot access the cookie (default)
TINA4_SESSION_SAMESITE=Lax	# CSRF protection (default)

httpOnly

`TINA4_SESSION_HTTPONLY=true` (default) makes the session cookie invisible to JavaScript. XSS attacks cannot steal the session ID. Almost never a reason to set this to `false`.

secure

`TINA4_SESSION_SECURE=true` restricts the cookie to HTTPS connections. Set to `true` in production. During development with `http://localhost`, set to `false` or the browser will not send the cookie.

sameSite

Controls cross-site cookie behavior:

Value	Behavior
<code>Strict</code>	Never sent with cross-site requests. Safest. Breaks some flows (clicking links from email).
<code>Lax</code>	Sent with top-level navigations (clicking links) but not cross-site API calls. Good default.
<code>None</code>	Always sent. Requires <code>secure=true</code> . Only for cross-site cookie access.

Session Regeneration

After login, regenerate the session ID to prevent session fixation attacks:

```
Router::post("/login", function ($request, $response) {
    // Validate credentials...

    $request->session->regenerate();

    $request->session->set("user_id", $user["id"]);

    return $response->redirect("/dashboard");
});
```

Session fixation: attacker sets a known session ID on the victim's browser before login. After login, the attacker uses that same ID. Regeneration invalidates the old ID.

Destroy a Session

To completely destroy a session (not just clear its data):

```
Router::post("/logout", function ($request, $response) {
    $request->session->destroy();
    return $response->redirect("/login");
});
```

14. Exercise: Build a Shopping Cart with Session Storage

A cart stored entirely in session data. No database.

Requirements

Method	Path	Description
POST	/api/cart/add	Add item. Body: {"product_id": 1, "name": "Widget", "price": 9.99, "quantity": 2}
GET	/api/cart	View cart. Items, quantities, subtotals, total.
PUT	/api/cart/{product_id:int}	Update quantity. Body: {"quantity": 3}. Remove if 0.
DELETE	/api/cart/{product_id:int}	Remove item.
DELETE	/api/cart	Clear cart.

Business Rules

- Adding an existing product increments quantity instead of duplicating
- Total calculated dynamically
- Full cart state returned after every operation

Test with:

```
# Add first item
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/cart/add \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"product_id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "quantity": 1}' \
  -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt

# Add second item
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/cart/add \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"product_id": 2, "name": "USB-C Hub", "price": 49.99, "quantity": 2}' \
  -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt

# Add more of item 1 (increments, no duplicate)
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/cart/add \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"product_id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "quantity": 1}' \
  -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt

# View cart
curl http://localhost:7145/api/cart -b cookies.txt

# Update quantity
curl -X PUT http://localhost:7145/api/cart/2 \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"quantity": 5}' \
  -c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt

# Remove item
curl -X DELETE http://localhost:7145/api/cart/1 -b cookies.txt -c cookies.txt

# Clear cart
curl -X DELETE http://localhost:7145/api/cart -b cookies.txt -c cookies.txt
```

15. Solution

Create `src/routes/cart.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

function getCart($session) {
    return $session->get("cart", []);
}

function cartResponse($cart) {
    $total = 0;
    $itemCount = 0;
    $items = [];

    foreach ($cart as $item) {
        $subtotal = $item["price"] * $item["quantity"];
        $total += $subtotal;
        $itemCount += $item["quantity"];
        $items[] = array_merge($item, ["subtotal" => $subtotal]);
    }
}
```

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```

        return [
            "items" => $items,
            "item_count" => $itemCount,
            "unique_items" => count($cart),
            "total" => round($total, 2)
        ];
    }
}

Router::post("/api/cart/add", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["product_id"]) || empty($body["name"]) || !isset($body["price"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "product_id, name, and price are required"], 400);
    }

    $cart = getCart($request->session);
    $productId = (int) $body["product_id"];
    $quantity = (int) ($body["quantity"] ?? 1);
    $found = false;

    foreach ($cart as $index => $item) {
        if ($item["product_id"] === $productId) {
            $cart[$index]["quantity"] += $quantity;
            $found = true;
            break;
        }
    }

    if (!$found) {
        $cart[] = [
            "product_id" => $productId,
            "name" => $body["name"],
            "price" => (float) $body["price"],
            "quantity" => $quantity
        ];
    }

    $request->session->set("cart", $cart);

    return $response->json(cartResponse($cart));
});

Router::get("/api/cart", function ($request, $response) {
    $cart = getCart($request->session);
    return $response->json(cartResponse($cart));
});

Router::put("/api/cart/{product_id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $productId = $request->params["product_id"];
    $quantity = (int) ($request->body["quantity"] ?? 0);
    $cart = getCart($request->session);
    $found = false;

    foreach ($cart as $index => $item) {
        if ($item["product_id"] === $productId) {
            if ($quantity <= 0) {
                array_splice($cart, $index, 1);
            } else {
                $cart[$index]["quantity"] = $quantity;
            }
        }
    }
}

```

```

        }
        $found = true;
        break;
    }
}

if (!$found) {
    return $response->json(["error" => "Product not in cart"], 404);
}

$request->session->set("cart", $cart);

return $response->json(cartResponse($cart));
});

Router::delete("/api/cart/{product_id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $productId = $request->params["product_id"];
    $cart = getCart($request->session);
    $found = false;

    foreach ($cart as $index => $item) {
        if ($item["product_id"] === $productId) {
            array_splice($cart, $index, 1);
            $found = true;
            break;
        }
    }

    if (!$found) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Product not in cart"], 404);
    }

    $request->session->set("cart", $cart);

    return $response->json(cartResponse($cart));
});

Router::delete("/api/cart", function ($request, $response) {
    $request->session->set("cart", []);

    return $response->json(cartResponse([]));
});

```

After adding two items and adding more of item 1:

```

{
    "items": [
        {"product_id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "quantity": 2, "subtotal": 159.98},
        {"product_id": 2, "name": "USB-C Hub", "price": 49.99, "quantity": 2, "subtotal": 99.98}
    ],
    "item_count": 4,
    "unique_items": 2,
    "total": 259.96
}

```

Keyboard has **quantity: 2** (1 + 1). Not two separate entries.

After clearing:

```

{"items":[],"item_count":0,"unique_items":0,"total":0}

```

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16. Gotchas

1. Sessions Do Not Work with curl Without Cookie Flags

Problem: Every curl request sees an empty session.

Cause: curl does not save or send cookies by default.

Fix: Use `-c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt`. Browsers handle this automatically.

2. Session Data Disappears After Server Restart

Problem: All session data gone.

Cause: File sessions in the temp directory. Cleared on restart.

Fix: Set `TINA4_SESSION_PATH` to a persistent directory. For production, use Redis or Valkey.

3. Session Cookie Not Sent in Production

Problem: Sessions work locally. Fail in production.

Cause: `TINA4_SESSION_SECURE=true` but the app sees HTTP (behind a proxy that terminates SSL).

Fix: Ensure the reverse proxy sets `X-Forwarded-Proto: https`. Or verify the connection is HTTPS end-to-end.

4. Flash Messages Show Twice

Problem: Flash message appears. Appears again on the next page.

Cause: Read it but did not clear it.

Fix: Use `$request->session->getFlash("message")` instead of `$request->session->get()`. The `getFlash()` method reads and deletes in one step.

5. Large Session Data Causes Slow Requests

Problem: Pages load slowly. Performance degrades over time.

Cause: Storing too much in the session. Entire result sets. File contents. Large arrays. Session data serializes and deserializes on every request.

Fix: Keep sessions small. Store IDs and references. Not entire objects.

6. Remember Me Token Not Invalidated on Password Change

Problem: After password change, other devices still logged in.

Cause: Remember token not cleared.

Fix: Clear the token on password change: `$db->execute("UPDATE users SET remember_token = NULL WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $userId])`. Forces all devices to re-authenticate.

7. Session Fixation

Problem: Attacker hijacks a session by setting a known ID before login.

Cause: Session ID not regenerated after authentication.

Fix: Call `$request->session->regenerate()` after login. New ID. Old one useless.

Middleware

1. The Gatekeepers

Your API needs CORS headers for the React frontend, rate limiting for public endpoints, and auth checks for admin routes. You could paste the same 10 lines of CORS code into every handler. You will forget one. You could pile every check into a giant `if` tree. The business logic disappears under boilerplate.

Middleware solves this. Wrap routes with reusable logic. Each middleware does one job -- check a token, set CORS headers, log the request, enforce rate limits -- and the framework decides whether to continue to the next layer. Route handlers stay focused on their purpose.

Chapter 2 introduced middleware briefly. This chapter goes deep: built-in middleware, custom middleware, execution order, short-circuiting, and real-world patterns.

2. What Middleware Is

Middleware is code that runs before or after your route handler. It sits in the HTTP pipeline between the incoming request and the response. Every request can pass through multiple middleware layers before reaching the handler.

Tina4 PHP supports two styles of middleware:

Route-level middleware (function-based) receives `$request` and `$response`. To continue the chain, return nothing (null/void). To short-circuit, return a `Response` object directly. To block with a 403, return `false`.

```
<?php

// This middleware continues to the next layer (returns nothing)
function passthrough($request, $response) {
    // do something with the request
}

<?php

// This middleware short-circuits with a response
function blockUnauthorized($request, $response) {
    if (!$request->bearerToken()) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Unauthorized"], 401);
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Class-based middleware (global) uses naming conventions. Static methods prefixed with `before` run before the handler. Methods prefixed with `after` run after it. Each method receives `[$request, $response]` and returns `[$request, $response]`.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
```

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```

class MyMiddleware
{
    public static function beforeCheck(Request $request, Response $response): array
    {
        // Runs before the route handler
        return [$request, $response];
    }

    public static function afterCleanup(Request $request, Response $response): array
    {
        // Runs after the route handler
        return [$request, $response];
    }
}

```

If a **before*** method sets the response status to ≥ 400 , the handler is skipped (short-circuit).

Register class-based middleware globally with **Middleware::use()**:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\CorsMiddleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\RequestLogger;

Middleware::use(CorsMiddleware::class);
Middleware::use(RequestLogger::class);

```

Global middleware runs on every request, in the order registered.

3. Built-in CorsMiddleware

CORS controls which domains can call your API. When React at <http://localhost:3000> calls your Tina4 API at <http://localhost:7145>, the browser sends a preflight **OPTIONS** request first. Wrong headers: the browser blocks everything.

Tina4 provides **CorsMiddleware**. Configure in **.env**:

```

TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=http://localhost:3000,https://myapp.com
TINA4_CORS_METHODS=GET,POST,PUT,PATCH,DELETE,OPTIONS
TINA4_CORS_HEADERS=Content-Type,Authorization,X-API-Key
TINA4_CORS_MAX_AGE=86400

```

Register it globally:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\CorsMiddleware;

Middleware::use(CorsMiddleware::class);

```

The **beforeCors** method sets CORS response headers on every request. For **OPTIONS** preflight requests, it sets a 204 status which short-circuits the handler.

Test the preflight:

```

curl -X OPTIONS http://localhost:7145/api/products \
-H "Origin: http://localhost:3000" \

```

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```
-H "Access-Control-Request-Method: POST" \  
-H "Access-Control-Request-Headers: Content-Type,Authorization" \  
-v
```

Response headers:

```
Access-Control-Allow-Origin: http://localhost:3000  
Access-Control-Allow-Methods: GET,POST,PUT,PATCH,DELETE,OPTIONS  
Access-Control-Allow-Headers: Content-Type,Authorization,X-API-Key  
Access-Control-Max-Age: 86400
```

The **OPTIONS** request returns **204 No Content** with those headers. The browser caches the preflight for 86400 seconds (24 hours). Subsequent requests skip the preflight.

Wildcard Origins

During development:

```
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=*
```

The default. Do not use ***** in production. Specify your domains.

CORS Without Middleware

Set **TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS** in **.env** and Tina4 applies CORS headers globally. The middleware approach gives finer control -- CORS on specific groups, none on internal routes.

4. Built-in RateLimiter

Prevents a single client from flooding your API. Tracks requests per IP. Returns **429 Too Many Requests** when exceeded.

Configure in **.env**:

```
TINA4_RATE_LIMIT=60  
TINA4_RATE_WINDOW=60
```

60 requests per 60 seconds per IP. Register it globally:

```
<?php  
use Tina4\Middleware;  
use Tina4\Middleware\RateLimiter;  
  
Middleware::use(RateLimiter::class);
```

When exceeded, the **beforeRateLimit** method sets a 429 status on the response, which short-circuits the handler. The response includes rate limit headers:

```
X-RateLimit-Limit: 60  
X-RateLimit-Remaining: 0  
Retry-After: 42
```

Built-in RequestLogger

The **RequestLogger** middleware logs every request with its timing. It uses two hooks:

- **beforeLog** stamps the start time before the handler runs

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- `afterLog` calculates elapsed time and writes an info-level log entry

Register it globally:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\RequestLogger;

Middleware::use(RequestLogger::class);
```

The log output looks like:

```
GET /api/users 12.34ms
POST /api/products 45.67ms
```

Built-in SecurityHeadersMiddleware

The `SecurityHeadersMiddleware` adds standard security headers to every response.

Register it globally:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\SecurityHeadersMiddleware;

Middleware::use(SecurityHeadersMiddleware::class);
```

It sets the following headers by default:

Header	Default Value
<code>X-Frame-Options</code>	<code>DENY</code>
<code>Content-Security-Policy</code>	<code>default-src 'self'</code>
<code>Strict-Transport-Security</code>	<code>max-age=31536000;</code> <code>includeSubDomains</code>
<code>Referrer-Policy</code>	<code>strict-origin-when-cross-origin</code>
<code>Permissions-Policy</code>	<code>camera=(), microphone=(),</code> <code>geolocation=()</code>
<code>X-Content-Type-Options</code>	<code>nosniff</code>

Override any header via environment variables in `.env`:

```
TINA4_FRAME_OPTIONS=SAMEORIGIN
TINA4_CSP=default-src 'self'; script-src 'self' https://cdn.example.com
TINA4_HSTS=max-age=63072000; includeSubDomains; preload
TINA4_REFERRER_POLICY=no-referrer
TINA4_PERMISSIONS_POLICY=camera=(), microphone=(), geolocation=(self)
```

Combining All Four Built-In Middleware

A common production setup registers all four globally:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\CorsMiddleware;
```

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```

use Tina4\Middleware\RateLimiter;
use Tina4\Middleware\RequestLogger;
use Tina4\Middleware\SecurityHeadersMiddleware;

Middleware::use(CorsMiddleware::class);
Middleware::use(RateLimiter::class);
Middleware::use(RequestLogger::class);
Middleware::use(SecurityHeadersMiddleware::class);

```

Order matters. CORS handles **OPTIONS** preflight first. The rate limiter only counts real requests (not preflight). The logger measures total time including the other middleware. Security headers are added to every response.

5. Writing Custom Middleware

Route-level middleware functions receive **\$request** and **\$response**. Return nothing to continue the chain. Return a **Response** to short-circuit. Return **false** to block with 403.

Request Logging Middleware

```

<?php

function logRequest($request, $response) {
    $method = $request->method;
    $path = $request->path;
    $ip = $request->ip;

    error_log "[" . date("Y-m-d H:i:s") . "] " . $method . " " . $path . " from " . $ip);
    // return nothing to continue
}

```

Save in **src/routes/middleware.php**. Apply it to a route:

```

Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["products" => []]);
})->middleware([function ($request, $response) {
    error_log($request->method . " " . $request->path);
}]);

```

Or apply the named function to a group:

```

Router::group("/api", function () {
    Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["products" => []]);
    });
}, [$logRequest]);

```

Note: **Router::group()** takes an **array** of middleware callables as its third argument.

IP Whitelist Middleware

```
<?php

function ipWhitelist($request, $response) {
    $allowedIps = explode(",", $_ENV["ALLOWED_IPS"] ?? "127.0.0.1");

    if (!in_array($request->ip, $allowedIps)) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Access denied",
            "your_ip" => $request->ip
        ], 403);
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Configure in `.env`:

```
ALLOWED_IPS=127.0.0.1,10.0.0.5,192.168.1.100
```

When the IP is not in the list, the middleware returns a `Response` object. This short-circuits the chain -- the handler never runs.

Request Validation Middleware

```
<?php

function requireJson($request, $response) {
    if (in_array($request->method, ["POST", "PUT", "PATCH"])) {
        $contentType = $request->headers["Content-Type"] ?? "";

        if (strpos($contentType, "application/json") === false) {
            return $response->json([
                "error" => "Content-Type must be application/json",
                "received" => $contentType
            ], 415);
        }
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Ensures all write requests send JSON. Status: `415 Unsupported Media Type`.

Writing Class-Based Middleware

For more complex middleware, use the class-based pattern with `before*` and `after*` static methods. This style is for **global** middleware registered via `Middleware::use()`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

class InputSanitizer
{
    public static function beforeSanitize(Request $request, Response $response): array
    {
        if (is_array($request->body)) {
            $request->body = self::sanitize($request->body);
        }
        return [$request, $response];
    }
}
```

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```

    }

    private static function sanitize(array $data): array
    {
        $clean = [];
        foreach ($data as $key => $value) {
            if (is_string($value)) {
                $clean[$key] = htmlspecialchars($value, ENT_QUOTES, 'UTF-8');
            } elseif (is_array($value)) {
                $clean[$key] = self::sanitize($value);
            } else {
                $clean[$key] = $value;
            }
        }
        return $clean;
    }
}

```

Register it globally:

```

Middleware::use(InputSanitizer::class);

```

JWT Authentication Middleware (Class-Based)

A real-world authentication middleware that verifies JWT tokens:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Auth;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

class JwtAuthMiddleware
{
    public static function beforeVerifyToken(Request $request, Response $response): array
    {
        $authHeader = $request->headers["Authorization"] ?? "";

        if (empty($authHeader) || !str_starts_with($authHeader, "Bearer ")) {
            $response->status(401);
            return [$request, $response->json(["error" => "Authorization header required"])]];
        }

        $token = substr($authHeader, 7);

        if (!Auth::validToken($token)) {
            $response->status(401);
            return [$request, $response->json(["error" => "Invalid or expired token"])]];
        }

        $request->user = Auth::getPayload($token);
        return [$request, $response];
    }
}

```

Register it globally so all routes require authentication:

```

Middleware::use(JwtAuthMiddleware::class);

```

The middleware short-circuits with 401 if the token is missing or invalid. When `beforeVerifyToken` sets the response status to `>= 400`, the framework skips the route handler.

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The decoded payload is available as `$request->user` in the handler.

6. Applying Middleware to Individual Routes

Use the `->middleware()` method to attach route-level middleware. Pass an array of callables:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["data" => [1, 2, 3]]);
})->middleware([function ($request, $response) {
    error_log("Accessing /api/data");
}]);
```

Multiple middleware functions run in listed order:

```
Router::post("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["created" => true], 201);
})->middleware([$logRequest, $requireJson]);
```

You can also use named functions defined elsewhere:

```
$checkAuth = function ($request, $response) {
    if (!$request->bearerToken()) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Unauthorized"], 401);
    }
};

Router::get("/api/secret", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["secret" => "data"]);
})->middleware([$checkAuth]);
```

7. Route Groups with Shared Middleware

Groups apply middleware to every route inside. The third argument is an **array** of middleware callables:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

$checkAuth = function ($request, $response) {
    if (!$request->bearerToken()) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Unauthorized"], 401);
    }
};

$logRequest = function ($request, $response) {
    error_log($request->method . " " . $request->path);
};

// Public API -- no auth needed
Router::group("/api/public", function () {
    Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
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    });
});
```

```

        return $response->json(["products" => []]);
    });

    Router::get("/categories", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["categories" => []]);
    });

}, [$logRequest]);

// Admin API -- auth required, IP restricted, logged
Router::group("/api/admin", function () {

    Router::get("/users", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["users" => []]);
    });

    Router::delete("/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $id = $request->params["id"];
        return $response->json(["deleted" => $id]);
    });

}, [$logRequest, $ipWhitelist, $checkAuth]);

```

Routes inside a group can add their own middleware. Group middleware runs first, then route-specific:

```

Router::group("/api", function () {

    // Execution: $logRequest -> $requireJson -> handler
    Router::post("/upload", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["uploaded" => true]);
    })->middleware([$requireJson]);

}, [$logRequest]);

```

8. Middleware Execution Order

Route-level middleware runs in listed order. Each middleware either returns nothing (continue) or returns a **Response** (stop).

```

<?php

$middlewareA = function ($request, $response) {
    error_log("A: running");
    // returns nothing -- continues to B
};

$middlewareB = function ($request, $response) {
    error_log("B: running");
    // returns nothing -- continues to C
};

$middlewareC = function ($request, $response) {
    error_log("C: running");
    // returns nothing -- continues to handler
};

```

```
Router::get("/api/test", function ($request, $response) {
    error_log("Handler");
    return $response->json(["ok" => true]);
})->middleware([$middlewareA, $middlewareB, $middlewareC]);
```

Server log:

```
A: running
B: running
C: running
Handler
```

The request flows through the middleware array in order: A, B, C, then the handler.

Placement matters:

- Authentication goes early. Catch unauthorized requests before doing work.
- Validation goes before the handler. Reject bad input early.
- Logging can go first to capture every request, even blocked ones.

Group + Route Middleware Order

```
Router::group("/api", function () {

    Router::get("/data", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["data" => true]);
    })->middleware([$middlewareC]);

}, [$middlewareA, $middlewareB]);
```

Execution: `$middlewareA` -> `$middlewareB` -> `$middlewareC` -> handler. Group middleware always runs before route middleware.

9. Short-Circuiting

When middleware returns a `Response` object, the chain stops. No subsequent middleware runs. The handler never executes.

Authentication Short-Circuit

```
<?php

function requireAuth($request, $response) {
    $token = $request->headers["Authorization"] ?? "";

    if (empty($token)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Authentication required"], 401);
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Missing header: `401` returned. Handler never runs. No database query. No business logic. Resources saved.

Blocking with false

Returning `false` from middleware tells the framework to respond with a generic **403 Forbidden**:

```
<?php

function requireAdmin($request, $response) {
    if (!isAdmin($request)) {
        return false; // framework sends 403 Forbidden
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Maintenance Mode

```
<?php

function maintenanceMode($request, $response) {
    $isMaintenanceMode = ($_ENV["MAINTENANCE_MODE"] ?? "false") === "true";

    if ($isMaintenanceMode) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Service is undergoing maintenance",
            "retry_after" => 300
        ], 503);
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

Add to `.env`:

```
MAINTENANCE_MODE=true
```

Every request gets **503 Service Unavailable**.

Read-Only Mode

```
<?php

function readOnly($request, $response) {
    if (in_array($request->method, ["POST", "PUT", "PATCH", "DELETE"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "API is in read-only mode"], 405);
    }
    // return nothing to continue
}
```

GET requests pass. Write operations blocked. Useful for standby replicas or demo environments.

10. Modifying Requests in Middleware

Middleware can attach data to the request before the handler sees it:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Auth;

function attachUser($request, $response) {
    $authHeader = $request->headers["Authorization"] ?? "";
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```



```

        if (!empty($authHeader) && str_starts_with($authHeader, "Bearer ")) {
            $token = substr($authHeader, 7);
            if (Auth::validToken($token)) {
                $request->user = Auth::getPayload($token);
            }
        }

        // return nothing -- this middleware does not block
    }

```

Different from blocking auth middleware. This attaches user data if present but does not reject unauthenticated requests. Some routes need user data for personalization but remain accessible without it.

Adding Request Metadata

```

<?php

function addRequestId($request, $response) {
    $requestId = bin2hex(random_bytes(8));
    $request->requestId = $requestId;
    $response->addHeader("X-Request-Id", $requestId);
    // return nothing to continue
}

```

The handler accesses `$request->requestId` for logging and correlation:

```

Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    error_log "[" . $request->requestId . "] Processing data request");
    return $response->json(["request_id" => $request->requestId, "data" => []]);
})->middleware([$addRequestId]);

```

11. Real-World Middleware Stack

A realistic production setup combining global class-based middleware with route-level function middleware:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Middleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\CorsMiddleware;
use Tina4\Middleware\RateLimiter;
use Tina4\Middleware\RequestLogger;

// Global middleware -- runs on every request
Middleware::use(CorsMiddleware::class);
Middleware::use(RateLimiter::class);
Middleware::use(RequestLogger::class);

<?php
use Tina4 Router;

// src/routes/middleware.php

$addRequestId = function ($request, $response) {
    $request->requestId = bin2hex(random_bytes(8));
    $response->addHeader("X-Request-Id", $request->requestId);
};

```

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```

$requireApiKey = function ($request, $response) {
    $apiKey = $request->headers["X-API-Key"] ?? "";
    $validKeys = explode(",", $_ENV["API_KEYS"] ?? "");

    if (!in_array($apiKey, $validKeys)) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Invalid or missing API key",
            "request_id" => $request->requestId ?? null
        ], 401);
    }
};

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

// src/routes/api.php

Router::group("/api/v1", function () {

    Router::get("/products", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["products" => [
            ["id" => 1, "name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99],
            ["id" => 2, "name" => "Gadget", "price" => 19.99]
        ]]);
    });

    Router::get("/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $id = $request->params["id"];
        return $response->json(["id" => $id, "name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99]);
    });

    Router::post("/products", function ($request, $response) {
        $body = $request->body;
        return $response->json([
            "id" => 3,
            "name" => $body["name"] ?? "Unknown",
            "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 0)
        ], 201);
    });

}, [$addRequestId, $requireApiKey]);

```

Without API key:

```
{"error": "Invalid or missing API key", "request_id": "a1b2c3d4e5f6a7b8"}
```

With valid key:

```
{"products": [{"id": 1, "name": "Widget", "price": 9.99}, {"id": 2, "name": "Gadget", "price": 19.99}]}
```

12. Exercise: Build an API Key Middleware

Build API key middleware:

- Check for **X-API-Key** header
- Validate against a comma-separated list in **API_KEYS** env variable

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- Missing key: 401 with {"error": "API key required"}
- Invalid key: 403 with {"error": "Invalid API key"}
- Valid key: attach to `$request->apiKey` and continue
- Apply to a group with at least two endpoints

Setup

API_KEYS=key-alpha-001,key-beta-002,key-gamma-003

Test with:

```
# No key -- 401
curl http://localhost:7145/api/partner/data

# Invalid key -- 403
curl http://localhost:7145/api/partner/data \
  -H "X-API-Key: wrong-key"

# Valid key -- 200
curl http://localhost:7145/api/partner/data \
  -H "X-API-Key: key-alpha-001"

# Valid key on another endpoint
curl http://localhost:7145/api/partner/stats \
  -H "X-API-Key: key-beta-002"
```

13. Solution

Create `src/routes/api-key-middleware.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

$validateApiKey = function ($request, $response) {
    $apiKey = $request->headers["X-API-Key"] ?? "";

    if (empty($apiKey)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "API key required"], 401);
    }

    $validKeys = array_map("trim", explode(",", $_ENV["API_KEYS"] ?? ""));

    if (!in_array($apiKey, $validKeys)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid API key"], 403);
    }

    $request->apiKey = $apiKey;
    // return nothing to continue
};
```

```
Router::group("/api/partner", function () {

    Router::get("/data", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json([
            "authenticated_with" => $request->apiKey,
        ]);
    });
});
```

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```

        "data" => [
            ["id" => 1, "value" => "alpha"],
            ["id" => 2, "value" => "beta"]
        ]
    });
});

Router::get("/stats", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json([
        "authenticated_with" => $request->apiKey,
        "stats" => [
            "total_requests" => 1423,
            "avg_response_ms" => 42
        ]
    ]);
});

}, [$validateApiKey]);

```

No key: 401 -- {"error": "API key required"}

Invalid key: 403 -- {"error": "Invalid API key"}

Valid key:

```

{
    "authenticated_with": "key-alpha-001",
    "data": [
        {"id": 1, "value": "alpha"},
        {"id": 2, "value": "beta"}
    ]
}
---

```

14. Gotchas

1. Route Middleware Must Be Callable

Problem: Passing a string name instead of a callable to `->middleware()` or `Router::group()`.

Cause: Route-level middleware expects an array of callable functions (closures or function references), not string names.

Fix: Pass callables: `->middleware([$myFunction])` or `->middleware([function ($request, $response) { ... }])`. Use variables holding closures, not strings.

2. Returning the Wrong Thing from Middleware

Problem: Middleware runs but does not behave as expected -- handler runs when it should be blocked, or chain stops when it should continue.

Cause: Confusion about return values. Route-level middleware uses a three-way contract:

- Return nothing (null/void) to continue
- Return a **Response** to short-circuit_____

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- Return `false` to block with 403

Fix: To continue, just do not return anything. To block, return `$response->json(..., 401)`. Do not return `true` or other values.

3. Middleware Order Matters

Problem: Logging middleware does not see the request ID.

Cause: `$logRequest` runs before `$addRequestId`.

Fix: Put `$addRequestId` first: `[$addRequestId, $logRequest]`. Think: what needs to happen first.

4. CORS Preflight Returns 404

Problem: Browser `OPTIONS` request gets 404. `GET` and `POST` work with curl.

Cause: No `CorsMiddleware` registered. `OPTIONS` is not handled.

Fix: Register `Middleware::use(CorsMiddleware::class)`. It handles `OPTIONS` and returns correct CORS headers. Or set `CORS_ORIGINS` in `.env` for global handling.

5. Rate Limiter Counts Preflight Requests

Problem: Frontend hits rate limit faster than expected. Every `POST` counts as two (`OPTIONS` + `POST`).

Fix: Register `CorsMiddleware` before `RateLimiter` globally. CORS handles `OPTIONS` and short-circuits with 204. The rate limiter only sees real requests.

6. Middleware File Not Auto-Loaded

Problem: Middleware variable is undefined when used in a route file.

Cause: File is not in `src/routes/`. Tina4 auto-loads `.php` files from that directory only.

Fix: Put middleware in `src/routes/middleware.php`. Filename does not matter. Location does.

7. Group Middleware Expects an Array

Problem: Passing a single callable instead of an array to `Router::group()`.

Cause: The third parameter of `Router::group()` is typed as `array $middleware = []`.

Fix: Always wrap in an array: `Router::group("/api", $callback, [$myMiddleware])`, not `Router::group("/api", $callback, $myMiddleware)`.

8. Mixing Up the Two Middleware Styles

Problem: Trying to use a class-based middleware in `->middleware()` or a function in `Middleware::use()`.

Cause: The two styles serve different purposes. Route-level middleware (`->middleware()` and `Router::group()`) takes callable functions. Global middleware (`Middleware::use()`) takes class names with `before*/after*` static methods.

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Fix: Use `Middleware::use(MyClass::class)` for class-based global middleware. Use `->middleware([$callable])` for route-level function middleware.

Security

Every route you write is a door. Chapter 8 gave you locks. Chapter 10 gave you guards. Chapter 9 gave you session keys. This chapter ties them together into a defence that works without thinking about it.

Tina4 ships secure by default. POST routes require authentication. CSRF tokens protect forms. Security headers harden every response. The framework does the boring security work so you focus on building features. But you need to understand what it does — and why — so you don't accidentally undo it.

1. Secure-by-Default Routing

Every POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE route requires a valid `Authorization: Bearer` token. No configuration needed. No method to call. The framework enforces this before your handler runs.

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::post("/api/orders", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    // This handler ONLY runs if the request carries a valid Bearer token.
    // Without one, the framework returns 401 before your code executes.
    return $response(["created" => true], 201);
});
```

Test it without a token:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/orders \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"product": "widget"}'
# 401 Unauthorized
```

Test it with a valid token:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/orders \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiJ9..." \
  -d '{"product": "widget"}'
# 201 Created
```

GET routes are public by default. Anyone can read. Writing requires proof of identity.

Making a Write Route Public

Some endpoints need to accept unauthenticated writes — webhooks, registration forms, public contact forms. Use `->noAuth()`:

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```

use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::post("/api/webhooks/stripe", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    // No token required. Stripe can POST here freely.
    return $response(["received" => true]);
})->noAuth();

```

Protecting a GET Route

Admin dashboards, user profiles, account settings — some pages need protection even though they only read data. Use `->secure()`:

```

use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/api/admin/users", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    // Requires a valid Bearer token, even though it's a GET.
    return $response(["users" => []]);
})->secure();

```

The Rule

Method	Default	Override
GET, HEAD, OPTIONS	Public	<code>->secure()</code> to protect
POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE	Auth required	<code>->noAuth()</code> to open

Two methods. One rule. No surprises.

2. CSRF Protection

Cross-Site Request Forgery tricks a user's browser into submitting a form to your server. The browser sends cookies automatically — including session cookies. Without CSRF protection, an attacker's page can submit forms as your logged-in user.

Tina4 blocks this with form tokens.

How It Works

- Your template renders a hidden token using `{{ form_token() }}`.
- The browser submits the token with the form data.
- The `CsrfMiddleware` validates the token before the route handler runs.
- Invalid or missing tokens receive a **403 Forbidden** response.

The Template

```
<form method="POST" action="/api/profile">
  {{ form_token() }}
  <input type="text" name="name" placeholder="Your name">
  <button type="submit">Save</button>
</form>
```

The `{{ form_token() }}` call generates a hidden input field containing a signed JWT. The token is bound to the current session — a token from one session cannot be used in another.

The Middleware

CSRF protection is on by default. Every POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE request must include a valid form token. The middleware checks two places:

- **Request body** — `$request->body["formToken"]`
- **Request header** — `X-Form-Token`

If the token is missing or invalid, the middleware returns 403 before your handler runs.

AJAX Requests

For JavaScript-driven forms, send the token as a header:

```
// frond.min.js handles this automatically via saveForm()
// For manual AJAX, extract the token from the hidden field:
const token = document.querySelector('input[name="formToken"]').value;

fetch("/api/profile", {
  method: "POST",
  headers: {
    "Content-Type": "application/json",
    "X-Form-Token": token
  },
  body: JSON.stringify({ name: "Alice" })
});
```

Tokens in Query Strings — Blocked

Tokens must never appear in URLs. Query strings are logged in server access logs, browser history, and referrer headers. A token in the URL is a token anyone can steal.

Tina4 rejects any request that carries `formToken` in the query string and logs a warning:

```
CSRF token found in query string – rejected for security.
Use POST body or X-Form-Token header instead.
```

Skipping CSRF Validation

Three scenarios skip CSRF checks automatically:

- **GET, HEAD, OPTIONS** — Safe methods don't modify state.
- **Routes with `->noAuth()`** — Public write endpoints don't need CSRF (they have no session to protect).
- **Requests with a valid Bearer token** — API clients authenticate with tokens, not cookies. CSRF only matters for cookie-based sessions.

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Disabling CSRF Globally

For internal microservices behind a firewall — where no browser ever touches the API — you can disable CSRF entirely:

```
TINA4_CSRF=false
```

Leave it enabled for anything a browser can reach. The cost is one hidden field per form. The protection is worth it.

3. Session-Bound Tokens

A form token alone prevents cross-site forgery. But what if someone steals a token from a form? Session binding stops them.

When `{{ form_token() }}` generates a token, it embeds the current session ID in the JWT payload. The CSRF middleware checks that the session ID in the token matches the session ID of the request. A token stolen from one session cannot be replayed in another.

This happens automatically. No configuration. No extra code.

How Stolen Tokens Fail

- Attacker visits your site, gets a form token for session `abc-123`.
- Attacker sends that token from their own session `xyz-789`.
- The middleware compares: `abc-123 != xyz-789` — rejected with 403.

The token is cryptographically valid. But it belongs to the wrong session. The binding catches it.

4. Security Headers

Every response from Tina4 carries security headers. The `SecurityHeadersMiddleware` injects them before the response reaches the browser. No opt-in required.

Header	Default Value	Purpose
<code>X-Frame-Options</code>	<code>SAMEORIGIN</code>	Prevents clickjacking — your pages cannot be embedded in iframes on other domains.
<code>X-Content-Type-Options</code>	<code>nosniff</code>	Stops browsers from guessing content types. A script is a script, not HTML.
<code>Content-Security-Policy</code>	<code>default-src 'self'</code>	Controls which resources the browser loads. Blocks inline scripts from injected HTML.

Referrer-Policy	strict-origin-when-cross-origin	Limits referrer data sent to external sites. Protects internal URLs from leaking.
X-XSS-Protection	0	Disabled. Modern CSP replaces this legacy header. Keeping it on can introduce vulnerabilities.
Permissions-Policy	camera=(), microphone=(), geolocation=()	Disables browser APIs your app does not need.

HSTS — Enforcing HTTPS

Strict Transport Security tells the browser to always use HTTPS. Disabled by default (it breaks local development on HTTP). Enable it in production:

```
TINA4_HSTS=31536000
```

This sets a one-year HSTS policy with `includeSubDomains`. Once a browser sees this header, it refuses to connect over HTTP — even if the user types `http://`.

Customising Headers

Override any header via environment variables:

```
TINA4_FRAME_OPTIONS=DENY
TINA4_CSP=default-src 'self'; script-src 'self' https://cdn.example.com
TINA4_REFERRER_POLICY=no-referrer
TINA4_PERMISSIONS_POLICY=camera=(), microphone=(), geolocation=(), payment=()
```

5. SameSite Cookies

Session cookies control who can send them. The `SameSite` attribute tells the browser when to include the cookie in requests.

Value	Behaviour
Strict	Cookie sent only on same-site requests. Even clicking a link from email to your site won't include the cookie. The user must navigate directly.
Lax	Cookie sent on same-site requests and top-level navigations (clicking a link). Not sent on cross-site AJAX or form POSTs from other domains.

None	Cookie sent on all requests, including cross-site. Requires Secure flag (HTTPS only).
------	--

Tina4 defaults to **Lax**. This blocks cross-site form submissions (CSRF) while allowing normal link navigation. Users click a link to your site from an email — they stay logged in. An attacker's page submits a hidden form — the cookie is withheld.

For most applications, **Lax** is the right choice. Change it only if you understand the trade-offs.

6. Login Flow — Complete Example

Authentication, sessions, tokens, and security converge in the login flow. Here is a complete implementation.

The Login Route

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\Auth;

Router::post("/api/login", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $email = $request->body["email"] ?? "";
    $password = $request->body["password"] ?? "";

    if (empty($email) || empty($password)) {
        return $response(["error" => "Email and password required"], 400);
    }

    // Look up user (replace with your database query)
    $user = $DBA->fetch(
        "SELECT id, email, password_hash, role FROM users WHERE email = ?",
        [$email]
    )->asObject()[0] ?? null;

    if (!$user) {
        return $response(["error" => "Invalid credentials"], 401);
    }

    // Verify password
    if (!Auth::checkPassword($password, $user->password_hash)) {
        return $response(["error" => "Invalid credentials"], 401);
    }

    // Generate token with user claims
    $secret = $_ENV["TINA4_SECRET"] ?? getenv("TINA4_SECRET");
    $token = Auth::getToken([
        "sub" => $user->id,
        "email" => $user->email,
        "role" => $user->role,
    ], $secret);

    // Store user in session
    $request->session->set("user_id", $user->id);
    $request->session->set("email", $user->email);
    $request->session->set("role", $user->role);
    $request->session->save();

    return $response([
        "token" => $token,
        "user" => ["id" => $user->id, "email" => $user->email],
    ]);
})->noAuth();
```

The `->noAuth()` call opens this route to unauthenticated requests. The handler validates credentials and issues a token. The session stores the user identity for server-side lookups.

The Login Form

```
{% extends "base.twig" %}
{% block content %}
<div class="container mt-5" style="max-width: 400px;">
  <h2>Login</h2>
  <form id="loginForm">
    {{ form_token() }}
    <div class="mb-3">
      <label for="email">Email</label>
      <input type="email" name="email" id="email" class="form-control"
        placeholder="you@example.com" required>
    </div>
    <div class="mb-3">
      <label for="password">Password</label>
      <input type="password" name="password" id="password" class="form-control"
        placeholder="Your password" required>
    </div>
    <button type="button" class="btn btn-primary w-100"
      onclick="saveForm('loginForm', '/api/login', 'loginMsg', handleLogin)">
      Sign In
    </button>
    <div id="loginMsg" class="mt-3"></div>
  </form>
</div>

<script>
function handleLogin(result) {
  if (result.token) {
    localStorage.setItem("token", result.token);
    window.location.href = "/dashboard";
  }
}
</script>
{% endblock %}
```

Protected Pages — Checking the Session

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/dashboard", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
  $userId = $request->session->get("user_id");

  if (!$userId) {
    return $response->redirect("/login");
  }

  return $response->render("dashboard.twig", [
    "email" => $request->session->get("email"),
    "role" => $request->session->get("role"),
  ]);
});
```

Logout — Destroying the Session

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::post("/api/logout", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $request->session->destroy();
    return $response(["logged_out" => true]);
})->noAuth();
```

7. Handling Expired Sessions

Sessions expire. Tokens expire. The user clicks a link and finds themselves staring at a broken page or a cryptic error. A good security implementation handles expiry gracefully.

The Pattern: Redirect to Login, Then Back

When a session expires mid-use, the user should:

- See a login page — not an error.
- Log in again.
- Land on the page they were trying to reach — not the home page.

```
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/account/settings", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $userId = $request->session->get("user_id");

    if (!$userId) {
        // Remember where they wanted to go
        $returnUrl = urlencode($request->url);
        return $response->redirect("/login?redirect={$returnUrl}");
    }

    return $response->render("settings.twig", ["user_id" => $userId]);
});
```

The login handler reads the **redirect** parameter after successful authentication:

```
Router::post("/api/login", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    // ... validate credentials ...

    $redirectUrl = $request->query["redirect"] ?? "/dashboard";

    return $response([
        "token" => $token,
        "redirect" => $redirectUrl,
    ]);
})->noAuth();
```

The login form JavaScript redirects to the saved URL:

```
function handleLogin(result){_____
```

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```

    if (result.token) {
        localStorage.setItem("token", result.token);
        window.location.href = result.redirect || "/dashboard";
    }
}

```

Token Refresh

Tokens expire based on `TINA4_TOKEN_LIMIT` (default: 60 minutes). The `frond.min.js` frontend library handles token refresh automatically — every response includes a `FreshToken` header with a new token. The client stores it and uses it for the next request.

For custom AJAX code, read the header yourself:

```

const res = await fetch("/api/data", {
    headers: { "Authorization": "Bearer " + localStorage.getItem("token") }
});

const freshToken = res.headers.get("FreshToken");
if (freshToken) {
    localStorage.setItem("token", freshToken);
}

```

8. Rate Limiting

Brute-force login attempts. Credential stuffing. API abuse. Rate limiting stops all of them.

Tina4 includes a sliding-window rate limiter that tracks requests per IP address. It activates automatically.

```

TINA4_RATE_LIMIT=100
TINA4_RATE_WINDOW=60

```

One hundred requests per sixty seconds per IP. Exceed the limit and the server returns `429 Too Many Requests` with headers telling the client when to retry:

```

X-RateLimit-Limit: 100
X-RateLimit-Remaining: 0
X-RateLimit-Reset: 45

```

For login routes, consider a stricter limit:

```

use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\Middleware;

class LoginRateLimit extends Middleware
{
    public static function beforeRateCheck(Request $request, Response $response): array
    {
        // Custom rate limiter: 5 attempts per 60 seconds for login
        $ip = $request->ip;
        // ... implement per-route rate limiting ...
        return [$request, $response];
    }
}

```

```
Router::post("/api/login", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    // ... login logic ...
})->noAuth()->middleware(LoginRateLimit::class);
```

9. CORS and Credentials

When your frontend runs on a different origin than your API (common in development), CORS controls whether the browser sends cookies and auth headers.

Tina4 handles CORS automatically. The relevant security settings:

```
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=*
TINA4_CORS_CREDENTIALS=true
```

Two rules to remember:

- **TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=*** with **TINA4_CORS_CREDENTIALS=true** is invalid per the CORS spec. Tina4 handles this — when origin is `*`, the credentials header is not sent. But in production, list your actual origins.
- **Cookies need SameSite=None; Secure** for true cross-origin requests. If your API is on `api.example.com` and your frontend is on `app.example.com`, the default **Lax** cookie works because they share the same registrable domain. Different domains need **SameSite=None**.

Production CORS:

```
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=https://app.example.com,https://admin.example.com
TINA4_CORS_CREDENTIALS=true
```

10. Security Checklist

Before you deploy, verify:

- [] **TINA4_SECRET** is set to a long, random string — not the default.
- [] **TINA4_DEBUG=false** in production.
- [] **TINA4_HSTS=31536000** if serving over HTTPS.
- [] **TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS** lists your actual domains — not `*`.
- [] **TINA4_CSRF=true** (the default) for any browser-facing application.
- [] Login route uses `->noAuth()` and validates credentials before issuing tokens.
- [] Session is regenerated after login (prevents session fixation).
- [] Passwords are hashed with `Auth::hashPassword()` — never stored in plain text.
- [] File uploads are validated and size-limited (**TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE**).
- [] Rate limiting is active on login and registration routes.
- [] Expired sessions redirect to login with a return URL.

Gotchas

1. "My POST route returns 401 but I didn't add auth"

Cause: Tina4 requires authentication on all write routes by default.

Fix: Chain `->noAuth()` on the route definition if the endpoint should be public. Otherwise, send a valid Bearer token with the request.

2. "CSRF validation fails on AJAX requests"

Cause: The form token is not included in the request.

Fix: Send the token as an `X-Form-Token` header. If using `frond.min.js`, call `saveForm()` — it handles tokens automatically.

3. "I disabled CSRF but forms still fail"

Cause: The route still requires Bearer auth (separate from CSRF). CSRF and auth are independent checks.

Fix: Either send a Bearer token or chain `->noAuth()` on the route.

4. "My Content-Security-Policy blocks inline scripts"

Cause: The default CSP is `default-src 'self'`, which blocks inline `<script>` tags and `onclick` handlers.

Fix: Move scripts to external `.js` files (the right approach) or relax the CSP:

```
TINA4_CSP=default-src 'self'; script-src 'self' 'unsafe-inline'
```

Prefer external scripts. Inline scripts are an XSS vector.

5. "User stays logged in after session expires"

Cause: The frontend stores a JWT in `localStorage`. The token is still valid even after the session is destroyed server-side.

Fix: Check the session on every page load. If the session is gone, redirect to login regardless of the token. Tokens authenticate API calls; sessions track server-side state. Both must be valid.

Exercise: Secure Contact Form

Build a public contact form that:

- Does not require login (`->noAuth()`).
- Validates CSRF tokens (form includes `{{ form_token() }}`).
- Rate-limits submissions to 3 per minute per IP.
- Stores messages in the database._____

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- Returns a success message.

Solution

```
// src/routes/contact.php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/contact", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    return $response->render("contact.twig", ["title" => "Contact Us"]);
});

Router::post("/api/contact", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $name = trim($request->body["name"] ?? "");
    $email = trim($request->body["email"] ?? "");
    $message = trim($request->body["message"] ?? "");

    if (empty($name) || empty($email) || empty($message)) {
        return $response(["error" => "All fields are required"], 400);
    }

    global $DBA;

    $DBA->exec(
        "INSERT INTO contact_messages (name, email, message) VALUES (?, ?, ?)",
        [$name, $email, $message]
    );
    $DBA->commit();

    return $response(["success" => true, "message" => "Thank you for your message"]);
})->noAuth();

{# src/templates/contact.twig #}
{% extends "base.twig" %}
{% block title %}Contact Us{% endblock %}
{% block content %}
<div class="container mt-5" style="max-width: 500px;">
    <h2>{{ title }}</h2>
    <form id="contactForm">
        {{ form_token() }}
        <div class="mb-3">
            <label for="name">Name</label>
            <input type="text" name="name" id="name" class="form-control"
                placeholder="Jane Smith" required>
        </div>
        <div class="mb-3">
            <label for="email">Email</label>
            <input type="email" name="email" id="email" class="form-control"
                placeholder="jane@example.com" required>
        </div>
        <div class="mb-3">
            <label for="message">Message</label>
            <textarea name="message" id="message" class="form-control" rows="4"
                placeholder="How can we help?" required></textarea>
        </div>
        <button type="button" class="btn btn-primary"
            onclick="saveForm('contactForm', '/api/contact', 'contactMsg')">
            Send Message
        </button>
    </div>
</div>
```

```
        </button>
        <div id="contactMsg" class="mt-3"></div>
    </form>
</div>
{% endblock %}
```

The form is public. The CSRF token is present. The `->noAuth()` call opens the route. The middleware validates the token. The database stores the message. The user sees confirmation.

Five moving parts. Zero security holes. The framework handles the rest.

Caching

1. From 800ms to 3ms

Your product catalog page runs 12 database queries. It takes 800 milliseconds to render. Every visitor triggers the same queries, the same template rendering, the same JSON serialization -- for data that changes once a day.

Add caching. The first request takes 800ms. The next 10,000 take 3ms each. A 266x improvement. One line of configuration.

Caching stores the result of expensive operations for reuse. Tina4 provides caching at multiple levels: response caching (entire HTTP responses), database query caching, and a direct cache API for custom use cases.

2. Response Caching with ResponseCache Middleware

The fastest cache is at the HTTP response level. The **ResponseCache** middleware stores the complete response -- headers and body -- and serves it on subsequent requests without calling your route handler at all.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    // This handler runs 12 database queries and takes 800ms
    // With ResponseCache, it only runs once every 5 minutes

    error_log("Handler called -- this should only appear once every 5 minutes");

    $products = [
        ["id" => 1, "name" => "Wireless Keyboard", "price" => 79.99],
        ["id" => 2, "name" => "USB-C Hub", "price" => 49.99],
        ["id" => 3, "name" => "Monitor Stand", "price" => 129.99]
    ];

    return $response->json(["products" => $products, "generated_at" => date("c")]);
}, "ResponseCache:300");
```

"ResponseCache:300" caches the response for 300 seconds (5 minutes). During those 5 minutes:

- The first request runs the handler (800ms)
- The next 10,000 requests serve the cached response (3ms each)
- After 300 seconds, the cache expires and the next request runs the handler again

```
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products
```

```
{
  "products": [
    {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99},
    {"id": 2, "name": "USB-C Hub", "price": 49.99},
```

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```

    {"id": 3, "name": "Monitor Stand", "price": 129.99}
  ],
  "generated_at": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00"
}

```

Call it again within 5 minutes:

```

curl http://localhost:7145/api/products

{
  "products": [
    {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99},
    {"id": 2, "name": "USB-C Hub", "price": 49.99},
    {"id": 3, "name": "Monitor Stand", "price": 129.99}
  ],
  "generated_at": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00"
}

```

Same **generated_at** timestamp. The handler did not run. The response came from cache.

Cache Headers

The **ResponseCache** middleware sets cache-related headers:

```

X-Cache: HIT
X-Cache-TTL: 247
Cache-Control: public, max-age=300

```

- **X-Cache: HIT** or **X-Cache: MISS** -- whether the response came from cache
- **X-Cache-TTL** -- remaining time-to-live in seconds
- **Cache-Control** -- enables browser and CDN caching

Caching with Query Parameters

The cache key includes the full URL with query parameters. **/api/products?page=1** and **/api/products?page=2** are cached separately:

```

Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);
    $limit = 20;
    $offset = ($page - 1) * $limit;

    // Simulate database query
    return $response->json([
        "page" => $page,
        "products" => [],
        "generated_at" => date("c")
    ]);
}, "ResponseCache:300");

```

```

curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products?page=1" # Cache MISS, stores for page=1
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products?page=2" # Cache MISS, stores for page=2
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products?page=1" # Cache HIT

```

What Not to Cache

Do not use **ResponseCache** on:

- **POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE routes:** Only GET responses should be cached

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- **User-specific endpoints:** `/api/profile` returns different data for each user
- **Real-time data:** Stock prices, live scores, chat messages
- **Authenticated endpoints:** Unless the cache is scoped per user

```
// GOOD: Public, stable data
Router::get("/api/categories", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["categories" => []]);
}, "ResponseCache:3600"); // Cache for 1 hour

// BAD: User-specific data -- do NOT cache
Router::get("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json($request->user);
}, "authMiddleware"); // No ResponseCache here
```

3. Memory Cache (Default)

Tina4's cache system stores data in memory by default. No configuration needed.

```
# This is the default -- you do not need to set it
TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND=memory
```

Memory cache is the fastest option. No disk I/O. No network calls. But it resets when the server restarts. Ideal for development and single-server deployments where losing the cache on restart is acceptable.

4. Redis Cache

For production: cache persistence across server restarts. Shared cache across multiple server instances. Use Redis:

```
TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND=redis
TINA4_CACHE_URL=localhost
TINA4_CACHE_URL=6379
TINA4_CACHE_URL=your-redis-password
```

Your code does not change. `cache_get`, `cache_set`, and `ResponseCache` all work the same. Only the storage backend changes.

Why Redis?

- Cache survives server restarts
- Shared across multiple server instances behind a load balancer
- Sub-millisecond reads and writes
- Built-in key expiry. TTL cleanup is automatic
- Same Redis instance can serve sessions, cache, and queues

5. File Cache

Cache persistence without Redis. File-based caching:

```
TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND=file
TINA4_CACHE_DIR=/path/to/cache/directory
```

Each cache entry becomes a file on disk. Slower than memory or Redis, but survives server restarts without extra infrastructure.

When to Use File Cache

- You need persistence but cannot run Redis
- Your hosting is limited (shared hosting, no external services)
- Cache entries are large and you do not want them in memory

6. Direct Cache API

For custom caching logic, use `cache_get`, `cache_set`, and `cache_delete` directly.

cache_set

```
<?php
use function Tina4\cache_set;

// Cache a value for 300 seconds
cache_set("product:42", [
    "id" => 42,
    "name" => "Wireless Keyboard",
    "price" => 79.99,
    "in_stock" => true
], 300);

// Cache a string
cache_set("exchange_rate:USD_EUR", "0.92", 3600);

// Cache indefinitely (no TTL)
cache_set("app:config", ["theme" => "dark", "lang" => "en"]);
```

cache_get

```
<?php
use function Tina4\cache_get;

$product = cache_get("product:42");
// Returns the cached array, or null if not found or expired

if ($product === null) {
    // Cache miss -- fetch from database
    $product = fetchProductFromDatabase(42);
    cache_set("product:42", $product, 300);
}

return $response->json($product);
```

cache_delete

```
<?php
use function Tina4\cache_delete;

// Delete a specific key
cache_delete("product:42");

// Delete multiple keys
cache_delete("product:42");
cache_delete("product:43");
cache_delete("product:44");
```

Real-World Pattern: Cache-Aside

The most common caching pattern. Also called lazy loading:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;
use function Tina4\cache_get;
use function Tina4\cache_set;

Router::get("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $cacheKey = "product:" . $id;

    // 1. Try the cache first
    $product = cache_get($cacheKey);

    if ($product !== null) {
        // Cache hit -- return immediately
        return $response->json(array_merge($product, ["source" => "cache"]));
    }

    // 2. Cache miss -- fetch from database
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $product = $db->fetchOne(
        "SELECT id, name, category, price, in_stock FROM products WHERE id = :id",
        ["id" => $id]
    );

    if ($product === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Product not found"], 404);
    }

    // 3. Store in cache for next time
    cache_set($cacheKey, $product, 600); // Cache for 10 minutes

    return $response->json(array_merge($product, ["source" => "database"]));
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/products/42
```

First call (cache miss):

```
{
  "id": 42,
  "name": "Wireless Keyboard",
  "category": "Electronics", _____
```

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```

    "price": 79.99,
    "in_stock": true,
    "source": "database"
  }

```

Second call (cache hit):

```

{
  "id": 42,
  "name": "Wireless Keyboard",
  "category": "Electronics",
  "price": 79.99,
  "in_stock": true,
  "source": "cache"
}

```

7. Database Query Caching

Tina4 caches database query results when enabled in `.env`:

```

TINA4_DB_CACHE=true
TINA4_DB_CACHE_TTL=300

```

Identical queries return cached results instead of hitting the database:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;

Router::get("/api/categories", function ($request, $response) {
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    // First call: executes the query (20ms)
    // Subsequent calls within 300 seconds: returns cached result (0.1ms)
    $categories = $db->fetchAll("SELECT * FROM categories ORDER BY name");

    return $response->json(["categories" => $categories]);
});

```

The cache key derives from the SQL query and its parameters. Different queries or different parameters produce different cache keys:

```

// These are cached separately:
$db->fetchAll("SELECT * FROM products WHERE category = :cat", ["cat" => "Electronics"]);
$db->fetchAll("SELECT * FROM products WHERE category = :cat", ["cat" => "Fitness"]);

```

When to Use DB Cache

- Read-heavy applications where the same queries run repeatedly
- Reference data that changes rarely (categories, countries, settings)
- Dashboard queries that aggregate large datasets

When Not to Use DB Cache

- Write-heavy applications where data changes constantly

- Queries with real-time requirements (inventory counts, live prices)
- Queries that must return the latest data

Skipping Cache for Specific Queries

```
// Force a fresh query, bypassing the cache
$freshData = $db->fetchAll("SELECT * FROM products", [], ["no_cache" => true]);
```

8. Cache Invalidation Strategies

The hardest problem in caching: knowing when to clear the cache. Stale cache serves outdated data. Premature invalidation reduces cache effectiveness.

Strategy 1: Time-Based Expiry (TTL)

The simplest approach. Set a TTL. Let the cache expire on its own:

```
cache_set("products:featured", $featuredProducts, 600); // Expires in 10 minutes
```

Good for data where near-real-time accuracy is acceptable. A 10-minute delay in updating the featured products list is usually fine.

Strategy 2: Event-Based Invalidation

Clear the cache when the underlying data changes:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;
use function Tina4\cache_set;
use function Tina4\cache_delete;

// Update a product
Router::put("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $db->execute(
        "UPDATE products SET name = :name, price = :price WHERE id = :id",
        ["name" => $body["name"], "price" => $body["price"], "id" => $id]
    );

    // Invalidate the cache for this product
    cache_delete("product:" . $id);

    // Also invalidate any list caches that might include this product
    cache_delete("products:all");
    cache_delete("products:featured");

    $updated = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM products WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    return $response->json($updated);
});
```

The most accurate strategy. The cache is always fresh after a write. The downside: you must remember to invalidate everywhere the data could be cached.

Strategy 3: Write-Through Cache

Update the cache at the same time as the database:

```
Router::put("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;
    $db = Database::getConnection();

    $db->execute(
        "UPDATE products SET name = :name, price = :price WHERE id = :id",
        ["name" => $body["name"], "price" => $body["price"], "id" => $id]
    );

    $updated = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM products WHERE id = :id", ["id" => $id]);

    // Write the new data directly to cache (instead of deleting)
    cache_set("product:" . $id, $updated, 600);

    return $response->json($updated);
});
```

The cache always has the latest data. No cache miss after an update. The next read comes from the already-warm cache.

9. TTL Management

Choosing the right TTL depends on change frequency and tolerance for stale data:

Data Type	Suggested TTL	Reasoning
Static config (categories, countries)	3600 (1 hour)	Changes rarely, stale data is harmless
Product catalog	300 (5 min)	Updates several times per day
User profile	60 (1 min)	Users expect changes to appear fast
Search results	120 (2 min)	Balance between freshness and performance
Dashboard stats	30 (30 sec)	Near-real-time but expensive to compute
Exchange rates	60 (1 min)	Updates frequently, slight delay is acceptable
Shopping cart	0 (no cache)	Must reflect current state

Dynamic TTL

Adjust TTL based on data characteristics:

```
<?php
use function Tina4\cache_set;
use function Tina4\cache_get;

function getCachedProduct($id) {
    $cacheKey = "product:" . $id;
    $product = cache_get($cacheKey);

    if ($product !== null) {
        return $product;
    }

    $product = fetchProductFromDatabase($id);

    // Popular products: shorter TTL (more likely to change)
    // Inactive products: longer TTL (rarely change)
    $ttl = ($product["view_count"] > 1000) ? 60 : 3600;

    cache_set($cacheKey, $product, $ttl);

    return $product;
}
---
```

10. Cache Statistics

Monitor cache performance. Verify that caching helps:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use function Tina4\cache_stats;

Router::get("/api/cache/stats", function ($request, $response) {
    $stats = cache_stats();

    return $response->json($stats);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/cache/stats

{
  "backend": "memory",
  "entries": 42,
  "hits": 15234,
  "misses": 891,
  "hit_rate": "94.5%",
  "memory_bytes": 524288,
  "oldest_entry_age": 3542
}
```

A hit rate above 90% means your caching strategy works. Below 80% suggests TTLs are too short, the cache is too small, or you are caching data that is accessed too infrequently to benefit.

The dev dashboard at [/__dev](#) also shows cache statistics, including per-key hit counts and miss counts.

11. Combining Cache Layers

For maximum performance, layer multiple cache strategies:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Database;
use function Tina4\cache_get;
use function Tina4\cache_set;

Router::get("/api/catalog", function ($request, $response) {
    $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);
    $cacheKey = "catalog:page:" . $page;

    // Layer 1: Check application cache
    $catalog = cache_get($cacheKey);

    if ($catalog !== null) {
        return $response->json(array_merge($catalog, ["cache" => "application"]));
    }

    // Layer 2: Database query (with DB-level caching if TINA4_DB_CACHE=true)
    $db = Database::getConnection();
    $limit = 20;
    $offset = ($page - 1) * $limit;

    $products = $db->fetchAll(
        "SELECT p.*, c.name as category_name
        FROM products p
        JOIN categories c ON p.category_id = c.id
        WHERE p.active = 1
        ORDER BY p.created_at DESC
        LIMIT :limit OFFSET :offset",
        ["limit" => $limit, "offset" => $offset]
    );

    $total = $db->fetchOne("SELECT COUNT(*) as count FROM products WHERE active = 1");

    $catalog = [
        "products" => $products,
        "page" => $page,
        "total" => $total["count"],
        "pages" => (int) ceil($total["count"] / $limit),
        "generated_at" => date("c")
    ];

    // Store in application cache
    cache_set($cacheKey, $catalog, 300);

    return $response->json(array_merge($catalog, ["cache" => "none"]));
}, "ResponseCache:60"); // Layer 3: HTTP response cache (60 seconds)
```

Three cache layers:

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- **ResponseCache** (60 seconds): The entire HTTP response is cached. No PHP code runs.
- **Application cache** (300 seconds): If the response cache expired but the app cache is fresh, skip the database queries.
- **DB query cache** (if enabled): Individual query results are cached even if the application cache missed.

The first visitor after a full cache expiry waits 800ms. Everyone else gets the response in under 5ms.

12. Exercise: Cache an Expensive Product Listing Endpoint

Build a product listing endpoint that uses caching at multiple levels.

Requirements

- Create a **GET /api/store/products** endpoint that:
 - Accepts query parameters: **category**, **page**, **limit**
 - Returns a list of products with pagination metadata
 - Uses the direct cache API (**cache_get/cache_set**) with a 5-minute TTL
 - Includes a **source** field in the response ("**cache**" or "**database**")
- Create a **POST /api/store/products** endpoint that:
 - Creates a new product
 - Invalidates the relevant cache entries
- Create a **GET /api/store/cache-stats** endpoint that shows cache statistics

Test with:

```
# First call -- cache miss, slow
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/store/products?category=Electronics&page=1"

# Second call -- cache hit, fast
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/store/products?category=Electronics&page=1"

# Different category -- cache miss
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/store/products?category=Fitness&page=1"

# Create a product -- should invalidate cache
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/store/products \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Smart Watch", "category": "Electronics", "price": 299.99}'

# Same query again -- cache miss (invalidated by the POST)
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/store/products?category=Electronics&page=1"

# Check cache stats
curl http://localhost:7145/api/store/cache-stats
```

13. Solution

Create `src/routes/store-cached.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use function Tina4\cache_get;
use function Tina4\cache_set;
use function Tina4\cache_delete;
use function Tina4\cache_stats;

// Simulated product database
function getProductStore() {
    return [
        ["id" => 1, "name" => "Wireless Keyboard", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 79.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 2, "name" => "Yoga Mat", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 29.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 3, "name" => "Coffee Grinder", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 49.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 4, "name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 5, "name" => "Running Shoes", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 119.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 6, "name" => "Bluetooth Speaker", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 39.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 7, "name" => "Resistance Bands", "category" => "Fitness", "price" => 14.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["id" => 8, "name" => "French Press", "category" => "Kitchen", "price" => 34.99, "in_stock" => true],
    ];
}

// List products with caching
Router::get("/api/store/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $category = $request->params["category"] ?? null;
    $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);
    $limit = (int) ($request->params["limit"] ?? 20);

    // Build cache key from query parameters
    $cacheKey = "store:products:" . md5(json_encode([
        "category" => $category,
        "page" => $page,
        "limit" => $limit
    ]));

    // Try cache first
    $cached = cache_get($cacheKey);

    if ($cached !== null) {
        return $response->json(array_merge($cached, ["source" => "cache"]));
    }

    // Simulate expensive database query
    usleep(100000); // 100ms delay to simulate a slow query

    $products = getProductStore();

    // Filter by category
    if ($category !== null) {
        $products = array_values(array_filter(
            $products,
            fn($p) => strtolower($p["category"]) === strtolower($category)
        ));
    }

    $total = count($products);
```

```

$offset = ($page - 1) * $limit;
$products = array_slice($products, $offset, $limit);

$result = [
    "products" => $products,
    "page" => $page,
    "limit" => $limit,
    "total" => $total,
    "pages" => (int) ceil($total / $limit),
    "generated_at" => date("c")
];

// Cache for 5 minutes
cache_set($cacheKey, $result, 300);

return $response->json(array_merge($result, ["source" => "database"]));
});

// Create product and invalidate cache
Router::post("/api/store/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["name"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Name is required"], 400);
    }

    $product = [
        "id" => rand(100, 9999),
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "category" => $body["category"] ?? "General",
        "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 0),
        "in_stock" => true
    ];

    // Invalidate all product list caches
    // In a real app with many cache keys, you would track which keys to invalidate
    // For now, we delete known cache patterns
    $categories = ["Electronics", "Fitness", "Kitchen", "General"];
    foreach ($categories as $cat) {
        for ($p = 1; $p <= 5; $p++) {
            $key = "store:products:" . md5(json_encode([
                "category" => $cat,
                "page" => $p,
                "limit" => 20
            ]));
            cache_delete($key);
        }
    }

    // Also invalidate the unfiltered list
    for ($p = 1; $p <= 5; $p++) {
        $key = "store:products:" . md5(json_encode([
            "category" => null,
            "page" => $p,
            "limit" => 20
        ]));
        cache_delete($key);
    }
}

```



```

        return $response->json([
            "message" => "Product created",
            "product" => $product,
            "cache_invalidated" => true
        ], 201);
    });

// Cache statistics
Router::get("/api/store/cache-stats", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(cache_stats());
});

```

Expected output -- first call (cache miss):

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/store/products?category=Electronics&page=1"
```

```

{
  "products": [
    {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "category": "Electronics", "price": 79.99, "in_stock": true},
    {"id": 4, "name": "Standing Desk", "category": "Electronics", "price": 549.99, "in_stock": true},
    {"id": 6, "name": "Bluetooth Speaker", "category": "Electronics", "price": 39.99, "in_stock": true}
  ],
  "page": 1,
  "limit": 20,
  "total": 3,
  "pages": 1,
  "generated_at": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00",
  "source": "database"
}

```

Expected output -- second call (cache hit):

```

{
  "products": [
    {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "category": "Electronics", "price": 79.99, "in_stock": true},
    {"id": 4, "name": "Standing Desk", "category": "Electronics", "price": 549.99, "in_stock": true},
    {"id": 6, "name": "Bluetooth Speaker", "category": "Electronics", "price": 39.99, "in_stock": true}
  ],
  "page": 1,
  "limit": 20,
  "total": 3,
  "pages": 1,
  "generated_at": "2026-03-22T14:30:00+00:00",
  "source": "cache"
}

```

Same **generated_at**. Source changed from "database" to "cache". The handler did not run.

Expected output -- after creating a product:

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/store/products \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Smart Watch", "category": "Electronics", "price": 299.99}'

{
  "message": "Product created",
  "product": {
    "id": 4721,
    "name": "Smart Watch",
    "category": "Electronics",
    "price": 299.99,

```

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```

    "in_stock": true
  },
  "cache_invalidated": true
}

```

The next request to the same URL is a cache miss again. The POST invalidated the cache.

14. Gotchas

1. Caching Authenticated Responses

Problem: User A's profile is served to User B because the response was cached.

Cause: `ResponseCache` caches by URL only. `/api/profile` returns different data per user, but all requests hit the same URL. The first user's response is served to everyone.

Fix: Do not use `ResponseCache` on user-specific endpoints. Use the direct cache API with user-specific keys: `cache_set("profile:" . $userId, $data, 300)`.

2. Cache Stampede

Problem: A popular cache key expires. Hundreds of requests hit the database at once. All experience a cache miss at the same moment.

Cause: All requests see the miss. All try to rebuild the cache independently.

Fix: Use cache locking or "stale-while-revalidate." One request rebuilds the cache. Others serve the stale value. Tina4's `ResponseCache` handles this by serving the expired response to concurrent requests while one request refreshes it.

3. Memory Cache Lost on Restart

Problem: After restarting the server, performance drops until the cache warms up.

Cause: Memory cache dies when the process restarts. Every request is a cache miss until data populates again.

Fix: For production, use Redis cache (`TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND=redis`). It persists across restarts. Or implement a cache warmup script that pre-populates the cache with frequently accessed data.

4. Stale Data After Database Update

Problem: You updated a product's price in the database. The API still returns the old price.

Cause: The cache holds the old data. It has not expired yet.

Fix: Always invalidate or update the cache when you modify the underlying data. Use `cache_delete("product:" . $id)` after an update, or use write-through caching with `cache_set()` to write the new value.

5. Cache Key Collisions

Problem: Two different queries ~~return the same cached data.~~

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Cause: Cache keys are not specific enough. Using `"products"` as a key for both the full list and a filtered list causes collisions.

Fix: Include all relevant parameters in the cache key: `"products:category:Electronics:page:1:limit:20"`. Or use an MD5 hash of the parameters: `"products:" . md5(json_encode($params))`.

6. Serialization Overhead

Problem: Caching makes certain requests slower, not faster.

Cause: The cached object is large. Serializing and deserializing it takes more time than re-computing it.

Fix: Only cache data that is expensive to compute. If the original operation takes 5ms and cache serialization takes 10ms, caching is counterproductive. Profile before and after to verify the improvement.

7. Forgetting to Set TTL

Problem: Cache entries never expire. Server memory grows until it crashes.

Cause: You called `cache_set("key", $value)` without a TTL. The entry lives forever (or until the server restarts).

Fix: Always set a TTL: `cache_set("key", $value, 300)`. Even for data that "never changes," set a long TTL -- 86400 (24 hours). This provides a safety net against stale data and prevents unbounded memory growth.

Queue System

1. Do Not Make the User Wait

Your app sends welcome emails on signup, generates PDF invoices, and resizes uploaded images. Each task takes 2 to 30 seconds. Do them inside the HTTP request and the user stares at a spinner while the server processes. That is a broken experience.

Queues move slow work to a background process. The handler drops a job onto a queue and responds immediately. A separate consumer picks it up. The user sees "Welcome -- check your email." in under 100 milliseconds. The email arrives 5 seconds later.

Tina4 has a built-in queue system. Works out of the box with a file-based backend. No Redis. No RabbitMQ. No external services. Add jobs. Process them.

2. Why Queues Matter

Without queues:

```
User clicks "Sign Up"
-> Server validates input (10ms)
-> Server creates user in database (20ms)
-> Server sends welcome email (3000ms)
-> Server generates PDF welcome kit (2000ms)
-> Server resizes avatar (1500ms)
-> User sees response (6530ms later)
```

With queues:

```
User clicks "Sign Up"
-> Server validates input (10ms)
-> Server creates user in database (20ms)
-> Server queues: send welcome email (1ms)
-> Server queues: generate PDF (1ms)
-> Server queues: resize avatar (1ms)
-> User sees response (33ms later)
```

Meanwhile, in the background:

```
-> Consumer sends welcome email
-> Consumer generates PDF
-> Consumer resizes avatar
```

6.5 seconds becomes 33 milliseconds. The work still happens. Just not during the HTTP request.

Beyond speed, queues provide:

- **Retry logic:** Email server down. Job retries automatically.
- **Rate limiting:** Process at a controlled pace. Do not overwhelm external services.
- **Fault isolation:** A failed PDF does not crash the signup request.
- **Scaling:** More consumers for higher load.

3. File Queue (Default)

The file-based backend is the default. No configuration needed. First job creates the queue storage automatically.

Creating a Queue and Pushing a Job

```
<?php
use Tina4\Queue;

$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

// Push a job
$queue->push([
    "to" => "alice@example.com",
    "subject" => "Order Confirmation",
    "body" => "Your order #1234 has been confirmed."
]);
```

You can also use the longer constructor form:

```
$queue = new Queue('file', [], 'emails');
```

Convenience Method: produce

The **produce** method pushes to a specific topic without creating a separate Queue instance:

```
$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');
$queue->produce('invoices', ["order_id" => 101, "format" => "pdf"]);
```

Push with Priority

Jobs default to priority 0 (normal). Higher numbers are popped first:

```
// Normal priority (default)
$queue->push(["to" => "alice@example.com", "subject" => "Newsletter"]);

// High priority -- processed before normal jobs
$queue->push(["to" => "alice@example.com", "subject" => "Password Reset"], priority: 10);
```

Queue Size

Check how many pending messages are in the queue:

```
$count = $queue->size();
```

Pass a status string to count jobs in a specific state:

```
$failed = $queue->size("failed");
$completed = $queue->size("completed");
$reserved = $queue->size("reserved");
```

4. Pushing from Route Handlers

The most common pattern is pushing messages from route handlers:

```
<?php
use Tina4 Router;
```

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```

use Tina4\Queue;

Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    // Create the user (database logic)
    $userId = 42; // Simulated

    $queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

    // Queue a welcome email
    $queue->push([
        "user_id" => $userId,
        "to" => $body["email"],
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "subject" => "Welcome!"
    ]);

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Registration successful. Welcome email will arrive shortly.",
        "user_id" => $userId
    ], 201);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/register \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

{
  "message": "Registration successful. Welcome email will arrive shortly.",
  "user_id": 42
}

```

Response returns immediately. The email job waits in the queue.

5. Consuming Jobs

The **consume** method is a generator that yields jobs one at a time. Each job must be explicitly completed or failed:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Queue;

$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

foreach ($queue->consume('emails') as $job) {
    try {
        sendEmail($job->payload['to'], $job->payload['subject'], $job->payload['body']);
        $job->complete();
    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        $job->fail($e->getMessage());
    }
}

```

Retry with Delay

If a job fails but you want to retry it after a cooldown instead of marking it as failed:

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```
foreach ($queue->consume('emails') as $job) {
    try {
        sendEmail($job->payload['to'], $job->payload['subject'], $job->payload['body']);
        $job->complete();
    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        // Retry after 30 seconds instead of failing immediately
        $job->retry(30);
    }
}
```

Manual Pop

For more control, pop a single message:

```
$job = $queue->pop();

if ($job !== null) {
    try {
        sendEmail($job->payload['to'], $job->payload['subject']);
        $job->complete();
    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        $job->fail($e->getMessage());
    }
}

---
```

6. Job Lifecycle

Every job moves through states:

```
push() -> PENDING -> pop()/consume() -> RESERVED -> $job->complete() -> COMPLETED
                                                    -> $job->fail() -> FAILED
                                                                |
                                                                retry (manual)
                                                                |
                                                                PENDING
                                                                |
                                                                max retries exceeded
                                                                |
                                                                DEAD LETTER
```

Job Methods

When you receive a job from `consume` or `pop`, you have three methods:

- `$job->complete()` -- mark the job as done
- `$job->fail($reason)` -- mark the job as failed with a reason string
- `$job->reject($reason)` -- alias for `fail`
- `$job->retry($delaySeconds)` -- re-queue the job after a delay (in seconds). The job goes back to PENDING after the delay elapses.

Job Properties

- `$job->topic` -- the topic this job belongs to. Useful when consuming from multiple topics.

Always call `complete`, `fail`, or `retry` on every job. If you do not, the job stays reserved.

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7. Retry and Dead Letters

Max Retries

The default `max_retries` is 3. When a job's attempt count reaches `max_retries`, `retryFailed()` skips it.

Retrying Failed Jobs

```
// Retry a specific job by ID
$queue->retry($jobId);

// Retry all failed jobs (skips those that exceeded max_retries)
$queue->retryFailed();
```

Dead Letters

Jobs that have exceeded `max_retries` are dead letters. There is no magic dead letter queue -- you retrieve and handle them yourself:

```
$deadJobs = $queue->deadLetters();

foreach ($deadJobs as $job) {
    error_log("Dead job: " . $job->id);
    error_log(" Payload: " . json_encode($job->payload));
    error_log(" Error: " . $job->error);
}
```

Purging Jobs

Remove jobs by status:

```
$queue->purge("completed");
$queue->purge("failed");
```

8. Producing Multiple Jobs

One action. Multiple background tasks:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Queue;

Router::post("/api/orders", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $orderId = 101;
    $queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

    $queue->push([
        "order_id" => $orderId,
        "to" => $body["email"],
        "subject" => "Order Confirmation"
    ]);
});
```

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```

$queue->produce("invoices", [
    "order_id" => $orderId,
    "format" => "pdf"
]);

$queue->produce("inventory", [
    "items" => $body["items"]
]);

$queue->produce("warehouse", [
    "order_id" => $orderId,
    "shipping_address" => $body["shipping_address"]
]);

return $response->json([
    "message" => "Order placed successfully",
    "order_id" => $orderId
], 201);
});

```

Four jobs queued in under 5 milliseconds. Instant response.

9. Switching Backends

Switching backends is a config change, not a code change.

Default: File

```

# No config needed -- file is the default
# Optionally set a custom storage path (defaults to ./queue)
TINA4_QUEUE_PATH=./data/queue

```

RabbitMQ

```

TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND=rabbitmq
TINA4_QUEUE_URL=amqp://user:pass@localhost:5672

```

Kafka

```

TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND=kafka
TINA4_QUEUE_URL=localhost:9092

```

MongoDB

```

TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND=mongodb
TINA4_QUEUE_URL=mongodb://user:pass@localhost:27017/tina4

```

Your queue code does not change at all. The same `$queue->push()` and `$queue->consume()` calls work with every backend.

10. Exercise: Build an Email Queue

Build a queue-based email system with failure handling.

Requirements

- Create these endpoints:

Method	Path	Description
POST	/api/emails/send	Queue an email for sending
GET	/api/emails/queue	Show pending email count
GET	/api/emails/dead	List dead letter jobs
POST	/api/emails/retry	Retry all failed jobs

- The email payload should include: **to** (required), **subject** (required), **body** (required)
- Create a consumer that processes the queue, simulating occasional failures
- When an email fails repeatedly, it should end up in dead letters

Test with:

```
# Queue an email
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/emails/send \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"to": "alice@example.com", "subject": "Welcome!", "body": "Thanks for signing up."}'

# Check queue size
curl http://localhost:7145/api/emails/queue

# Check dead letters
curl http://localhost:7145/api/emails/dead

# Retry failed
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/emails/retry
```

11. Solution

Create `src/routes/email-queue.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Queue;

$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/emails/send", function ($request, $response) use ($queue) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $errors = [];
    if (empty($body["to"])) $errors[] = "'to' is required";
    if (empty($body["subject"])) $errors[] = "'subject' is required";
    if (empty($body["body"])) $errors[] = "'body' is required";
```

```

        if (!empty($errors)) {
            return $response->json(["errors" => $errors], 400);
        }

        $messageId = $queue->push([
            "to" => $body["to"],
            "subject" => $body["subject"],
            "body" => $body["body"]
        ]);

        return $response->json([
            "message" => "Email queued for sending",
            "message_id" => $messageId
        ], 201);
    });

    Router::get("/api/emails/queue", function ($request, $response) use ($queue) {
        $count = $queue->size();
        return $response->json(["pending" => $count]);
    });

    Router::get("/api/emails/dead", function ($request, $response) use ($queue) {
        $deadJobs = $queue->deadLetters();
        $items = [];
        foreach ($deadJobs as $job) {
            $items[] = [
                "id" => $job->id,
                "payload" => $job->payload,
                "error" => $job->error
            ];
        }
        return $response->json(["dead_letters" => $items, "count" => count($items)]);
    });

    Router::post("/api/emails/retry", function ($request, $response) use ($queue) {
        $queue->retryFailed();
        return $response->json(["message" => "Failed emails re-queued for retry"]);
    });

```

Create a separate consumer file `src/workers/email_worker.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Queue;

$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');

foreach ($queue->consume('emails') as $job) {
    $payload = $job->payload;

    echo "Sending email to {$payload['to']}\n";
    echo "  Subject: {$payload['subject']}\n";

    try {
        // Simulate sending (replace with real email logic)
        sleep(1);

        // Simulate failure for a specific address
        if ($payload['to'] === 'bad@example.com') {
            throw new \RuntimeException("SMTP connection refused");
        }
    }
}

```

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```

    }

    echo "  Email sent to {$payload['to']} successfully!\n";
    $job->complete();

    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        echo "  Failed: {$e->getMessage()}\n";
        $job->fail($e->getMessage());
    }
}

```

After the consumer has retried a job to `bad@example.com` three times, `$queue->deadLetters()` returns that job. The `/api/emails/dead` endpoint shows it. You investigate, fix the address, and call `/api/emails/retry` to re-queue.

12. Gotchas

1. Always call complete or fail

Problem: Jobs stay in reserved status forever.

Cause: Your consumer does not call `$job->complete()` or `$job->fail()`. The job stays reserved and is never released.

Fix: Always call one of `$job->complete()`, `$job->fail($reason)`, or `$job->reject($reason)` in your consumer loop.

2. Worker not picking up messages

Problem: Messages are pushed but nothing happens.

Cause: No consumer process is running, or the consumer is listening on a different topic.

Fix: Make sure the consumer is running. Check that the topic name in `$queue->push()` matches the topic in `$queue->consume()`.

3. Payload must be JSON-serializable

Problem: `$queue->push()` throws a serialization error.

Cause: You passed an object, database connection, file handle, or other non-serializable value.

Fix: Payload must contain only simple types: strings, numbers, booleans, arrays of these. Pass IDs, not objects. The consumer looks up records by ID.

4. Dead letters pile up

Problem: Dead letters accumulate and nobody notices.

Cause: Failed jobs that exceed `max_retries` become dead letters but are never cleaned up.

Fix: Monitor dead letters with `$queue->deadLetters()`. Set up an alert when the count exceeds a threshold. Investigate the root cause, fix it, then call `$queue->retryFailed()` or `$queue->purge("failed")`.

5. File backend for production

Problem: Multiple workers cause contention on the file backend.

Cause: The file backend is designed for single-worker setups.

Fix: For production with multiple workers, switch to RabbitMQ, Kafka, or MongoDB via the `TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND` environment variable.

6. Consumer returns nothing

Problem: Jobs process but immediately fail.

Cause: You forgot to call `$job->complete()`. Without it, the job stays reserved or is treated as failed.

Fix: Always call `$job->complete()` on success and `$job->fail($reason)` on failure. Do not rely on return values.

Events

1. Decouple Your Code

A user registers. You need to send a welcome email, create a default profile, assign a free trial, and log the event. Without events, your registration handler does all of it directly. It grows. It imports five different services. It becomes impossible to test in isolation.

Events invert that. The registration handler emits one event: `user.registered`. Five listeners respond to it independently. Each listener is small, single-purpose, and testable on its own. Adding a sixth action means adding one new listener. No changes to the registration handler.

Tina4 has a built-in events system. No external message broker. No configuration. Zero dependencies.

2. Listening for Events

Register a listener with `Events::on()`. The listener fires every time the event is emitted.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    echo "Send welcome email to: {$data['email']}\n";
});

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    echo "Create default profile for user {$data['id']}\n";
});
```

Multiple listeners on the same event all run. Registration order is the default execution order.

3. Emitting Events

Emit an event with `Events::emit()`. Every registered listener for that event fires synchronously in registration order.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;

// Register listeners (usually done at app boot)
Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    echo "Welcome email -> {$data['email']}\n";
});

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    echo "Default profile -> user {$data['id']}\n";
});

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
```

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```

        echo "Free trial started for {$data['name']}\n";
    });

    // Emit the event (usually done inside a route handler or service)
    Events::emit('user.registered', [
        'id' => 42,
        'name' => 'Alice',
        'email' => 'alice@example.com',
        'plan' => 'free'
    ]);

```

Output:

```

Welcome email -> alice@example.com
Default profile -> user 42
Free trial started for Alice

```

All three listeners ran. The emitter does not know they exist.

4. One-Shot Listeners with once()

`Events::once()` registers a listener that fires exactly once, then removes itself.

```

<?php
use Tina4\Events;

// This listener fires on the first emit only
Events::once('app.boot', function (): void {
    echo "Database connection pool initialized\n";
});

Events::emit('app.boot'); // Fires: "Database connection pool initialized"
Events::emit('app.boot'); // Nothing -- listener was already removed
Events::emit('app.boot'); // Nothing

```

Useful for one-time initialization, cache warmup, or any setup that must run exactly once regardless of how many times the event fires.

5. Removing Listeners with off()

`Events::off()` removes a specific listener or all listeners for an event.

```

<?php
use Tina4\Events;

$auditListener = function (array $data): void {
    echo "Audit log: order {$data['id']} placed\n";
};

// Register
Events::on('order.placed', $auditListener);

// Works
Events::emit('order.placed', ['id' => 101]);

```

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```
// Output: Audit log: order 101 placed

// Remove this specific listener
Events::off('order.placed', $auditListener);

// Listener no longer fires
Events::emit('order.placed', ['id' => 102]);
// Output: (nothing)
```

Remove all listeners for an event:

```
Events::off('order.placed');
```

After this call, `Events::emit('order.placed', ...)` fires nothing.

6. Priority

Listeners with a higher priority run before those with lower priority. Default priority is 0. Pass priority as the third argument to `Events::on()`.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;

Events::on('payment.received', function (array $data): void {
    echo "3. Send receipt email\n";
}, 0); // Priority 0 -- runs third

Events::on('payment.received', function (array $data): void {
    echo "1. Record payment in ledger\n";
}, 10); // Priority 10 -- runs first

Events::on('payment.received', function (array $data): void {
    echo "2. Update subscription status\n";
}, 5); // Priority 5 -- runs second

Events::emit('payment.received', ['amount' => 99.00, 'currency' => 'USD']);
```

Output:

```
1. Record payment in ledger
2. Update subscription status
3. Send receipt email
```

Higher number = higher priority = runs earlier.

7. Events in Route Handlers

The typical pattern: emit events from route handlers, define listeners in a separate boot file.

`src/boot/events.php` — register all listeners at startup:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;
```

```
// User events
```

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```

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    // Send welcome email via Messenger
    \Tina4\Messenger::send(
        to: $data['email'],
        subject: 'Welcome to the app!',
        body: "Hi {$data['name']}, your account is ready."
    );
});

Events::on('user.registered', function (array $data): void {
    // Queue a follow-up drip email for day 3
    $queue = new \Tina4\Queue(topic: 'drip-emails');
    $queue->push([
        'user_id' => $data['id'],
        'template' => 'day3-followup',
        'send_at' => time() + (3 * 86400)
    ]);
});

// Order events
Events::on('order.completed', function (array $data): void {
    error_log("[order] completed: #{ $data['id'] } total={ $data['total'] }");
});

```

`src/routes/users.php` — emit from the route handler:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Events;

Router::post('/api/users/register', function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body['email']) || empty($body['name'])) {
        return $response->json(['error' => 'email and name are required'], 400);
    }

    // Create user (simplified)
    $user = [
        'id' => rand(1000, 9999),
        'name' => $body['name'],
        'email' => $body['email'],
        'plan' => $body['plan'] ?? 'free'
    ];

    // Emit — listeners handle the rest
    Events::emit('user.registered', $user);

    return $response->json([
        'message' => 'Registration successful',
        'user_id' => $user['id']
    ], 201);
});

```

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/users/register \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com"}'

```

```

{
  "message": "Registration successful",

```

```
"user_id": 4721
}
```

The route handler responds immediately. The listeners handle the rest.

8. Checking Registered Listeners

Inspect which events have listeners (useful in tests and during development):

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;

Events::on('order.placed', function (): void {});
Events::on('order.placed', function (): void {});
Events::on('payment.failed', function (): void {});

$count = Events::count('order.placed'); // 2
$all    = Events::listeners();           // ['order.placed' => [...], 'payment.failed' => [...]]
$has    = Events::hasListeners('order.placed'); // true
```

In tests, reset all events between test cases:

```
Events::reset();
```

9. Exercise: Order Lifecycle Events

Build an order system where each state change emits an event and multiple listeners respond.

Requirements

- Define listeners for: `order.created`, `order.paid`, `order.shipped`
- Create these endpoints:

Method	Path	Description
POST	<code>/api/orders</code>	Create order, emit <code>order.created</code>
POST	<code>/api/orders/{id}/pay</code>	Mark paid, emit <code>order.paid</code>
POST	<code>/api/orders/{id}/ship</code>	Mark shipped, emit <code>order.shipped</code>

- Each event should have at least two listeners (e.g., logging + notification)

Test with:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/orders \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"customer": "Alice", "items": ["Widget A", "Widget B"], "total": 59.98}'
```

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/orders/1001/pay
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/orders/1001/ship
```

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10. Solution

src/boot/order-events.php:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Events;

Events::on('order.created', function (array $order): void {
    error_log("[order] created #{ $order['id'] } for { $order['customer'] }");
}, 10);

Events::on('order.created', function (array $order): void {
    // Notify warehouse
    error_log("[warehouse] new order #{ $order['id'] } -> " . implode(', ', $order['items']));
}, 5);

Events::on('order.paid', function (array $order): void {
    error_log("[payment] received for order #{ $order['id'] } - \${ $order['total'] }");
}, 10);

Events::on('order.paid', function (array $order): void {
    // Trigger fulfillment
    error_log("[fulfillment] queue pick-and-pack for order #{ $order['id'] }");
}, 5);

Events::on('order.shipped', function (array $order): void {
    error_log("[shipping] order #{ $order['id'] } dispatched -> { $order['customer'] }");
}, 10);

Events::on('order.shipped', function (array $order): void {
    // Send tracking email
    error_log("[email] tracking notification sent for order #{ $order['id'] }");
}, 5);
```

src/routes/orders.php:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Events;

$orders = [];

Router::post('/api/orders', function ($request, $response) use (&$orders) {
    $body = $request->body;
    $order = [
        'id'          => rand(1000, 9999),
        'customer'    => $body['customer'] ?? 'Unknown',
        'items'       => $body['items'] ?? [],
        'total'       => $body['total'] ?? 0,
        'status'      => 'created'
    ];
    $orders[$order['id']] = $order;
    Events::emit('order.created', $order);
    return $response->json(['message' => 'Order created', 'order' => $order], 201);
});

Router::post('/api/orders/{id:int}/pay', function ($request, $response) use (&$orders) {
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```

```

    $id = $request->params['id'];
    if (!isset($orders[$id])) {
        return $response->json(['error' => 'Order not found'], 404);
    }
    $orders[$id]['status'] = 'paid';
    Events::emit('order.paid', $orders[$id]);
    return $response->json(['message' => 'Order marked as paid', 'order' => $orders[$id]]);
});

Router::post('/api/orders/{id:int}/ship', function ($request, $response) use (&$orders) {
    $id = $request->params['id'];
    if (!isset($orders[$id])) {
        return $response->json(['error' => 'Order not found'], 404);
    }
    $orders[$id]['status'] = 'shipped';
    Events::emit('order.shipped', $orders[$id]);
    return $response->json(['message' => 'Order shipped', 'order' => $orders[$id]]);
});
---

```

11. Gotchas

1. Listeners fire synchronously

Problem: A slow listener blocks the HTTP response.

Cause: `Events::emit()` runs all listeners in the same thread before returning. A listener that takes 2 seconds delays the response by 2 seconds.

Fix: For slow work (emails, PDF generation), push to a queue inside the listener instead of doing the work inline.

2. Uncaught exceptions in listeners crash the emit

Problem: One bad listener prevents the remaining listeners from running.

Cause: An exception propagates up from the listener and aborts the emit loop.

Fix: Wrap listener bodies in try/catch, or register a global error handler on the event system. At minimum, log the error and continue.

3. Forgetting to reset in tests

Problem: Tests interfere with each other because a listener registered in test A fires during test B.

Cause: Events are global state. Listeners accumulate across tests.

Fix: Call `Events::reset()` in your test `setUp` or `tearDown` method.

4. Using closures with off()

Problem: `Events::off('event', $listener)` does not remove the listener.

Cause: You registered an anonymous closure inline and are trying to pass a different closure reference to `off()`.

Fix: Assign the closure to a named variable before registering it, then pass that same variable to `off()`.

Localization

1. One App, Many Languages

Your app goes live. Users arrive from Germany, Brazil, Japan. Everything is in English. They bounce.

Localization (L10n) makes the same app speak every language. UI strings, error messages, date formats, and number formatting adapt to the user's locale. The code stays the same.

Tina4 provides a built-in `I18n` class that loads JSON locale files, interpolates variables, falls back to a default locale when a key is missing, and requires no external packages.

2. Locale Files

Store translations as JSON files. One file per locale. Place them in `src/locales/` by convention.

`src/locales/en.json`:

```
{
  "welcome": "Welcome, {name}!",
  "goodbye": "Goodbye, {name}.",
  "errors": {
    "required": "The {field} field is required.",
    "min_length": "The {field} must be at least {min} characters.",
    "not_found": "The requested resource was not found."
  },
  "orders": {
    "count": "You have {count} order(s).",
    "empty": "You have no orders yet."
  },
  "nav": {
    "home": "Home",
    "products": "Products",
    "account": "My Account",
    "logout": "Log Out"
  }
}
```

`src/locales/de.json`:

```
{
  "welcome": "Willkommen, {name}!",
  "goodbye": "Auf Wiedersehen, {name}.",
  "errors": {
    "required": "Das Feld {field} ist erforderlich.",
    "min_length": "Das Feld {field} muss mindestens {min} Zeichen lang sein.",
    "not_found": "Die angeforderte Ressource wurde nicht gefunden."
  },
  "orders": {
    "count": "Sie haben {count} Bestellung(en).",
    "empty": "Sie haben noch keine Bestellungen."
  },
}
```

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```

    "nav": {
      "home": "Startseite",
      "products": "Produkte",
      "account": "Mein Konto",
      "logout": "Abmelden"
    }
  }
}

```

`src/locales/pt.json`:

```

{
  "welcome": "Bem-vindo, {name}!",
  "goodbye": "Até logo, {name}.",
  "errors": {
    "required": "O campo {field} é obrigatório.",
    "not_found": "O recurso solicitado não foi encontrado."
  },
  "nav": {
    "home": "Início",
    "products": "Produtos",
    "account": "Minha Conta",
    "logout": "Sair"
  }
}

```

3. Loading and Using I18n

```

<?php
use Tina4\I18n;

// Load locale files
$i18n = new I18n('src/locales');

// Set the active locale
$i18n->setLocale('de');

// Translate a key
echo $i18n->t('welcome', ['name' => 'Alice']);
// Output: Willkommen, Alice!

echo $i18n->t('errors.not_found');
// Output: Die angeforderte Ressource wurde nicht gefunden.

echo $i18n->t('orders.count', ['count' => 3]);
// Output: Sie haben 3 Bestellung(en).

```

Dot notation navigates nested keys. `'errors.required'` accesses `$translations['errors']['required']`.

4. Fallback Locale

When a key exists in `en.json` but not in the active locale file, `I18n` falls back to the default locale automatically.

```

<?php
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales', defaultLocale: 'en');
$i18n->setLocale('pt');

// 'orders.count' missing from pt.json -- falls back to en.json
echo $i18n->t('orders.count', ['count' => 2]);
// Output: You have 2 order(s).

// 'nav.home' exists in pt.json
echo $i18n->t('nav.home');
// Output: Início

```

Fallback prevents blank strings from appearing in partially translated apps. Ship the English version first. Translations can come later without breaking anything.

5. Locale Switching in API Routes

Detect the locale from the **Accept-Language** header, a query parameter, or the user's profile. Then set it on the **I18n** instance.

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales', defaultLocale: 'en');

function resolveLocale($request, I18n $i18n): string {
    // 1. Query parameter: ?lang=de
    if (!empty($request->params['lang'])) {
        return $request->params['lang'];
    }

    // 2. Accept-Language header: Accept-Language: de-DE,de;q=0.9
    $header = $request->headers['Accept-Language'] ?? 'en';
    $primary = explode(',', $header)[0];
    $lang = explode('-', $primary)[0];

    // 3. Fall back to default
    return $i18n->hasLocale($lang) ? $lang : 'en';
}

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::get('/api/greeting', function ($request, $response) use ($i18n) {
    $locale = resolveLocale($request, $i18n);
    $i18n->setLocale($locale);

    $name = $request->params['name'] ?? 'stranger';

    return $response->json([
        'locale' => $locale,
        'message' => $i18n->t('welcome', ['name' => $name]),
        'nav' => [

```

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```

        'home'      => $i18n->t('nav.home'),
        'products' => $i18n->t('nav.products'),
        'account'  => $i18n->t('nav.account')
    ]
    });
}

curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greeting?name=Alice&lang=de"

{
  "locale": "de",
  "message": "Willkommen, Alice!",
  "nav": {
    "home": "Startseite",
    "products": "Produkte",
    "account": "Mein Konto"
  }
}

curl "http://localhost:7145/api/greeting?name=Alice&lang=pt"

{
  "locale": "pt",
  "message": "Bem-vindo, Alice!",
  "nav": {
    "home": "Início",
    "products": "Produtos",
    "account": "Minha Conta"
  }
}
---
```

6. Interpolation

Placeholders use `{key}` syntax. Pass values as an associative array.

```

<?php
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales');
$i18n->setLocale('en');

// Single value
echo $i18n->t('welcome', ['name' => 'Bob']);
// Welcome, Bob!

// Multiple values
echo $i18n->t('errors.min_length', [
    'field' => 'password',
    'min'   => 8
]);
// The password must be at least 8 characters.

// Missing placeholder value -- left as-is
echo $i18n->t('welcome');
// Welcome, {name}!
```

No special escaping needed. Values are inserted as-is.

7. Checking Available Locales

```
<?php
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales');

// List all loaded locales
$locales = $i18n->getLocales();
// ['en', 'de', 'pt']

// Check if a locale exists
$has = $i18n->hasLocale('fr'); // false
$has = $i18n->hasLocale('de'); // true

// Get the current active locale
$current = $i18n->getLocale(); // 'en' (default)
```

Expose available locales via API for frontend locale switchers:

```
Router::get('/api/locales', function ($request, $response) use ($i18n) {
    return $response->json([
        'available' => $i18n->getLocales(),
        'default'   => 'en'
    ]);
});
```

8. Localized Validation Errors

Return validation errors in the user's language:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales', defaultLocale: 'en');

Router::post('/api/users', function ($request, $response) use ($i18n) {
    $lang = $request->params['lang'] ?? 'en';
    $i18n->setLocale($lang);
    $body = $request->body;

    $errors = [];

    if (empty($body['name'])) {
        $errors[] = $i18n->t('errors.required', ['field' => 'name']);
    }

    if (empty($body['email'])) {
        $errors[] = $i18n->t('errors.required', ['field' => 'email']);
    }

    if (!empty($body['password']) && strlen($body['password']) < 8) {
        $errors[] = $i18n->t('errors.min_length', ['field' => 'password', 'min' => 8]);
    }
});
```

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```

    }

    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response->json(['errors' => $errors], 422);
    }

    return $response->json(['message' => 'User created'], 201);
});

curl -X POST "http://localhost:7145/api/users?lang=de" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"password": "abc"}'

{
  "errors": [
    "Das Feld name ist erforderlich.",
    "Das Feld email ist erforderlich.",
    "Das Feld password muss mindestens 8 Zeichen lang sein."
  ]
}
---
```

9. Adding Locales at Runtime

Load additional locale data programmatically (useful when translations come from a database):

```

<?php
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales');

// Add or extend a locale at runtime
$i18n->addTranslations('fr', [
    'welcome' => 'Bienvenue, {name} !',
    'goodbye' => 'Au revoir, {name}.',
    'nav' => [
        'home' => 'Accueil',
        'products' => 'Produits',
        'account' => 'Mon Compte',
        'logout' => 'Déconnexion'
    ]
]);

$i18n->setLocale('fr');
echo $i18n->t('welcome', ['name' => 'Alice']);
// Bienvenue, Alice !
---
```

10. Exercise: Multilingual API

Build a product API that returns localized content.

Requirements

- Create locale files for **en**, **de**, and one other language of your choice with keys for:
- **product.in_stock**, **product.out_of_stock** —————

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- `product.price` (e.g., "Price: {amount}")
- `errors.not_found`
- Create `GET /api/products/{id}` that:
 - Accepts `?lang=` query parameter
 - Returns product data with localized status and label strings
- Create `GET /api/locales` that returns the list of available locales

Test with:

```
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/1?lang=en"
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/1?lang=de"
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/products/999?lang=de"
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/locales"
```

11. Gotchas

1. Missing keys return the key name

Problem: The UI shows `errors.not_found` instead of a message.

Cause: The key does not exist in the active locale, and `defaultLocale` is not set or that locale also lacks the key.

Fix: Set `defaultLocale: 'en'` and ensure the English locale file has all keys. It is the source of truth.

2. Locale files not loaded

Problem: `$i18n->t('welcome')` returns the raw key on all locales.

Cause: The locale directory path is wrong, or JSON files have a syntax error.

Fix: Verify the path passed to `new I18n()` is correct relative to the project root. Validate JSON files with `php -r "echo json_encode(json_decode(file_get_contents('src/locales/en.json')));"`.

3. Placeholder not replaced

Problem: Output shows `Welcome, {name}!` with the literal `{name}`.

Cause: You called `$i18n->t('welcome')` without passing the values array.

Fix: Always pass replacement values: `$i18n->t('welcome', ['name' => $user['name']])`.

4. Locale not resetting between requests

Problem: After one request with `?lang=de`, subsequent requests without a `lang` parameter return German text.

Cause: The `I18n` instance is shared and locale state persists across the request lifecycle if the instance lives in a service container.

Fix: Always call `$i18n->setLocale($locale)` at the start of each request before calling `t()`. Do not assume the locale from a previous request.

Structured Logging

1. Stop Using `error_log`

`error_log("Something happened")` works. It also produces an unreadable wall of text in production. Searching for a specific error across 500,000 lines of plain text is painful. Correlating a log line with a request, a user, and a timestamp is manual detective work.

Structured logging writes JSON. Every log entry is a machine-readable object with a timestamp, level, message, and whatever context you attach. Log aggregators (Datadog, Grafana Loki, AWS CloudWatch, Papertrail) can query, filter, and alert on structured logs.

Tina4 provides `Debug::message()` for structured logging. It uses PHP's standard log infrastructure. No external packages.

2. Log Levels

Tina4 defines five log levels as constants:

Constant	Value	When to use
<code>TINA4_LOG_DEBUG</code>	<code>'DEBUG'</code>	Verbose detail for development
<code>TINA4_LOG_INFO</code>	<code>'INFO'</code>	Normal operations, confirmations
<code>TINA4_LOG_WARNING</code>	<code>'WARNING'</code>	Something unexpected but recoverable
<code>TINA4_LOG_ERROR</code>	<code>'ERROR'</code>	A failure that needs attention
<code>TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL</code>	<code>'CRITICAL'</code>	System is failing. Immediate action required

Higher levels are always visible. Lower levels are filtered by `TINA4_LOG_LEVEL`.

3. Basic Logging

```
<?php
use Tina4\Debug;

Debug::message("Application started", TINA4_LOG_INFO);
Debug::message("Cache miss for key: product:42", TINA4_LOG_DEBUG);
Debug::message("Payment gateway responded slowly", TINA4_LOG_WARNING);
Debug::message("Database query failed", TINA4_LOG_ERROR);
Debug::message("Out of disk space", TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL);
```

Output (JSON format):

```
{"timestamp":"2026-04-02T14:30:01Z","level":"INFO","message":"Application started"}
{"timestamp":"2026-04-02T14:30:01Z","level":"DEBUG","message":"Cache miss for key: product:42"}
{"timestamp":"2026-04-02T14:30:01Z","level":"WARNING","message":"Payment gateway responded slowl"}
{"timestamp":"2026-04-02T14:30:01Z","level":"ERROR","message":"Database query failed"}
{"timestamp":"2026-04-02T14:30:01Z","level":"CRITICAL","message":"Out of disk space"}
```

Each line is a complete JSON object. One per log entry.

4. Log Level Filtering

Set the minimum log level via environment variable. Only messages at or above that level appear in the output.

```
# .env
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING
```

With this setting:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Debug;

Debug::message("Detailed SQL query", TINA4_LOG_DEBUG);    // Suppressed
Debug::message("User logged in", TINA4_LOG_INFO);         // Suppressed
Debug::message("Slow query detected", TINA4_LOG_WARNING); // Appears
Debug::message("Auth service unreachable", TINA4_LOG_ERROR); // Appears
Debug::message("Disk full", TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL);          // Appears
```

Recommended levels by environment:

Environment	TINA4LOGLEVEL
Development	DEBUG
Staging	INFO
Production	WARNING

5. Logging with Context

Pass a context array as the third argument. Context values are merged into the JSON log entry.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Debug;

Debug::message("User login attempt", TINA4_LOG_INFO, [
    'user_id'    => 42,
    'email'      => 'alice@example.com',
    'ip'         => '203.0.113.5',
    'user_agent' => 'Mozilla/5.0 ...'
]);
```

Output:

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-04-02T14:30:01Z",
  "level": "INFO",
  "message": "User login attempt",
  "user_id": 42,
  "email": "alice@example.com",
  "ip": "203.0.113.5",
  "user_agent": "Mozilla/5.0 ..."
}
```

Context makes log lines searchable: `level:INFO AND user_id:42` finds every action by that user.

6. Logging in Route Handlers

Log the lifecycle of an HTTP request. Incoming requests, decisions made, and outcomes:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Debug;

Router::post('/api/payments', function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    Debug::message("Payment request received", TINA4_LOG_INFO, [
        'amount' => $body['amount'] ?? null,
        'currency' => $body['currency'] ?? 'USD',
        'ip' => $request->server['REMOTE_ADDR'] ?? null
    ]);

    if (empty($body['amount']) || $body['amount'] <= 0) {
        Debug::message("Payment rejected: invalid amount", TINA4_LOG_WARNING, [
            'amount' => $body['amount'] ?? 'missing'
        ]);
        return $response->json(['error' => 'Invalid payment amount'], 400);
    }

    // Simulate payment processing
    $success = true;
    $transactionId = 'txn_' . uniqid();

    if ($success) {
        Debug::message("Payment processed successfully", TINA4_LOG_INFO, [
            'transaction_id' => $transactionId,
            'amount' => $body['amount'],
            'currency' => $body['currency'] ?? 'USD'
        ]);
        return $response->json(['transaction_id' => $transactionId], 201);
    } else {
        Debug::message("Payment gateway failure", TINA4_LOG_ERROR, [
            'amount' => $body['amount'],
            'gateway' => 'stripe',
            'reason' => 'Gateway timeout'
        ]);
    }
});
```



```

        return $response->json(['error' => 'Payment failed'], 502);
    }
});
---
```

7. Logging Exceptions

Log exceptions with full context. Include the message, file, line, and trace:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Debug;

function processOrder(array $order): array {
    try {
        // Simulate work that might fail
        if (empty($order['items'])) {
            throw new \InvalidArgumentException("Order must have at least one item");
        }

        return ['status' => 'processed', 'order_id' => $order['id']];

    } catch (\InvalidArgumentException $e) {
        Debug::message("Order validation failed", TINA4_LOG_WARNING, [
            'order_id' => $order['id'] ?? null,
            'error'     => $e->getMessage()
        ]);
        throw $e;

    } catch (\Throwable $e) {
        Debug::message("Unexpected error processing order", TINA4_LOG_ERROR, [
            'order_id' => $order['id'] ?? null,
            'error'     => $e->getMessage(),
            'file'      => $e->getFile(),
            'line'      => $e->getLine(),
            'trace'     => $e->getTraceAsString()
        ]);
        throw $e;
    }
}
---
```

8. Request Correlation

Attach a request ID to every log message within a request. All log lines from the same request share one ID. This lets you filter a full request trace from thousands of concurrent requests.

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Debug;

Router::any('*', function ($request, $response) {
    // Generate a request ID and attach to all logs in this request
    $requestId = bin2hex(random_bytes(8));
    $GLOBALS['request_id'] = $requestId;

    Debug::message("Request started", TINA4_LOG_DEBUG, [
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    ]
});
---
```

```

        'request_id' => $requestId,
        'method'     => $request->method,
        'path'       => $request->server['REQUEST_URI'] ?? '/'
    ]);

    return null; // Pass through to the real handler
}, 'next');

function logWithRequest(string $message, string $level, array $ctx = []): void {
    Debug::message($message, $level, array_merge(
        ['request_id' => $GLOBALS['request_id'] ?? 'none'],
        $ctx
    ));
}

```

With request correlation, a single `grep "request_id:a3f8c1d2"` finds every log line for one HTTP request.

9. Performance Logging

Log slow operations automatically. Time your expensive calls:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Debug;

function timedQuery(callable $query, string $label, float $warnThresholdMs = 100): mixed {
    $start = microtime(true);
    $result = $query();
    $durationMs = (microtime(true) - $start) * 1000;

    $level = $durationMs > $warnThresholdMs ? TINA4_LOG_WARNING : TINA4_LOG_DEBUG;

    Debug::message("Query timing: {$label}", $level, [
        'label'          => $label,
        'duration_ms'    => round($durationMs, 2),
        'threshold_ms'   => $warnThresholdMs,
        'slow'           => $durationMs > $warnThresholdMs
    ]);

    return $result;
}

// Usage
$products = timedQuery(
    fn() => fetchAllProducts(),
    'fetchAllProducts',
    warnThresholdMs: 50
);

```

Any query slower than 50ms emits a **WARNING**. All others emit **DEBUG** and are suppressed in production.

10. Environment Configuration

```
# Minimum level to log (DEBUG | INFO | WARNING | ERROR | CRITICAL)
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING

# Log output destination (stderr | stdout | file)
TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT=stderr

# Log file path (only used when TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT=file)
TINA4_LOG_FILE=./logs/app.log

# Log format (json | text)
TINA4_LOG_FORMAT=json
```

In development, use **DEBUG** level with **text** format for human-readable output. In production, use **WARNING** or **ERROR** level with **json** format for log aggregators.

11. Gotchas

1. Logging sensitive data

Problem: User passwords and payment card numbers appear in log files.

Cause: You logged the entire request body without filtering.

Fix: Never log raw **\$request->body** or **\$_POST**. Explicitly list the fields you want to log, excluding sensitive ones:

```
Debug::message("User updated", TINA4_LOG_INFO, [
    'user_id' => $body['id'],
    'email'   => $body['email'],
    // NOT: 'password' => $body['password']
]);
```

2. Logging too much in production

Problem: Log volume is enormous. Storage costs spike. Log aggregator rate limits trigger.

Cause: **TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=DEBUG** in production logs every cache miss, DB query, and template render.

Fix: Set **TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING** in production. Use **DEBUG** only in development.

3. Forgetting to log errors before rethrowing

Problem: A caught exception is rethrown but never logged. It disappears silently or appears only in a generic error handler with no context.

Fix: Always log before rethrowing. The context (order ID, user ID, inputs) is available inside the catch block. It is gone by the time the exception reaches the top-level handler.

Email with Messenger

1. Every App Sends Email

Your SaaS app needs signup confirmations. Password resets. Weekly digests. Attachments. HTML templates. Reliable delivery.

Email is plumbing. Every application needs it. Nobody wants to build it. SMTP configuration. Plain text fallbacks. Attachment encoding. Connection timeouts. Bounce handling. The details pile up.

Tina4's `Messenger` class handles all of it. Configure in `.env`. Create an instance. Send. In development mode, emails land in the dev dashboard -- not in real inboxes. No accidents.

2. Messenger Configuration via `.env`

All email configuration lives in `.env`:

```
TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.example.com
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=your-email@example.com
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-app-password
TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION=tls
TINA4_MAIL_FROM=noreply@example.com
TINA4_MAIL_FROM_NAME=My Store
```

Variable	Description	Common Values
<code>TINA4_MAIL_HOST</code>	SMTP server hostname	<code>smtp.gmail.com</code> , <code>smtp.mailgun.org</code> , <code>smtp.sendgrid.net</code>
<code>TINA4_MAIL_PORT</code>	SMTP port	<code>587</code> (TLS), <code>465</code> (SSL), <code>25</code> (unencrypted)
<code>TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME</code>	Login username	Usually your email address
<code>TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD</code>	Login password or app-specific password	App passwords for Gmail
<code>TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION</code>	Encryption method	<code>tls</code> (recommended), <code>ssl</code> , <code>none</code>
<code>TINA4_MAIL_FROM</code>	Default "From" address	<code>noreply@yourdomain.com</code>
<code>TINA4_MAIL_FROM_NAME</code>	Default "From" display name	<code>My Store</code> , <code>Acme Corp</code>

Common Provider Configurations

Gmail:

```
TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.gmail.com
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=your-email@gmail.com
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-app-password
TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION=tls
```

Note: Gmail requires an "App Password" (not your regular password) when two-factor authentication is enabled.

Mailgun:

```
TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.mailgun.org
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=postmaster@mg.yourdomain.com
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-mailgun-smtp-password
TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION=tls
```

SendGrid:

```
TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.sendgrid.net
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=apikey
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-sendgrid-api-key
TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION=tls
```

3. Constructor Override Pattern

Different purposes need different accounts. Transactional emails from one sender. Marketing from another. Override the configuration in the constructor:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Messenger;

// Uses .env defaults
$mailer = new Messenger();

// Override specific settings
$marketingMailer = new Messenger([
    "host" => "smtp.mailgun.org",
    "port" => 587,
    "username" => "marketing@mg.yourdomain.com",
    "password" => "marketing-smtp-password",
    "encryption" => "tls",
    "from_address" => "newsletter@yourdomain.com",
    "from_name" => "My Store Newsletter"
]);
```

The constructor accepts an associative array. Override any `.env` value. Unspecified keys fall back to the `.env` configuration.

4. Sending Plain Text Email

The simplest email:

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```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Messenger;

Router::post("/api/contact", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $mailer = new Messenger();

    $result = $mailer->send(
        $body["email"],           // To
        "Contact Form Submission", // Subject
        "Name: " . $body["name"] . "\n" . // Body (plain text)
        "Email: " . $body["email"] . "\n" .
        "Message:\n" . $body["message"]
    );

    if ($result["success"]) {
        return $response->json(["message" => "Email sent successfully"]);
    }

    return $response->json(["error" => "Failed to send email", "details" => $result["error"]], 500);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/contact \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "message": "I love your products!"}'

{"message": "Email sent successfully"}

```

The `send()` method returns an array with **"success"** (boolean) and **"error"** (string, present only on failure).

The send() Method

```
$mailer->send($to, $subject, $body, $options = []);
```

- **\$to**: Recipient email address (string)
- **\$subject**: Email subject line (string)
- **\$body**: Email body content (string -- plain text or HTML)
- **\$options**: Optional settings (array)

5. Sending HTML Email with Text Fallback

Most emails should be HTML with a plain text fallback. Some email clients do not render HTML:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Messenger;

$mailer = new Messenger();

$htmlBody = '
<html>
<body style="font-family: Arial, sans-serif; max-width: 600px; margin: 0 auto;">
    <div style="background: #1a1a2e; color: white; padding: 20px; text-align: center;">

```

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```

        <h1 style="margin: 0;">Welcome to My Store!</h1>
    </div>
    <div style="padding: 20px;">
        <p>Hi Alice,</p>
        <p>Thank you for creating your account. We are excited to have you!</p>
        <p>Here is what you can do next:</p>
        <ul>
            <li>Browse our <a href="https://mystore.com/products">product catalog</a></li>
            <li>Set up your <a href="https://mystore.com/profile">profile</a></li>
            <li>Check out our <a href="https://mystore.com/deals">current deals</a></li>
        </ul>
        <p>If you have any questions, reply to this email and we will get back to you within 24<br>
        Cheers,<br>The My Store Team</p>
    </div>
    <div style="background: #f5f5f5; padding: 12px; text-align: center; font-size: 12px; color:
    <p>You received this because you signed up at mystore.com</p>
    </div>
</body>
</html>';

```

```

$textBody = "Hi Alice,\n\n" .
    "Thank you for creating your account. We are excited to have you!\n\n" .
    "Here is what you can do next:\n" .
    "- Browse our product catalog: https://mystore.com/products\n" .
    "- Set up your profile: https://mystore.com/profile\n" .
    "- Check out our current deals: https://mystore.com/deals\n\n" .
    "If you have any questions, reply to this email.\n\n" .
    "Cheers,\nThe My Store Team";

```

```

$result = $mailer->send(
    "alice@example.com",
    "Welcome to My Store!",
    $htmlBody,
    ["text_body" => $textBody]
);

```

The `text_body` option provides the plain text fallback. Email clients that cannot render HTML show the text version instead.

6. Adding Attachments

Attach files by path:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Messenger;

$mailer = new Messenger();

$result = $mailer->send(
    "accounting@example.com",
    "Monthly Invoice #1042",
    "<h2>Invoice #1042</h2><p>Please find the invoice attached.</p>",
    [
        "attachments" => [
            "/path/to/invoices/invoice-1042.pdf",
            "/path/to/reports/monthly-summary.csv"
        ]
    ]
);

```

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```
    ]
  ]
);
```

Each attachment is an absolute file path. Tina4 reads the file, determines the MIME type, and encodes it for transmission.

Inline Attachments with Custom Names

```
$result = $mailer->send(
    "alice@example.com",
    "Your Export",
    "<p>Here is your data export.</p>",
    [
        "attachments" => [
            [
                "path" => "/tmp/export-20260322.csv",
                "name" => "my-store-export.csv" // Custom filename
            ]
        ]
    ]
);
```

The recipient sees `my-store-export.csv` regardless of the actual filename on disk.

7. CC and BCC

```
<?php
use Tina4\Messenger;

$mailer = new Messenger();

$result = $mailer->send(
    "alice@example.com",
    "Team Meeting Notes",
    "<p>Here are the notes from today's meeting.</p>",
    [
        "cc" => ["bob@example.com", "charlie@example.com"],
        "bcc" => ["manager@example.com"],
        "reply_to" => "alice@example.com"
    ]
);
```

- **cc**: Array of email addresses to carbon copy. All recipients see CC addresses.
- **bcc**: Array of email addresses to blind carbon copy. Recipients cannot see BCC addresses.
- **reply_to**: When the recipient clicks "Reply," this address is used instead of the "From" address.

8. Custom Headers

Add custom headers to outgoing emails with `addHeader()`:

```
<?php
```

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```

use Tina4\Messenger;

$mailer = new Messenger();

$mailer->addHeader("X-Priority", "1");
$mailer->addHeader("X-Mailer", "Tina4 Messenger");
$mailer->addHeader("List-Unsubscribe", "<https://mystore.com/unsubscribe?token=abc123>");

$result = $mailer->send(
    "alice@example.com",
    "Important Update",
    "<p>Your account requires attention.</p>"
);

```

Headers persist for the lifetime of the **Messenger** instance. Create a fresh instance if you need different headers for the next email.

Common custom headers:

Header	Purpose
X-Priority	1 (high), 3 (normal), 5 (low)
X-Mailer	Identifies the sending application
List-Unsubscribe	One-click unsubscribe link (required by some providers)
X-Entity-Ref-ID	Prevents email threading in some clients
Precedence	bulk for mass emails, list for mailing lists

9. Reading Inbox via IMAP

Tina4's Messenger reads emails via IMAP:

```

TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_HOST=imap.example.com
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PORT=993
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_USERNAME=support@example.com
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PASSWORD=your-imap-password
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_ENCRYPTION=ssl

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Messenger;

Router::get("/api/inbox", function ($request, $response) {
    $mailer = new Messenger();

    $emails = $mailer->getInbox([
        "limit" => 20,
        "unread_only" => true
    ]);

    $messages = [];
    foreach ($emails as $email) {

```

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```

        $messages[] = [
            "id" => $email["id"],
            "from" => $email["from"],
            "subject" => $email["subject"],
            "date" => $email["date"],
            "preview" => substr($email["text_body"], 0, 200),
            "has_attachments" => !empty($email["attachments"])
        ];
    }

    return $response->json(["messages" => $messages, "count" => count($messages)]);
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/inbox

{
  "messages": [
    {
      "id": "12345",
      "from": "customer@example.com",
      "subject": "Order question",
      "date": "2026-03-22T10:30:00+00:00",
      "preview": "Hi, I have a question about my recent order...",
      "has_attachments": false
    }
  ],
  "count": 1
}

```

Reading a Specific Email

```

Router::get("/api/inbox/{id}", function ($request, $response) {
    $mailer = new Messenger();
    $emailId = $request->params["id"];

    $email = $mailer->getMessage($emailId);

    if ($email === null) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $email["id"],
        "from" => $email["from"],
        "to" => $email["to"],
        "subject" => $email["subject"],
        "date" => $email["date"],
        "html_body" => $email["html_body"],
        "text_body" => $email["text_body"],
        "attachments" => array_map(fn($a) => [
            "name" => $a["name"],
            "size" => $a["size"],
            "type" => $a["type"]
        ], $email["attachments"] ?? [])
    ]);
});

```

Searching Emails

Search the inbox with IMAP search criteria:_____

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```

$mailer = new Messenger();

// Search by subject
$results = $mailer->searchInbox("SUBJECT \"invoice\"");

// Search by sender
$results = $mailer->searchInbox("FROM \"alice@example.com\"");

// Search by date range
$results = $mailer->searchInbox("SINCE \"22-Mar-2026\" BEFORE \"29-Mar-2026\"");

// Unread messages from a specific sender
$results = $mailer->searchInbox("UNSEEN FROM \"support@example.com\"");

```

The search string follows IMAP search syntax. Common operators: **FROM**, **TO**, **SUBJECT**, **BODY**, **SINCE**, **BEFORE**, **SEEN**, **UNSEEN**.

Marking Messages

```

$mailer = new Messenger();

// Mark as read
$mailer->markRead("12345");

// Mark as unread
$mailer->markUnread("12345");

```

Pass the message ID returned by **getInbox()** or **searchInbox()**.

Deleting Messages

```

$mailer = new Messenger();
$mailer->deleteMessage("12345");

```

The message moves to the Trash folder (or is marked for deletion, depending on the IMAP server).

Listing Folders

```

$mailer = new Messenger();
$folders = $mailer->getFolders();
// ["INBOX", "Sent", "Drafts", "Trash", "Spam", "Archive"]

```

Reading from a Specific Folder

```

$mailer = new Messenger();
$sentEmails = $mailer->getInbox([
    "folder" => "Sent",
    "limit" => 10
]);

```

Pass the **folder** option to read from any IMAP folder. The default is **"INBOX"**.

10. Dev Mode: Email Interception

When **TINA4_DEBUG=true**, all outgoing emails are intercepted. They appear in the dev dashboard instead of reaching real recipients. ~~No accidents during development.~~

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Navigate to [/__dev](#) and find the "Mail" section. You see:

- Every email "sent" during the current session
- The To, CC, and BCC addresses
- The subject and body (HTML and plain text)
- Attachments (viewable inline)
- The timestamp

Test email without configuring a real SMTP server. Inspect the output without polluting anyone's inbox.

Disabling Interception

To test real email delivery during development:

```
TINA4_MAILBOX_DIR=false
```

Emails now reach real recipients even when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. Use with caution. You do not want to email your entire user base from a dev machine.

11. Using Templates for Email Content

Hardcoding HTML in PHP strings is fragile and hard to read. Use Frond templates for email content.

Create [src/templates/emails/welcome.html](#):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
</head>
<body style="font-family: Arial, sans-serif; max-width: 600px; margin: 0 auto; background: #f5f5f5">
  <div style="background: #1a1a2e; color: white; padding: 24px; text-align: center; border-radius: 12px 12px 0 0;">
    <h1 style="margin: 0; font-size: 24px;">Welcome, {{ name }}!</h1>
  </div>
  <div style="background: white; padding: 24px; border-radius: 0 0 8px 8px;">
    <p>Hi {{ name }},</p>
    <p>Your account has been created successfully. Here are your details:</p>

    <table style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse; margin: 16px 0;">
      <tr>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold;">Email</td>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ email }}</td>
      </tr>
      <tr>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold;">Account ID</td>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ user_id }}</td>
      </tr>
      <tr>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold;">Signed up at</td>
        <td style="padding: 8px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ signed_up_at }}</td>
      </tr>
    </table>
  </div>
</body>
</html>
```

```

</table>

<p>Get started by exploring:</p>
<ul>
  <li><a href="{{ base_url }}/products" style="color: #1a1a2e;">Our product catalog</a>
  <li><a href="{{ base_url }}/profile" style="color: #1a1a2e;">Your profile settings</a>
</ul>

{% if promo_code %}
  <div style="background: #d4edda; padding: 16px; border-radius: 4px; margin: 16px 0;">
    <strong>Special offer!</strong> Use code <code>{{ promo_code }}</code> for 10% off
  </div>
{% endif %}

<p>Cheers,<br>The {{ app_name }} Team</p>
</div>

<div style="text-align: center; padding: 12px; color: #888; font-size: 12px;">
  <p>You received this because you signed up at {{ app_name }}.</p>
  <p><a href="{{ base_url }}/unsubscribe?token={{ unsubscribe_token }}" style="color: #888;">Unsubscribe</a>
</div>
</body>
</html>

```

Rendering and Sending

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Messenger;
use Tina4\Frond;

Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    // Create user (database logic)
    $userId = 42;

    // Render the email template
    $emailData = [
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "email" => $body["email"],
        "user_id" => $userId,
        "signed_up_at" => date("F j, Y"),
        "base_url" => $_ENV["APP_URL"] ?? "http://localhost:7145",
        "app_name" => "My Store",
        "promo_code" => "WELCOME10",
        "unsubscribe_token" => bin2hex(random_bytes(16))
    ];

    $htmlBody = Frond::render("emails/welcome.html", $emailData);

    // Send the email
    $mailer = new Messenger();
    $result = $mailer->send(
        $body["email"],
        "Welcome to My Store, " . $body["name"] . "!",
        $htmlBody,
        [
            "text_body" => "Hi " . $body["name"] . ",\n\nWelcome to My Store! Your account (#" .
        ]
    );

    return $response->json([
        "message" => "Registration successful",
        "email_sent" => $result["success"],
        "user_id" => $userId
    ], 201);
});

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/register \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securePass123"}'

{
  "message": "Registration successful",
  "email_sent": true,
  "user_id": 42
}
```

With `TINA4_DEBUG=true`, the email appears in the dev dashboard. Inspect the rendered HTML. Check that template variables were substituted. Verify the layout.

12. Sending Email via Queues

In production, do not send email inside a route handler. The SMTP handshake takes time. The user waits. Push email work to the queue system (Chapter 12):

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Queue;
use Tina4\Messenger;
use Tina4\Frond;

// In the route handler, just queue the email
Router::post("/api/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;
    $userId = 42; // Simulated

    Queue::produce("emails", [
        "template" => "emails/welcome.html",
        "to" => $body["email"],
        "subject" => "Welcome to My Store, " . $body["name"] . "!",
        "data" => [
            "name" => $body["name"],
            "email" => $body["email"],
            "user_id" => $userId,
            "signed_up_at" => date("F j, Y"),
            "base_url" => $_ENV["APP_URL"] ?? "http://localhost:7145",
            "app_name" => "My Store",
            "promo_code" => "WELCOME10"
        ]
    ]);

    return $response->json(["message" => "Registration successful", "user_id" => $userId], 201);
});

// The consumer sends the actual email
Queue::consume("emails", function ($job) {
    $payload = $job->payload;

    $htmlBody = Frond::render($payload["template"], $payload["data"]);

    $mailer = new Messenger();
    $result = $mailer->send(
        $payload["to"],
        $payload["subject"],
        $htmlBody
    );

    if (!$result["success"]) {
        error_log("Email failed: " . $result["error"]);
        return false; // Retry
    }

    error_log("Email sent to " . $payload["to"]);
    return true;
});
```

The route handler returns in under 50 milliseconds. The queue worker sends the email in the background. Automatic retries handle temporary SMTP failures.

13. Exercise: Build a Contact Form with Email Notification

Build a contact form that sends an email notification when submitted.

Requirements

- Create a **GET /contact** page that renders a contact form with fields: name, email, subject, and message
- Create a **POST /contact** endpoint that:
 - Validates all fields are present
 - Sends an email notification to the site admin (**admin@example.com**)
 - The email should include all form fields, formatted with HTML
 - Shows a flash message on success
 - Redirects back to the contact page
- Create an email template at **src/templates/emails/contact-notification.html** that formats the contact submission

Test with:

```
# View the form
curl http://localhost:7145/contact

# Submit the form
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/contact \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Bob", "email": "bob@example.com", "subject": "Product inquiry", "message": "Do y

# Check the dev dashboard for the intercepted email
# Navigate to http://localhost:7145/__dev
```

14. Solution

Create **src/templates/emails/contact-notification.html**:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head><meta charset="UTF-8"></head>
<body style="font-family: Arial, sans-serif; max-width: 600px; margin: 0 auto;">
  <div style="background: #1a1a2e; color: white; padding: 16px; text-align: center;">
    <h2 style="margin: 0;">New Contact Form Submission</h2>
  </div>
  <div style="padding: 20px; background: white;">
    <table style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;">
      <tr>
        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold; width: 50%;>Name
        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ name }} ({{ email }})
      </tr>
      <tr>
```



```

        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold;">Sub
        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ subject }}</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee; font-weight: bold;">Dat
        <td style="padding: 10px; border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;">{{ submitted_at }}</td>
    </tr>
</table>

<div style="margin-top: 16px; padding: 16px; background: #f8f9fa; border-radius: 4px;">
    <h3 style="margin-top: 0;">Message</h3>
    <p style="white-space: pre-wrap;">{{ message }}</p>
</div>

<p style="margin-top: 16px; color: #888; font-size: 12px;">
    Reply directly to this email to respond to {{ name }} at {{ email }}.
</p>
</div>
</body>
</html>

```

Create `src/templates/contact.html`:

```

{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}Contact Us{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>Contact Us</h1>

    {% if flash %}
        <div style="padding: 12px; border-radius: 4px; margin-bottom: 16px;">
            {% if flash.type == 'success' %}background: #d4edda; color: #155724;{% endif %}
            {% if flash.type == 'error' %}background: #f8d7da; color: #721c24;{% endif %}">
                {{ flash.message }}
            </div>
    {% endif %}

    <form method="POST" action="/contact" style="max-width: 500px;">
        <div style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
            <label for="name" style="display: block; margin-bottom: 4px; font-weight: bold;">Name
            <input type="text" name="name" id="name" required
                style="width: 100%; padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px;"
            </div>

        <div style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
            <label for="email" style="display: block; margin-bottom: 4px; font-weight: bold;">Email
            <input type="email" name="email" id="email" required
                style="width: 100%; padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px;"
            </div>

        <div style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
            <label for="subject" style="display: block; margin-bottom: 4px; font-weight: bold;">Subject
            <input type="text" name="subject" id="subject" required
                style="width: 100%; padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px;"
            </div>

        <div style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
            <label for="message" style="display: block; margin-bottom: 4px; font-weight: bold;">Message

```

```

        <textarea name="message" id="message" rows="6" required
            style="width: 100%; padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4
    </div>

    <button type="submit"
        style="padding: 10px 20px; background: #1a1a2e; color: white; border: none; bord
        Send Message
    </button>
</form>
{% endblock %}

```

Create `src/routes/contact.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Messenger;
use Tina4\Frond;

Router::get("/contact", function ($request, $response) {
    $flash = $request->session["_flash"] ?? null;
    unset($request->session["_flash"]);

    return $response->render("contact.html", [
        "flash" => $flash
    ]);
});

Router::post("/contact", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    // Validate
    $errors = [];
    if (empty($body["name"])) $errors[] = "Name is required";
    if (empty($body["email"])) $errors[] = "Email is required";
    if (empty($body["subject"])) $errors[] = "Subject is required";
    if (empty($body["message"])) $errors[] = "Message is required";

    if (!empty($errors)) {
        $request->session["_flash"] = [
            "type" => "error",
            "message" => "Please fill in all fields: " . implode(", ", $errors)
        ];
        return $response->redirect("/contact");
    }

    // Render the email template
    $htmlBody = Frond::render("emails/contact-notification.html", [
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "email" => $body["email"],
        "subject" => $body["subject"],
        "message" => $body["message"],
        "submitted_at" => date("F j, Y \a\\t g:i A")
    ]);

    // Send the email
    $mailer = new Messenger();
    $adminEmail = $_ENV["ADMIN_EMAIL"] ?? "admin@example.com";

    $result = $mailer->send(

```

```

        $adminEmail,
        "Contact Form: " . $body["subject"],
        $htmlBody,
        [
            "reply_to" => $body["email"],
            "text_body" => "Contact form submission from " . $body["name"] . " (" . $body["email"] . " " . $body["subject"] . " " . $body["message"] . "\n\n" .
                "Subject: " . $body["subject"] . "\n\n" .
                "Message:\n" . $body["message"]
        ]
    );

    if ($result["success"]) {
        $request->session["_flash"] = [
            "type" => "success",
            "message" => "Thank you for your message! We will get back to you shortly."
        ];
    } else {
        $request->session["_flash"] = [
            "type" => "error",
            "message" => "Sorry, there was a problem sending your message. Please try again later."
        ];
    }

    return $response->redirect("/contact");
});

```

Testing:

- Open <http://localhost:7145/contact> in your browser
- Fill in the form and submit
- You should see a green "Thank you" flash message
- Open http://localhost:7145/__dev to see the intercepted email
- The email should show the sender details, subject, message, and formatted HTML

API test:

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/contact \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"name": "Bob", "email": "bob@example.com", "subject": "Product inquiry", "message": "Do y
-c cookies.txt -b cookies.txt

```

The response is a **302** redirect to </contact>. Follow the redirect to see the flash message:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/contact -b cookies.txt
```

The HTML response includes the success flash message.

15. Gotchas

1. Gmail Blocks "Less Secure" Apps

Problem: Sending via Gmail fails with "Authentication failed" or "Username and Password not accepted."

Cause: Gmail blocks SMTP access from apps that do not use OAuth2 by default. Your regular password will not work with two-factor authentication enabled.

Fix: Generate an "App Password" in your Google Account settings (Security > 2-Step Verification > App Passwords). Use this 16-character password as `TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD`. It is separate from your regular Google password.

2. Emails Go to Spam

Problem: Emails are delivered but land in the spam folder.

Cause: Your sending domain lacks proper DNS records (SPF, DKIM, DMARC), or you send from a free email provider (Gmail, Yahoo).

Fix: Use a dedicated sending domain with proper DNS records. Set up SPF, DKIM, and DMARC. Or use a transactional email service -- Mailgun, SendGrid, Amazon SES -- that manages email reputation for you.

3. HTML Email Looks Broken

Problem: The email renders in Gmail but breaks in Outlook or Apple Mail.

Cause: Email clients have wildly different HTML/CSS support. CSS flexbox, grid, and many modern properties do not work in email.

Fix: Use inline styles. Not external stylesheets, not `<style>` blocks. Use table-based layouts for complex designs. Test with an email preview tool. Keep it simple. Most transactional emails do not need elaborate designs.

4. Attachment File Not Found

Problem: `Messenger::send()` returns an error about a missing file.

Cause: The attachment path is relative or incorrect. The file does not exist at the specified location.

Fix: Use absolute paths for attachments. Verify the file exists before calling `send()`: `if (!file_exists($path)) { ... }`. If the file is generated at runtime (a PDF, for example), make sure the generation completes before sending.

5. Dev Mode Intercepts Emails Silently

Problem: You set up SMTP. No emails arrive. No errors either.

Cause: `TINA4_DEBUG=true` intercepts all emails and shows them in the dev dashboard. The email never reaches the SMTP server.

Fix: Check the dev dashboard at `/__dev` for intercepted emails. If you need real email delivery during development, set `TINA4_MAILBOX_DIR=false`. Remove this setting before committing.

6. Email Template Variables Not Substituted

Problem: The email body shows `{{ name }}` instead of the user's name.

Cause: You passed the raw template file content instead of rendering it through Frond. The template engine never ran.

Fix: Use `FronD::render("emails/template.html", $data)` to render the template with variables substituted. Do not use `file_get_contents()`. That gives you the raw template source.

7. Connection Timeout on Send

Problem: `Messenger::send()` hangs for 30 seconds and then fails with a timeout error.

Cause: The SMTP server is unreachable. The port is blocked by a firewall. The hostname is wrong.

Fix: Test SMTP connectivity: `telnet smtp.example.com 587`. Verify the hostname, port, and encryption settings. Check that your firewall allows outbound connections on the SMTP port. Corporate firewalls often block ports 587 and 465. Ask your network administrator.

Frontend with tina4css

1. The Problem with Frontend Toolchains

Your client wants a dashboard. You know the drill. Install Node.js. Run `npm install`. Watch 200MB of `node_modules` download. Configure webpack or Vite. Set up PostCSS. Add a CSS framework. Maybe Tailwind with its purge config. Pray nothing breaks when you upgrade a dependency six months later.

Tina4 takes a different path. The framework ships with **tina4css** -- a Bootstrap-compatible CSS framework -- and **frond.js** -- a lightweight JavaScript helper library. Both arrive when you scaffold a project. No npm. No webpack. No build step. Link the files. Start building.

By the end of this chapter, you have a complete admin dashboard with sidebar, navigation, cards, tables, modals, and dark mode support. Zero npm dependencies.

2. What Ships with Tina4

Run `tina4 init`. Two files appear in your project:

```
src/public/
├── css/
│   ├── tina4.css      # The CSS framework
├── js/
│   ├── frond.js       # AJAX helpers, form submission, token management
├── scss/
│   └── tina4.scss     # SCSS source (optional, for customization)
```

Include them in any template:

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
<script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
```

That is everything. No CDN. No package manager. No version conflicts.

3. The Grid System

tina4css uses a 12-column responsive grid, compatible with Bootstrap's class names. Know Bootstrap? You know tina4css.

```
<div class="container">
  <div class="row">
    <div class="col-md-4">
      <p>One third</p>
    </div>
    <div class="col-md-4">
      <p>One third</p>
    </div>
    <div class="col-md-4">
      <p>One third</p>
    </div>
  </div>
```

The Intelligent Native Application Framework

```
</div>
</div>
```

Breakpoints:

Class Prefix	Screen Width	Typical Device
<code>col-</code>	All sizes	Phones and up
<code>col-sm-</code>	$\geq 576\text{px}$	Large phones
<code>col-md-</code>	$\geq 768\text{px}$	Tablets
<code>col-lg-</code>	$\geq 992\text{px}$	Desktops
<code>col-xl-</code>	$\geq 1200\text{px}$	Large desktops

Columns stack vertically on screens smaller than their breakpoint. A `col-md-6` element takes half the row on tablets and up, but full width on phones.

4. Components

Navbar

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-dark bg-dark">
  <div class="container">
    <a class="navbar-brand" href="/">My Dashboard</a>
    <ul class="navbar-nav">
      <li class="nav-item">
        <a class="nav-link active" href="/dashboard">Dashboard</a>
      </li>
      <li class="nav-item">
        <a class="nav-link" href="/users">Users</a>
      </li>
      <li class="nav-item">
        <a class="nav-link" href="/settings">Settings</a>
      </li>
    </ul>
  </div>
</nav>
```

Use `navbar-light bg-light` for a light theme, or `navbar-dark bg-primary` for a colored background.

Buttons

```
<button class="btn btn-primary">Save</button>
<button class="btn btn-secondary">Cancel</button>
<button class="btn btn-danger">Delete</button>
<button class="btn btn-success">Approve</button>
<button class="btn btn-warning">Warning</button>
<button class="btn btn-outline-primary">Outlined</button>
<button class="btn btn-sm btn-primary">Small</button>
<button class="btn btn-lg btn-primary">Large</button>
```

Cards

```
<div class="card">
  <div class="card-header">
    Monthly Revenue
  </div>
  <div class="card-body">
    <h5 class="card-title">$12,450</h5>
    <p class="card-text">Up 8% from last month</p>
  </div>
  <div class="card-footer text-muted">
    Updated 5 minutes ago
  </div>
</div>
```

Forms

```
<form>
  <div class="form-group">
    <label for="email">Email address</label>
    <input type="email" class="form-control" id="email"
      placeholder="you@example.com">
  </div>
  <div class="form-group">
    <label for="password">Password</label>
    <input type="password" class="form-control" id="password">
  </div>
  <div class="form-group form-check">
    <input type="checkbox" class="form-check-input" id="remember">
    <label class="form-check-label" for="remember">Remember me</label>
  </div>
  <button type="submit" class="btn btn-primary">Sign In</button>
</form>
```


Tables

```
<table class="table table-striped table-hover">
  <thead>
    <tr>
      <th>ID</th>
      <th>Name</th>
      <th>Email</th>
      <th>Role</th>
      <th>Actions</th>
    </tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
    <tr>
      <td>1</td>
      <td>Alice Johnson</td>
      <td>alice@example.com</td>
      <td><span class="badge badge-primary">Admin</span></td>
      <td>
        <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-primary">Edit</button>
        <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-danger">Delete</button>
      </td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>2</td>
      <td>Bob Smith</td>
      <td>bob@example.com</td>
      <td><span class="badge badge-secondary">User</span></td>
      <td>
        <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-primary">Edit</button>
        <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-danger">Delete</button>
      </td>
    </tr>
  </tbody>
</table>
```

Table variants: **table-bordered**, **table-striped**, **table-hover**, **table-sm** (compact), **table-responsive** (wraps in a scrollable container on small screens). Mix and match.

Badges

```
<span class="badge badge-primary">Primary</span>
<span class="badge badge-success">Active</span>
<span class="badge badge-warning">Pending</span>
<span class="badge badge-danger">Overdue</span>
<span class="badge badge-info">Info</span>
<span class="badge badge-dark">Dark</span>
```

Alerts

```
<div class="alert alert-success">
  Product saved successfully.
</div>

<div class="alert alert-danger">
  Error: could not connect to the database.
</div>

<div class="alert alert-warning alert-dismissible">
  Your trial expires in 3 days.
  <button type="button" class="close" data-dismiss="alert">&times;</button>
</div>

<div class="alert alert-info">
  Tip: you can drag and drop items to reorder them.
</div>
```

Modals

```
<button class="btn btn-primary" data-toggle="modal" data-target="#confirmModal">
  Delete User
</button>

<div class="modal" id="confirmModal">
  <div class="modal-dialog">
    <div class="modal-content">
      <div class="modal-header">
        <h5 class="modal-title">Confirm Deletion</h5>
        <button type="button" class="close" data-dismiss="modal">&times;</button>
      </div>
      <div class="modal-body">
        <p>Are you sure you want to delete this user? This action cannot be undone.</p>
      </div>
      <div class="modal-footer">
        <button class="btn btn-secondary" data-dismiss="modal">Cancel</button>
        <button class="btn btn-danger">Delete</button>
      </div>
    </div>
  </div>
</div>
```

tina4css includes the JavaScript needed for modal toggling. No jQuery required.

Progress Bars

```
<div class="progress">
  <div class="progress-bar bg-success" style="width: 75%">75%</div>
</div>

<div class="progress">
  <div class="progress-bar bg-warning progress-bar-striped" style="width: 45%">
    45% - Uploading...
  </div>
</div>
```

5. SCSS Customization

The SCSS source lives in `src/public/scss/tina4.scss`. Customize colors, fonts, or spacing here. Compile to CSS when ready.

Variables

At the top of `tina4.scss`, you will find variables you can override:

```
// Colors
$primary: #007bff;
$secondary: #6c757d;
$success: #28a745;
$danger: #dc3545;
$warning: #ffc107;
$info: #17a2b8;
$dark: #343a40;
$light: #f8f9fa;

// Typography
$font-family-base: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif;
$font-size-base: 1rem;
$line-height-base: 1.5;

// Spacing
$spacer: 1rem;

// Border radius
$border-radius: 0.25rem;

// Breakpoints
$breakpoint-sm: 576px;
$breakpoint-md: 768px;
$breakpoint-lg: 992px;
$breakpoint-xl: 1200px;
```

Compiling SCSS

If you edit the SCSS files, compile them with the Tina4 CLI:

```
tina4 scss

Compiling SCSS...
src/public/scss/tina4.scss → src/public/css/tina4.css
Done.
```

This reads all `.scss` files from `src/public/scss/` and writes compiled CSS to `src/public/css/`. No Sass gem. No Node. No additional dependencies. The Tina4 CLI includes a built-in SCSS compiler.

You can also run it in watch mode during development:

```
tina4 scss --watch

Watching src/public/scss/ for changes...
[14:30:05] Compiled tina4.scss → tina4.css (42ms)
```

Every time you save a `.scss` file, it recompiles automatically.

Custom Theme Example

Create `src/public/scss/custom.scss`:

```
// Override variables before importing tina4
$primary: #6f42c1;
$font-family-base: "Inter", sans-serif;
$border-radius: 0.5rem;

// Import the base framework
@import "tina4";

// Add your own styles
.sidebar {
  background: $dark;
  color: $light;
  min-height: 100vh;
  padding: 1rem;

  .nav-link {
    color: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.7);
    padding: 0.5rem 1rem;
    border-radius: $border-radius;

    &:hover, &.active {
      color: #fff;
      background: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.1);
    }
  }
}
```

Compile:

```
tina4 scss
```

Then reference your custom CSS in your template:

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/custom.css">
```

6. frond.js -- The JavaScript Helper

frond.js is a lightweight JavaScript library that ships with Tina4. AJAX helpers. Form submission. JWT token management. No jQuery. No Axios. No other library.

AJAX Requests

```
// GET request
frond.get("/api/products", function (data) {
  console.log(data.products);
});

// GET with error handling
frond.get("/api/products", function (data) {
  console.log(data);
}, function (error) {
  console.error("Failed:", error);
});

// POST request
frond.post("/api/products", {
  name: "Widget",
  price: 9.99
}, function (data) {
  console.log("Created:", data);
});

// PUT request
frond.put("/api/products/1", {
  name: "Updated Widget",
  price: 12.99
}, function (data) {
  console.log("Updated:", data);
});

// DELETE request
frond.delete("/api/products/1", function (data) {
  console.log("Deleted");
});
```

Form Submission

frond.js can intercept form submissions and send them via AJAX instead of a full page reload:

```
<form id="createProduct" data-frond-submit="/api/products" data-frond-method="POST">
  <div class="form-group">
    <label for="name">Product Name</label>
    <input type="text" class="form-control" name="name" id="name">
  </div>
  <div class="form-group">
    <label for="price">Price</label>
    <input type="number" class="form-control" name="price" id="price" step="0.01">
  </div>
  <button type="submit" class="btn btn-primary">Create Product</button>
</form>

<div id="result"></div>

<script>
  frond.onSubmit("createProduct", function (response) {
    document.getElementById("result").innerHTML =
      '<div class="alert alert-success">Product created: ' + response.name + '</div>';
  }, function (error) {
    document.getElementById("result").innerHTML =
      '<div class="alert alert-danger">Error: ' + error.message + '</div>';
  });
</script>
```

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```
});
</script>
```

The `data-frond-submit` attribute tells frond.js the URL to POST to. The `data-frond-method` attribute specifies the HTTP method. frond.js serializes all form fields as JSON automatically.

Token Management

When your application uses JWT authentication (Chapter 8), frond.js manages tokens automatically:

```
// Store the token after login
frond.setToken("eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIs...");

// All subsequent requests include the Authorization header automatically
frond.get("/api/profile", function (data) {
  // The request included: Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIs...
  console.log(data);
});

// Clear the token on logout
frond.clearToken();
```

frond.js stores the token in `localStorage` and includes it as a `Bearer` token in the `Authorization` header on every request.

Loading Indicators

```
// Show a loading state while fetching
frond.get("/api/products", function (data) {
  renderProducts(data.products);
}, null, {
  loading: "#loadingSpinner" // CSS selector for loading element
});
```

The element with id `loadingSpinner` will be shown while the request is in flight and hidden when it completes.

7. Building a Dashboard Layout

A real admin dashboard. Template layout with sidebar, top navbar, and content area.

The Base Layout

Create `src/templates/admin/layout.html`:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}Admin Dashboard{% endblock %}</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
  <style>
    * { margin: 0; padding: 0; box-sizing: border-box; }
```

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```

body { font-family: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif; }

.app-wrapper { display: flex; min-height: 100vh; }

.sidebar {
  width: 250px;
  background: #1a1a2e;
  color: #e0e0e0;
  padding: 0;
  flex-shrink: 0;
}
.sidebar-header {
  padding: 20px;
  font-size: 1.2em;
  font-weight: bold;
  color: #fff;
  border-bottom: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.1);
}
.sidebar-nav { list-style: none; padding: 10px 0; }
.sidebar-nav li a {
  display: block;
  padding: 10px 20px;
  color: rgba(255,255,255,0.7);
  text-decoration: none;
  transition: all 0.2s;
}
.sidebar-nav li a:hover,
.sidebar-nav li a.active {
  color: #fff;
  background: rgba(255,255,255,0.1);
}
.sidebar-nav li a .badge {
  float: right;
  margin-top: 2px;
}

.main-content { flex: 1; background: #f5f5f5; }

.topbar {
  background: #fff;
  padding: 12px 24px;
  border-bottom: 1px solid #e0e0e0;
  display: flex;
  justify-content: space-between;
  align-items: center;
}
.topbar-title { font-size: 1.1em; font-weight: 600; }
.topbar-actions { display: flex; gap: 12px; align-items: center; }

.content-area { padding: 24px; }

.stats-grid {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(240px, 1fr));
  gap: 20px;
  margin-bottom: 24px;
}

.stat-card {
  border-bottom: 1px solid #ccc;

```

```

        background: #fff;
        border-radius: 8px;
        padding: 20px;
        box-shadow: 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
    }
    .stat-card .stat-value { font-size: 2em; font-weight: bold; }
    .stat-card .stat-label { color: #888; margin-top: 4px; }
    .stat-card .stat-change { font-size: 0.85em; margin-top: 8px; }
    .stat-card .stat-change.up { color: #28a745; }
    .stat-card .stat-change.down { color: #dc3545; }

    @media (max-width: 768px) {
        .sidebar { display: none; }
        .stats-grid { grid-template-columns: 1fr; }
    }
</style>
{% block extra_css %}{% endblock %}
</head>
<body>
    <div class="app-wrapper">
        <aside class="sidebar">
            <div class="sidebar-header">Admin Panel</div>
            <ul class="sidebar-nav">
                <li><a href="/admin" class="{% if active_page == 'dashboard' %}active{% endif %}">Dashboard</a></li>
                <li><a href="/admin/users" class="{% if active_page == 'users' %}active{% endif %}">Users</a></li>
                <li><a href="/admin/products" class="{% if active_page == 'products' %}active{% endif %}">Products</a></li>
                <li><a href="/admin/orders" class="{% if active_page == 'orders' %}active{% endif %}">Orders</a>
                    <div>
                        <span>{{ pending_orders }}</span>
                    </div>
                </li>
                <li><a href="/admin/settings" class="{% if active_page == 'settings' %}active{% endif %}">Settings</a></li>
            </ul>
        </aside>

        <div class="main-content">
            <div class="topbar">
                <span class="topbar-title">{{ block page_title }}Dashboard{% endblock %}</span>
                <div class="topbar-actions">
                    <span>Welcome, {{ user_name | default("Admin") }}</span>
                    <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-danger">Logout</button>
                </div>
            </div>

            <div class="content-area">
                {{ block content }}
            </div>
        </div>

        <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
    </body>
</html>

```


The Dashboard Page

Create `src/templates/admin/dashboard.html`:

```
{% extends "admin/layout.html" %}

{% block title %}Dashboard - Admin{% endblock %}
{% block page_title %}Dashboard{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <div class="stats-grid">
        {% for stat in stats %}
            <div class="stat-card">
                <div class="stat-value">{{ stat.value }}</div>
                <div class="stat-label">{{ stat.label }}</div>
                <div class="stat-change {{ stat.direction }}">
                    {{ stat.direction == "up" ? "+" : "" }}{{ stat.change }}% from last month
                </div>
            </div>
        {% endfor %}
    </div>

    <div class="row">
        <div class="col-md-8">
            <div class="card">
                <div class="card-header">Recent Orders</div>
                <div class="card-body" style="padding: 0;">
                    <table class="table table-hover" style="margin: 0;">
                        <thead>
                            <tr>
                                <th>Order ID</th>
                                <th>Customer</th>
                                <th>Total</th>
                                <th>Status</th>
                            </tr>
                        </thead>
                        <tbody>
                            {% for order in recent_orders %}
                                <tr>
                                    <td>#{{ order.id }}</td>
                                    <td>{{ order.customer }}</td>
                                    <td>${{ order.total | number_format(2) }}</td>
                                    <td>
                                        {% if order.status == "completed" %}
                                            <span class="badge badge-success">Completed</span>
                                        {% elseif order.status == "pending" %}
                                            <span class="badge badge-warning">Pending</span>
                                        {% elseif order.status == "cancelled" %}
                                            <span class="badge badge-danger">Cancelled</span>
                                        {% endif %}
                                    </td>
                                </tr>
                            {% endfor %}
                        </tbody>
                    </table>
                </div>
            </div>
        </div>
        <div class="col-md-4">


---



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```

```

<div class="card">
  <div class="card-header">Quick Actions</div>
  <div class="card-body">
    <button class="btn btn-primary btn-block" style="margin-bottom: 8px;">
      Add New Product
    </button>
    <button class="btn btn-outline-primary btn-block" style="margin-bottom: 8px;">
      View Reports
    </button>
    <button class="btn btn-outline-secondary btn-block">
      Export Data
    </button>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="card" style="margin-top: 20px;">
  <div class="card-header">System Health</div>
  <div class="card-body">
    <p><strong>CPU:</strong></p>
    <div class="progress" style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
      <div class="progress-bar bg-success" style="width: {{ cpu_usage }}%">
        {{ cpu_usage }}%
      </div>
    </div>
    <p><strong>Memory:</strong></p>
    <div class="progress" style="margin-bottom: 12px;">
      <div class="progress-bar bg-info" style="width: {{ memory_usage }}%">
        {{ memory_usage }}%
      </div>
    </div>
    <p><strong>Disk:</strong></p>
    <div class="progress">
      <div class="progress-bar bg-warning" style="width: {{ disk_usage }}%">
        {{ disk_usage }}%
      </div>
    </div>
  </div>
</div>
</div>
</div>
{% endblock %}

```

The Dashboard Route

Create `src/routes/admin.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/admin", function ($request, $response) {
    $stats = [
        ["label" => "Total Users", "value" => "1,247", "change" => 12, "direction" => "up"],
        ["label" => "Revenue", "value" => "$34,500", "change" => 8, "direction" => "up"],
        ["label" => "Orders", "value" => "456", "change" => 3, "direction" => "down"],
        ["label" => "Conversion Rate", "value" => "3.2%", "change" => 0.5, "direction" => "up"]
    ];

    $recentOrders = [
        ["id" => 1042, "customer" => "Alice Johnson", "total" => 149.99, "status" => "completed"]
    ];

```

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```

        ["id" => 1041, "customer" => "Bob Smith", "total" => 89.50, "status" => "pending"],
        ["id" => 1040, "customer" => "Carol Davis", "total" => 234.00, "status" => "completed"],
        ["id" => 1039, "customer" => "David Lee", "total" => 45.99, "status" => "cancelled"],
        ["id" => 1038, "customer" => "Eva Martinez", "total" => 178.25, "status" => "pending"]
    ];

    return $response->render("admin/dashboard.html", [
        "active_page" => "dashboard",
        "user_name" => "Admin",
        "pending_orders" => 2,
        "stats" => $stats,
        "recent_orders" => $recentOrders,
        "cpu_usage" => 42,
        "memory_usage" => 68,
        "disk_usage" => 55
    ]);
});

```

Start the server. Visit <http://localhost:7145/admin>. You see:

- Dark sidebar on the left with navigation links
- Top bar with a welcome message and logout button
- Four stat cards showing users, revenue, orders, and conversion rate
- Recent orders table with color-coded status badges
- Quick action buttons in a card on the right
- System health progress bars

Zero npm dependencies.

8. Dark Mode Support

tina4css includes built-in dark mode. One attribute on the `<html>` element:

```
<html lang="en" data-theme="dark">
```

Light backgrounds become dark. Dark text becomes light. All components adapt.

Toggle with JavaScript

Add a dark mode toggle button to your layout:

```

<button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-secondary" onclick="toggleDarkMode()">
    Toggle Dark Mode
</button>

<script>
    function toggleDarkMode() {
        const html = document.documentElement;
        const current = html.getAttribute("data-theme");
        const next = current === "dark" ? "light" : "dark";
        html.setAttribute("data-theme", next);
        localStorage.setItem("theme", next);
    }

```

```
// Load saved preference
const saved = localStorage.getItem("theme");
if (saved) {
    document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", saved);
}
</script>
```

Respecting System Preference

If the user has not set a preference, respect their operating system setting:

```
const saved = localStorage.getItem("theme");
if (saved) {
    document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", saved);
} else if (window.matchMedia("(prefers-color-scheme: dark)").matches) {
    document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", "dark");
}
```

Custom Dark Mode Colors

In your SCSS, you can customize the dark mode palette:

```
[data-theme="dark"] {
    --bg-primary: #1a1a2e;
    --bg-secondary: #16213e;
    --text-primary: #e0e0e0;
    --text-secondary: #a0a0a0;
    --border-color: #2d2d4a;
    --card-bg: #16213e;
}
---
```

9. Responsive Design

tina4css is mobile-first. Components stack on small screens. They expand on larger screens.

Responsive Utilities

Show and hide elements at different breakpoints:

```
<!-- Only visible on medium screens and up -->
<div class="d-none d-md-block">
    Desktop sidebar content
</div>

<!-- Only visible on small screens -->
<div class="d-block d-md-none">
    Mobile navigation
</div>
```

Responsive Tables

Wrap tables in a `.table-responsive` container to make them scroll horizontally on small screens:

```
<div class="table-responsive">
    <table class="table">
        <!-- Wide table content -->
    </table>
```

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</div>

Spacing Utilities

Use margin and padding utilities that respond to breakpoints:

```
<div class="p-2 p-md-4">Padding: 0.5rem on mobile, 1.5rem on desktop</div>
<div class="mt-2 mt-lg-5">Margin-top: 0.5rem on mobile, 3rem on large screens</div>
```

Spacing scale:

Class	Size
* -0	0
* -1	0.25rem
* -2	0.5rem
* -3	1rem
* -4	1.5rem
* -5	3rem

Directions: **m** (margin), **p** (padding), **t** (top), **b** (bottom), **l** (left), **r** (right), **x** (horizontal), **y** (vertical).

10. Building a Users Page with AJAX

A users management page. Data loads via AJAX using frond.js.

Create `src/templates/admin/users.html`:

```
{% extends "admin/layout.html" %}

{% block title %}Users - Admin{% endblock %}
{% block page_title %}User Management{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  <div class="card">
    <div class="card-header" style="display: flex; justify-content: space-between; align-items: center;">
      <span>All Users</span>
      <button class="btn btn-sm btn-primary" data-toggle="modal" data-target="#addUserModal">
        Add User
      </button>
    </div>
    <div class="card-body" style="padding: 0;">
      <div id="loadingSpinner" class="text-center p-4" style="display: none;">
        Loading...
      </div>
      <table class="table table-hover" id="usersTable" style="margin: 0;">
        <thead>
          <tr>
            <th>ID</th>
            <th>Name</th>
            <th>Email</th>
          </tr>
        </thead>
        <tbody>
          <tr>
            <td>1</td>
            <td>John Doe</td>
            <td>john.doe@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>2</td>
            <td>Jane Smith</td>
            <td>jane.smith@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>3</td>
            <td>Bob Johnson</td>
            <td>bob.johnson@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>4</td>
            <td>Alice Brown</td>
            <td>alice.brown@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>5</td>
            <td>Charlie Davis</td>
            <td>charlie.davis@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>6</td>
            <td>Diana Prince</td>
            <td>diana.prince@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>7</td>
            <td>Ethan Hunt</td>
            <td>ethan.hunt@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>8</td>
            <td>Fiona Glenanne</td>
            <td>fiona.glenanne@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>9</td>
            <td>Gavin Hastings</td>
            <td>gavin.hastings@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>10</td>
            <td>Helen Magnus</td>
            <td>helen.magnus@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>11</td>
            <td>Ivan Drago</td>
            <td>ivan.drago@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>12</td>
            <td>Jack Bauer</td>
            <td>jack.bauer@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>13</td>
            <td>Karen Sisco</td>
            <td>karen.sisco@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>14</td>
            <td>Leo Fitz</td>
            <td>leo.fitz@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>15</td>
            <td>Miles Morales</td>
            <td>miles.morales@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>16</td>
            <td>Nancy Drew</td>
            <td>nancy.drew@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>17</td>
            <td>Oscar Martinez</td>
            <td>oscar.martinez@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>18</td>
            <td>Pete Dinklage</td>
            <td>pete.dinklage@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>19</td>
            <td>Quinn Fabray</td>
            <td>quinn.fabray@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>20</td>
            <td>Ravi Chakrabarty</td>
            <td>ravi.chakrabarty@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>21</td>
            <td>Samantha Carter</td>
            <td>samantha.carter@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>22</td>
            <td>Tad Tipton</td>
            <td>tad.tipton@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>23</td>
            <td>Uma Thurman</td>
            <td>uma.thurman@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>24</td>
            <td>Victor Zsido</td>
            <td>victor.zsido@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>25</td>
            <td>Wendell Burt</td>
            <td>wendell.burt@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>26</td>
            <td>Xavier Woods</td>
            <td>xavier.woods@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>27</td>
            <td>Yara Cole</td>
            <td>yara.cole@example.com</td>
          </tr>
          <tr>
            <td>28</td>
            <td>Zoe Lomon</td>
            <td>zoe.lomon@example.com</td>
          </tr>
        </tbody>
      </table>
    </div>
  </div>
</block content %}
```

```

                <th>Created</th>
                <th>Actions</th>
            </tr>
        </thead>
        <tbody id="usersBody">
            <!-- Populated by JavaScript -->
        </tbody>
    </table>
</div>
</div>

<!-- Add User Modal -->
<div class="modal" id="addUserModal">
    <div class="modal-dialog">
        <div class="modal-content">
            <div class="modal-header">
                <h5 class="modal-title">Add New User</h5>
                <button type="button" class="close" data-dismiss="modal">&times;</button>
            </div>
            <div class="modal-body">
                <form id="addUserForm">
                    <div class="form-group">
                        <label for="userName">Name</label>
                        <input type="text" class="form-control" name="name" id="userName" re
                    </div>
                    <div class="form-group">
                        <label for="userEmail">Email</label>
                        <input type="email" class="form-control" name="email" id="userEmail"
                    </div>
                </form>
            </div>
            <div class="modal-footer">
                <button class="btn btn-secondary" data-dismiss="modal">Cancel</button>
                <button class="btn btn-primary" onclick="createUser()">Create User</button>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</div>

<div id="alertArea" style="margin-top: 16px;"></div>
{% endblock %}

{% block extra_js %}
<script>
    function loadUsers() {
        frond.get("/api/users", function (data) {
            var tbody = document.getElementById("usersBody");
            tbody.innerHTML = "";

            if (data.data && data.data.length > 0) {
                data.data.forEach(function (user) {
                    var row = '<tr>'
                        + '<td>' + user.id + '</td>'
                        + '<td>' + user.name + '</td>'
                        + '<td>' + user.email + '</td>'
                        + '<td>' + user.created_at + '</td>'
                        + '<td>'
                        + '<button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-primary" onclick="editUser(' +
                        + '<button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-danger" onclick="deleteUser(' +

```

```

        + '</td>'
        + '</tr>';
        tbody.innerHTML += row;
    });
} else {
    tbody.innerHTML = '<tr><td colspan="5" class="text-center p-4">No users found</td></tr>';
}
}, null, { loading: "#loadingSpinner" });
}

function createUser() {
    var name = document.getElementById("userName").value;
    var email = document.getElementById("userEmail").value;

    frond.post("/api/users", { name: name, email: email }, function (data) {
        document.getElementById("alertArea").innerHTML =
            '<div class="alert alert-success">User "' + data.name + '" created.</div>';
        loadUsers();
    }, function (error) {
        document.getElementById("alertArea").innerHTML =
            '<div class="alert alert-danger">Error creating user.</div>';
    });
}

function deleteUser(id) {
    if (confirm("Are you sure you want to delete this user?")) {
        frond.delete("/api/users/" + id, function () {
            loadUsers();
        });
    }
}

// Load users on page load
loadUsers();
</script>
{% endblock %}

```

Create the route for the users page:

```

Router::get("/admin/users", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->render("admin/users.html", [
        "active_page" => "users",
        "user_name" => "Admin",
        "pending_orders" => 2
    ]);
});

```

This page loads users via an AJAX call to </api/users> (provided by auto-CRUD on the User model from Chapter 6). The table populates dynamically, and users can be added through a modal form and deleted with confirmation -- all without full page reloads.

11. Exercise: Build a Complete Admin Dashboard

Build an admin dashboard with the following features:

Requirements

- **Layout** -- Sidebar with navigation links for Dashboard, Products, and Orders. Top bar with the current user name and a dark mode toggle button.
- **Dashboard Page** ([GET /admin](#)) -- Four stat cards (Total Products, Total Orders, Revenue, Low Stock Items). A table of the 5 most recent orders. A progress bar showing inventory health (percentage of products in stock).
- **Products Page** ([GET /admin/products](#)) -- A table listing all products with columns: ID, Name, Category, Price, Stock Status. An "Add Product" button that opens a modal with a form. The form submits via frond.js AJAX to [POST /api/products](#). After submission, the table reloads without a page refresh.
- **Dark Mode** -- The toggle button switches between light and dark themes. The preference persists in localStorage.

Seed Data

Create a route that populates sample data:

```
Router::get("/admin/seed", function ($request, $response) {
    $products = [
        ["name" => "Wireless Keyboard", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 79.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["name" => "USB-C Hub", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 49.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["name" => "Standing Desk", "category" => "Furniture", "price" => 549.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["name" => "Monitor Light", "category" => "Electronics", "price" => 39.99, "in_stock" => true],
        ["name" => "Ergonomic Chair", "category" => "Furniture", "price" => 399.99, "in_stock" => true]
    ];

    foreach ($products as $data) {
        $product = new Product();
        $product->name = $data["name"];
        $product->category = $data["category"];
        $product->price = $data["price"];
        $product->inStock = $data["in_stock"];
        $product->save();
    }

    return $response->json(["message" => "Seeded " . count($products) . " products"]);
});
```

Expected Result

Visit <http://localhost:7145/admin> and see:

- A sidebar with navigation (Dashboard highlighted)
- Four stat cards showing product and order counts
- A recent orders table with status badges
- A dark mode toggle that switches the entire UI

Visit <http://localhost:7145/admin/products> and see:

- A table of all products loaded via AJAX
- An "Add Product" button that opens a modal

- Form submission creates the product and refreshes the table

12. Solution

The solution follows the same patterns shown in sections 7 and 10. Create the layout template extending the base layout from section 7. Create the dashboard page template with stat cards using `{% for stat in stats %}`. Create the products page template using the AJAX pattern from section 10, but for products instead of users.

For the products page, use auto-CRUD on the Product model (`$autoCrud = true`) so the API endpoints are available at `/api/products`. Load the table with `frond.get("/api/products", ...)` and handle form submission with `frond.post("/api/products", ...)`.

For the dark mode toggle, add the JavaScript from section 8 to the base layout template inside the `{% block extra_js %}` block.

The key route handlers are:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/admin", function ($request, $response) {
    $product = new Product();
    $allProducts = $product->select("*");
    $inStockCount = count(array_filter($allProducts, fn($p) => $p->inStock));
    $totalProducts = count($allProducts);
    $stockHealth = $totalProducts > 0 ? round(($inStockCount / $totalProducts) * 100) : 0;

    $stats = [
        ["label" => "Total Products", "value" => $totalProducts, "change" => 5, "direction" => "up"],
        ["label" => "Total Orders", "value" => 156, "change" => 12, "direction" => "up"],
        ["label" => "Revenue", "value" => "$8,450", "change" => 3, "direction" => "up"],
        ["label" => "Low Stock", "value" => $totalProducts - $inStockCount, "change" => 2, "direction" => "down"],
    ];

    return $response->render("admin/dashboard.html", [
        "active_page" => "dashboard",
        "stats" => $stats,
        "stock_health" => $stockHealth,
        "recent_orders" => [],
        "pending_orders" => 0
    ]);
});

Router::get("/admin/products", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->render("admin/products.html", [
        "active_page" => "products",
        "pending_orders" => 0
    ]);
});
```

13. Gotchas

1. CSS File Not Loading

Problem: The browser shows unstyled HTML. The CSS file returns a 404.

Cause: The CSS file must be inside `src/public/css/`. If you put it in `src/css/` or `css/` at the root, Tina4 will not serve it.

Fix: Make sure the file is at `src/public/css/tina4.css`. Static files are served from `src/public/`.

2. SCSS Changes Not Reflected

Problem: You edited `tina4.scss` but the browser still shows the old styles.

Cause: SCSS must be compiled to CSS. Editing the `.scss` file does not automatically update the `.css` file unless you are running `tina4 scss --watch`.

Fix: Run `tina4 scss` to compile, or use `tina4 scss --watch` during development.

3. Modal Does Not Open

Problem: Clicking a button with `data-toggle="modal"` does nothing.

Cause: `frond.js` is not loaded, or the `data-target` value does not match the modal's `id`.

Fix: Check that `<script src="/js/frond.js"></script>` is included before `</body>`. Verify that `data-target="#myModal"` matches `<div class="modal" id="myModal">` (the `#` prefix is required in `data-target`).

4. frond.js AJAX Returns HTML Instead of JSON

Problem: `frond.get("/api/products", ...)` receives an HTML page instead of JSON data.

Cause: The route handler returns `$response->render(...)` or `$response->html(...)` instead of `$response->json(...)`. Or the URL is wrong and hitting a catch-all route that returns HTML.

Fix: Verify the API route returns JSON. Check the URL in the `frond.js` call matches the route path exactly.

5. Dark Mode Flickers on Load

Problem: The page loads in light mode for a split second before switching to dark mode.

Cause: The theme is set by JavaScript after the page renders. The initial HTML does not include `data-theme="dark"`.

Fix: Move the theme detection script to the `<head>` section so it runs before the body renders:

```
<head>
  <script>
    (function() {
      var t = localStorage.getItem("theme");
```

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```

        if (t) document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", t);
        else if (window.matchMedia("(prefers-color-scheme: dark)").matches)
            document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", "dark");
    })();
</script>
</head>

```

6. Form Data Not Reaching the Server

Problem: `frond.post()` sends the request but `$request->body` is empty on the server.

Cause: frond.js sends JSON by default. If you are building the data object incorrectly or passing a `FormData` object, the server may not parse it correctly.

Fix: Pass a plain JavaScript object to `frond.post()`. Do not use `new FormData()` -- frond.js handles serialization internally. Make sure your object keys match what the server expects:

```

frond.post("/api/products", {
    name: document.getElementById("name").value,
    price: parseFloat(document.getElementById("price").value)
}, callback);

```

7. Responsive Grid Not Working

Problem: Columns do not stack on mobile. They overflow horizontally instead.

Cause: Missing the viewport meta tag. Without it, mobile browsers render the page at desktop width.

Fix: Add this to your `<head>`:

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
```

This tag is included in all the examples above but is easy to forget when creating templates from scratch.

14. HtmlElement — Programmatic HTML Builder

Build HTML in PHP without string concatenation:

```

$el = new HtmlElement("div", ["class" => "card"], ["Hello"]);
echo $el; // <div class="card">Hello</div>

// Nesting
$card = new HtmlElement("div", ["class" => "card"], [
    new HtmlElement("h2", [], ["Title"]),
    new HtmlElement("p", [], ["Content"]),
]);

// Helper functions
extract(HtmlElement::helpers());
echo $_div(["class" => "card"], $_p("Hello"), $_a(["href" => "/"], "Home"));

```

Void tags (`<br>`, `<img>`, `<input>`) render without closing tags. Boolean attributes render as bare names.

Testing

1. Why Tests Matter More Than You Think

Friday afternoon. Your client reports a critical bug in production. You fix it. One line of code. But did that fix break anything else? You have 47 routes, 12 ORM models, and 3 middleware functions. Manually clicking through every page takes an hour. Running the test suite takes 2 seconds.

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

```
ProductTest
[PASS] test_create_product
[PASS] test_load_product
[PASS] test_update_product
[PASS] test_delete_product
[PASS] test_list_products_with_filter
```

```
AuthTest
[PASS] test_login_with_valid_credentials
[PASS] test_login_with_invalid_password
[PASS] test_protected_route_without_token
[PASS] test_protected_route_with_valid_token
```

```
9 tests, 9 passed, 0 failed (0.34s)
```

Everything still works. Deploy with confidence. Enjoy your weekend.

Tina4 includes an inline testing framework. No external packages. No PHPUnit configuration. Write a test. Run it. Done.

2. Your First Test

Tests live in the `tests/` directory. Every `.php` file there is auto-discovered when you run `tina4 test`.

Create `tests/BasicTest.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class BasicTest extends Test
{
    public function testAddition()
    {
        $this->assertEqual(2 + 2, 4, "Basic addition should work");
    }

    public function testStringContains()
    {
        $greeting = "Hello, World!";
        $this->assertTrue(str_contains($greeting, "world"), "Greeting should contain 'World'");
    }
}
```

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```

    }

    public function testArrayLength()
    {
        $items = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5];
        $this->assertEqual(count($items), 5, "Array should have 5 items");
    }
}

```

Run it:

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

```

BasicTest
[PASS] test_addition
[PASS] test_string_contains
[PASS] test_array_length

```

```
3 tests, 3 passed, 0 failed (0.02s)
```

How It Works

- Your test class extends `Tina4\Test`.
- Every method that starts with `test` is a test case. The method name is converted to a readable label: `testAddition` becomes `test_addition`.
- Inside each test, you call assertion methods to verify behavior.
- If all assertions pass, the test passes. If any assertion fails, the test fails and you see the failure message.

3. Assertion Methods

Tina4's Test class provides these assertion methods:

assertEqual(\$actual, \$expected, \$message)

Checks that two values are equal.

```

$this->assertEqual(4, 4, "Should be equal");           // PASS
$this->assertEqual("hello", "hello", "Strings match"); // PASS
$this->assertEqual(4, 5, "Not equal");                 // FAIL

```

assertTrue(\$value, \$message)

Checks that a value is truthy.

```

$this->assertTrue(true, "Should be true");           // PASS
$this->assertTrue(1, "1 is truthy");                 // PASS
$this->assertTrue("yes", "Non-empty string is truthy"); // PASS
$this->assertTrue(false, "This fails");              // FAIL
$this->assertTrue(0, "Zero is falsy");               // FAIL

```

assertFalse(\$value, \$message)

Checks that a value is falsy.

```
$this->assertFalse(false, "Should be false");           // PASS
$this->assertFalse(0, "Zero is falsy");                 // PASS
$this->assertFalse("", "Empty string is falsy");        // PASS
$this->assertFalse(true, "This fails");                 // FAIL
```

assertRaises(\$callable, \$exceptionClass, \$message)

Checks that a function throws a specific exception.

```
$this->assertRaises(function () {
    throw new \InvalidArgumentException("Bad input");
}, \InvalidArgumentException::class, "Should throw InvalidArgumentException");

$this->assertRaises(function () {
    $result = 10 / 0;
}, \DivisionByZeroError::class, "Should throw on division by zero");
```

assertNotEqual(\$actual, \$expected, \$message)

Checks that two values are not equal.

```
$this->assertNotEqual("hello", "world", "Strings differ"); // PASS
$this->assertNotEqual(4, 4, "Same values");                 // FAIL
```

assertNull(\$value, \$message)

Checks that a value is null.

```
$this->assertNull(null, "Should be null");               // PASS
$this->assertNull("hello", "Not null");                  // FAIL
```

assertNotNull(\$value, \$message)

Checks that a value is not null.

```
$this->assertNotNull("hello", "Has value");              // PASS
$this->assertNotNull(null, "Is null");                   // FAIL
```

4. Testing ORM Models

Test a Product model. Create records. Load them. Update them. Delete them.

Create [tests/ProductTest.php](#):

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class ProductTest extends Test
{
    private ?int $testProductId = null;

    public function testCreateProduct()
    {
        $product = new Product();
```

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```

$product->name = "Test Widget";
$product->category = "Testing";
$product->price = 19.99;
$product->inStock = true;
$product->save();

$this->assertNotNull($product->id, "Product should have an ID after save");
$this->assertTrue($product->id > 0, "Product ID should be positive");

$this->testProductId = $product->id;
}

public function testLoadProduct()
{
    // Create a product to load
    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = "Load Test Widget";
    $product->category = "Testing";
    $product->price = 29.99;
    $product->save();

    // Load it back
    $loaded = new Product();
    $loaded->load($product->id);

    $this->assertEqual($loaded->name, "Load Test Widget", "Name should match");
    $this->assertEqual($loaded->category, "Testing", "Category should match");
    $this->assertEqual($loaded->price, 29.99, "Price should match");
    $this->assertTrue($loaded->inStock, "Should be in stock by default");
}

public function testUpdateProduct()
{
    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = "Update Test Widget";
    $product->price = 10.00;
    $product->save();

    $id = $product->id;

    // Update it
    $product->name = "Updated Widget";
    $product->price = 15.00;
    $product->save();

    // Reload and verify
    $reloaded = new Product();
    $reloaded->load($id);

    $this->assertEqual($reloaded->name, "Updated Widget", "Name should be updated");
    $this->assertEqual($reloaded->price, 15.00, "Price should be updated");
}

public function testDeleteProduct()
{
    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = "Delete Me";
    $product->price = 5.00;
    $product->save();

```

```

        $id = $product->id;
        $product->delete();

        // Try to load the deleted product
        $gone = new Product();
        $gone->load($id);

        $this->assertTrue(empty($gone->id), "Deleted product should not be loadable");
    }

    public function testSelectWithFilter()
    {
        // Create products in different categories
        $p1 = new Product();
        $p1->name = "Filter Test A";
        $p1->category = "FilterCat";
        $p1->price = 10.00;
        $p1->save();

        $p2 = new Product();
        $p2->name = "Filter Test B";
        $p2->category = "FilterCat";
        $p2->price = 20.00;
        $p2->save();

        $p3 = new Product();
        $p3->name = "Other Product";
        $p3->category = "Other";
        $p3->price = 30.00;
        $p3->save();

        // Query by category
        $product = new Product();
        $results = $product->select("*", "category = :cat", ["cat" => "FilterCat"]);

        $this->assertTrue(count($results) >= 2, "Should find at least 2 FilterCat products");

        $names = array_map(fn($p) => $p->name, $results);
        $this->assertTrue(in_array("Filter Test A", $names), "Should include Filter Test A");
        $this->assertTrue(in_array("Filter Test B", $names), "Should include Filter Test B");
    }
}

```

Run it:

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

```

ProductTest
[PASS] test_create_product
[PASS] test_load_product
[PASS] test_update_product
[PASS] test_delete_product
[PASS] test_select_with_filter

```

```
5 tests, 5 passed, 0 failed (0.18s)
```


Test Database

By default, **tina4 test** uses a separate test database so your development data is not affected. The test database is created at **data/test.db** (SQLite) and is reset before each test run. If you want to use a different database for tests, set it in **.env**:

```
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/test.db
```

5. Testing Routes

Tina4 provides a test client for HTTP requests to your routes. No server needed.

Create **tests/RouteTest.php**:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class RouteTest extends Test
{
    public function testHealthEndpoint()
    {
        $response = $this->get("/health");

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Health check should return 200");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertEqual($body["status"], "ok", "Status should be 'ok'");
        $this->assertNotNull($body["version"], "Should include version");
    }

    public function testGetProducts()
    {
        $response = $this->get("/api/products");

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Should return 200");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertTrue(isset($body["data"]) || isset($body["products"]), "Should contain prod");
    }

    public function testCreateProduct()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/products", [
            "name" => "Route Test Product",
            "category" => "Testing",
            "price" => 42.00
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 201, "Should return 201 Created");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertEqual($body["name"], "Route Test Product", "Name should match");
        $this->assertEqual($body["price"], 42.00, "Price should match");
    }

    public function testGetProductNotFound()
```

```

{
    $response = $this->get("/api/products/99999");

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 404, "Should return 404 for missing product");
}

public function testCreateProductValidation()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/products", []);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 400, "Should return 400 for empty body");
}

public function testDeleteProduct()
{
    // Create a product first
    $createResponse = $this->post("/api/products", [
        "name" => "To Be Deleted",
        "price" => 1.00
    ]);
    $body = json_decode($createResponse->body, true);
    $id = $body["id"];

    // Delete it
    $deleteResponse = $this->delete("/api/products/" . $id);
    $this->assertEqual($deleteResponse->statusCode, 204, "Should return 204 No Content");

    // Verify it is gone
    $getResponse = $this->get("/api/products/" . $id);
    $this->assertEqual($getResponse->statusCode, 404, "Should return 404 after deletion");
}
}

```

Test Client Methods

The test client provides methods for all HTTP verbs:

```

// GET request
$response = $this->get("/api/products");

// GET with query parameters
$response = $this->get("/api/products?category=Electronics&page=2");

// POST with JSON body
$response = $this->post("/api/products", ["name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99]);

// PUT with JSON body
$response = $this->put("/api/products/1", ["name" => "Updated Widget"]);

// PATCH with JSON body
$response = $this->patch("/api/products/1", ["price" => 12.99]);

// DELETE
$response = $this->delete("/api/products/1");

// Request with custom headers
$response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
    "Authorization" => "Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIs..."
]);

```

Response Object

The response object has these properties:

```
$response->statusCode; // HTTP status code (200, 201, 404, etc.)
$response->body;       // Response body as a string
$response->headers;    // Response headers as an associative array
$response->contentType; // Content-Type header value
```

6. Testing Authentication

Create `tests/AuthTest.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class AuthTest extends Test
{
    private ?string $token = null;

    public function testLoginWithValidCredentials()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
            "email" => "admin@example.com",
            "password" => "correct-password"
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Login should succeed");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertNotNull($body["token"], "Should return a JWT token");
        $this->assertTrue(strlen($body["token"]) > 50, "Token should be a substantial string");

        $this->token = $body["token"];
    }

    public function testLoginWithInvalidPassword()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
            "email" => "admin@example.com",
            "password" => "wrong-password"
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Should reject invalid password");
    }

    public function testLoginWithMissingFields()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
            "email" => "admin@example.com"
        ]);

        $this->assertTrue(
            $response->statusCode === 400 || $response->statusCode === 401,
            "Should reject missing password"
        );
    }
}
```

```

public function testProtectedRouteWithoutToken()
{
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile");

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Should reject unauthenticated request");
}

public function testProtectedRouteWithValidToken()
{
    // Login first to get a token
    $loginResponse = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
        "email" => "admin@example.com",
        "password" => "correct-password"
    ]);
    $loginBody = json_decode($loginResponse->body, true);
    $token = $loginBody["token"];

    // Access protected route with token
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $token
    ]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Should allow authenticated request");

    $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
    $this->assertEqual($body["user"]["email"], "admin@example.com", "Should return user data");
}

public function testProtectedRouteWithInvalidToken()
{
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer invalid.token.here"
    ]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Should reject invalid token");
}
}
}
---

```

7. Setup and Teardown

Use `setUp()` and `tearDown()` methods to run code before and after each test:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class UserTest extends Test
{
    private ?int $userId = null;

    public function setUp(): void
    {
        // Runs before each test
        $user = new User();
        $user->name = "Test User";
        $user->email = "test-" . time() . "@example.com";
        $user->save();
        $this->userId = $user->id;
    }
}

```

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```

    }

    public function tearDown(): void
    {
        // Runs after each test
        if ($this->userId) {
            $user = new User();
            $user->load($this->userId);
            if (!empty($user->id)) {
                $user->delete();
            }
        }
    }

    public function testUserExists()
    {
        $user = new User();
        $user->load($this->userId);
        $this->assertNotNull($user->id, "User should exist");
        $this->assertEqual($user->name, "Test User", "Name should match");
    }

    public function testUpdateUser()
    {
        $user = new User();
        $user->load($this->userId);
        $user->name = "Updated Name";
        $user->save();

        $reloaded = new User();
        $reloaded->load($this->userId);
        $this->assertEqual($reloaded->name, "Updated Name", "Name should be updated");
    }
}

```

`setUp()` runs before every test method. `tearDown()` runs after every test method. Pass or fail, the cleanup runs. Each test starts with a clean state.

8. Running Tests

Run All Tests

```
tina4 test
```

Run a Specific Test File

```
tina4 test --file tests/ProductTest.php
```

Run a Specific Test Method

```
tina4 test --file tests/ProductTest.php --method testCreateProduct
```

Verbose Output

```
tina4 test --verbose
```

```
Running tests...
```

```

ProductTest
[PASS] test_create_product (0.03s)
    assertEquals: Product should have an ID after save
    assertTrue: Product ID should be positive
[PASS] test_load_product (0.02s)
    assertEquals: Name should match
    assertEquals: Category should match
    assertEquals: Price should match
    assertTrue: Should be in stock by default
[PASS] test_update_product (0.04s)
    assertEquals: Name should be updated
    assertEquals: Price should be updated
[PASS] test_delete_product (0.02s)
    assertTrue: Deleted product should not be loadable
[PASS] test_select_with_filter (0.05s)
    assertTrue: Should find at least 2 FilterCat products
    assertTrue: Should include Filter Test A
    assertTrue: Should include Filter Test B

5 tests, 5 passed, 0 failed (0.16s)

```

Verbose mode shows each assertion within each test, along with timing information.

Failed Test Output

When a test fails, you see exactly what went wrong:

```

ProductTest
[PASS] test_create_product
[FAIL] test_load_product
    assertEquals FAILED: Name should match
        Expected: "Load Test Widget"
        Actual:   "Wrong Name"
        File: tests/ProductTest.php:34
[PASS] test_update_product

3 tests, 2 passed, 1 failed (0.12s)

```

The failure message shows the assertion that failed, what was expected, what was actually received, and the file and line number.

9. PHPUnit Integration

If your team already uses PHPUnit, Tina4 tests can run alongside it. Install PHPUnit via Composer:

```
composer require --dev phpunit/phpunit
```

Create **phpunit.xml** at the project root:

```

<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<phpunit bootstrap="vendor/autoload.php"
    colors="true"
    stopOnFailure="false">
    <testsuites>
        <testsuite name="Application">
            <directory>tests</directory>

```

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```

        </testsuite>
    </testsuites>
</phpunit>

```

Tina4's **Test** class is compatible with PHPUnit. Your test files work with both **tina4 test** and **vendor/bin/phpunit** without modification.

```
vendor/bin/phpunit
```

```
PHPUnit 10.5.0 by Sebastian Bergmann and contributors.
```

```
.....
```

```
5 / 5 (100%)
```

```
Time: 00:00.340, Memory: 8.00 MB
```

```
OK (5 tests, 12 assertions)
```

Code Coverage

With PHPUnit, you can generate code coverage reports:

```
vendor/bin/phpunit --coverage-text
```

```
Code Coverage Report:
```

```
Summary:
```

```
Classes: 60.00% (3/5)
```

```
Methods: 75.00% (15/20)
```

```
Lines: 82.14% (115/140)
```

```
Product
```

```
Methods: 100.00% ( 5/ 5) Lines: 100.00% ( 28/ 28)
```

```
User
```

```
Methods: 66.67% ( 4/ 6) Lines: 78.95% ( 30/ 38)
```

For HTML coverage reports:

```
vendor/bin/phpunit --coverage-html coverage/
```

Open **coverage/index.html** in your browser to see a visual breakdown of which lines are covered by tests.

Note: Code coverage requires the Xdebug or PCOV extension. Install one of them:

```
# Xdebug
```

```
pecl install xdebug
```

```
# PCOV (faster for coverage only)
```

```
pecl install pcov
```

```
---
```

10. Testing Best Practices

Test One Thing Per Test

Each test method verifies one behavior. When it fails, you know what broke.

```
// Good: each test verifies one thing
public function testCreateProductReturns201()
{
    _____
}
```

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```

        $response = $this->post("/api/products", ["name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99]);
        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 201, "Should return 201");
    }

    public function testCreateProductReturnsCreatedProduct()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/products", ["name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99]);
        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertEqual($body["name"], "Widget", "Should return the product name");
    }

    // Avoid: testing multiple unrelated things
    public function testEverything()
    {
        // Creates, reads, updates, deletes, checks auth, validates input...
        // When this fails, you don't know which part broke
    }

```

Use Descriptive Assertion Messages

```

// Good: tells you what went wrong
$this->assertEqual($user->name, "Alice", "User name should be 'Alice' after creation");

// Bad: unhelpful when it fails
$this->assertEqual($user->name, "Alice", "Failed");

```

Isolate Tests

Each test creates its own data and cleans up after itself. Never depend on data from another test or from the development database.

```

// Good: creates its own data
public function testDeleteProduct()
{
    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = "Temporary";
    $product->price = 1.00;
    $product->save();

    $product->delete();

    $check = new Product();
    $check->load($product->id);
    $this->assertTrue(empty($check->id), "Product should be deleted");
}

// Bad: depends on data from another test or the dev database
public function testDeleteProduct()
{
    $product = new Product();
    $product->load(1); // Assumes product with ID 1 exists
    $product->delete();
}
---

```

11. Exercise: Test a User Model and Authentication Flow

Write a complete test suite for a ~~User model and authentication system.~~

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Requirements

Create `tests/UserModelTest.php` with these tests:

- **testCreateUser** -- Create a user with name, email. Verify the user gets an ID and all fields are correct.
- **testDuplicateEmail** -- Try to create two users with the same email. Verify the second one raises an exception or returns an error.
- **testUpdateUser** -- Create a user, update their name, reload and verify.
- **testDeleteUser** -- Create a user, delete them, verify they cannot be loaded.
- **testSelectUsers** -- Create 3 users, query all, verify count is at least 3.

Create `tests/AuthFlowTest.php` with these tests:

- **testRegisterNewUser** -- POST to `/api/auth/register` with name, email, password. Verify 201 status.
- **testRegisterDuplicateEmail** -- Register the same email twice. Verify the second returns 409 Conflict.
- **testLoginSuccess** -- Login with correct credentials. Verify you get a JWT token.
- **testLoginFailure** -- Login with wrong password. Verify 401 status.
- **testAccessProtectedRoute** -- Use the token from login to access `/api/profile`. Verify 200 status and correct user data.
- **testAccessWithExpiredToken** -- Use a manually crafted expired token. Verify 401 status.

Expected output:

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

```
UserModelTest
```

```
[PASS] test_create_user
[PASS] test_duplicate_email
[PASS] test_update_user
[PASS] test_delete_user
[PASS] test_select_users
```

```
AuthFlowTest
```

```
[PASS] test_register_new_user
[PASS] test_register_duplicate_email
[PASS] test_login_success
[PASS] test_login_failure
[PASS] test_access_protected_route
[PASS] test_access_with_expired_token
```

```
11 tests, 11 passed, 0 failed (0.52s)
```

```
---
```

12. Solution

tests/UserModelTest.php

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class UserModelTest extends Test
{
    public function testCreateUser()
    {
        $user = new User();
        $user->name = "Test User";
        $user->email = "testuser-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
        $user->save();

        $this->assertNotNull($user->id, "User should have an ID after save");
        $this->assertEqual($user->name, "Test User", "Name should match");
        $this->assertTrue(str_contains($user->email, "@example.com"), "Email should be set");
    }

    public function testDuplicateEmail()
    {
        $email = "duplicate-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";

        $user1 = new User();
        $user1->name = "First User";
        $user1->email = $email;
        $user1->save();

        $this->assertRaises(function () use ($email) {
            $user2 = new User();
            $user2->name = "Second User";
            $user2->email = $email;
            $user2->save();
        }, \Exception::class, "Should reject duplicate email");
    }

    public function testUpdateUser()
    {
        $user = new User();
        $user->name = "Original Name";
        $user->email = "update-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
        $user->save();

        $id = $user->id;
        $user->name = "New Name";
        $user->save();

        $reloaded = new User();
        $reloaded->load($id);
        $this->assertEqual($reloaded->name, "New Name", "Name should be updated");
    }

    public function testDeleteUser()
    {
        $user = new User();
        $user->name = "Delete Me";
        $user->email = "delete-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
    }
}
```

```

        $user->save();

        $id = $user->id;
        $user->delete();

        $gone = new User();
        $gone->load($id);
        $this->assertTrue(empty($gone->id), "Deleted user should not exist");
    }

    public function testSelectUsers()
    {
        for ($i = 0; $i < 3; $i++) {
            $user = new User();
            $user->name = "Select Test User " . $i;
            $user->email = "select-test-" . $i . "-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
            $user->save();
        }

        $user = new User();
        $results = $user->select("*");

        $this->assertTrue(count($results) >= 3, "Should have at least 3 users");
    }
}

```

tests/AuthFlowTest.php

```
<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class AuthFlowTest extends Test
{
    private string $testEmail;
    private string $testPassword = "SecurePassword123!";

    public function setUp(): void
    {
        $this->testEmail = "auth-test-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
    }

    public function testRegisterNewUser()
    {
        $response = $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
            "name" => "Auth Test User",
            "email" => $this->testEmail,
            "password" => $this->testPassword
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 201, "Registration should return 201");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertEqual($body["name"], "Auth Test User", "Should return user name");
        $this->assertNotNull($body["id"], "Should return user ID");
    }

    public function testRegisterDuplicateEmail()
    {
        $email = "dup-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";

        // Register first time
        $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
            "name" => "First",
            "email" => $email,
            "password" => $this->testPassword
        ]);

        // Register again with same email
        $response = $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
            "name" => "Second",
            "email" => $email,
            "password" => $this->testPassword
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 409, "Duplicate email should return 409");
    }

    public function testLoginSuccess()
    {
        $email = "login-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";

        // Register
        $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
            "name" => "Login User",
            "email" => $email,
```

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```

        "password" => $this->testPassword
    ]]);

    // Login
    $response = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
        "email" => $email,
        "password" => $this->testPassword
    ]]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Login should return 200");

    $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
    $this->assertNotNull($body["token"], "Should return a token");
}

public function testLoginFailure()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
        "email" => "nobody@example.com",
        "password" => "wrong"
    ]]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Invalid login should return 401");
}

public function testAccessProtectedRoute()
{
    $email = "profile-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";

    // Register and login
    $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
        "name" => "Profile User",
        "email" => $email,
        "password" => $this->testPassword
    ]]);

    $loginResponse = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
        "email" => $email,
        "password" => $this->testPassword
    ]]);

    $token = json_decode($loginResponse->body, true)["token"];

    // Access protected route
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $token
    ]]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Should allow access with valid token");

    $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
    $this->assertEqual($body["user"]["email"], $email, "Should return correct user");
}

public function testAccessWithExpiredToken()
{
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer expired.invalid.token"
    ]]);

```

```

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Should reject invalid token");
    }
}
---

```

13. Gotchas

1. Tests Run in Order

Problem: Test B depends on data created in Test A, but sometimes Test B fails.

Cause: While tests within a class run in the order they are defined, test classes may run in any order. If Test B depends on Test A being in a different class, this is fragile.

Fix: Each test should create its own data. Never depend on another test's side effects. Use `setUp()` to create the data each test needs.

2. Test Database vs Development Database

Problem: Running tests deletes your development data.

Cause: Tests are running against the same database as your development server.

Fix: Tina4 uses a separate test database by default (`data/test.db`). If your tests are modifying development data, check that `TINA4_DATABASE_URL` is set correctly in `.env`, or that you are running `tina4 test` (not executing test files manually).

3. Unique Constraint Failures

Problem: Tests fail with "UNIQUE constraint failed" on the email field.

Cause: Previous test runs left data in the test database, or two tests create records with the same email.

Fix: Use `uniqid()` or `time()` to generate unique values in tests:

```
$user->email = "test-" . uniqid() . "@example.com";
```

4. Test Method Not Discovered

Problem: You wrote a test method but it does not appear in the output.

Cause: The method name does not start with `test`. Tina4 only runs methods that begin with `test` (case-sensitive).

Fix: Rename the method to start with `test`: `testCreateProduct`, `testLoginFailure`, etc.

5. Assertion Arguments Reversed

Problem: The failure message shows "Expected: 404, Actual: 200" but that seems backward.

Cause: You passed the arguments in the wrong order. `assertEqual($actual, $expected)` -- actual comes first, expected comes second.

Fix: Follow the convention: `$this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "message")`. The first argument is what you got, the second is what you expected.

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6. Cannot Test Routes That Require Authentication Setup

Problem: Tests for protected routes fail because the authentication middleware expects a database table or JWT secret that does not exist in the test environment.

Cause: The test database is empty -- it does not have the users table or the JWT secret is not configured.

Fix: Use `setUp()` to create the necessary data:

```
public function setUp(): void
{
    // Create the users table if it does not exist
    $user = new User();
    $user->createTable();

    // Create a test user
    $user->name = "Test Admin";
    $user->email = "admin@test.com";
    $user->passwordHash = password_hash("password", PASSWORD_DEFAULT);
    $user->save();
}
```

7. Tests Pass Locally but Fail in CI

Problem: All tests pass on your machine but fail in continuous integration.

Cause: The CI environment may have a different PHP version, missing extensions, or different filesystem permissions. Also, tests that depend on time or random values can be flaky.

Fix: Make tests deterministic. Avoid relying on the current time, filesystem state, or external services. If you must test time-dependent behavior, mock the clock or use fixed timestamps. Check that your CI environment matches your local PHP version and has all required extensions.

Scaffolding

One command. Six files. A working CRUD feature with routes, templates, tests, and Swagger docs -- ready to run.

That is Tina4's scaffolding system. It generates the boilerplate you write by hand in every project: models, migrations, routes, forms, views, and tests. You describe what you want. The generators produce it.

The CRUD Generator

This is the generator most developers reach for first. It creates everything a feature needs in one shot.

```
tina4php generate crud Product --fields "name:string,price:float"
```

That single command creates six files:

#	File	Purpose
1	<code>src/orm/Product.php</code>	ORM model with typed fields
2	<code>migrations/20260401_create_product.sql</code>	UP migration (CREATE TABLE)
3	<code>migrations/20260401_create_product.down.sql</code>	DOWN migration (DROP TABLE)
4	<code>src/routes/products.php</code>	CRUD routes with Swagger annotations
5	<code>src/templates/products/form.html</code>	Form template with typed inputs and <code>form_token</code>
6	<code>src/templates/products/view.html</code>	List and detail templates
7	<code>tests/ProductTest.php</code>	PHPUnit stubs for all CRUD operations

What Each File Contains

The **model** maps the `product` table to a PHP class:

```
<?php

use Tina4\ORM;

class Product extends ORM
{
```

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```

        public string $tableName = "product";
        public ?int $id = null;
        public ?string $name = null;
        public ?float $price = null;
        public ?string $createdAt = null;
        public ?string $updatedAt = null;
    }

```

The **migration** creates the table:

```

-- migrations/20260401_create_product.sql
CREATE TABLE product (
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    name VARCHAR(255),
    price FLOAT,
    created_at DATETIME DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
    updated_at DATETIME DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

```

The **down migration** reverses it:

```

-- migrations/20260401_create_product.down.sql
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS product;

```

The **routes** file wires up five endpoints with Swagger docs:

```

<?php

use Tina4\Get;
use Tina4\Post;
use Tina4\Put;
use Tina4>Delete;

Get::add("/api/products", function ($response, $request) {
    $products = (new Product())->select();
    return $response($products);
})->description("List all products");

Get::add("/api/products/{id}", function ($response, $request) {
    $product = new Product();
    $product->id = $request->params["id"];
    $product->load();
    return $response($product);
})->description("Get a product by ID");

Post::add("/api/products", function ($response, $request) {
    $product = new Product($request->body);
    $product->save();
    return $response($product, 201);
})->description("Create a product");

Put::add("/api/products/{id}", function ($response, $request) {
    $product = new Product($request->body);
    $product->id = $request->params["id"];
    $product->save();
    return $response($product);
})->description("Update a product");

Delete::add("/api/products/{id}", function ($response, $request) {
    $product = new Product();

```

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```

        $product->id = $request->params["id"];
        $product->delete();
        return $response(null, 204);
    })->description("Delete a product");

```

The **form template** renders typed inputs with CSRF protection:

```

<form method="POST" action="/api/products">
    <input type="hidden" name="form_token" value="{{ form_token }}">
    <label>Name</label>
    <input type="text" name="name" required>
    <label>Price</label>
    <input type="number" step="0.01" name="price" required>
    <button type="submit">Save</button>
</form>

```

The **test file** stubs out CRUD assertions:

```

<?php

```

```

use PHPUnit\Framework\TestCase;
use Tina4\App;

```

```

class ProductTest extends TestCase
{

```

```

    private $client;

```

```

    protected function setUp(): void
    {

```

```

        $app = new App();
        $this->client = $app->testClient();
    }

```

```

    public function testCreateProduct(): void
    {

```

```

        $response = $this->client->post("/api/products", ["name" => "Widget", "price" => 9.99]);
        $this->assertEquals(201, $response->statusCode);
    }

```

```

    public function testListProducts(): void
    {

```

```

        $response = $this->client->get("/api/products");
        $this->assertEquals(200, $response->statusCode);
    }

```

```

    public function testGetProduct(): void
    {

```

```

        $response = $this->client->get("/api/products/1");
        $this->assertEquals(200, $response->statusCode);
    }

```

```

    public function testUpdateProduct(): void
    {

```

```

        $response = $this->client->put("/api/products/1", ["name" => "Updated Widget"]);
        $this->assertEquals(200, $response->statusCode);
    }

```

```

    public function testDeleteProduct(): void
    {

```

```

        $response = $this->client->delete("/api/products/1");

```

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```

        $this->assertEquals(204, $response->statusCode);
    }
}

```

Run It

After generating, run the migration and start the server:

```

tina4php migrate
tina4php serve

```

Open Swagger UI at <http://localhost:7145/swagger> and test every endpoint. The scaffolded code works out of the box.

Individual Generators

The CRUD generator calls several smaller generators under the hood. You can call each one directly when you need a single piece.

Model

```

tina4php generate model Product --fields "name:string,price:float"

```

Creates three files: the ORM model ([src/orm/Product.php](#)), the UP migration, and the DOWN migration. No routes, no templates, no tests.

Route

```

tina4php generate route products --model Product

```

Creates one file: [src/routes/products.php](#) with CRUD endpoints and Swagger annotations. The model must exist first.

Migration

```

tina4php generate migration add_category_to_product

```

Creates two files: [migrations/20260401_add_category_to_product.sql](#) and [migrations/20260401_add_category_to_product.down.sql](#). Both are empty stubs. You write the SQL.

Middleware

```

tina4php generate middleware AuthLog

```

Creates one file with before and after stubs:

```

<?php

use Tina4\Middleware;

Middleware::add("AuthLogBefore", function ($request) {
    echo "Request: {$request->method} {$request->url}\n";
    return $request;
}, true); // before

Middleware::add("AuthLogAfter", function ($request, $response) {
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```

```
        echo "Response: {$response->statusCode}\n";
        return $response;
    }, false); // after
```

Test

```
tina4php generate test products --model Product
```

Creates one file: `tests/ProductTest.php` with PHPUnit CRUD stubs.

Form

```
tina4php generate form Product --fields "name:string,price:float"
```

Creates one file: `src/templates/products/form.html` with typed inputs and `form_token`.

View

```
tina4php generate view Product --fields "name:string,price:float"
```

Creates two templates: a list view and a detail view in `src/templates/products/`.

CRUD

```
tina4php generate crud Product --fields "name:string,price:float"
```

Shorthand for running all generators at once: model, migration, route, form, view, and test.

Auth

```
tina4php generate auth
```

Generates the full authentication scaffold: User model, migrations, login/register/logout routes, templates, and tests.

AutoCRUD

AutoCRUD automatically generates REST API endpoints from your ORM models:

- `GET /api/{table}` — List with pagination (`?limit=10&offset=0`)
- `GET /api/{table}/{id}` — Get single record
- `POST /api/{table}` — Create record
- `PUT /api/{table}/{id}` — Update record
- `DELETE /api/{table}/{id}` — Delete record

Usage

```
$crud = new AutoCrud($db, '/api');
$crud->register(User::class);
$crud->generateRoutes();
```

`AutoCrud::register()` wires up a single model class. `generateRoutes()` mounts the five standard endpoints automatically — no route files needed.

The Auth Generator

Authentication needs more than one file. The auth generator creates seven:

```
tina4php generate auth
```

#	File	Purpose
1	src/orm/User.php	User model with hashed password field
2	migrations/20260401_create_user.sql	UP migration
3	migrations/20260401_create_user.down.sql	DOWN migration
4	src/routes/auth.php	Login, register, logout routes
5	src/templates/auth/login.html	Login form
6	src/templates/auth/register.html	Registration form
7	tests/AuthTest.php	Auth flow tests

The generated routes handle password hashing, JWT token creation, and session management. The templates include CSRF tokens. The tests cover registration, login, invalid credentials, and logout.

Run the migration, start the server, and you have working auth:

```
tina4php migrate
tina4php serve
```

Field Types

Generators accept these field types. Each type maps to a specific column type in migrations, input type in forms, and display format in views.

Field Type	Migration Column	Form Input	View Display
string	VARCHAR(255)	<input type="text">	Plain text
int	INTEGER	<input type="number">	Number
float	FLOAT	<input type="number" step="0.01">	Decimal

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bool	BOOLEAN	<input type="checkbox">	Yes / No
text	TEXT	<textarea>	Paragraph
datetime	DATETIME	<input type="datetime-local">	Formatted date
blob	BLOB	<input type="file">	Download link

Table Naming Convention

Tina4 uses singular table names. The model name `Product` maps to the table `product`. The model name `OrderItem` maps to `order_item`. The generator handles the conversion.

Combining Generators

Sometimes you want a model with routes but no form. Or a model with a migration but no test. The `--with` flags let you compose:

```
tina4php generate model Product --fields "name:string,price:float" --with-route --with-migration
```

Available flags:

Flag	Adds
<code>--with-route</code>	CRUD route file
<code>--with-migration</code>	Migration files (included by default with model)
<code>--with-test</code>	Test file
<code>--with-form</code>	Form template
<code>--with-view</code>	View templates

The `generate crud` command is equivalent to using all `--with` flags at once.

Exercise: Scaffold a Blog

Build a blog with three resources using generators.

Step 1: Generate the auth system.

```
tina4php generate auth
```

Step 2: Scaffold the Post resource.

```
tina4php generate crud Post --fields "title:string,body:text,published:bool"
```

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Step 3: Scaffold the Category resource.

```
tina4php generate crud Category --fields "name:string,description:text"
```

Step 4: Add a migration to link posts to categories.

```
tina4php generate migration add_category_id_to_post
```

Edit the migration to add the foreign key:

```
ALTER TABLE post ADD COLUMN category_id INTEGER REFERENCES category(id);
```

Step 5: Run all migrations and start the server.

```
tina4php migrate  
tina4php serve
```

You now have a working blog with authentication, posts, categories, and Swagger documentation. Total commands: five. Total hand-written SQL: one line.

Gotchas

Generators Do Not Overwrite

If a file exists, the generator skips it and prints a warning. This protects your edits. To regenerate, delete the file first.

Run Migrate After Generate

The model generator creates migration files. Those files do nothing until you run `tina4php migrate`. Generate and migrate are separate steps by design.

File Naming Matters

The generator derives file names from the model name. `Product` becomes `Product.php` for the model and `products.php` for routes. Do not rename generated files unless you update all imports.

Field Changes Need New Migrations

Changing `--fields` and re-running the generator does not update existing migrations. Create a new migration with `generate migration` and write the ALTER TABLE by hand.

Singular Table Names

Tina4 uses singular table names: `product`, not `products`. The route paths use plural (`/api/products`), but the table stays singular. The generator handles this split.

API Documentation with Swagger

1. The 47-Endpoint Problem

Your team ships 47 API endpoints. The frontend developer asks what each one accepts. You email a spreadsheet. It goes stale in a week. You write a wiki page. Nobody updates it. You add code comments. Nobody reads them.

Swagger solves this for good. It generates interactive API documentation from annotations in your route files. The docs stay current because they live in the code. Your frontend developer browses every endpoint, sees request and response shapes, and tests calls from the browser.

Tina4 auto-generates a Swagger UI at `/swagger` from doc-block annotations. No build step. No extra tooling. Write the annotations. The documentation appears.

2. What Swagger/OpenAPI Is

OpenAPI is a specification for describing REST APIs. Swagger is the toolset that reads OpenAPI specs and produces documentation, client SDKs, and server stubs.

An OpenAPI spec describes:

- Every endpoint (path + HTTP method)
- Parameters (path, query, header, body)
- Responses (status codes, body schemas)
- Data schemas (what a "User" or "Product" looks like)
- Authentication requirements
- Grouping and tagging

Tina4 builds this spec from doc-block comments in your PHP. No JSON or YAML by hand.

3. Enabling Swagger

Available out of the box when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. Navigate to:

`http://localhost:7145/swagger`

The Swagger UI appears with all defined routes. No annotations yet means default descriptions.

For production, control it explicitly:

`TINA4_SWAGGER_ENABLED=true`

The Swagger JSON Endpoint

Raw OpenAPI spec:

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```
http://localhost:7145/swagger/openapi.json
curl http://localhost:7145/swagger/openapi.json
```

```
{
  "openapi": "3.0.3",
  "info": {
    "title": "My Store API",
    "version": "1.0.0"
  },
  "paths": {
    "/api/products": {
      "get": {
        "summary": "List all products",
        "responses": {
          "200": {
            "description": "Successful response"
          }
        }
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Import this JSON into Postman, Insomnia, or use it to generate client SDKs.

4. Adding Descriptions to Routes

Doc-block comments above route definitions:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * List all products
 * @description Returns a paginated list of all products in the catalog
 * @tags Products
 */
Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["products" => []]);
});
```

First line becomes the **summary**. **@description** provides detail. **@tags** groups the endpoint.

Documenting Path Parameters

```
/**
 * Get a product by ID
 * @description Returns a single product with full details including inventory status
 * @tags Products
 * @param int $id The unique product identifier
 */
Router::get("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => "Wireless Keyboard",
        "price" => 79.99
    ]);
});
```

@param tells Swagger about the path parameter. Shows as a required field with type information.

Documenting Query Parameters

```
/**
 * Search products
 * @description Search the product catalog by name, category, or price range
 * @tags Products
 * @query string $q Search query (searches product name and description)
 * @query string $category Filter by category name
 * @query float $min_price Minimum price filter
 * @query float $max_price Maximum price filter
 * @query int $page Page number (default: 1)
 * @query int $limit Items per page (default: 20, max: 100)
 */
Router::get("/api/products/search", function ($request, $response) {
    $q = $request->query["q"] ?? "";
    $page = (int) ($request->query["page"] ?? 1);
    $limit = min((int) ($request->query["limit"] ?? 20), 100);

    return $response->json([
        "query" => $q,
        "page" => $page,
        "limit" => $limit,
        "results" => [],
        "total" => 0
    ]);
});
```

Each **@query** adds a parameter to the docs with type and description.

5. Documenting Request and Response Schemas

Request Body

```
/**
 * Create a new product
 * @description Creates a product in the catalog. Requires admin authentication.
 * @tags Products
 * @body {"name": "string", "category": "string", "price": "float", "in_stock": "bool", "description": "string"}
 * @response 201 {"id": "int", "name": "string", "category": "string", "price": "float", "in_stock": "bool"}
 * @response 400 {"error": "string"}
 */
Router::post("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body();

    if (empty($body["name"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Name is required"], 400);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => 1,
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "category" => $body["category"] ?? "Uncategorized",
        "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 0),
        "in_stock" => (bool) ($body["in_stock"] ?? true),
        "created_at" => date("c")
    ], 201);
});
```

@body describes the expected JSON. **@response** documents each status code and its payload.

Multiple Response Codes

```
/**
 * Update a product
 * @description Update an existing product by ID. Only provided fields are updated.
 * @tags Products
 * @param int $id Product ID
 * @body {"name": "string", "category": "string", "price": "float", "in_stock": "bool"}
 * @response 200 {"id": "int", "name": "string", "category": "string", "price": "float", "in_stock": "bool"}
 * @response 404 {"error": "string", "id": "int"}
 * @response 400 {"error": "string"}
 */
Router::put("/api/products/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Product not found", "id" => $id], 404);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => $body["name"] ?? "Widget",
        "category" => $body["category"] ?? "General",
        "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 9.99),
        "in_stock" => (bool) ($body["in_stock"] ?? true),
        "updated_at" => date("c")
    ]);
});
```

Swagger UI shows each response code with its schema. A 200 versus a 404 at a glance.

6. Tags for Grouping Endpoints

Tags organize the Swagger UI. Without tags: one flat list. With tags: collapsible sections.

```
/**
 * List all users
 * @tags Users
 */
Router::get("/api/users", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["users" => []]);
});

/**
 * Get user by ID
 * @tags Users
 */
Router::get("/api/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["id" => $request->params["id"], "name" => "Alice"]);
});

/**
 * List all orders
 * @tags Orders
 */
Router::get("/api/orders", function ($request, $response) {
```

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```

        return $response->json(["orders" => []]);
    });

    /**
     * Create an order
     * @tags Orders
     */
    Router::post("/api/orders", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["order_id" => 1], 201);
    });

    /**
     * List all products
     * @tags Products
     */
    Router::get("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["products" => []]);
    });

```

Three sections in the UI: "Users", "Orders", "Products". Each expands to show its endpoints.

Multiple Tags

An endpoint in multiple groups:

```

    /**
     * Get user's orders
     * @tags Users, Orders
     */
    Router::get("/api/users/{id:int}/orders", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->json(["orders" => []]);
    });

```

Appears in both the "Users" and "Orders" sections.

7. Example Values

Realistic data instead of type names:

```

    /**
     * Create a new product
     * @description Creates a product in the catalog
     * @tags Products
     * @example request {"name": "Ergonomic Keyboard", "category": "Electronics", "price": 89.99, "in_stock": true}
     * @example response {"id": 42, "name": "Ergonomic Keyboard", "category": "Electronics", "price": 89.99, "in_stock": true, "created_at": "2023-01-01T00:00:00Z"}
     */
    Router::post("/api/products", function ($request, $response) {
        $body = $request->body;

        return $response->json([
            "id" => 42,
            "name" => $body["name"],
            "category" => $body["category"] ?? "Uncategorized",
            "price" => (float) ($body["price"] ?? 0),
            "in_stock" => (bool) ($body["in_stock"] ?? true),
            "created_at" => date("c")
        ], 201);
    });

```

```
});
```

The `@example` annotations populate the Swagger UI. When a developer clicks "Try it out", the example request is pre-filled.

8. Try-It-Out from the Swagger UI

Every endpoint has a "Try it out" button. Click it:

- Input fields expand
- Example values pre-fill (if provided)
- Edit parameters, headers, body
- The actual HTTP request fires against your running server
- Response appears: status, headers, body

A live testing tool inside your documentation. No Postman needed.

Authentication in Try-It-Out

Endpoints requiring auth show a lock icon. Click "Authorize" at the top of the Swagger UI. Enter your JWT or API key. All subsequent requests include the header.

Tina4 auto-detects auth requirements from `@secured` and `@noauth` annotations.

9. Customizing the Swagger Info Block

Configure in `.env`:

```
TINA4_SWAGGER_TITLE=My Store API
TINA4_SWAGGER_DESCRIPTION=API for managing products, orders, and users
TINA4_SWAGGER_VERSION=1.0.0
```

This appears in the Swagger UI header and the OpenAPI spec:

```
{
  "openapi": "3.0.3",
  "info": {
    "title": "My Store API",
    "description": "API for managing products, orders, and users",
    "version": "1.0.0",
    "contact": {
      "email": "api@mystore.com"
    },
    "license": {
      "name": "MIT"
    }
  }
}
```

10. Generating Client SDKs from the Spec

The OpenAPI spec at [/swagger/openapi.json](#) feeds code generation tools. Client libraries in any language.

Using OpenAPI Generator

```
npm install -g @openapitools/openapi-generator-cli
```

```
# TypeScript client
openapi-generator-cli generate \
  -i http://localhost:7145/swagger/openapi.json \
  -g typescript-fetch \
  -o ./frontend/api-client
```

```
# Python client
openapi-generator-cli generate \
  -i http://localhost:7145/swagger/openapi.json \
  -g python \
  -o ./python-client
```

The generated code is typed. IDE autocompletion works:

```
const api = new ProductsApi();

const product = await api.getProductById({ id: 42 });
console.log(product.name); // TypeScript knows this is a string

const newProduct = await api.createProduct({
  name: "Widget",
  category: "General",
  price: 9.99,
  inStock: true
});
```

Update annotations. Regenerate. Client stays in sync.

11. A Complete Documented API

All annotation features together:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * List all users
 * @description Returns a paginated list of users. Supports filtering by role and searching by name
 * @tags Users
 * @query int $page Page number (default: 1)
 * @query int $limit Items per page (default: 20)
 * @query string $role Filter by role (admin, user, moderator)
 * @query string $search Search by name or email
 * @response 200 {"users": [{"id": "int", "name": "string", "email": "string", "role": "string"}]}
 * @example response {"users": [{"id": 1, "name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "role": "user"}]}
 */
Router::get("/api/users", function ($request, $response) {
```

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```

$page = (int) ($request->query["page"] ?? 1);
$limit = (int) ($request->query["limit"] ?? 20);

return $response->json([
    "users" => [
        ["id" => 1, "name" => "Alice", "email" => "alice@example.com", "role" => "admin"],
        ["id" => 2, "name" => "Bob", "email" => "bob@example.com", "role" => "user"]
    ],
    "total" => 42,
    "page" => $page,
    "pages" => (int) ceil(42 / $limit)
]);
});

/**
 * Get user by ID
 * @description Returns full user profile including account creation date
 * @tags Users
 * @param int $id User ID
 * @response 200 {"id": "int", "name": "string", "email": "string", "role": "string", "created_at": "string"}
 * @response 404 {"error": "string"}
 * @example response {"id": 1, "name": "Alice", "email": "alice@example.com", "role": "admin", "created_at": "2026-01-15T10:30:00+00:00"}
 */
Router::get("/api/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => "Alice",
        "email" => "alice@example.com",
        "role" => "admin",
        "created_at" => "2026-01-15T10:30:00+00:00"
    ]);
});

/**
 * Create a new user
 * @description Creates a user account. Email must be unique.
 * @tags Users
 * @body {"name": "string", "email": "string", "password": "string", "role": "string"}
 * @response 201 {"id": "int", "name": "string", "email": "string", "role": "string", "created_at": "string"}
 * @response 400 {"errors": ["string"]}
 * @response 409 {"error": "string"}
 * @example request {"name": "Charlie", "email": "charlie@example.com", "password": "securePass123", "role": "user"}
 * @example response {"id": 3, "name": "Charlie", "email": "charlie@example.com", "role": "user", "created_at": "2026-01-15T10:30:00+00:00"}
 */
Router::post("/api/users", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    $errors = [];
    if (empty($body["name"])) $errors[] = "Name is required";
    if (empty($body["email"])) $errors[] = "Email is required";
    if (empty($body["password"])) $errors[] = "Password is required";

    if (!empty($errors)) {
        return $response->json($errors, 400);
    }

    // Create user logic here
    $id = 3;
    $name = "Charlie";
    $email = "charlie@example.com";
    $role = "user";
    $created_at = "2026-01-15T10:30:00+00:00";

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => $name,
        "email" => $email,
        "role" => $role,
        "created_at" => $created_at
    ], 201);
});

```



```

        return $response->json(["errors" => $errors], 400);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => 3,
        "name" => $body["name"],
        "email" => $body["email"],
        "role" => $body["role"] ?? "user",
        "created_at" => date("c")
    ], 201);
});

/**
 * Delete a user
 * @description Permanently deletes a user account. Requires admin role.
 * @tags Users
 * @param int $id User ID
 * @response 204
 * @response 404 {"error": "string"}
 */
Router::delete("/api/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json(null, 204);
});

```

Visit [/swagger](#). Four endpoints under "Users". Full parameter documentation, examples, multiple response codes.

12. Exercise: Document a Complete User API

Extend the User API with three more endpoints. Full Swagger annotations on each.

Requirements

Method	Path	Description
PUT	/api/users/{id}	Update a user. Body: name, email, role. Response: updated user.
GET	/api/users/{id}/orders	List a user's orders. Query: status filter, pagination.
POST	/api/users/{id}/avatar	Upload user avatar. Body: avatar_url string.

Each endpoint needs:

- Summary (first line)

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- `@description`
- `@tags`
- `@param` for path parameters
- `@query` for query parameters (where applicable)
- `@body` for request body (where applicable)
- `@response` for each status code
- `@example` for request and response (where applicable)

Verify at:

`http://localhost:7145/swagger`

13. Solution

Create `src/routes/user-api-documented.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * Update a user
 * @description Updates an existing user's profile information. Only provided fields are updated
 * @tags Users
 * @param int $id User ID
 * @body {"name": "string", "email": "string", "role": "string"}
 * @response 200 {"id": "int", "name": "string", "email": "string", "role": "string", "updated_at": "string"}
 * @response 404 {"error": "string"}
 * @response 409 {"error": "string"}
 * @example request {"name": "Alice Smith", "email": "alice.smith@example.com", "role": "admin"}
 * @example response {"id": 1, "name": "Alice Smith", "email": "alice.smith@example.com", "role": "admin"}
 */
Router::put("/api/users/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "name" => $body["name"] ?? "Alice",
        "email" => $body["email"] ?? "alice@example.com",
        "role" => $body["role"] ?? "user",
        "updated_at" => date("c")
    ]);
});

/**
 * List user orders
 * @description Returns a paginated list of orders for a specific user. Supports filtering by order status
 * @tags Users, Orders
```

```

* @param int $id User ID
* @query string $status Filter by order status (pending, processing, shipped, delivered, cancel
* @query int $page Page number (default: 1)
* @query int $limit Items per page (default: 20)
* @response 200 {"orders": [{"id": "int", "product": "string", "quantity": "int", "total": "flo
* @response 404 {"error": "string"}
* @example response {"orders": [{"id": 101, "product": "Wireless Keyboard", "quantity": 2, "tot
*/
Router::get("/api/users/{id:int}/orders", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $status = $request->query["status"] ?? null;
    $page = (int) ($request->query["page"] ?? 1);

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    $orders = [
        ["id" => 101, "product" => "Wireless Keyboard", "quantity" => 2, "total" => 159.98, "sta
        ["id" => 102, "product" => "USB-C Hub", "quantity" => 1, "total" => 49.99, "status" => "
    ];

    if ($status !== null) {
        $orders = array_values(array_filter($orders, fn($o) => $o["status"] === $status));
    }

    return $response->json(["orders" => $orders, "total" => count($orders), "page" => $page]);
});

/**
* Upload user avatar
* @description Sets or updates the avatar URL for a user. The avatar should be hosted on a CDN
* @tags Users
* @param int $id User ID
* @body {"avatar_url": "string"}
* @response 200 {"id": "int", "avatar_url": "string", "updated_at": "string"}
* @response 400 {"error": "string"}
* @response 404 {"error": "string"}
* @example request {"avatar_url": "https://cdn.example.com/avatars/alice-2026.jpg"}
* @example response {"id": 1, "avatar_url": "https://cdn.example.com/avatars/alice-2026.jpg", "
*/
Router::post("/api/users/{id:int}/avatar", function ($request, $response) {
    $id = $request->params["id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    if ($id > 100) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    if (empty($body["avatar_url"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "avatar_url is required"], 400);
    }

    return $response->json([
        "id" => $id,
        "avatar_url" => $body["avatar_url"],
        "updated_at" => date("c")
    ]);
});

```

Visit <http://localhost:7145/swagger>. Verify:

- "Users" section has six endpoints (list, get, create, update, delete, avatar)
- "Orders" section shows "List user orders" (dual-tagged)
- Each endpoint has summary, description, parameters, request body, response codes
- "Try it out" works
- Examples pre-fill

14. Gotchas

1. Annotations Must Be Directly Above the Route

Problem: Swagger annotations missing from the docs.

Cause: Blank line or code between the doc-block and `Router::`. Tina4 reads only doc-blocks immediately above the route definition.

Fix: `*/` must be on the line directly before `Router::get(...)`. No blank lines.

2. Missing @tags Makes Endpoints Hard to Find

Problem: All endpoints in one flat list.

Cause: No `@tags`. Everything grouped under "default".

Fix: Add `@tags ResourceName` to every route.

3. @body Must Be Valid JSON

Problem: Body schema shows empty or broken.

Cause: Malformed JSON. Trailing comma, missing quotes, unescaped characters.

Fix: Validate the JSON. Double quotes on every key and string value. No trailing commas.

4. Swagger Shows Unannotated Routes

Problem: Routes without annotations appear with minimal docs.

Cause: Tina4 includes all registered routes. By design. Nothing hidden.

Fix: Add annotations for quality. Hide a route with `@hidden` in its doc-block.

5. Response Examples Do Not Match Reality

Problem: Example response shows different fields than the actual API.

Cause: Annotations written once, never updated. They are comments. Not validated against code.

Fix: Treat annotations as code. When the handler changes, update annotations. Consider integration tests that compare responses to documented schemas.

6. Swagger UI Not Available in Production

Problem: `/swagger` returns 404 in production.

Cause: Swagger disabled when `TINA4_DEBUG=false`.

Fix: Set `TINA4_SWAGGER_ENABLED=true` in `.env` for staging servers. Be aware that public documentation reveals implementation details.

7. SDK Generation Produces Incorrect Types

Problem: Generated TypeScript client has `any` types.

Cause: Annotations use generic strings instead of typed schemas.

Fix: Use correct OpenAPI type format: `"name": "string"` (lowercase), `"price": "number"`, `"in_stock": "boolean"`, `"tags": ["string"]` (array of strings).

API Client

1. Calling External APIs Without Dependencies

Every app calls external services. Weather APIs. Payment gateways. CRM systems. Shipping providers. The default PHP approach is cURL — verbose, error-prone, and full of boilerplate.

Tina4 provides a built-in `Api` class that wraps cURL with a clean interface. It supports GET, POST, PUT, DELETE, and PATCH with custom headers, basic auth, JSON or form payloads, and timeout control — no Guzzle, no Composer dependencies.

2. Creating an API Client

```
<?php
use Tina4\Api;

// Base URL -- all requests are relative to this
$api = new Api('https://api.example.com');
```

The `Api` class stores the base URL and shared configuration. Individual requests specify the path.

3. `sendRequest()`

All requests go through `sendRequest()`. It returns an associative array with:

- `status` — HTTP status code (integer)
- `body` — parsed response body (array if JSON, string otherwise)
- `headers` — response headers
- `error` — error message string on failure, `null` on success

```
<?php
use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com');

// GET request
$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/posts/1');

echo $result['status'];           // 200
print_r($result['body']);        // ['id' => 1, 'title' => '...', ...]
```

4. GET Requests

Fetch a resource:

```
<?php
```

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```

use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com');

$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/users/1');

if ($result['status'] === 200) {
    $user = $result['body'];
    echo "Name: {$user['name']}\n";
    echo "Email: {$user['email']}\n";
} else {
    echo "Error {$result['status']}: " . ($result['error'] ?? 'Unknown error');
}
}

---

```

5. POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE

Pass the payload as the fourth argument to `sendRequest()`.

POST — Create a resource

```

<?php
use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com');

$result = $api->sendRequest('POST', '/posts', [], [
    'title' => 'My New Post',
    'body'  => 'This is the content of the post.',
    'userId' => 1
]);

echo $result['status'];           // 201
echo $result['body']['id'];       // 101 (new resource ID)

```

PUT — Full update

```

$result = $api->sendRequest('PUT', '/posts/1', [], [
    'id'      => 1,
    'title'   => 'Updated Title',
    'body'    => 'Updated content.',
    'userId'  => 1
]);

echo $result['status']; // 200

```

PATCH — Partial update

```

$result = $api->sendRequest('PATCH', '/posts/1', [], [
    'title' => 'Just the title changed'
]);

echo $result['status']; // 200

```

DELETE — Remove a resource

```

$result = $api->sendRequest('DELETE', '/posts/1');

echo $result['status']; // 200 or 204

```

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6. Query Parameters

Pass query parameters as the third argument:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com');

$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/posts', [
    'userId' => 1,
    '_limit' => 5,
    '_sort' => 'id',
    '_order' => 'desc'
]);

// Resolves to: GET /posts?userId=1&_limit=5&_sort=id&_order=desc

echo count($result['body']); // 5
```

7. Custom Headers

Use `addCustomHeaders()` to set headers that apply to all subsequent requests from this client instance.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://api.stripe.com/v1');

$api->addCustomHeaders([
    'Authorization' => 'Bearer sk_test_YOUR_STRIPE_KEY_HERE',
    'Stripe-Version' => '2023-10-16',
    'Idempotency-Key' => bin2hex(random_bytes(16))
]);

$result = $api->sendRequest('POST', '/payment_intents', [], [
    'amount' => 2000, // $20.00 in cents
    'currency' => 'usd',
    'payment_method_types' => ['card']
]);

echo $result['status']; // 200
echo $result['body']['id']; // pi_30WL...
echo $result['body']['status']; // requires_payment_method
```

8. Basic Authentication

Use `setUsernamePassword()` for HTTP Basic Auth:

```
<?php
```

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```

use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://api.example.com');
$api->setUsernamePassword('my-api-key', 'my-api-secret');

$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/account');

echo $result['body']['plan']; // 'enterprise'

```

The credentials are Base64-encoded and sent as an **Authorization: Basic ...** header.

9. Bearer Token Auth

Use a custom header for token-based auth (OAuth2, JWT):

```

<?php
use Tina4\Api;

// Step 1: Get an access token
$authApi = new Api('https://auth.example.com');
$tokenResult = $authApi->sendRequest('POST', '/oauth/token', [], [
    'grant_type' => 'client_credentials',
    'client_id'   => getenv('CLIENT_ID'),
    'client_secret' => getenv('CLIENT_SECRET')
]);

$accessToken = $tokenResult['body']['access_token'];

// Step 2: Use the token for API calls
$api = new Api('https://api.example.com');
$api->addCustomHeaders([
    'Authorization' => "Bearer {$accessToken}",
    'Accept'        => 'application/json'
]);

$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/resources');

```

10. Error Handling

Always check **status** before accessing **body**. Handle network errors via **error**:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Api;

function fetchUser(int $id): ?array {
    $api = new Api('https://api.example.com');
    $result = $api->sendRequest('GET', "/users/{$id}");

    // Network or cURL failure
    if ($result['error'] !== null) {
        error_log("API network error: {$result['error']}");
        return null;
    }
}

```

// HTTP error responses

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```

        if ($result['status'] === 404) {
            return null; // Not found -- expected, return null
        }

        if ($result['status'] === 429) {
            // Rate limited -- retry after delay
            sleep((int) ($result['headers']['Retry-After'] ?? 5));
            return fetchUser($id); // Retry once
        }

        if ($result['status'] >= 500) {
            error_log("API server error {$result['status']} for user {$id}");
            throw new \RuntimeException("External API unavailable");
        }

        if ($result['status'] !== 200) {
            error_log("Unexpected status {$result['status']}");
            return null;
        }

        return $result['body'];
    }
}

```

11. Calling External APIs from Routes

Wrap the [Api](#) client in route handlers to build aggregator or proxy endpoints:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Api;

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::get('/api/weather/{city}', function ($request, $response) {
    $city = $request->params['city'];
    $apiKey = getenv('OPENWEATHER_API_KEY');

    $api = new Api('https://api.openweathermap.org/data/2.5');

    $result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/weather', [
        'q' => $city,
        'appid' => $apiKey,
        'units' => 'metric'
    ]);

    if ($result['status'] === 404) {
        return $response->json(['error' => "City '{$city}' not found"], 404);
    }

    if ($result['status'] !== 200) {
        return $response->json(['error' => 'Weather service unavailable'], 502);
    }

    $weather = $result['body'];

    return $response->json([

```

```

        'city'          => $weather['name'],
        'country'       => $weather['sys']['country'],
        'temperature'   => $weather['main']['temp'],
        'description'   => $weather['weather'][0]['description'],
        'humidity'      => $weather['main']['humidity'],
        'wind_speed'    => $weather['wind']['speed']
    });
});

curl http://localhost:7145/api/weather/London

{
  "city": "London",
  "country": "GB",
  "temperature": 12.5,
  "description": "overcast clouds",
  "humidity": 81,
  "wind_speed": 5.2
}

```

12. Exercise: GitHub API Proxy

Build a proxy that fetches GitHub repository information.

Requirements

- Create these endpoints:

Method	Path	Description
GET	/api/github/{owner}/{repo}	Repo details (stars, forks, description)
GET	/api/github/{owner}/{repo}/releases	Latest 5 releases

- Use the GitHub public API at <https://api.github.com>
- Set the required **User-Agent** header (GitHub rejects requests without it)
- Handle 404 gracefully

Test with:

```

curl http://localhost:7145/api/github/tina4/tina4-python
curl http://localhost:7145/api/github/tina4/tina4-python/releases
curl http://localhost:7145/api/github/nobody/nonexistent-repo

```

13. Gotchas

1. No timeout set

Problem: A slow external API hangs your request for 30+ seconds.

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Cause: cURL default timeout is 0 (infinite wait).

Fix: Pass a timeout in the options: `$api->sendRequest('GET', '/path', [], [], ['timeout' => 5])`. Always set a reasonable timeout for external calls.

2. Not checking status before accessing body

Problem: Code crashes with "Undefined index" when the body is an error message, not the expected structure.

Cause: The API returned a 4xx/5xx error. The body is an error object, not the expected resource.

Fix: Always check `$result['status']` before accessing `$result['body']`.

3. Credentials in source code

Problem: API keys and secrets are committed to the repository.

Cause: Credentials hard-coded in the `Api` instantiation call.

Fix: Always read credentials from environment variables: `getenv('TINA4_API_KEY')`. Never commit `.env` files.

4. Not handling rate limits

Problem: After many requests, the API returns 429 and all subsequent calls fail.

Cause: No rate limit detection or backoff logic.

Fix: Check for `status === 429`, read `Retry-After` from the response headers, and sleep before retrying.

GraphQL

1. The Problem GraphQL Solves

Your mobile app needs a list of products. Each product has a name, price, 20 image URLs, a full description, 15 review objects, and 8 other fields you do not need right now. REST sends all of it. 50KB of JSON when you needed 2KB. On a spotty mobile connection, that wasted bandwidth matters.

Now your web dashboard needs the same products plus the category, stock status, and supplier info. REST forces you into three requests (products, categories, suppliers) stitched together on the client, or a custom endpoint with query parameter parsing on the server.

GraphQL solves both problems. The client asks for the fields it needs. The server returns those fields. One endpoint. One request. One response with the right shape.

Tina4 includes a built-in GraphQL engine. No external packages. No Apollo Server. No [graphql-php](#) library. Part of the framework.

2. GraphQL vs REST -- A Quick Comparison

Aspect	REST	GraphQL
Endpoints	One per resource (/products, /users)	One endpoint (/graphql)
Data shape	Server decides	Client decides
Over-fetching	Common (get all fields)	Never (get only requested fields)
Under-fetching	Common (multiple requests needed)	Never (get related data in one query)
Versioning	/api/v1/, /api/v2/	Schema evolves, no versioning needed
Caching	HTTP caching works naturally	Requires client-side cache management
Learning curve	Low	Moderate

REST is still great for simple APIs. GraphQL shines when clients have diverse data needs -- mobile apps, dashboards, third-party integrations.

3. Enabling GraphQL

GraphQL is available by default. The engine serves requests at `/graphql`. Change the endpoint in `.env` if needed:

```
TINA4_GRAPHQL_ENDPOINT=/graphql
```

To verify it is working, start the server and send a test query:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ __schema { queryType { name } } }"}'

{
  "data": {
    "__schema": {
      "queryType": {
        "name": "Query"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

If you see that response, GraphQL is running.

4. Defining a Schema

A GraphQL schema defines the data types your API can return and the operations clients can execute.

Create `src/graphql/schema.graphql`:

```
type Product {
  id: Int!
  name: String!
  category: String!
  price: Float!
  inStock: Boolean!
  createdAt: String
}

type Query {
  products: [Product!]!
  product(id: Int!): Product
}
```

This schema says:

- A **Product** has six fields. The **!** means the field is non-nullable.
- The **Query** type has two operations: `products` returns a list of products, and `product(id)` returns a single product (or null if not found).

Tina4 auto-discovers `.graphql` files in `src/graphql/`. You do not need to register them.

5. Writing Resolvers

A resolver is the function that runs when a query or mutation executes. Resolvers live in `src/graphql/` as PHP files.

Create `src/graphql/resolvers.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\GraphQL;

// Resolve the "products" query
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "products", function ($root, $args) {
    $product = new Product();
    $products = $product->select("...", "", [], "name ASC");

    return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $products);
});

// Resolve the "product" query
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "product", function ($root, $args) {
    $product = new Product();
    $product->load($args["id"]);

    if (empty($product->id)) {
        return null;
    }

    return $product->toArray();
});
```

The `GraphQL::resolve()` method takes three arguments:

- **Type name** -- The GraphQL type this resolver belongs to (`Query`, `Mutation`, or a custom type).
- **Field name** -- The field within the type this resolver handles.
- **Resolver function** -- Receives `$root` (the parent value, if any) and `$args` (the query arguments).

Testing the Queries

List all products:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"query": "{ products { id name price inStock } }"}'

{
  "data": {
    "products": [
      {"id": 1, "name": "Wireless Keyboard", "price": 79.99, "inStock": true},
      {"id": 2, "name": "USB-C Hub", "price": 49.99, "inStock": true},
      {"id": 3, "name": "Standing Desk", "price": 549.99, "inStock": false}
    ]
  }
}
```

Notice: the response only contains the four fields we asked for (`id`, `name`, `price`, `inStock`), not `category` or `createdAt`. That is GraphQL in action.

Get a single product with all fields:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ product(id: 1) { id name category price inStock createdAt } }}"'

{
  "data": {
    "product": {
      "id": 1,
      "name": "Wireless Keyboard",
      "category": "Electronics",
      "price": 79.99,
      "inStock": true,
      "createdAt": "2026-03-22 14:30:00"
    }
  }
}
```

Request a product that does not exist:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ product(id: 999) { id name } }}"'

{
  "data": {
    "product": null
  }
}
```

6. Mutations

Mutations create, update, or delete data. They live in the schema alongside queries.

Update `src/graphql/schema.graphql`:

```
type Product {
  id: Int!
  name: String!
  category: String!
  price: Float!
  inStock: Boolean!
  createdAt: String
}
```

```
input ProductInput {
  name: String!
  category: String
  price: Float!
  inStock: Boolean
}
```

```
input ProductUpdateInput {
  name: String
```

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```

        category: String
        price: Float
        inStock: Boolean
    }

    type DeleteResult {
        success: Boolean!
        message: String!
    }

    type Query {
        products: [Product!]!
        product(id: Int!): Product
        productsByCategory(category: String!): [Product!]!
    }

    type Mutation {
        createProduct(input: ProductInput!): Product!
        updateProduct(id: Int!, input: ProductUpdateInput!): Product
        deleteProduct(id: Int!): DeleteResult!
    }

```

Key concepts:

- **input types** define the shape of data the client sends. They are like regular types but used for arguments.
- **Mutation type** lists all write operations. By convention, mutations are named with verbs: **createProduct**, **updateProduct**, **deleteProduct**.
- Fields in **ProductUpdateInput** are all optional (no **!**) because the client may only want to update one field.

Mutation Resolvers

Add to `src/graphql/resolvers.php`:

```

// Create a product
GraphQL::resolve("Mutation", "createProduct", function ($root, $args) {
    $input = $args["input"];

    $product = new Product();
    $product->name = $input["name"];
    $product->category = $input["category"] ?? "Uncategorized";
    $product->price = (float) $input["price"];
    $product->inStock = (bool) ($input["inStock"] ?? true);
    $product->save();

    return $product->toArray();
});

// Update a product
GraphQL::resolve("Mutation", "updateProduct", function ($root, $args) {
    $product = new Product();
    $product->load($args["id"]);

    if (empty($product->id)) {
        return null;
    }
}

```

```

        $input = $args["input"];
        if (isset($input["name"])) $product->name = $input["name"];
        if (isset($input["category"])) $product->category = $input["category"];
        if (isset($input["price"])) $product->price = (float) $input["price"];
        if (isset($input["inStock"])) $product->inStock = (bool) $input["inStock"];
        $product->save();

        return $product->toArray();
    });

// Delete a product
GraphQL::resolve("Mutation", "deleteProduct", function ($root, $args) {
    $product = new Product();
    $product->load($args["id"]);

    if (empty($product->id)) {
        return ["success" => false, "message" => "Product not found"];
    }

    $product->delete();
    return ["success" => true, "message" => "Product deleted"];
});

// Query: products by category
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "productsByCategory", function ($root, $args) {
    $product = new Product();
    $products = $product->select("*", "category = :category", [
        "category" => $args["category"]
    ]);

    return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $products);
});

```

Testing Mutations

Create a product:

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "query": "mutation { createProduct(input: { name: \"Desk Lamp\", category: \"Office\", price
  }'

{
  "data": {
    "createProduct": {
      "id": 4,
      "name": "Desk Lamp",
      "price": 39.99
    }
  }
}

```

Update a product:

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "query": "mutation { updateProduct(id: 4, input: { price: 44.99, inStock: false }) { id name
  }'

```

```
{
  "data": {
    "updateProduct": {
      "id": 4,
      "name": "Desk Lamp",
      "price": 44.99,
      "inStock": false
    }
  }
}
```

Delete a product:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
  "query": "mutation { deleteProduct(id: 4) { success message } }"
}'

{
  "data": {
    "deleteProduct": {
      "success": true,
      "message": "Product deleted"
    }
  }
}
```

7. Nested Types and Relationships

GraphQL's real power: traversing relationships in a single query. Authors and comments in a blog schema.

Update [src/graphql/schema.graphql](#):

```
type User {
  id: Int!
  name: String!
  email: String!
  posts: [Post!]!
}

type Post {
  id: Int!
  title: String!
  body: String!
  published: Boolean!
  author: User!
  comments: [Comment!]!
  commentCount: Int!
}

type Comment {
  id: Int!
  authorName: String!
  body: String!
  post: Post!
```

```

}

type Product {
  id: Int!
  name: String!
  category: String!
  price: Float!
  inStock: Boolean!
  createdAt: String
}

input ProductInput {
  name: String!
  category: String
  price: Float!
  inStock: Boolean
}

type DeleteResult {
  success: Boolean!
  message: String!
}

type Query {
  products: [Product!]!
  product(id: Int!): Product
  productsByCategory(category: String!): [Product!]!
  posts: [Post!]!
  post(id: Int!): Post
  user(id: Int!): User
}

type Mutation {
  createProduct(input: ProductInput!): Product!
  deleteProduct(id: Int!): DeleteResult!
}

```

Add resolvers for the nested types:

```

// Posts query
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "posts", function ($root, $args) {
  $post = new Post();
  $posts = $post->select("", "published = :pub", ["pub" => 1], "created_at DESC");
  return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $posts);
});

// Single post query
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "post", function ($root, $args) {
  $post = new Post();
  $post->load($args["id"]);
  return empty($post->id) ? null : $post->toArray();
});

// Resolve Post.author (nested field)
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "author", function ($post, $args) {
  $user = new User();
  $user->load($post["user_id"]);
  return $user->toArray();
});

```

```
// Resolve Post.comments (nested field)
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "comments", function ($post, $args) {
    $comment = new Comment();
    $comments = $comment->select("*", "post_id = :postId", ["postId" => $post["id"]]);
    return array_map(fn($c) => $c->toArray(), $comments);
});

// Resolve Post.commentCount (computed field)
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "commentCount", function ($post, $args) {
    $comment = new Comment();
    $comments = $comment->select("count(*) as cnt", "post_id = :postId", ["postId" => $post["id"]]);
    return $comments[0]->cnt ?? 0;
});

// Resolve User.posts (nested field)
GraphQL::resolve("User", "posts", function ($user, $args) {
    $post = new Post();
    $posts = $post->select("*", "user_id = :userId", ["userId" => $user["id"]]);
    return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $posts);
});
```

Now clients can query across relationships in a single request:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
  "query": "{ posts { id title author { name email } comments { authorName body } commentCount }"
}'

{
  "data": {
    "posts": [
      {
        "id": 1,
        "title": "My First Post",
        "author": {
          "name": "Alice",
          "email": "alice@example.com"
        },
        "comments": [
          {"authorName": "Bob", "body": "Great post!"}
        ],
        "commentCount": 1
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

One request. The fields the client asked for. Nothing more. Nothing less.

8. Auto-Generating Schema from ORM Models

If your ORM models have `$autoCrud = true`, Tina4 can auto-generate GraphQL types and basic CRUD resolvers for them. Enable this in `.env`:

```
TINA4_GRAPHQL_AUTO_SCHEMA=true
```

With this setting, every ORM model with `$autoCrud = true` automatically gets:

- A GraphQL type with fields matching the model properties
- A query to list all records (e.g., `products`)
- A query to get one by ID (e.g., `product(id: Int!)`)
- A mutation to create (e.g., `createProduct(input: ProductInput!)`)
- A mutation to update (e.g., `updateProduct(id: Int!, input: ProductUpdateInput!)`)
- A mutation to delete (e.g., `deleteProduct(id: Int!)`)

You can still define custom resolvers that override the auto-generated ones. Custom resolvers always take precedence.

9. The GraphiQL Playground

When `TINA4_DEBUG=true`, Tina4 serves a GraphiQL interactive playground at:

`http://localhost:7145/graphql/playground`

GraphiQL gives you:

- A query editor with syntax highlighting and auto-completion
- A documentation explorer showing all types, queries, and mutations
- A results panel showing the response
- Query history

This is the fastest way to explore and test your GraphQL API during development. Type a query on the left, click the play button, and see the results on the right. The documentation explorer on the right sidebar shows every type, field, and argument available in your schema.

GraphiQL is only available when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. In production, it is disabled automatically.

10. Query Variables

For production, clients send query variables separately from the query string. This prevents injection and allows query caching.

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "query": "query GetProduct($id: Int!) { product(id: $id) { id name price } }",
    "variables": {"id": 1}
  }'

{
  "data": {
    "product": {
      "id": 1,
```

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```

        "name": "Wireless Keyboard",
        "price": 79.99
    }
}
}

```

The query uses `$id` as a placeholder, and the actual value comes from the `variables` object. This is safer and more efficient than string interpolation.

11. Exercise: Build a GraphQL API for a Blog

Build a complete GraphQL API for a blog with posts, authors, and comments.

Requirements

- **Schema** -- Define types for `User`, `Post`, and `Comment` with the following fields:
 - `User`: id, name, email, posts (nested)
 - `Post`: id, title, body, published, author (nested), comments (nested), commentCount (computed)
 - `Comment`: id, authorName, body, createdAt
- **Queries:**
 - `posts` -- List all published posts
 - `post(id: Int!)` -- Get a single post by ID
 - `user(id: Int!)` -- Get a user with their posts
- **Mutations:**
 - `createPost(userId: Int!, title: String!, body: String!, published: Boolean)` -- Create a new post
 - `addComment(postId: Int!, authorName: String!, body: String!)` -- Add a comment to a post
- Use the ORM models from Chapter 6 (User, Post, Comment).

Test with these queries:

```
# List published posts with author names
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ posts { id title author { name } commentCount } }}"'

# Get a specific post with all comments
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ post(id: 1) { title body author { name email } comments { authorName body } }}"'

# Create a post
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "mutation { createPost(userId: 1, title: \"GraphQL is great\", body: \"Here is w\""}'

# Add a comment
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "mutation { addComment(postId: 1, authorName: \"Carol\", body: \"Nice article!\")}"'

# Get a user with all their posts
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/graphql \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"query": "{ user(id: 1) { name email posts { title published } } }"}'
```

12. Solution

Schema

Create `src/graphql/blog-schema.graphql`:

```
type User {
  id: Int!
  name: String!
  email: String!
  posts: [Post!]!
}

type Post {
  id: Int!
  title: String!
  body: String!
  published: Boolean!
  author: User!
  comments: [Comment!]!
  commentCount: Int!
  createdAt: String
}

type Comment {
  id: Int!
  authorName: String!
  body: String!
  createdAt: String
}
```



```

type Query {
  posts: [Post!]!
  post(id: Int!): Post
  user(id: Int!): User
}

type Mutation {
  createPost(userId: Int!, title: String!, body: String!, published: Boolean): Post!
  addComment(postId: Int!, authorName: String!, body: String!): Comment!
}

```

Resolvers

Create `src/graphql/blog-resolvers.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\GraphQL;

// Query: list published posts
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "posts", function ($root, $args) {
    $post = new Post();
    $posts = $post->select("?", "published = :pub", ["pub" => 1], "created_at DESC");
    return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $posts);
});

// Query: single post
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "post", function ($root, $args) {
    $post = new Post();
    $post->load($args["id"]);
    return empty($post->id) ? null : $post->toArray();
});

// Query: single user
GraphQL::resolve("Query", "user", function ($root, $args) {
    $user = new User();
    $user->load($args["id"]);
    return empty($user->id) ? null : $user->toArray();
});

// Post.author resolver
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "author", function ($post, $args) {
    $user = new User();
    $user->load($post["user_id"]);
    return $user->toArray();
});

// Post.comments resolver
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "comments", function ($post, $args) {
    $comment = new Comment();
    $comments = $comment->select("?", "post_id = :postId", [
        "postId" => $post["id"]
    ], "created_at ASC");
    return array_map(fn($c) => $c->toArray(), $comments);
});

// Post.commentCount resolver
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "commentCount", function ($post, $args) {
    $comment = new Comment();
    $results = $comment->select("count(*) as cnt", "post_id = :postId", [

```

```

        "postId" => $post["id"]
    });
    return (int) ($results[0]->cnt ?? 0);
});

// User.posts resolver
GraphQL::resolve("User", "posts", function ($user, $args) {
    $post = new Post();
    $posts = $post->select("", "user_id = :userId", [
        "userId" => $user["id"]
    ], "created_at DESC");
    return array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $posts);
});

// Mutation: create a post
GraphQL::resolve("Mutation", "createPost", function ($root, $args) {
    $user = new User();
    $user->load($args["userId"]);

    if (empty($user->id)) {
        throw new \Exception("User not found");
    }

    $post = new Post();
    $post->userId = $args["userId"];
    $post->title = $args["title"];
    $post->body = $args["body"];
    $post->published = (bool) ($args["published"] ?? false);
    $post->save();

    return $post->toArray();
});

// Mutation: add a comment
GraphQL::resolve("Mutation", "addComment", function ($root, $args) {
    $post = new Post();
    $post->load($args["postId"]);

    if (empty($post->id)) {
        throw new \Exception("Post not found");
    }

    $comment = new Comment();
    $comment->postId = $args["postId"];
    $comment->authorName = $args["authorName"];
    $comment->body = $args["body"];
    $comment->save();

    return $comment->toArray();
});

```

Expected output for { posts { id title author { name } commentCount } }:

```

{
  "data": {
    "posts": [
      {
        "id": 1,
        "title": "My First Post",

```

```

        "author": {"name": "Alice"},
        "commentCount": 1
    },
    {
        "id": 2,
        "title": "GraphQL is great",
        "author": {"name": "Alice"},
        "commentCount": 0
    }
]
}
}
---

```

13. Input Validation

Tina4's GraphQL engine validates every argument against its declared type before your resolver runs. You never need to check whether a required argument is present or whether a string arrived where an integer was expected -- the engine rejects the query before your code executes.

The built-in validator covers:

- **Non-null enforcement** -- Arguments marked with **!** must be present and non-null.
- **Scalar type checking** -- **Int**, **Float**, **String**, **Boolean**, and **ID** values are verified against their declared type.
- **Type coercion** -- When safe, the engine coerces compatible values automatically (e.g., an integer **42** passed to a **Float** field becomes **42.0**, or a string **"7"** passed to an **Int** field becomes **7**).
- **List item validation** -- For **[Int!]!** arguments, the engine checks that the value is a list, that no item is null, and that every item is an integer.

Example: Missing Required Argument

Suppose you define a query that requires an **id**:

```

<?php
use Tina4\GraphQL;

GraphQL::resolve("Query", "user", function ($root, $args) {
    $user = new User();
    $user->load($args["id"]);
    return empty($user->id) ? null : $user->toArray();
});

```

With the schema declaring **user(id: ID!): User**, sending a query without the required argument:

```

{
  user {
    name
    email
  }
}

```

Returns an error before the resolver runs:

```
{
  "errors": [
    {
      "message": "Argument 'id' of type 'ID!' is required but not provided.",
      "locations": [{"line": 2, "column": 3}]
    }
  ]
}
```

Your resolver never executes. No null-check needed inside the function.

14. Field-Level Auth Directives

Tina4 supports three directives that control field-level access in your GraphQL schema:

Directive	Effect
@auth	Field resolves only when <code>ctx["user"]</code> is present (any authenticated user)
@role(role: "admin")	Field resolves only when <code>ctx["user"]["role"]</code> matches the specified role
@guest	Field resolves only when <code>ctx["user"]</code> is absent (unauthenticated visitors)

Passing Auth Context

Pass user information through the context parameter of `execute()`:

```
<?php
$result = $gql->execute($query, $variables, [
    'user' => ['id' => 1, 'role' => 'admin']
]);
```

When no user is logged in, pass an empty context or omit the `user` key:

```
<?php
$result = $gql->execute($query, $variables, []);
```

Schema Example

```
type User {
  id: ID!
  name: String!
  email: String! @auth
  role: String! @role(role: "admin")
}

type Query {
  me: User @auth
  publicStats: Stats @guest
  users: [User!]! @role(role: "admin")
}
```

Behavior on Failed Auth

When a directive check fails, the field resolves to `null` silently -- no error is added to the response. The rest of the query executes normally. This prevents leaking information about which fields exist behind authentication.

For example, if a non-admin user queries:

```
{
  users {
    name
    email
    role
  }
}
```

The response is:

```
{
  "data": {
    "users": null
  }
}
```

No error message. No hint that the field requires admin access. The field is simply excluded.

15. Gotchas

1. Schema File Not Found

Problem: Queries return errors about unknown types or fields.

Cause: The `.graphql` file is not in `src/graphql/`, or has a syntax error that prevents parsing.

Fix: Make sure schema files are in `src/graphql/` and end with `.graphql`. Check for syntax errors -- a missing `!` or unmatched brace will cause the entire schema to fail silently.

2. Resolver Not Called

Problem: A query returns `null` even though data exists.

Cause: The resolver is not registered, or the type/field names do not match the schema exactly. GraphQL is case-sensitive.

Fix: Verify that `GraphQL::resolve("Query", "products", ...)` matches `type Query { products: ... }` exactly. Check capitalization.

3. Nested Resolver Returns Wrong Data

Problem: `post.author` returns the entire post instead of the user.

Cause: The nested resolver receives the parent object as its first argument (`$post`), not a fresh model. If you return the parent instead of loading the related record, you get the wrong data.

Fix: In a nested resolver, always load the related record from the database using the foreign key from the parent:

```
GraphQL::resolve("Post", "author", function ($post, $args) {  
  $user = new User();  
  $user->load($post["user_id"]); // Use the foreign key from the parent  
  return $user->toArray();  
});
```

4. Mutation Input Not Parsed

Problem: `$args["input"]` is null inside a mutation resolver.

Cause: The mutation signature in the schema uses an `input` type, but the client query passes arguments directly instead of wrapping them in an `input` object.

Fix: Match the query to the schema. If the schema says `createProduct(input: ProductInput!)`, the client must send `createProduct(input: { name: "Widget", price: 9.99 })`, not `createProduct(name: "Widget", price: 9.99)`.

5. N+1 Query Problem

Problem: Loading 50 posts with their authors generates 51 database queries (1 for posts + 50 for authors).

Cause: Each nested resolver runs independently. When you resolve `author` for each post, that is one query per post.

Fix: Use data loader patterns or batch loading. For simple cases, you can pre-load all related records in the parent resolver and pass them down. Check `$ctx["__selections"]` to see which nested fields the client requested -- if `author` is not in the selection set, skip the join. For ORM queries, use the `include` parameter to eager-load relationships in a single query. For complex cases, consider using the REST API with eager loading instead of GraphQL for that particular endpoint.

6. GraphQL Playground Returns 404

Problem: `/graphql/playground` returns a 404 error.

Cause: `TINA4_DEBUG` is set to `false`. The playground is only available in debug mode.

Fix: Set `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in your `.env` file. The playground is intentionally disabled in production.

7. Type Mismatch Between Schema and Resolver

Problem: A field declared as `Int!` in the schema receives a string from the resolver, causing a type error.

Cause: PHP does not enforce types as strictly as GraphQL. If your resolver returns `"42"` (a string) for an `Int!` field, GraphQL rejects it.

Fix: The input validation layer (see section 13) now coerces compatible types automatically -- a string `"42"` passed as an argument to an `Int` parameter is converted before your resolver runs. However, resolver *return values* still need correct types. Cast values explicitly with `(int)`, `(float)`, `(bool)`:

```
return [
    "id" => (int) $product->id,
    "price" => (float) $product->price,
    "inStock" => (bool) $product->inStock
];
```

The `toArray()` method handles this automatically for model properties with type declarations, but computed or derived fields need manual casting.

Real-time with WebSocket

1. The Refresh Button Problem

Your project management app needs live updates. Someone moves a card from "In Progress" to "Done." Everyone else should see it. No page refresh. No polling. No waiting.

HTTP is a conversation with amnesia. The client asks, the server answers, the connection dies. The server cannot reach back.

WebSocket fixes this. It opens a persistent, two-way channel between browser and server. Either side sends messages at any time. The connection holds until someone closes it.

Tina4 treats WebSocket the same as routing. Define a handler. Assign a path. Done.

2. What WebSocket Is

HTTP works this way:

```
Client: "Give me /api/products"
Server: "Here are the products" (connection closes)
Client: "Give me /api/products" (new connection)
Server: "Here are the products" (connection closes)
```

WebSocket works this way:

```
Client: "I want to upgrade to WebSocket on /ws/chat"
Server: "Upgrade accepted. Connection open."
Client: "Hello everyone!"
Server: "Alice says: Hello everyone!" (pushed to all clients)
Server: "Bob joined the chat" (pushed to all clients, at any time)
Client: "Goodbye!"
Server: "Alice says: Goodbye!"
Client: (closes connection)
```

Four differences matter:

- **Persistent:** The connection stays open. No repeated handshakes.
- **Bi-directional:** The server pushes data without the client asking.
- **Low overhead:** After the initial handshake, messages are tiny. No HTTP headers per message.
- **Real-time:** Messages arrive within milliseconds.

3. Router::websocket() -- WebSocket as a Route

Define WebSocket handlers with `Router::websocket()`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
```

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```
Router::websocket("/ws/echo", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "message") {
        $connection->send("Echo: " . $data);
    }
});
```

The simplest handler. It receives a message and sends it back with "Echo: " prepended. Three arguments arrive:

- **\$connection:** The WebSocket connection object. Send messages through it.
- **\$event:** The event type: "open", "message", or "close".
- **\$data:** The message data. Present only for "message" events.

Starting the Server

WebSocket runs alongside your HTTP server:

```
tina4 serve

Tina4 PHP v3.0.0
HTTP server running at http://0.0.0.0:7145
WebSocket server running at ws://0.0.0.0:7145
Press Ctrl+C to stop
```

Both protocols share the same port. Tina4's built-in server uses PHP's `stream_select()` to multiplex HTTP and WebSocket connections in a single process -- no extensions like Swoole or ReactPHP required. The server detects the upgrade request and routes to the correct handler.

4. Connection Events

Every WebSocket connection passes through three lifecycle events.

Open

Fires when a client connects:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::websocket("/ws/notifications", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "open") {
        error_log("Client connected: " . $connection->id);
        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "welcome",
            "message" => "Connected to notifications",
            "connection_id" => $connection->id
        ]));
    }
});
```

Message

Fires when a client sends data:

```
Router::websocket("/ws/notifications", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "open") {
```

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```

        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "welcome",
            "connection_id" => $connection->id
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        $message = json_decode($data, true);
        error_log("Received from " . $connection->id . ": " . $data);

        // Process the message based on its type
        if (($message["type"] ?? "") === "ping") {
            $connection->send(json_encode([
                "type" => "pong",
                "timestamp" => date("c")
            ]));
        }
    }
});

```

Close

Fires when a client disconnects:

```

Router::websocket("/ws/notifications", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "open") {
        error_log("Client connected: " . $connection->id);
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        error_log("Message from " . $connection->id . ": " . $data);
    }

    if ($event === "close") {
        error_log("Client disconnected: " . $connection->id);
        // Clean up: remove from tracking, notify others, etc.
    }
});

```

A Complete Handler

All three events in one handler:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::websocket("/ws/chat", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    switch ($event) {
        case "open":
            error_log("[Chat] New connection: " . $connection->id);
            $connection->send(json_encode([
                "type" => "system",
                "message" => "Welcome to the chat!",
                "your_id" => $connection->id
            ]));
            break;

        case "message":
            $message = json_decode($data, true);
            error_log("[Chat] " . $connection->id . ": " . ($message["text"] ?? $data));
    }
});

```

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```

        // Echo back with sender info
        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "message",
            "from" => $connection->id,
            "text" => $message["text"] ?? $data,
            "timestamp" => date("c")
        ]));
        break;

    case "close":
        error_log("[Chat] Disconnected: " . $connection->id);
        break;
    }
});
---

```

5. Sending to a Single Client

`$connection->send()` targets the specific client that triggered the event:

```

Router::websocket("/ws/private", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "message") {
        $message = json_decode($data, true);
        $action = $message["action"] ?? "";

        if ($action === "get-time") {
            $connection->send(json_encode([
                "type" => "time",
                "server_time" => date("c"),
                "timezone" => date_default_timezone_get()
            ]));
        }

        if ($action === "get-status") {
            $connection->send(json_encode([
                "type" => "status",
                "uptime" => 3600,
                "connections" => 42,
                "memory_mb" => round(memory_get_usage() / 1024 / 1024, 2)
            ]));
        }
    }
});

```

Only the sender receives the response. Other connected clients see nothing.

Closing a Connection

`$connection->close()` terminates the connection from the server side:

```

Router::websocket("/ws/secure", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "open") {
        // Reject unauthenticated connections
        $token = $connection->params["token"] ?? "";
        if (!Auth::validToken($token)) {
            $connection->send(json_encode([
                "type" => "error",
                "message" => "Invalid token"
            ]));
        }
    }
});

```

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```

    }));
    $connection->close();
    return;
  }
}
});

```

The client receives the close event. Use this for kicking users, enforcing authentication, or cleaning up idle connections.

6. Broadcasting to All Clients

`$connection->broadcast()` sends a message to every client connected to the same WebSocket path:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::websocket("/ws/announcements", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    if ($event === "open") {
        // Tell everyone about the new connection
        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => "A new user joined",
            "online_count" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        $message = json_decode($data, true);

        // Broadcast the message to everyone (including sender)
        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "announcement",
            "from" => $connection->id,
            "text" => $message["text"] ?? "",
            "timestamp" => date("c")
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "close") {
        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => "A user left",
            "online_count" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }
});

```

One client sends a message. Every client connected to `/ws/announcements` receives it. Chat rooms, live dashboards, collaborative editing -- they all start here.

Broadcast Excluding Sender

Send to everyone except the client that triggered the event:

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```

if ($event === "message") {
    $message = json_decode($data, true);

    // Send to sender (confirmation)
    $connection->send(json_encode([
        "type" => "sent",
        "text" => $message["text"]
    ]));

    // Send to everyone else
    $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
        "type" => "message",
        "from" => $message["username"] ?? "Anonymous",
        "text" => $message["text"],
        "timestamp" => date("c")
    ]), true); // true = exclude sender
}

```

The second argument to `broadcast()` excludes the sender when set to `true`. The sender gets a "sent" confirmation. Everyone else gets the "message."

7. Path-Scoped Isolation

Different WebSocket paths are walls. Clients connected to `/ws/chat/room-1` never see messages from `/ws/chat/room-2`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::websocket("/ws/chat/{room}", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    $room = $connection->params["room"];

    if ($event === "open") {
        error_log("[Room " . $room . "] New connection: " . $connection->id);
        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => "Someone joined room " . $room,
            "room" => $room,
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        $message = json_decode($data, true);

        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "message",
            "room" => $room,
            "from" => $message["username"] ?? "Anonymous",
            "text" => $message["text"] ?? "",
            "timestamp" => date("c")
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "close") {
        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([

```

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```

        "type" => "system",
        "message" => "Someone left room " . $room,
        "room" => $room,
        "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
    ]));
}
});

```

Connect to different rooms:

```

ws://localhost:7145/ws/chat/general    -- general chat
ws://localhost:7145/ws/chat/random    -- random chat
ws://localhost:7145/ws/chat/dev-team  -- dev team chat

```

Broadcasting in `/ws/chat/general` reaches only clients in `/ws/chat/general`. The `dev-team` and `random` rooms are separate worlds.

Chat rooms. Project-specific notifications. Per-user channels. No extra configuration. The URL path is the isolation boundary.

8. Building a Live Chat

A complete chat application with usernames, typing indicators, and message history.

WebSocket Handler

Create `src/routes/chat-ws.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

$chatUsers = [];

Router::websocket("/ws/livechat/{room}", function ($connection, $event, $data) use (&$chatUsers) {
    $room = $connection->params["room"];

    if ($event === "open") {
        // User has not set their name yet
        $chatUsers[$connection->id] = [
            "id" => $connection->id,
            "username" => "Anonymous",
            "room" => $room,
            "joined_at" => date("c")
        ];

        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "welcome",
            "message" => "Connected to room: " . $room,
            "your_id" => $connection->id,
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        $message = json_decode($data, true);
        $type = $message["type"] ?? "message";
    }
}

```

```

        if ($type === "set-username") {
            $oldName = $chatUsers[$connection->id]["username"];
            $chatUsers[$connection->id]["username"] = $message["username"];

            $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
                "type" => "system",
                "message" => $oldName . " is now known as " . $message["username"]
            ]));
        }

        if ($type === "message") {
            $username = $chatUsers[$connection->id]["username"];

            $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
                "type" => "message",
                "from" => $username,
                "from_id" => $connection->id,
                "text" => $message["text"] ?? "",
                "timestamp" => date("c")
            ]));
        }

        if ($type === "typing") {
            $username = $chatUsers[$connection->id]["username"];

            $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
                "type" => "typing",
                "username" => $username
            ]), true); // Exclude sender
        }
    }

    if ($event === "close") {
        $username = $chatUsers[$connection->id]["username"] ?? "Unknown";
        unset($chatUsers[$connection->id]);

        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => $username . " left the chat",
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }
});

```

9. Live Notifications

WebSocket pushes notifications to users in real time:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Queue;

// WebSocket handler for notifications
Router::websocket("/ws/notifications/{userId}", function ($connection, $event, $data) {
    $userId = $connection->params["userId"];

    if ($event === "open") {

```

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```

        error_log("[Notifications] User " . $userId . " connected");
        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "connected",
            "message" => "Listening for notifications"
        ]));
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        // Client can send acknowledgments or mark notifications as read
        $message = json_decode($data, true);
        if (($message["type"] ?? "") === "mark-read") {
            error_log("[Notifications] User " . $userId . " read notification " . $message["id"])
        }
    }
}

});

// HTTP endpoint that triggers a notification
Router::post("/api/orders/{orderId:int}/ship", function ($request, $response) {
    $orderId = $request->params["orderId"];
    $userId = $request->body["user_id"] ?? 0;

    // Update order status in database...

    // Send real-time notification via WebSocket
    // The notification is pushed to all connections on /ws/notifications/{userId}
    Router::pushToWebSocket("/ws/notifications/" . $userId, json_encode([
        "type" => "notification",
        "title" => "Order Shipped",
        "message" => "Your order #" . $orderId . " has been shipped!",
        "action_url" => "/orders/" . $orderId,
        "timestamp" => date("c")
    ]));

    return $response->json(["message" => "Order shipped, user notified"]);
});

```

`Router::pushToWebSocket()` bridges the gap. Your HTTP handlers send messages to WebSocket clients. Request-response meets real-time.

10. Connecting from JavaScript

Tina4 ships `frond.js`, a built-in JavaScript helper library with WebSocket support.

Basic Connection

```
<script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
<script>
  const ws = frond.ws("/ws/chat/general");

  ws.on("open", function () {
    console.log("Connected to chat");
  });

  ws.on("message", function (data) {
    const message = JSON.parse(data);
    console.log("Received:", message);

    if (message.type === "message") {
      addMessageToUI(message.from, message.text, message.timestamp);
    }

    if (message.type === "system") {
      addSystemMessage(message.message);
    }
  });

  ws.on("close", function () {
    console.log("Disconnected from chat");
  });

  // Send a message
  function sendMessage(text) {
    ws.send(JSON.stringify({
      type: "message",
      text: text
    }));
  }

  // Set username
  function setUsername(name) {
    ws.send(JSON.stringify({
      type: "set-username",
      username: name
    }));
  }
</script>
```

Auto-Reconnect

frond.js reconnects when the connection drops:

```
const ws = frond.ws("/ws/notifications/42", {
  reconnect: true,           // Enable auto-reconnect (default: true)
  reconnectInterval: 3000,   // Retry every 3 seconds
  maxReconnectAttempts: 10   // Give up after 10 attempts
});

ws.on("reconnect", function (attempt) {
  console.log("Reconnecting... attempt " + attempt);
});

ws.on("reconnect_failed", function () {
  console.log("Failed to reconnect after maximum attempts");
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}
```

```
});
```

Using Native WebSocket

The native WebSocket API works too:

```
const ws = new WebSocket("ws://localhost:7145/ws/chat/general");

ws.onopen = function () {
  console.log("Connected");
  ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "set-username", username: "Alice" }));
};

ws.onmessage = function (event) {
  const message = JSON.parse(event.data);
  console.log("Received:", message);
};

ws.onclose = function () {
  console.log("Disconnected");
};

ws.onerror = function (error) {
  console.error("WebSocket error:", error);
};
```

The advantage of **frond.js**: auto-reconnect, message buffering during reconnection, a cleaner event API.

11. A Complete Chat Page

A full chat page using templates and WebSocket.

Create **src/templates/chat.html**:

```
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}Chat - {{ room }}{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  <h1>Chat Room: {{ room }}</h1>
  <p id="status">Connecting...</p>
  <p id="online">Online: 0</p>

  <div id="messages" style="border: 1px solid #ddd; height: 400px; overflow-y: scroll; padding: 10px;>
  </div>

  <div id="typing" style="height: 20px; color: #888; font-style: italic; margin-bottom: 4px;>
  </div>

  <form id="chat-form" style="display: flex; gap: 8px;>
    <input type="text" id="message-input" placeholder="Type a message..."
      style="flex: 1; padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px;">
    <button type="submit" style="padding: 8px 16px; background: #333; color: white; border: 1px solid #ddd;">
      Send
    </button>
  </form>
```

```

<script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
<script>
  const room = "{{ room }}";
  const ws = frond.ws("/ws/livechat/" + room);
  const messagesDiv = document.getElementById("messages");
  const statusEl = document.getElementById("status");
  const onlineEl = document.getElementById("online");
  const typingEl = document.getElementById("typing");

  let username = prompt("Enter your username:") || "Anonymous";

  ws.on("open", function () {
    statusEl.textContent = "Connected";
    ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "set-username", username: username }));
  });

  ws.on("message", function (data) {
    const msg = JSON.parse(data);

    if (msg.type === "message") {
      const div = document.createElement("div");
      div.style.marginBottom = "8px";
      div.innerHTML = "<strong>" + msg.from + ":</strong> " + msg.text;
      messagesDiv.appendChild(div);
      messagesDiv.scrollTop = messagesDiv.scrollHeight;
    }

    if (msg.type === "system") {
      const div = document.createElement("div");
      div.style.cssText = "color: #888; font-style: italic; margin-bottom: 8px;";
      div.textContent = msg.message;
      messagesDiv.appendChild(div);
      messagesDiv.scrollTop = messagesDiv.scrollHeight;
    }

    if (msg.type === "typing") {
      typingEl.textContent = msg.username + " is typing...";
      setTimeout(function () { typingEl.textContent = ""; }, 2000);
    }

    if (msg.online !== undefined) {
      onlineEl.textContent = "Online: " + msg.online;
    }
  });

  ws.on("close", function () {
    statusEl.textContent = "Disconnected. Reconnecting...";
  });

  document.getElementById("chat-form").addEventListener("submit", function (e) {
    e.preventDefault();
    const input = document.getElementById("message-input");
    if (input.value.trim()) {
      ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "message", text: input.value }));
      input.value = "";
    }
  });

  document.getElementById("message-input").addEventListener("input", function () {

```

```

        ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "typing" }));
    });
</script>
{% endblock %}

```

Create the route to serve the page:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/chat/{room}", function ($request, $response) {
    $room = $request->params["room"];
    return $response->render("chat.html", ["room" => $room]);
});

```

Open <http://localhost:7145/chat/general> in two browser tabs. Type in one. Watch the message appear in the other.

12. Exercise: Build a Real-Time Chat Room

Build a WebSocket chat room with the following features:

Requirements

- WebSocket endpoint at [/ws/room/{roomName}](#) that handles:
 - **open**: Send welcome message with connection count
 - **message** with type **set - name**: Set the user's display name
 - **message** with type **chat**: Broadcast the message to all clients with the sender's name
 - **close**: Broadcast that the user left
- HTTP endpoint at **GET** [/room/{roomName}](#) that serves an HTML chat page
- The chat page should:
 - Prompt for a username on load
 - Display messages in real time
 - Show system messages (join/leave) in a different style
 - Show the count of online users

Test by:

- Open <http://localhost:7145/room/test> in two browser tabs
- Set different usernames in each
- Send messages from both tabs and verify they appear in both
- Close one tab and verify the "user left" message appears in the other

13. Solution

Create `src/routes/chat-room.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

$roomUsers = [];

Router::websocket("/ws/room/{roomName}", function ($connection, $event, $data) use (&$roomUsers)
    $room = $connection->params["roomName"];
    $key = $room . ":" . $connection->id;

    if ($event === "open") {
        $roomUsers[$key] = "Anonymous";

        $connection->send(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => "Welcome to room: " . $room . ". Set your name with: {\\"type\\": \\"set-n
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));

        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => "A new user joined",
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]), true);
    }

    if ($event === "message") {
        $msg = json_decode($data, true);
        $type = $msg["type"] ?? "chat";

        if ($type === "set-name") {
            $oldName = $roomUsers[$key] ?? "Anonymous";
            $newName = $msg["name"] ?? "Anonymous";
            $roomUsers[$key] = $newName;

            $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
                "type" => "system",
                "message" => $oldName . " changed their name to " . $newName
            ]));
        }

        if ($type === "chat") {
            $username = $roomUsers[$key] ?? "Anonymous";

            $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
                "type" => "chat",
                "from" => $username,
                "text" => $msg["text"] ?? "",
                "timestamp" => date("H:i:s")
            ]));
        }
    }

    if ($event === "close") {
        $username = $roomUsers[$key] ?? "Anonymous";
        unset($roomUsers[$key]);
    }
}
```

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```

        $connection->broadcast(json_encode([
            "type" => "system",
            "message" => $username . " left the room",
            "online" => $connection->connectionCount()
        ]));
    }
});

```

```

Router::get("/room/{roomName}", function ($request, $response) {
    $room = $request->params["roomName"];
    return $response->render("room.html", ["room" => $room]);
});

```

Create `src/templates/room.html`:

```

{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}Room: {{ room }}{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>Room: {{ room }}</h1>
    <p id="online" style="color: #666;">Online: 0</p>

    <div id="messages" style="border: 1px solid #ddd; height: 400px; overflow-y: auto; padding: 10px;">

    <form id="form" style="display: flex; gap: 8px;">
        <input type="text" id="input" placeholder="Type a message..."
            style="flex: 1; padding: 10px; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px; font-size: 14px;" />
        <button type="submit"
            style="padding: 10px 20px; background: #1a1a2e; color: white; border: none; border-radius: 4px;">
            Send
        </button>
    </form>

    <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
    <script>
        const room = "{{ room }}";
        const username = prompt("Choose a username:") || "Anonymous";
        const ws = frond.ws("/ws/room/" + room);
        const msgs = document.getElementById("messages");

        ws.on("open", function () {
            ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "set-name", name: username }));
        });

        ws.on("message", function (raw) {
            const msg = JSON.parse(raw);
            const div = document.createElement("div");
            div.style.marginBottom = "8px";

            if (msg.type === "chat") {
                div.innerHTML = "<strong>" + msg.from + "</strong> <span style='color:#999;font-size: 0.9em;'>" + msg.message + "</span>";
            } else if (msg.type === "system") {
                div.style.color = "#888";
                div.style.fontStyle = "italic";
                div.textContent = msg.message;
            }

            msgs.appendChild(div);
        });
    </script>

```

```

        msg.scrollLeft = msg.scrollHeight;

        if (msg.online !== undefined) {
            document.getElementById("online").textContent = "Online: " + msg.online;
        }
    });

    document.getElementById("form").addEventListener("submit", function (e) {
        e.preventDefault();
        const input = document.getElementById("input");
        if (input.value.trim()) {
            ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "chat", text: input.value }));
            input.value = "";
        }
    });
</script>
{% endblock %}

```

Open <http://localhost:7145/room/test> in two browser tabs. Set different usernames. Send messages from one tab and watch them appear in both. Close one tab and verify the "left the room" message appears.

14. Scaling with a Backplane

When you run a single server instance, `broadcast()` reaches every connected client. But in production you often run multiple instances behind a load balancer. Each instance only knows about its own connections. A message broadcast on instance A never reaches clients connected to instance B.

A backplane solves this. It relays WebSocket messages across all instances using a shared pub/sub channel. Tina4 supports Redis as a backplane out of the box.

Configuration

Set two environment variables in your `.env`:

```

TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE=redis
TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE_URL=redis://localhost:6379

```

When `TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE` is set, every `broadcast()` call publishes the message to Redis. Every instance subscribes to the same channel and forwards the message to its local connections. No code changes required -- your existing WebSocket routes work as before.

Requirements

The Redis backplane requires a Redis client package as an optional dependency:

```
composer require predis/predis
```

If `TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE` is not set (the default), Tina4 broadcasts only to local connections. This is fine for single-instance deployments.

15. Gotchas

1. WebSocket Needs a Persistent Server

Problem: WebSocket connections drop or fail to connect.

Cause: You are running behind a traditional PHP-FPM + Nginx setup. PHP-FPM processes terminate after each HTTP request. No persistent process exists to maintain WebSocket connections.

Fix: Use `tina4 serve`. It runs a persistent server handling both HTTP and WebSocket. For production, run the Tina4 server directly -- not behind PHP-FPM. Nginx can still serve as a reverse proxy, but it must be configured for WebSocket: `proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade` and `proxy_set_header Connection "upgrade"`.

2. Messages Are Strings, Not Objects

Problem: `$data` in the message handler is a string, not a PHP array.

Cause: WebSocket transmits raw strings. JSON from the client arrives as a JSON string, not a decoded array.

Fix: Always `json_decode($data, true)` when you expect JSON. Always `json_encode()` when you send structured data. WebSocket does not know about content types. It moves bytes.

3. Connection Count Is Per-Path

Problem: `$connection->connectionCount()` returns a lower number than expected.

Cause: Connection count is scoped to the WebSocket path. Clients on `/ws/chat/room-1` are counted separately from `/ws/chat/room-2`.

Fix: This is by design. Each path is an isolated group. For a global connection count across all paths, maintain a counter in a shared variable.

4. Broadcasting Does Not Scale Across Servers

Problem: Users connected to different server instances do not see each other's messages.

Cause: `$connection->broadcast()` sends only to clients on the same server process. Multiple instances behind a load balancer each maintain their own connection sets.

Fix: Use a pub/sub backend. Redis works well. Each server subscribes to a Redis channel. Broadcast messages publish to Redis. All servers receive them.

5. Large Messages Cause Disconnects

Problem: The connection drops when sending a large message.

Cause: WebSocket servers enforce a maximum message size. The default is around 1MB. Exceed it, and the server closes the connection.

Fix: Keep messages small. Under 64KB is a good target. For large data transfers, use HTTP endpoints. WebSocket is built for small, frequent messages -- not bulk data.

6. Memory Leak from Tracking Connected Users

Problem: Server memory grows over time and crashes.

Cause: User data stored in a PHP array (like `$chatUsers`) is not cleaned up when users disconnect. The `close` handler does not remove them. The array grows without limit.

Fix: Always clean up in the `close` handler. Remove disconnected users from tracking arrays: `unset($chatUsers[$connection->id])`. Test by connecting and disconnecting repeatedly. Verify memory stays stable.

7. No Authentication on WebSocket Connect

Problem: Anyone can connect to your WebSocket endpoint and see all messages.

Cause: The WebSocket upgrade request does not carry your JWT token in the `Authorization` header. Browsers do not support custom headers on WebSocket connections.

Fix: Pass the token as a query parameter: `ws://localhost:7145/ws/chat?token=eyJ...`. In your `open` handler, validate the token and disconnect if invalid. Use a short-lived token for WebSocket connections. Or authenticate via HTTP first, store the session, and check the session cookie during the upgrade.

Server-Sent Events (SSE)

1. The Polling Problem

Your monitoring dashboard needs live metrics. CPU usage. Memory. Active connections. The numbers change every few seconds.

The obvious solution: poll. A timer fires every three seconds. The browser sends a GET request. The server queries the database. The server responds. The browser updates the page. Repeat.

That works. It also wastes resources. Nineteen out of twenty polls return the same data. Each one opens a connection, sends headers, waits for a response, and closes the connection. The server does the same work whether the data changed or not.

WebSocket solves this. A persistent, bi-directional connection. The server pushes when data changes. But WebSocket is designed for two-way communication. Chat rooms. Collaborative editing. Live gaming. Your dashboard only needs one direction: server to client.

Server-Sent Events (SSE) is the middle ground. One-way streaming over plain HTTP. The server pushes. The client listens. The browser reconnects automatically if the connection drops. No upgrade handshake. No special protocol. Just HTTP with a twist.

2. What SSE Is

HTTP works like this:

```
Client: "Give me /api/metrics"
Server: "Here are the metrics" (connection closes)
Client: "Give me /api/metrics" (new connection, 3 seconds later)
Server: "Here are the metrics" (connection closes)
```

WebSocket works like this:

```
Client: "Upgrade to WebSocket on /ws/metrics"
Server: "Upgrade accepted. Connection open."
Client: "Subscribe to CPU metrics"
Server: "CPU: 42%"
Server: "CPU: 38%" (pushed at any time)
Client: "Unsubscribe"
```

SSE works like this:

```
Client: "Give me /events (keep the connection open)"
Server: "data: CPU 42%"
Server: "data: CPU 38%" (pushed, no client request)
Server: "data: CPU 45%" (keeps flowing)
Client: (just listens)
```

The key differences:

Feature	HTTP Polling	WebSocket	SSE
Direction	Client to server	Both ways	Server to client

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Connection	New each time	Persistent	Persistent
Protocol	HTTP	WebSocket (upgrade)	HTTP
Auto-reconnect	No	No (manual)	Yes (built-in)
Binary data	Yes	Yes	No (text only)
Browser support	Universal	Universal	Universal (except IE)
Complexity	Simple	Moderate	Simple

SSE uses plain HTTP. No protocol upgrade. No special server support. The server sets **Content-Type: text/event-stream** and keeps the connection open. The browser's **EventSource** API handles reconnection, event parsing, and last-event-ID tracking.

3. Your First Stream

Create `src/routes/events.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/events", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $generator = function () {
        for ($i = 0; $i < 10; $i++) {
            yield "data: " . json_encode(["count" => $i, "message" => "tick"]) . "\n\n";
            sleep(1);
        }
        yield "data: " . json_encode(["done" => true]) . "\n\n";
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);
});
```

Three things happen here:

- **\$generator** is a closure that returns a PHP generator. Each **yield** produces one SSE message.
- **\$response->stream()** tells Tina4 to keep the connection open and send each chunk as the generator yields it.
- The framework sets **Content-Type: text/event-stream**, **Cache-Control: no-cache**, **Connection: keep-alive**, and **X-Accel-Buffering: no** for you.

Start the server and test with curl:

```
curl -N http://localhost:7145/events
```

You see one message per second:

```
data: {"count":0,"message":"tick"}
```

```
data: {"count":1,"message":"tick"}
```

```
data: {"count":2,"message":"tick"}
```

Each message arrives the moment the server yields it. No buffering. No waiting for the full response.

4. The SSE Protocol

SSE messages are plain text with a simple format. Each message is one or more field lines followed by a blank line.

The **data:** Field

The most common field. Contains the message payload.

```
data: Hello, world
```

Multiple **data:** lines in one message get joined with newlines:

```
data: line one
data: line two
```

The client receives this as `"line one\nline two"`.

The **event:** Field

Names the event type. Without it, the browser fires `onmessage`. With it, the browser fires a named event listener.

```
yield "event: metrics\n" + data: " . json_encode(["cpu" => 42]) . "\n\n";
yield "event: alert\n" + data: " . json_encode(["level" => "high", "message" => "CPU spike"]) . "\n\n";
```

On the client:

```
source.addEventListener("metrics", (e) => {
  const data = JSON.parse(e.data);
  updateDashboard(data);
});

source.addEventListener("alert", (e) => {
  const data = JSON.parse(e.data);
  showAlert(data.message);
});
```

Named events let you multiplex different data types on a single connection.

The **id:** Field

Sets the last event ID. If the connection drops, the browser sends `Last-Event-ID` in the reconnection request. Your server can resume from where it left off.

```
yield "id: {i}\n" + data: " . json_encode(["count" => i]) . "\n\n";
```

The `retry` Field

Tells the browser how many milliseconds to wait before reconnecting after a disconnect.

```
yield "retry: 5000\n\n"; // reconnect after 5 seconds
```

The Delimiter

Every SSE message ends with two newlines: `\n\n`. This tells the browser that the message is complete. A single `\n` separates fields within one message.

```
// One complete SSE message:
yield "event: update\nid: 42\ndata: " . json_encode(["value" => 100]) . "\n\n";

// Broken down:
// event: update\n      <- event type
// id: 42\n              <- event ID
// data: {"value":100}\n <- payload
// \n                  <- end of message (blank line)
```

5. Frontend: EventSource

The browser provides `EventSource` for consuming SSE streams. It handles connection management, reconnection, and message parsing.

Basic Usage

```
const source = new EventSource("/events");

source.onmessage = function (event) {
  const data = JSON.parse(event.data);
  console.log("Received:", data);
};

source.onerror = function () {
  console.log("Connection lost. Reconnecting...");
};

source.onopen = function () {
  console.log("Connected");
};
```

`EventSource` reconnects automatically when the connection drops. The `onerror` handler fires, the browser waits (default 3 seconds), then reconnects. Your server receives a new request with the `Last-Event-ID` header if you sent event IDs.

Named Events

```
const source = new EventSource("/events");

source.addEventListener("metrics", function (event) {
  updateChart(JSON.parse(event.data));
});

source.addEventListener("notification", function (event) {
  showToast(JSON.parse(event.data));
});

source.addEventListener("heartbeat", function (event) {
  // Connection is alive
});
```

Closing the Connection

```
source.close();
```

The browser stops reconnecting. The server receives a client disconnect.

With Authentication

EventSource does not support custom headers. Pass tokens as query parameters:

```
const token = getAuthToken();
const source = new EventSource(`/events?token=${token}`);
```

On the server:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\Auth;

Router::get("/events", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $token = $request->query["token"] ?? "";
    $payload = Auth::validToken($token);
    if (!$payload) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Unauthorized"], 401);
    }

    $generator = function () use ($payload) {
        while (true) {
            yield "data: " . json_encode(["user" => $payload["email"]]) . "\n\n";
            sleep(5);
        }
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);
});
```

6. Real Examples

Live Dashboard

Stream database metrics every five seconds:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\Database\Database;

Router::get("/events/dashboard", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $generator = function () {
        $db = Database::fromEnv();
        while (true) {
            $orders = $db->fetch("SELECT count(*) as total FROM orders")->records[0] ?? ["total" => 0];
            $revenue = $db->fetch("SELECT sum(total) as revenue FROM orders WHERE date(created_at) = date('now')")->records[0] ?? ["revenue" => 0];

            yield "data: " . json_encode([
                "orders" => (int) $orders["total"],
                "revenue" => (float) ($revenue["revenue"] ?? 0),
            ]) . "\n\n";
            sleep(5);
        }
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);
});
```

The client updates the dashboard numbers without polling. One connection. One query every five seconds. No wasted requests.

Build Progress

Stream deployment status as it happens:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/events/deploy/{buildId}", function (Request $request, Response $response, string $buildId) {
    $generator = function () use ($buildId) {
        $steps = [
            ["pull", "Pulling latest code..."],
            ["install", "Installing dependencies..."],
            ["test", "Running tests..."],
            ["build", "Building application..."],
            ["deploy", "Deploying to production..."],
            ["done", "Deployment complete"],
        ];

        foreach ($steps as [$step, $message]) {
            yield "event: progress\ndata: " . json_encode([
                "step" => $step,
                "message" => $message,
                "build_id" => $buildId,
            ]) . "\n\n";
        }
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);
});
```

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```

        sleep(2); // simulate work
    }
};

return $response->stream($generator);
});

```

The browser shows a progress bar that updates in real time. Each step arrives as it completes. The user watches the deployment unfold instead of staring at a spinner.

LLM Chat Streaming

Stream AI responses token by token. This is how ChatGPT works:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/events/chat", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $prompt = $request->query["q"] ?? "Hello";

    $generator = function () use ($prompt) {
        // Call the LLM API with streaming enabled
        $body = json_encode([
            "model" => "claude-sonnet-4-20250514",
            "max_tokens" => 512,
            "stream" => true,
            "messages" => [{"role" => "user", "content" => $prompt}],
        ]);

        $context = stream_context_create([
            "http" => [
                "method" => "POST",
                "header" => implode("\r\n", [
                    "Content-Type: application/json",
                    "x-api-key: " . getenv("ANTHROPIC_API_KEY"),
                    "anthropic-version: 2023-06-01",
                ]),
                "content" => $body,
            ],
        ]);

        $stream = fopen("https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages", "r", false, $context);
        while (!feof($stream)) {
            $line = trim(fgets($stream));
            if (str_starts_with($line, "data: ")) {
                $chunk = json_decode(substr($line, 6), true);
                if (($chunk["type"] ?? "") === "content_block_delta") {
                    $text = $chunk["delta"]["text"] ?? "";
                    yield "data: " . json_encode(["token" => $text]) . "\n\n";
                }
            }
        }
        fclose($stream);

        yield "data: " . json_encode(["done" => true]) . "\n\n";
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);

```



```
});
```

The frontend appends each token as it arrives:

```
const source = new EventSource(`/events/chat?q=${encodeURIComponent(question)}`);
const output = document.getElementById("response");

source.onmessage = function (event) {
    const data = JSON.parse(event.data);
    if (data.done) {
        source.close();
        return;
    }
    output.textContent += data.token;
};
```

The response builds character by character. The user reads as the AI writes. No waiting for the full answer.

File Processing Progress

Upload a CSV, stream the processing status:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::post("/api/import", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $file = $request->files["csv"] ?? null;
    if (!$file) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "No file"], 400);
    }

    $lines = explode("\n", trim($file["content"]));
    $total = count($lines) - 1; // minus header

    $generator = function () use ($lines, $total) {
        $rows = array_slice($lines, 1);
        foreach ($rows as $i => $line) {
            // Process each row
            $cols = explode(",", $line);
            // ... insert into database ...
            $processed = $i + 1;
            yield "data: " . json_encode([
                "processed" => $processed,
                "total" => $total,
                "percent" => (int) round($processed / $total * 100),
            ]) . "\n\n";
        }

        yield "data: " . json_encode(["done" => true, "total" => $total]) . "\n\n";
    };

    return $response->stream($generator, "text/event-stream");
});
```

The browser shows a progress bar that fills as each row is processed. The user sees exactly where the import stands.

7. Custom Content Types

SSE defaults to `text/event-stream`, but `$response->stream()` accepts any content type as the second argument. Use this for newline-delimited JSON (NDJSON), chunked binary, or custom protocols.

NDJSON Streaming

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;
use Tina4\Database\Database;

Router::get("/api/export", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $generator = function () {
        $db = Database::fromEnv();
        $result = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products", 1000);
        foreach ($result->records as $row) {
            yield json_encode($row) . "\n";
        }
    };

    return $response->stream($generator, "application/x-ndjson");
});
```

Each line is a complete JSON object. The client reads line by line. No need to parse a giant array. Memory stays flat regardless of how many rows you export.

Consuming NDJSON on the Client

```
async function streamProducts() {
    const response = await fetch("/api/export");
    const reader = response.body.getReader();
    const decoder = new TextDecoder();
    let buffer = "";

    while (true) {
        const { done, value } = await reader.read();
        if (done) break;

        buffer += decoder.decode(value, { stream: true });
        const lines = buffer.split("\n");
        buffer = lines.pop(); // keep incomplete line

        for (const line of lines) {
            if (line.trim()) {
                const product = JSON.parse(line);
                addToTable(product);
            }
        }
    }
}
```

8. SSE vs WebSocket

Both keep a persistent connection. Both push data in real time. The choice depends on the direction of communication.

Use Case	Choose	Why
Live dashboard	SSE	Server pushes metrics. Client only listens.
Chat application	WebSocket	Both sides send messages.
Notification feed	SSE	Server pushes. Client marks as read via separate HTTP POST.
Collaborative editor	WebSocket	Both sides send cursor positions and edits.
Build/deploy progress	SSE	Server streams status. Client watches.
LLM token streaming	SSE	Server streams tokens. Client displays them.
Online gaming	WebSocket	Low-latency, bi-directional input and state.
Stock ticker	SSE	Server pushes prices. Client displays.
File upload progress	HTTP (native)	Browser tracks upload. Server tracks processing via SSE.

Rule of thumb: If the client only listens, use SSE. If the client sends data back on the same connection, use WebSocket.

SSE has one advantage WebSocket does not: automatic reconnection. The browser's `EventSource` reconnects without any code. WebSocket requires manual reconnection logic (or `frond.js` which handles it for you).

9. Production Considerations

Nginx Proxy Buffering

Nginx buffers responses by default. SSE messages accumulate in the buffer and arrive in batches instead of one at a time. Tina4 sets `X-Accel-Buffering: no` on streaming responses, which tells Nginx to disable buffering for that response.

If you configure Nginx manually:

```
location /events/ {
    proxy_pass http://localhost:7145;
    proxy_buffering off;
    proxy_cache off;
    proxy_set_header Connection '';
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    chunked_transfer_encoding off;
}
```

Connection Limits

Each SSE connection is a persistent HTTP connection. Most servers limit concurrent connections. Tina4's built-in server uses `stream_select()` to multiplex thousands of connections in a single process. In production:

- Monitor open connections
- Set timeouts on long-running streams
- Close streams when the client no longer needs them

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/events/metrics", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $generator = function () {
        for ($i = 0; $i < 3600; $i++) { // max 1 hour (one message per second)
            yield "data: " . json_encode(["cpu" => get_cpu()]) . "\n\n";
            sleep(1);
        }
        yield "event: timeout\n" . "data: " . json_encode(["message" => "Stream expired. Reconnect."]);
    };

    return $response->stream($generator);
});
```

`$response->stream()` checks `connection_aborted()` after each chunk and breaks the loop when the client disconnects, so dropped clients release their slot immediately.

Heartbeat Messages

Some proxies and load balancers close idle connections after a timeout (typically 30-60 seconds). Send a heartbeat comment to keep the connection alive:

```
$generator = function () {
    while (true) {
        if (has_new_data()) {
            yield "data: " . json_encode(get_data()) . "\n\n";
        } else {
            yield ": heartbeat\n\n"; // SSE comment (colon prefix) -- ignored by EventSource
        }
        sleep(5);
    }
};
```

Lines starting with `:` are SSE comments. The browser ignores them, but they keep the connection alive through proxies.

10. Exercise: Build a Live Metrics Dashboard

Build a dashboard that streams server metrics to the browser.

Requirements

- SSE endpoint at `GET /events/server-metrics` that streams every 3 seconds:
- Current timestamp
- A random CPU percentage (simulate with `random_int(10, 90)`)
- A random memory percentage
- A random request count
- HTML page at `GET /dashboard` that:
 - Connects to the SSE endpoint
 - Displays the four metrics in cards
 - Updates the values in real time (no page refresh)
 - Shows a "Connected" / "Reconnecting..." status indicator

Test by:

- Open `http://localhost:7145/dashboard`
- Watch the numbers update every 3 seconds
- Stop the server and verify "Reconnecting..." appears
- Restart the server and verify it reconnects and resumes updating

11. Solution

Create `src/routes/server_metrics.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Request;
use Tina4\Response;

Router::get("/events/server-metrics", function (Request $request, Response $response) {
    $generator = function () {
        yield "retry: 3000\n\n";
        $counter = 0;
        while (true) {
            $payload = json_encode([
                "timestamp" => gmdate("c"),
                "cpu" => random_int(10, 90),
                "memory" => random_int(30, 85),
            ]);
            yield $payload . "\n\n";
            $counter++;
        }
    };
    $response->send($generator->get());
});
```

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```

        </script>
    </body>
</html>
HTML;
return $response->html($html);
});

```

Open <http://localhost:7145/dashboard>. The numbers update every three seconds. Stop the server. The status turns red: "Reconnecting..." Start it again. The status turns green. The numbers resume.

No polling. No WebSocket. No JavaScript timers. The browser handles everything.

12. What You Learned

- **SSE streams data from server to client** over a single HTTP connection. No upgrade. No special protocol.
- `$response->stream($generator)` keeps the connection open and flushes each chunk as the generator yields it.
- **The SSE protocol** uses `data:`, `event:`, `id:`, and `retry:` fields. Messages end with `\n\n`.
- `EventSource` on the client handles connection, parsing, and automatic reconnection.
- **Named events** let you multiplex different data types on one stream.
- **Custom content types** let you stream NDJSON, binary, or any format -- pass the type as the second argument to `stream()`.
- **SSE is for one-way server pushes**. Use WebSocket when the client needs to send data back on the same connection.
- **Heartbeat comments** keep connections alive through proxies. Tina4 sets `X-Accel-Buffering: no` to disable nginx buffering and breaks the loop on `connection_aborted()` to release dropped clients.

One direction. One connection. Real-time data. The server speaks. The client listens. The rest is infrastructure.

WSDL / SOAP

1. When You Need SOAP

Most new APIs use REST and JSON. But enterprise systems — banks, insurers, government portals, ERP platforms — often expose SOAP services. You need to interoperate. Sometimes you are also required to expose a SOAP interface for an existing client that cannot change.

Tina4 provides a [WSDL](#) base class. Extend it. Annotate methods with [@wsdl_operation](#). The WSDL document is generated automatically and served at [?wsdl](#). Your service handles both SOAP 1.1 and SOAP 1.2.

2. Creating a SOAP Service

Extend [Tina4\WSDL](#). Each public method annotated with [@wsdl_operation](#) becomes a SOAP operation.

```
<?php
use Tina4\WSDL;

class CalculatorService extends WSDL
{
    /**
     * Add two numbers together.
     *
     * @wsdl_operation
     * @param float $a First operand
     * @param float $b Second operand
     * @return float Sum of a and b
     */
    public function Add(float $a, float $b): float
    {
        return $a + $b;
    }

    /**
     * Subtract b from a.
     *
     * @wsdl_operation
     * @param float $a
     * @param float $b
     * @return float
     */
    public function Subtract(float $a, float $b): float
    {
        return $a - $b;
    }

    /**
     * Multiply two numbers.
     *
     * @wsdl_operation
     * @param float $a
```

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```

    * @param float $b
    * @return float
    */
    public function Multiply(float $a, float $b): float
    {
        return $a * $b;
    }

    /**
     * Divide a by b.
     *
     * @wsdl_operation
     * @param float $a Dividend
     * @param float $b Divisor (must not be zero)
     * @return float Quotient
     */
    public function Divide(float $a, float $b): float
    {
        if ($b == 0) {
            throw new \SoapFault('Receiver', 'Division by zero is not allowed');
        }
        return $a / $b;
    }
}
}
---

```

3. Registering the Service

Mount the service on a URL path. Tina4 handles routing, WSDL generation, and request dispatching:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::soap('/calculator', new CalculatorService());

```

That is the entire registration. The service is now live at:

- **POST /calculator** — accepts SOAP envelopes
- **GET /calculator?wsdl** — returns the auto-generated WSDL document

4. Accessing the Auto-Generated WSDL

```
curl http://localhost:7145/calculator?wsdl
```

Response:

```

<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<wsdl:definitions
    name="CalculatorService"
    targetNamespace="http://localhost:7145/calculator"
    xmlns:wsdl="http://schemas.xmlsoap.org/wsdl/"
    xmlns:soap="http://schemas.xmlsoap.org/wsdl/soap/"
    xmlns:tns="http://localhost:7145/calculator"
    xmlns:xsd="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema">

```

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```

<wsdl:types>
  <xsd:schema targetNamespace="http://localhost:7145/calculator">
    <xsd:element name="Add">
      <xsd:complexType>
        <xsd:sequence>
          <xsd:element name="a" type="xsd:float"/>
          <xsd:element name="b" type="xsd:float"/>
        </xsd:sequence>
      </xsd:complexType>
    </xsd:element>
    <!-- ... other operations ... -->
  </xsd:schema>
</wsdl:types>

<wsdl:portType name="CalculatorServicePortType">
  <wsdl:operation name="Add">
    <wsdl:documentation>Add two numbers together.</wsdl:documentation>
    <wsdl:input message="tns:AddSoapIn"/>
    <wsdl:output message="tns:AddSoapOut"/>
  </wsdl:operation>
  <!-- ... -->
</wsdl:portType>

<!-- binding, service, port elements follow -->
</wsdl:definitions>

```

The WSDL is derived from your PHP type hints and docblock comments. You write PHP. Tina4 writes the WSDL.

5. Calling the Service with PHP SoapClient

Test your service using PHP's built-in [SoapClient](#):

```

<?php

$client = new SoapClient('http://localhost:7145/calculator?wsdl', [
    'trace'      => true,
    'exceptions' => true
]);

// Add
$result = $client->Add(['a' => 10.5, 'b' => 4.5]);
echo $result->AddResult;    // 15.0

// Subtract
$result = $client->Subtract(['a' => 100, 'b' => 37]);
echo $result->SubtractResult;    // 63.0

// Multiply
$result = $client->Multiply(['a' => 6, 'b' => 7]);
echo $result->MultiplyResult;    // 42.0

// Divide
$result = $client->Divide(['a' => 22, 'b' => 7]);
echo $result->DivideResult;    // 3.142857...

// SOAP Fault on divide by zero

```

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```
try {  
    $client->Divide(['a' => 1, 'b' => 0]);  
} catch (\SoapFault $e) {  
    echo $e->getMessage(); // Division by zero is not allowed  
}  
---
```

6. A Real-World Service: Currency Conversion

```
<?php
use Tina4\WSDL;

class CurrencyService extends WSDL
{
    private array $rates = [
        'USD' => 1.0,
        'EUR' => 0.92,
        'GBP' => 0.79,
        'JPY' => 149.50,
        'AUD' => 1.54
    ];

    /**
     * Convert an amount from one currency to another.
     *
     * @wSDL_operation
     * @param float $amount Amount to convert
     * @param string $fromCurrency Source currency code (e.g., USD)
     * @param string $toCurrency Target currency code (e.g., EUR)
     * @return float Converted amount
     */
    public function Convert(float $amount, string $fromCurrency, string $toCurrency): float
    {
        $from = strtoupper($fromCurrency);
        $to = strtoupper($toCurrency);

        if (!isset($this->rates[$from])) {
            throw new \SoapFault('Receiver', "Unsupported currency: {$from}");
        }

        if (!isset($this->rates[$to])) {
            throw new \SoapFault('Receiver', "Unsupported currency: {$to}");
        }

        // Convert via USD as the base
        $usdAmount = $amount / $this->rates[$from];
        return round($usdAmount * $this->rates[$to], 2);
    }

    /**
     * List all supported currency codes.
     *
     * @wSDL_operation
     * @return string Comma-separated list of supported currencies
     */
    public function GetSupportedCurrencies(): string
    {
        return implode(',', array_keys($this->rates));
    }

    /**
     * Get the exchange rate from one currency to another.
     *
     * @wSDL_operation
     * @param string $fromCurrency Source currency code
     * @param string $toCurrency Target currency code
     */
}
```

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```

        * @return float          Exchange rate
        */
        public function GetRate(string $fromCurrency, string $toCurrency): float
        {
            return $this->Convert(1.0, $fromCurrency, $toCurrency);
        }
    }
}

```

Register:

```
Router::soap('/currency', new CurrencyService());
```

Call:

```

$client = new SoapClient('http://localhost:7145/currency?wsdl');

$converted = $client->Convert(['amount' => 100, 'fromCurrency' => 'USD', 'toCurrency' => 'EUR']);
echo $converted->ConvertResult;    // 92.0

$currencies = $client->GetSupportedCurrencies();
echo $currencies->GetSupportedCurrenciesResult;    // USD,EUR,GBP,JPY,AUD

```

7. Type Annotations

Tina4 reads PHP 8 type hints to generate XSD types. The mapping is:

PHP type	WSDL/XSD type
<code>int</code>	<code>xsd:integer</code>
<code>float</code>	<code>xsd:float</code>
<code>string</code>	<code>xsd:string</code>
<code>bool</code>	<code>xsd:boolean</code>
<code>array</code>	<code>xsd:anyType</code>

Always use explicit PHP 8 type declarations on parameters and return types. Without them, the WSDL generator falls back to `xsd:anyType`.

8. SOAP Faults

Throw `SoapFault` to return a structured SOAP error to the client. The first argument is the fault code, the second is the fault message.

Standard fault codes:

Code	When to use
<code>'Client'</code>	The request is malformed or missing required data

'Receiver'	The server encountered an error processing a valid request
'VersionMismatch'	SOAP version mismatch

```
/**
 * @wsdl_operation
 * @param int $userId
 * @return string
 */
public function GetUserEmail(int $userId): string
{
    if ($userId <= 0) {
        throw new \SoapFault('Client', 'User ID must be a positive integer');
    }

    $user = $this->db->fetchOne("SELECT email FROM users WHERE id = ?", [$userId]);

    if ($user === null) {
        throw new \SoapFault('Receiver', "User {$userId} not found");
    }

    return $user['email'];
}
---
```

9. Testing with curl

Send a raw SOAP envelope to test without a SOAP client:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/calculator \
-H "Content-Type: text/xml; charset=utf-8" \
-H "SOAPAction: \"Add\"" \
-d '<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<soap:Envelope xmlns:soap="http://schemas.xmlsoap.org/soap/envelope/">
  <soap:Body>
    <Add xmlns="http://localhost:7145/calculator">
      <a>10.5</a>
      <b>4.5</b>
    </Add>
  </soap:Body>
</soap:Envelope>'
```

Response:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<soap:Envelope xmlns:soap="http://schemas.xmlsoap.org/soap/envelope/">
  <soap:Body>
    <AddResponse xmlns="http://localhost:7145/calculator">
      <AddResult>15</AddResult>
    </AddResponse>
  </soap:Body>
</soap:Envelope>
---
```

10. Gotchas

1. Method not appearing in WSDL

Problem: A method exists on the class but does not appear in the generated WSDL.

Cause: Missing `@wsdl_operation` annotation in the docblock.

Fix: Add `@wsdl_operation` to the method's PHPDoc comment. All WSDL-exposed methods must have it.

2. Wrong XSD types

Problem: The client receives strings instead of numbers, or booleans instead of integers.

Cause: PHP type hints are missing. Without them, the generator defaults to `xsd:anyType`.

Fix: Always declare explicit parameter and return types using PHP 8 typed properties and return types.

3. SOAP Fault not reaching the client

Problem: Throwing `SoapFault` inside the service does not produce a proper SOAP fault response. The client receives a generic HTTP 500.

Cause: The exception is caught by a top-level error handler before Tina4 can serialize it as a SOAP fault.

Fix: Only throw `\SoapFault`. Do not throw generic exceptions. Tina4's SOAP dispatcher catches `SoapFault` and serializes it correctly.

4. WSDL URL is wrong in generated document

Problem: The generated WSDL contains `localhost` as the service URL. Clients in other environments cannot use it.

Cause: The WSDL generator reads the `Host` header from the current request.

Fix: Set `TINA4_HOST_NAME` in your environment to override the auto-detected host: `TINA4_HOST_NAME=https://api.example.com`.

DI Container

1. The Problem with Global State

Without dependency injection, your route handlers create their own service instances:

```
Router::post('/api/orders', function ($request, $response) {
    $db      = new Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL'));
    $mailer  = new Mailer(getenv('TINA4_MAIL_HOST'), getenv('TINA4_MAIL_PORT'));
    $logger  = new Logger('/var/log/app.log');
    // ...
});
```

Every handler creates fresh instances. Configuration is duplicated. Testing requires mocking at the class level. The code is tightly coupled to concrete implementations.

Dependency injection inverts this. You register services once. The container creates and manages them. Handlers receive what they need without knowing how it was constructed.

Tina4 provides a built-in **Container** class. No Reflection-based auto-wiring complexity. Register factories. Retrieve by name. Singletons for shared instances.

2. Creating a Container

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();
```

The container is an empty registry. Register services into it. Retrieve them by name.

3. register() — Transient Services

register() stores a factory callable. Each call to **get()** invokes the factory and returns a new instance.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();

// Register a factory for a database connection
$container->register('db', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL'));
});

// Register a logger
$container->register('logger', function () {
    return new \Psr\Log\NullLogger();
});

// Each get() creates a new instance
```

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```
$db1 = $container->get('db');
$db2 = $container->get('db');

var_dump($db1 === $db2);    // bool(false) -- different instances
```

Use transient services when you need isolated instances per request or per operation.

4. singleton() — Shared Instances

`singleton()` stores a factory that runs once. Every call to `get()` returns the same instance.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();

// Register as singleton -- created once, reused everywhere
$container->singleton('mailer', function () {
    $mailer = new \Tina4\Messenger();
    $mailer->setHost(getenv('TINA4_MAIL_HOST'));
    $mailer->setPort((int) getenv('TINA4_MAIL_PORT'));
    $mailer->setUsername(getenv('SMTP_USER'));
    $mailer->setPassword(getenv('SMTP_PASS'));
    return $mailer;
});

$container->singleton('cache', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Cache(backend: getenv('TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND', 'memory'));
});

// Same instance every time
$m1 = $container->get('mailer');
$m2 = $container->get('mailer');

var_dump($m1 === $m2);    // bool(true) -- same instance
```

Use singletons for services that are expensive to create (database pools, HTTP clients, email configuration) or must share state (caches, event buses).

5. get() and has()

`get()` retrieves a service by name. `has()` checks existence before retrieving.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();
$container->singleton('db', fn() => new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL')));

// Check before retrieving
if ($container->has('db')) {
    $db = $container->get('db');
}
```

```
// Throws \Tina4\ContainerException if name not registered
try {
    $missing = $container->get('nonexistent');
} catch (\Tina4\ContainerException $e) {
    echo $e->getMessage(); // "Service 'nonexistent' is not registered"
}
}
```

6. Services Depending on Other Services

Factories receive the container instance as their argument. Use it to resolve dependencies:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();

$container->singleton('logger', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Debug();
});

$container->singleton('db', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL'));
});

// OrderService depends on db and logger
$container->singleton('order_service', function () use ($container) {
    return new OrderService(
        db: $container->get('db'),
        logger: $container->get('logger')
    );
});

class OrderService {
    public function __construct(
        private \Tina4\Database $db,
        private \Tina4\Debug $logger
    ) {}

    public function createOrder(array $data): array {
        $this->logger->message("Creating order", TINA4_LOG_INFO, $data);
        // $this->db->execute(...);
        return ['id' => rand(1000, 9999), ...$data];
    }
}

$order = $container->get('order_service');
$order = $order->createOrder(['customer' => 'Alice', 'total' => 59.99]);
```

Services are composed through the container. Each service is unaware of how its dependencies were built.

7. Binding a Container to Route Handlers

Pass the container into your route handlers via [use](#):

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```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Container;

// Bootstrap container in app.php or index.php
$container = new Container();

$container->singleton('db', fn() => new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL')));

$container->singleton('order_service', function () use ($container) {
    return new OrderService($container->get('db'));
});

// Route uses the container
Router::post('/api/orders', function ($request, $response) use ($container) {
    $orderService = $container->get('order_service');
    $body = $request->body;

    $order = $orderService->createOrder([
        'customer' => $body['customer'],
        'items'     => $body['items'],
        'total'     => $body['total']
    ]);

    return $response->json(['order' => $order], 201);
});

Router::get('/api/orders/{id:int}', function ($request, $response) use ($container) {
    $orderService = $container->get('order_service');
    $order = $orderService->findOrder($request->params['id']);

    if ($order === null) {
        return $response->json(['error' => 'Order not found'], 404);
    }

    return $response->json(['order' => $order]);
});
---

```

8. reset() — Testing

`reset()` clears all registrations. Use it between test cases to prevent state leakage:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Container;

// In your test setUp
$container = new Container();
$container->singleton('db', fn() => new MockDatabase());

// Run the test
$service = $container->get('db');
assert($service instanceof MockDatabase);

// Tear down
$container->reset();

// Container is empty again

```

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```
assert($container->has('db') === false);
```

9. A Full App Bootstrap

[src/bootstrap.php](#) — all services registered in one place:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();

// Infrastructure
$container->singleton('db', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL'));
});

$container->singleton('cache', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Cache(getenv('TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND') ?: 'memory');
});

$container->singleton('queue', function () {
    return new \Tina4\Queue(topic: 'default');
});

$container->singleton('mailer', function () {
    $m = new \Tina4\Messenger();
    $m->setHost(getenv('TINA4_MAIL_HOST'));
    return $m;
});

// Domain services
$container->singleton('user_service', function () use ($container) {
    return new UserService(
        db: $container->get('db'),
        mailer: $container->get('mailer'),
        cache: $container->get('cache')
    );
});

$container->singleton('order_service', function () use ($container) {
    return new OrderService(
        db: $container->get('db'),
        queue: $container->get('queue')
    );
});

return $container;
```

In [index.php](#):

```
$container = require 'src/bootstrap.php';

// Pass to all routes
require 'src/routes/users.php';
require 'src/routes/orders.php';
```

10. Gotchas

1. Circular dependencies

Problem: Service A depends on B, and B depends on A. The container loops forever.

Cause: A circular dependency in your service graph.

Fix: Introduce a third service that both A and B depend on, or restructure to break the cycle. The container does not detect cycles automatically — you will see a PHP stack overflow.

2. Forgetting to use singleton for stateful services

Problem: Two calls to `$container->get('mailer')` produce two SMTP connections.

Cause: Registered with `register()` instead of `singleton()`.

Fix: Use `singleton()` for any service where a single shared instance is correct. Use `register()` only when you explicitly need a new instance each time.

3. Not resetting between tests

Problem: A singleton registered in test A bleeds into test B.

Cause: Tests share the same container instance without calling `reset()`.

Fix: Create a fresh `new Container()` or call `$container->reset()` in `setUp()` in each test class.

4. Storing request-scoped data in a singleton

Problem: User A's request data appears in User B's response.

Cause: A singleton service stores per-request state (current user, request context) on the instance itself.

Fix: Singletons must be stateless or explicitly scoped. Pass per-request data as method arguments rather than storing it on the service instance.

Service Runner

1. Work That Runs Outside HTTP Requests

Not everything fits in an HTTP request. A queue consumer that processes emails. A cache warmer that pre-populates product data on a schedule. These run continuously in the background, independent of web traffic.

Tina4's service runner provides a pattern for long-running background workers. They start with the application, restart on failure, and shut down cleanly.

2. The Service Interface

A background service implements a simple contract: a `run()` method that loops indefinitely, and a `stop()` method that signals it to exit.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Service;

class EmailQueueWorker extends Service
{
    private bool $running = true;
    private \Tina4\Queue $queue;

    public function __construct()
    {
        $this->queue = new \Tina4\Queue(topic: 'emails');
    }

    public function run(): void
    {
        echo "[EmailQueueWorker] Starting...\n";

        while ($this->running) {
            $job = $this->queue->pop();

            if ($job === null) {
                // No jobs pending -- sleep and check again
                sleep(1);
                continue;
            }

            try {
                $this->processEmail($job->payload);
                $job->complete();
                echo "[EmailQueueWorker] Email sent to {$job->payload['to']}\n";
            } catch (\Throwable $e) {
                $job->fail($e->getMessage());
                echo "[EmailQueueWorker] Failed: {$e->getMessage()}\n";
            }
        }

        echo "[EmailQueueWorker] Stopped.\n";
    }
}
```

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```

    }

    public function stop(): void
    {
        $this->running = false;
    }

    private function processEmail(array $payload): void
    {
        // Actual email sending logic here
        // \Tina4\Messenger::send($payload['to'], $payload['subject'], $payload['body']);
        echo "    Sending: {$payload['subject']} -> {$payload['to']}\n";
    }
}

---

```

3. Registering and Starting Services

```

<?php
use Tina4\ServiceRunner;

$runner = new ServiceRunner();

// Register services
$runner->add(new EmailQueueWorker());
$runner->add(new ReportGenerator());
$runner->add(new CacheWarmer());

// Start all services
$runner->start();

```

start() launches each service in its own process or thread (depending on the platform). Services run concurrently and independently.

4. A Report Generator Service

```
<?php
use Tina4\Service;

class ReportGenerator extends Service
{
    private bool $running = true;

    public function run(): void
    {
        echo "[ReportGenerator] Starting...\n";

        while ($this->running) {
            $now = new \DateTimeImmutable();
            $hour = (int) $now->format('G');

            // Generate daily summary at 02:00
            if ($hour === 2 && (int) $now->format('i') === 0) {
                $this->generateDailySummary($now->format('Y-m-d'));
                sleep(61); // Prevent double-trigger within the same minute
                continue;
            }

            sleep(30); // Check every 30 seconds
        }

        echo "[ReportGenerator] Stopped.\n";
    }

    public function stop(): void
    {
        $this->running = false;
    }

    private function generateDailySummary(string $date): void
    {
        echo "[ReportGenerator] Generating summary for {$date}...\n";
        // Build and email/store the report
    }
}

---
```

5. A Cache Warmer Service

Pre-populate the cache at startup and refresh it before it expires:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Service;
use function Tina4\cache_set;

class CacheWarmer extends Service
{
    private bool $running = true;
    private int $ttl = 300; // 5 minutes
    private int $refreshBefore = 60; // Refresh 60 seconds before expiry

    public function run(): void
```

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```

        $this->stop();
    });

    pcntl_signal(SIGINT, function () {
        echo "[RobustWorker] SIGINT received, stopping...\n";
        $this->stop();
    });
}

echo "[RobustWorker] Running...\n";

while ($this->running) {
    if (function_exists('pcntl_signal_dispatch')) {
        pcntl_signal_dispatch();
    }

    $this->doWork();
    sleep(5);
}

echo "[RobustWorker] Graceful shutdown complete.\n";
}

public function stop(): void
{
    $this->running = false;
}

private function doWork(): void
{
    // Business logic here
}
}
}
---

```

7. Running Services as a Standalone Script

For simple deployments, run services directly as a PHP CLI script:

src/workers/run.php:

```

<?php
require __DIR__ . '/../../vendor/autoload.php';

use Tina4\ServiceRunner;

$runner = new ServiceRunner();
$runner->add(new EmailQueueWorker());
$runner->add(new ReportGenerator());
$runner->start();

```

Run it:

```
php src/workers/run.php
```

Keep it alive with a process manager. With Supervisor:

```
[program:tina4-workers]
```

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```
command=php /var/www/app/src/workers/run.php
directory=/var/www/app
autostart=true
autorestart=true
stderr_logfile=/var/log/tina4-workers.err.log
stdout_logfile=/var/log/tina4-workers.out.log
user=www-data
```

With systemd:

```
[Unit]
Description=Tina4 Background Workers
After=network.target

[Service]
Type=simple
User=www-data
WorkingDirectory=/var/www/app
ExecStart=/usr/bin/php src/workers/run.php
Restart=always
RestartSec=5

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

8. Running with Docker

```
FROM php:8.3-cli

WORKDIR /app
COPY . .
RUN composer install --no-dev

CMD ["php", "src/workers/run.php"]

# docker-compose.yml (excerpt)
services:
  web:
    build: .
    # `tina4 serve` requires the Rust CLI; inside Docker we run the framework
    # directly with TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true so the framework boots without it.
    command: sh -c "TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true php index.php"

  workers:
    build: .
    command: php src/workers/run.php
    environment:
      - TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:./data/app.db
      - TINA4_MAIL_HOST=mailhog
    depends_on:
      - db
```

The web service and workers service share the same image. They run independently.

9. Gotchas

1. Services blocking each other

Problem: Two services are registered but only the first one runs. The second never starts.

Cause: The first service's `run()` method blocks the main thread forever. The second service never gets control.

Fix: Either use `ServiceRunner` with proper multi-process support (each service in its own process), or run each service in a separate PHP process. Do not put multiple blocking loops in the same process without concurrency support.

2. Memory leak in long-running workers

Problem: The worker process grows in memory until the server runs out.

Cause: Variables accumulate in the loop. Large result sets are never freed.

Fix: `unset()` large variables inside the loop. Call `gc_collect_cycles()` periodically. Keep loop iterations small — process one job at a time, not thousands.

3. Database connection dropped

Problem: The worker fails after several hours with "server has gone away" or "connection lost."

Cause: The database server closes idle connections. The worker holds a connection for hours and then tries to use a dead connection.

Fix: Reconnect on failure. Wrap your database calls in a try/catch. On `PDOException` matching "gone away" or "connection lost," create a new connection and retry.

4. Not logging worker errors

Problem: The worker silently fails. Nothing appears in logs. Jobs pile up.

Cause: Exceptions inside `processEmail()` or `doWork()` are caught by a bare catch block that does nothing.

Fix: Always log exceptions inside the worker loop using `Debug::message()`. At minimum, log the error and continue to the next job.

MCP Dev Tools

1. What is MCP?

The Model Context Protocol connects AI coding tools to your running application. Claude Code, Cursor, and other assistants speak this protocol. When they connect, they see your database, routes, templates, and files -- not as static text, but as live, queryable tools.

Tina4 ships a built-in MCP server. It starts automatically in dev mode. No configuration needed.

2. How It Works

Set `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in your `.env` file and start the server:

```
php app.php
```

The console prints:

```
MCP server available at http://localhost:7145/__dev/mcp
```

Tina4 writes the connection details to `.claude/settings.json` automatically. Claude Code discovers the server on its next restart. Cursor reads the same file.

Localhost-Only Security

The built-in MCP server activates only when two conditions hold:

- `TINA4_DEBUG=true`
- The server runs on `localhost`, `127.0.0.1`, or `0.0.0.0`

Deploy to a remote server and the MCP endpoint vanishes -- even with debug enabled. This prevents accidental exposure of database queries and file editing in production.

To enable on a staging server (rare, intentional), set:

```
TINA4_MCP_REMOTE=true
```

3. Connecting AI Tools

Claude Code

Tina4 auto-generates `.claude/settings.json`:

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "tina4-dev": {
      "url": "http://localhost:7145/__dev/mcp/sse"
    }
  }
}
```

Restart Claude Code. It connects and lists the tools.

Cursor

Copy the same MCP config into Cursor's settings. The SSE URL is identical.

Manual Connection

Any MCP client can connect via:

- **SSE endpoint:** `GET http://localhost:7145/__dev/mcp/sse` -- returns the message endpoint URL
- **Message endpoint:** `POST http://localhost:7145/__dev/mcp/message` -- accepts JSON-RPC 2.0 messages

4. Built-in Tools

The MCP server exposes 48 tools organized by category. The exact list lives in the framework's `Tina4\Mcp\Tools` registration block -- that is authoritative.

Database

Tool	Description
<code>database_query</code>	Execute a read-only SQL query (SELECT)
<code>database_execute</code>	Execute arbitrary SQL (INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, DDL)
<code>database_tables</code>	List all tables in the database
<code>database_columns</code>	Get column definitions for a specific table

Example -- an AI assistant queries your database directly:

```
Tool: database_query
Arguments: {"sql": "SELECT id, name, email FROM users WHERE active = 1"}
```

The `database_execute` tool handles write operations. It commits automatically after each statement.

Routes

Tool	Description
<code>route_list</code>	List all registered routes with methods and auth status
<code>route_test</code>	Call a route and return status, body, and headers
<code>swagger_spec</code>	Return the full OpenAPI 3.0.3 specification

The `route_test` tool lets an AI assistant verify endpoints without leaving the conversation:

```
Tool: route_test
Arguments: {"method": "GET", "path": "/api/users"}
```

Templates

Tool	Description
<code>template_render</code>	Render a Frond template string with provided data

Useful for testing template snippets:

```
Tool: template_render
Arguments: {"template": "Hello {{ name }}!", "data": "{\"name\": \"Alice\"}"}
```

Files

Tool	Description
<code>file_read</code>	Read a project file (relative to project root)
<code>file_write</code>	Write or update a project file (full overwrite)
<code>file_patch</code>	Targeted edit -- replace <code>old_string</code> with <code>new_string</code> in a file
<code>file_list</code>	List files in a directory
<code>asset_upload</code>	Upload a file to <code>src/public/</code>

File operations are sandboxed. Paths that escape the project directory are rejected. An AI assistant cannot read `/etc/passwd` or write outside your project.

Migrations

Tool	Description
<code>migration_status</code>	List pending and completed migrations
<code>migration_create</code>	Create a new migration file
<code>migration_run</code>	Run all pending migrations

Data and ORM

Tool	Description
<code>orm_describe</code>	List all ORM models with fields, types, and relationships
<code>seed_table</code>	Seed a table with fake data

Infrastructure

Tool	Description
<code>queue_status</code>	Queue size by status (pending, completed, failed)
<code>session_list</code>	Active sessions with data
<code>cache_stats</code>	Response cache hit/miss statistics

Debugging

Tool	Description
<code>log_tail</code>	Read recent log entries
<code>error_log</code>	Recent errors and exceptions with stack traces
<code>env_list</code>	Environment variables (sensitive values redacted)
<code>system_info</code>	Framework version, PHP version, project info

The `env_list` tool redacts any variable containing "secret", "password", "token", "key", or "credential" in its name.

Project introspection

Tool	Description
<code>git_status</code>	Show current branch, modified/untracked files, and recent commits
<code>deps_list</code>	List the project's declared Composer dependencies (from <code>composer.json</code>)
<code>project_overview</code>	One-shot snapshot: dependencies, routes, models, tables, errors, git

Persistent code index

Tool	Description
<code>index_rebuild</code>	Refresh the persistent project index (lazy, mtime-based)
<code>index_search</code>	Find files by path, symbol, route, or summary -- use FIRST for "where is X"
<code>index_file</code>	Full index entry for one file: symbols, routes, imports
<code>index_overview</code>	Project shape: files by language, routes, models, recent edits

Framework documentation (prose)

Tool	Description
<code>docs_list</code>	List framework documentation files
<code>docs_search</code>	Search Tina4 framework docs for a query string -- use before guessing
<code>docs_section</code>	Return a full markdown section from a framework doc file

Live API RAG (reflection)

`api_*` tools query the live framework reflection -- actual class/method signatures, file/line locations, with a `framework` vs `user` source tag. Use these for "what's the signature of X?" questions; `docs_*` is for "explain queues conceptually".

Tool	Description
<code>api_search</code>	Live API search -- finds framework + user classes/methods by name/summary
<code>api_class</code>	Live class reflection -- returns full method list and signatures for an FQN
<code>api_method</code>	Live method reflection -- returns signature, params, return type, file, line

Plan management

The `plan_*` family lets an AI assistant cooperate with a markdown plan file in `plan/`. Tina4 uses these to keep a steady record of in-progress refactors and multi-session work.

Tool	Description
------	-------------

<code>plan_current</code>	The active plan: title, steps (done/not), next step, progress
<code>plan_list</code>	All plans in <code>plan/</code> with progress and which one is active
<code>plan_create</code>	Create a new markdown plan and make it active
<code>plan_switch_to</code>	Make a different plan the active one
<code>plan_complete_step</code>	Tick a step as done (call the moment the step finishes)
<code>plan_add_step</code>	Append a new unchecked step to the current plan
<code>plan_note</code>	Append a timestamped note/breadcrumb to the current plan
<code>plan_archive</code>	Move a finished plan to <code>plan/done/</code> and clear the current pointer
<code>plan_read</code>	Full structured view of any plan by filename
<code>plan_flesh</code>	Auto-generate concrete build steps via qwen and append them to a plan

5. Protocol Details

The MCP server uses JSON-RPC 2.0 over HTTP. Two endpoints serve the protocol:

SSE Endpoint (GET)

```
GET /__dev/mcp/sse
Content-Type: text/event-stream
```

Returns the message endpoint URL as a server-sent event:

```
event: endpoint
data: http://localhost:7145/__dev/mcp/message
```

Message Endpoint (POST)

```
POST /__dev/mcp/message
Content-Type: application/json
```

Accepts JSON-RPC 2.0 requests:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "id": 1,
  "method": "tools/list",
  "params": {}
}
```

```
}
```

Returns JSON-RPC 2.0 responses:

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "id": 1,
  "result": {
    "tools": [
      {"name": "database_query", "description": "Execute a read-only SQL query", "inputSchema":
    ]
  }
}
```

Lifecycle

- Client sends `initialize` -- server responds with capabilities
- Client sends `notifications/initialized` -- server acknowledges
- Client calls `tools/list` -- server returns all registered tools with schemas
- Client calls `tools/call` with tool name and arguments -- server executes and returns results
- Client calls `resources/list` and `resources/read` for data resources

6. Troubleshooting

MCP server not starting:

- Check `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in `.env`
- Verify the server is running on localhost (not a remote host)

Claude Code not detecting the server:

- Restart Claude Code after starting the Tina4 server
- Check `.claude/settings.json` exists with the correct URL
- Verify the port matches your server's port

Tools returning errors:

- Database tools require `$db = new Database(...)` in `app.php`
- File tools are sandboxed to the project directory
- `database_execute` only works on localhost

Remote server — MCP disabled:

- This is intentional. Set `TINA4_MCP_REMOTE=true` only on staging environments you trust
- Never enable MCP on production servers

Building Custom MCP Servers

1. Beyond Dev Tools

Chapter 27 covered the built-in MCP server that ships with Tina4. It exposes framework internals for AI-assisted development. This chapter goes further: you build your own MCP servers that expose your application's business logic.

A CRM system exposes customer lookup. An accounting system exposes invoice queries. A warehouse system exposes inventory checks. Any domain logic that an AI assistant should access becomes an MCP tool.

2. Creating an MCP Server

Import `McpServer` and create an instance on any path:

```
use Tina4\McpServer;

$mcp = new McpServer("/api/my-tools", name: "My App Tools", version: "1.0.0");
```

The server registers HTTP endpoints at:

- `POST /api/my-tools/message` -- JSON-RPC message handler
- `GET /api/my-tools/sse` -- SSE endpoint for client discovery

Register it with the router in `app.php` before `run()`:

```
$mcp->registerRoutes($router);
```

3. Registering Tools with `#[McpTool]`

The `#[McpTool]` attribute turns a method into an MCP tool. Type hints become the input schema automatically:

```
use Tina4\McpServer;
use Tina4\McpTool;

$mcp = new McpServer("/crm/mcp", name: "CRM Tools");

class CrmTools
{
    #[McpTool("lookup_customer", description: "Find a customer by email", server: "crm")]
    public function lookupCustomer(string $email): array
    {
        global $db;
        return $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM customers WHERE email = ?", [$email]);
    }

    #[McpTool("recent_orders", description: "Get recent orders for a customer", server: "crm")]
    public function recentOrders(int $customerId, int $limit = 10): array
    {
```

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```

        global $db;
        $result = $db->fetch(
            "SELECT * FROM orders WHERE customer_id = ? ORDER BY created_at DESC",
            [$customerId], $limit
        );
        return $result->toArray();
    }
}

```

The attribute extracts:

- **Parameter names** from the method signature
- **Types** from type hints (`string` -> `"string"`, `int` -> `"integer"`, etc.)
- **Required vs optional** -- parameters with defaults are optional
- **Description** from the `description` argument or the docblock

An AI assistant sees these tools and their schemas:

```

{
  "name": "lookup_customer",
  "description": "Find a customer by email",
  "inputSchema": {
    "type": "object",
    "properties": {
      "email": {"type": "string"}
    },
    "required": ["email"]
  }
}
---

```

4. Registering Resources with #[McpResource]

Resources are read-only data endpoints. They expose reference data that AI assistants can browse:

```

use Tina4\McpResource;

class CrmResources
{
    #[McpResource("crm://product-catalog", description: "All active products", server: "crm")]
    public function productCatalog(): array
    {
        global $db;
        return $db->fetch("SELECT id, name, price, category FROM products WHERE active = 1")->toArray();
    }

    #[McpResource("crm://tax-rates", description: "Current tax rates by region", server: "crm")]
    public function taxRates(): array
    {
        global $db;
        return $db->fetch("SELECT region, rate FROM tax_rates")->toArray();
    }
}

```

Resources are accessed via `resources/list` and `resources/read` in the MCP protocol.

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5. Class-Based MCP Services

Group related tools into a service class. Each method with `#[McpTool]` becomes a tool:

```
use Tina4\McpServer;
use Tina4\McpTool;

$mcp = new McpServer("/accounting/mcp", name: "Accounting Tools");

class AccountingService
{
    private $db;

    public function __construct($db)
    {
        $this->db = $db;
    }

    #[McpTool("invoice_lookup", description: "Find an invoice by number", server: "accounting")]
    public function lookup(string $invoiceNo): ?array
    {
        return $this->db->fetchOne(
            "SELECT * FROM invoices WHERE invoice_no = ?", [$invoiceNo]
        );
    }

    #[McpTool("outstanding_balances", description: "List all unpaid invoices", server: "accounting")]
    public function balances(float $minAmount = 0.0): array
    {
        return $this->db->fetch(
            "SELECT * FROM invoices WHERE paid = 0 AND total >= ?", [$minAmount]
        )->toArray();
    }

    #[McpTool("monthly_summary", description: "Revenue summary for a month", server: "accounting")]
    public function summary(int $year, int $month): ?array
    {
        return $this->db->fetchOne(
            "SELECT SUM(total) as revenue, COUNT(*) as invoice_count "
            . "FROM invoices WHERE strftime('%Y', created_at) = ? "
            . "AND strftime('%m', created_at) = ?",
            [(string)$year, str_pad($month, 2, '0', STR_PAD_LEFT)]
        );
    }
}

// Create the service instance – methods are already registered via attributes
$accounting = new AccountingService($db);
```

6. Securing MCP Endpoints

By default, developer MCP servers are public. Add authentication using the standard Tina4 middleware:

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```

use Tina4\Secured;
use Tina4\Middleware;

// Secure the entire MCP path
#[Secured]
#[Middleware(AuthMiddleware::class)]
function registerMcp() {
    global $mcp, $router;
    $mcp->registerRoutes($router);
}

```

Or check the bearer token inside individual tools:

```

#[McpTool("sensitive_data", description: "Access restricted data", server: "crm")]
public function sensitiveData(string $token): array
{
    global $db;
    $payload = Auth::validTokenStatic($token);
    if (!$payload) {
        return ["error" => "Unauthorized"];
    }
    return $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM sensitive_table")->toArray();
}

```

7. Testing MCP Tools

Use **TestClient** to test MCP endpoints without starting a server, or test tool methods directly:

```

// Test the tool method directly
public function testLookupCustomer(): void
{
    $tools = new CrmTools();
    $result = $tools->lookupCustomer("alice@example.com");
    $this->assertNotNull($result);
    $this->assertEquals("alice@example.com", $result["email"]);
}

// Test via MCP protocol
public function testMcpToolCall(): void
{
    $resp = json_decode($mcp->handleMessage([
        "jsonrpc" => "2.0",
        "id" => 1,
        "method" => "tools/call",
        "params" => [
            "name" => "lookup_customer",
            "arguments" => ["email" => "alice@example.com"]
        ]
    ]), true);
    $this->assertArrayHasKey("result", $resp);
    $content = $resp["result"]["content"][0]["text"];
    $this->assertStringContainsString("alice", strtolower($content));
}

```

8. Complete Example: CRM MCP Server

Here is a full working example -- a CRM system with customer, order, and product tools:

```
<?php
// app.php
require_once "vendor/autoload.php";

use Tina4\McpServer;
use Tina4\McpTool;
use Tina4\McpResource;
use Tina4\Database;
use Tina4\ORM;

$db = new Database("sqlite:///crm.db");
ORM::bind($db);

// Create MCP server
$crmMcp = new McpServer("/crm/mcp", name: "CRM Assistant", version: "1.0.0");

class CrmService
{
    private $db;

    public function __construct($db)
    {
        $this->db = $db;
    }

    // Tools
    #[McpTool("find_customer", description: "Search customers by name or email", server: "crm")]
    public function findCustomer(string $query): array
    {
        return $this->db->fetch(
            "SELECT * FROM customers WHERE name LIKE ? OR email LIKE ?",
            ["%{$query}%", "%{$query}%"]
        )->toArray();
    }

    #[McpTool("customer_orders", description: "Get all orders for a customer", server: "crm")]
    public function customerOrders(int $customerId): array
    {
        return $this->db->fetch(
            "SELECT o.*, GROUP_CONCAT(oi.product_name) as items "
            . "FROM orders o LEFT JOIN order_items oi ON o.id = oi.order_id "
            . "WHERE o.customer_id = ? GROUP BY o.id ORDER BY o.created_at DESC",
            [$customerId]
        )->toArray();
    }

    #[McpTool("create_note", description: "Add a note to a customer record", server: "crm")]
    public function createNote(int $customerId, string $note): array
    {
        $this->db->insert("customer_notes", ["customer_id" => $customerId, "note" => $note]);
        return ["success" => true];
    }

    // Resources
    #[McpResource("crm://products", description: "Product catalog", server: "crm")]
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}
```



```

public function products(): array
{
    return $this->db->fetch("SELECT * FROM products WHERE active = 1")->toArray();
}

#[McpResource("crm://stats", description: "CRM statistics", server: "crm")]
public function stats(): array
{
    $customers = $this->db->fetchOne("SELECT COUNT(*) as count FROM customers");
    $orders = $this->db->fetchOne("SELECT COUNT(*) as count, SUM(total) as revenue FROM orders");
    return [
        "customers" => $customers["count"],
        "orders" => $orders["count"],
        "revenue" => $orders["revenue"],
    ];
}

}

// Create the service and register routes
$crm = new CrmService($db);
$crmMcp->registerRoutes($router);

Tina4\run();

```

Connect Claude Code to <http://localhost:7145/crm/mcp/sse> and ask:

"Find all customers named Smith and show their recent orders"

The AI calls `find_customer` with `query: "Smith"`, then `customer_orders` for each result. No custom API needed. The MCP protocol handles it.

9. Best Practices

- **One server per domain** -- CRM tools on [/crm/mcp](#), accounting on [/accounting/mcp](#)
- **Keep tools focused** -- one query per tool, not a Swiss-army-knife tool
- **Use type hints** -- they become the schema. An AI assistant cannot call a tool correctly without knowing the parameter types
- **Return structured data** -- arrays and objects, not formatted strings. Let the AI format for the user
- **Secure production endpoints** -- use `#[Secured]` or middleware for any MCP server that runs outside localhost
- **Test tools directly** -- call the PHP method in your test suite, not just through the MCP protocol

Dev Tools

1. Debugging at 2am

2am. Production monitoring pings you. A 500 error on checkout. You pull up the dev dashboard. The request inspector shows the failing request. The stack trace points to line 47 of `src/routes/checkout.php` -- a null reference on the shipping address because the user skipped the form field. You add a null check. Push the fix. Back to sleep. Total time: 30 seconds.

Tina4's dev tools ship with the framework from day one. When `TINA4_DEBUG=true`, you get a development dashboard, an error overlay with source code, hot reload, a request inspector with replay, a SQL query runner, a queue monitor, and system info -- all without installing extra packages.

2. Enabling the Dev Dashboard

Set `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in your `.env`:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
```

Restart your server and navigate to:

```
http://localhost:7145/__dev
```

No token or additional environment variables needed. The dashboard runs only when debug mode is on. Set `TINA4_DEBUG=false` in production and the entire dashboard disappears.

3. Dashboard Overview

The dev dashboard has several sections. Navigation tabs at the top:

System Overview

The landing page shows at a glance:

- **Framework version** -- The installed Tina4 PHP version
- **PHP version** -- The running PHP version and loaded extensions
- **Uptime** -- How long the server has been running
- **Memory usage** -- Current and peak memory consumption
- **Database status** -- Connection status, database engine, file size (for SQLite)
- **Environment** -- Current `.env` variables (sensitive values are masked)
- **Project structure** -- Directory listing of your project with file counts

Check here first when something feels off. Is the database connected? Is the right PHP version running? Are the environment variables loaded?

4. The Dev Toolbar

Visit any HTML page in your application (like `/products` or `/admin`). A debug toolbar appears at the bottom. Thin bar. Expands when you click on it.

The toolbar shows:

Field	What It Means
Request	HTTP method and URL of the current request
Status	HTTP response status code
Time	Total request processing time in milliseconds
DB	Number of database queries executed and total query time
Memory	PHP memory used for this request
Template	The template rendered and how long rendering took
Session	Session ID and session data summary
Route	Which route handler matched this request

Click any section to expand it and see details. For example, clicking "DB" shows every SQL query that ran during the request, with the query text, parameters, execution time, and number of rows returned.

Disabling the Toolbar

The toolbar is automatically hidden when `TINA4_DEBUG=false`. You can also hide it for specific routes by returning a response with the `X-Debug-Toolbar: off` header:

```
Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {  
    return $response->json(["data" => "no toolbar"], 200, [  
        "X-Debug-Toolbar" => "off"  
    ]);  
});
```

This is useful for API endpoints that return JSON -- the toolbar is only meaningful for HTML pages.

5. Error Overlay

An unhandled exception occurs. Tina4 does not show a generic "500 Internal Server Error" page. It shows a detailed error overlay with:

- **Exception type and message** -- What went wrong, in plain language
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- **Stack trace** -- Every function call that led to the error, from the entry point to the crash
- **Source code** -- The actual PHP code around the line that threw the exception, with the failing line highlighted
- **Request data** -- The HTTP method, URL, headers, body, and query parameters of the request that triggered the error
- **Environment** -- Relevant `.env` variables at the time of the error

Example Error

If you accidentally write:

```
Router::get("/api/broken", function ($request, $response) {
    $user = null;
    return $response->json(["name" => $user->name]);
});
```

Visiting `/api/broken` shows the error overlay:

TypeError: Cannot access property "name" on null

File: src/routes/api.php
Line: 4

```
2 | Router::get("/api/broken", function ($request, $response) {
3 |     $user = null;
> 4 |     return $response->json(["name" => $user->name]);
5 | });
```

Stack Trace:

```
#0 src/routes/api.php:4 - {closure}()
#1 vendor/tina4/tina4-php/src/Router.php:142 - call_user_func()
#2 vendor/tina4/tina4-php/src/Server.php:89 - Router->dispatch()
```

Request: GET /api/broken
Headers: Accept: */*
Query: (none)
Body: (none)

The highlighted line (line 4) makes it immediately obvious: `$user` is null and you are trying to access `->name` on it.

Error Overlay in Production

When `TINA4_DEBUG=false`, the error overlay is disabled. Users see a clean error page (`src/templates/errors/500.html` if it exists, or a generic message). Full error details go to `logs/error.log`.

6. Request Inspector

The request inspector records every HTTP request to your application:

- **Method and URL** -- GET `/api/products`, POST `/api/users`, etc.

- **Status code** -- 200, 201, 404, 500, etc. (color-coded: green for 2xx, yellow for 4xx, red for 5xx)
- **Response time** -- How many milliseconds the request took
- **Request ID** -- A unique identifier for correlating logs
- **Timestamp** -- When the request was received

Click on any request to see its full details:

Request Details Panel

- **Headers** -- All request headers (Accept, Content-Type, Authorization, etc.)
- **Body** -- The request body (for POST/PUT/PATCH), formatted as JSON if applicable
- **Query parameters** -- Parsed URL query parameters
- **Route match** -- Which route definition matched this request
- **Middleware** -- Which middleware ran and how long each took
- **Database queries** -- Every SQL query executed during this request, with timing
- **Template renders** -- Which templates were rendered and how long each took
- **Response headers** -- The response headers sent back to the client
- **Response body** -- The first 1000 characters of the response body

Filtering Requests

The inspector supports filtering:

- **By status:** Click the status code badges at the top to filter (e.g., show only 5xx errors)
- **By method:** Filter by GET, POST, PUT, DELETE
- **By path:** Search for a URL pattern (e.g., `/api/` to show only API requests)
- **By time range:** Show requests from the last 5 minutes, 1 hour, or all time

Request Replay

Click "Replay" on any request to re-send it. Reproduce an error without constructing the curl command by hand.

7. SQL Query Runner

The dev dashboard includes an interactive SQL query runner. Navigate to the "SQL" tab:

- **Execute queries** directly against your database
- **See results** in a formatted table
- **View query timing** -- how long each query took
- **Browse tables** -- a sidebar lists all tables in your database with their column definitions
- **Export results** -- download query results as CSV

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Example

Type into the query editor:

```
SELECT name, price, in_stock FROM products WHERE price > 50 ORDER BY price DESC
```

Click "Run" and see:

Results (3 rows, 2.1ms):

name	price	in_stock
Standing Desk	549.99	0
Ergonomic Chair	399.99	1
Wireless Keyboard	79.99	1

Faster than opening a separate database client. Test queries, check data, debug issues -- all without leaving the browser.

Safety

The query runner is read-write in development. You can run INSERT, UPDATE, and DELETE statements. Be careful -- there is no undo. In shared environments, consider using a read-only database user for the dev dashboard.

8. Hot Reload

Edit a file. Save it. The browser updates. No manual refresh. No external tools.

How It Works

The **tina4** Rust CLI is the sole file watcher for the Tina4 stack — PHP has no internal watcher (there never was one, unlike Python/Ruby/Node which had their own watchers that were removed in 3.11.x). The flow:



- The CLI watches **src/**, **migrations/**, **.env** with the **notify** crate. Events are filtered to real source changes — Access and Metadata-only events are dropped; **__pycache__**, **.git**, **.venv**, **node_modules**, **vendor**, **logs**, **.log/db*/.swp/.pyc** files are ignored. A real mtime check also defeats overlays / polling-mode spurious events (Podman, distrobox).
- On a real change the CLI POSTs **/__dev/api/reload** to your running PHP server. The server keeps running — there is no process restart for file edits.
- **DevAdmin** bumps its in-memory **\$reloadMtime** counter and broadcasts **{type: "reload"}** over WebSocket at **/__dev_reload**. **GET /__dev/api/mtime** returns the counter for browsers using the polling fallback.
- The inline reload script injected by the dev toolbar reloads the browser. SCSS/CSS changes are signalled as **type: "css"** and swap the stylesheet without a full reload.

No file watcher inside PHP. No sentinel file on disk. No daemon. No Node.js process. The Rust CLI watches, the framework relays, the browser reloads.

Watched Directories and File Types

The file watcher scans three locations:

- `src/` -- Your application code (routes, ORM models, templates, assets)
- `migrations/` -- Database migration files
- `.env` -- Environment configuration

What Happens on Reload

- **PHP source** (`src/routes/*.php`, `src/orm/*.php`, etc.) -- PHP loads these fresh on every request, so once the browser reloads, the next request sees the updated code. The server process stays up.
- **Template files** (`.twig`, `.html`) -- Re-read from disk on the next render.
- `.env` -- Re-read on next request.
- **SCSS/CSS** -- The browser swaps the stylesheet; no full page reload.

The PHP server never restarts for file edits. It only restarts if it actually crashes (unlikely in dev mode thanks to the error overlay catching most issues).

Activation

Hot reload is only active when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. In production (`TINA4_DEBUG=false`), the file watcher is disabled, the `/__dev_reload` WebSocket endpoint does not exist, and routes and templates are cached for performance.

Disabling Hot Reload

If hot reload interferes with your workflow (e.g., you are filling out a form and do not want it to reset), disable it in `.env`:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=false
```

This disables the browser-side reload while keeping `TINA4_DEBUG=true` for the rest of the dev tools.

9. Gallery -- Interactive Examples

The dev dashboard includes a Gallery section where you can deploy interactive code examples. This is useful for:

- Demonstrating API endpoints to team members
- Creating runnable documentation
- Prototyping features quickly

Creating a Gallery Entry

Create a file in `src/gallery/`:

```
<?php
// src/gallery/product-search.php
// title: Product Search
// description: Search products by name and category

use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/gallery/product-search", function ($request, $response) {
    $q = $request->params["q"] ?? "";
    $category = $request->params["category"] ?? "";

    $product = new Product();
    $conditions = [];
    $params = [];

    if (!empty($q)) {
        $conditions[] = "name LIKE :q";
        $params["q"] = "%" . $q . "%";
    }

    if (!empty($category)) {
        $conditions[] = "category = :category";
        $params["category"] = $category;
    }

    $filter = !empty($conditions) ? implode(" AND ", $conditions) : "";
    $results = $product->select("{}", $filter, $params, "name ASC");

    return $response->json([
        "query" => $q,
        "category" => $category,
        "results" => array_map(fn($p) => $p->toArray(), $results),
        "count" => count($results)
    ]);
});
```

The comments at the top (`// title:` and `// description:`) are parsed by the gallery and shown in the dashboard. Navigate to the Gallery tab to see all your interactive examples, with a "Try It" button that opens the endpoint in a new tab.

10. Queue Monitor

If your application uses background job queues (Chapter 12 -- Queues), the dev dashboard includes a queue monitor showing:

- **Pending jobs** -- Jobs waiting to be processed
- **Active jobs** -- Jobs currently being processed
- **Completed jobs** -- Recently completed jobs with timing
- **Failed jobs** -- Jobs that threw exceptions, with error details

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- **Dead-letter queue** -- Jobs that failed too many times and were moved to the dead-letter queue

For each job, you can see:

- The job class or function name
- The payload (serialized arguments)
- When it was enqueued
- When it started processing (if active)
- The error message and stack trace (if failed)
- How many times it has been retried

You can also:

- **Retry a failed job** -- Click "Retry" to move it back to the pending queue
- **Delete a job** -- Remove it from any queue
- **Pause/resume the queue** -- Temporarily stop processing without losing jobs

11. System Info

The System Info tab shows detailed information about your environment:

- **PHP Configuration** -- Version, loaded extensions, php.ini location, memory limit, max execution time, upload limits
- **Database Info** -- Engine, version, connection details, table sizes, index information
- **Server Info** -- OS, hostname, server software, document root
- **Tina4 Config** -- All loaded `.env` variables (sensitive values masked), auto-discovered routes, registered middleware, ORM models
- **Disk Usage** -- Size of your project directory, data directory, logs directory, and vendor directory

This is especially useful when debugging environment-specific issues. If a colleague says "it works on my machine," compare the System Info output between both environments to spot differences.

12. Exercise: Debug a Failing Route

Set up a project with the following intentionally broken route, then use the dev tools to find and fix the bug.

Setup

Create `src/routes/orders.php` with this intentionally broken code:

```
<?php
```

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```

use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/orders/summary", function ($request, $response) {
    $product = new Product();
    $products = $product->select("");

    $total = 0;
    foreach ($products as $p) {
        $total += $p->price * $p->quantity; // Bug: Product has no "quantity" field
    }

    $orderCount = count($products);
    $averageValue = $total / $orderCount; // Bug: division by zero if no products

    return $response->json([
        "total_value" => $total,
        "order_count" => $orderCount,
        "average_value" => round($averageValue, 2)
    ]);
});

```

Task

- Start the dev server with `tina4 serve`.
- Visit <http://localhost:7145/api/orders/summary>.
- Observe the error overlay.
- Use the error overlay to identify the exact line and cause of the error.
- Fix both bugs:
 - Replace `$p->quantity` with `1` (or remove the multiplication) since products do not have a quantity field.
 - Add a check for zero `$orderCount` before dividing.
- Reload the page and verify the response is correct.
- Open the dev dashboard at `/__dev` and find the failed request in the request inspector.
- Verify the fixed request now appears as a 200 in the inspector.

Expected Steps

- The error overlay shows: `Undefined property: Product::$quantity` on the line `$total += $p->price * $p->quantity;`
- You fix the line to `$total += $p->price;`
- You reload and get a new error (if there are zero products): `Division by zero`
- You add `if ($orderCount > 0)` before the division
- The endpoint returns valid JSON

13. Solution

The fixed route:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/api/orders/summary", function ($request, $response) {
    $product = new Product();
    $products = $product->select("*");

    $total = 0.0;
    foreach ($products as $p) {
        $total += $p->price;
    }

    $orderCount = count($products);
    $averageValue = $orderCount > 0 ? $total / $orderCount : 0;

    return $response->json([
        "total_value" => round($total, 2),
        "order_count" => $orderCount,
        "average_value" => round($averageValue, 2)
    ]);
});
```

Expected output (with 5 seeded products):

```
{
  "total_value": 909.95,
  "order_count": 5,
  "average_value": 181.99
}
```

What You Practiced

- Reading the error overlay to find the exact line and error type
- Understanding stack traces
- Using the request inspector to view failed and successful requests
- Iterative debugging -- fixing one error, reloading, fixing the next

14. Gotchas

1. Dev Dashboard Returns 404

Problem: Navigating to `/__dev` returns a 404 page.

Cause: `TINA4_DEBUG` is not set to `true`.

Fix: Add to your `.env`:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
```

Restart the server after changing `.env`.

3. Hot Reload Not Working

Problem: You save a file but the browser does not reload.

Cause: Hot reload uses a WebSocket connection to the `/__dev_reload` endpoint. If your browser blocks WebSocket connections (some corporate proxies do), or if you are accessing the site via a reverse proxy that does not forward WebSocket, hot reload will not work.

Fix: Check the browser console for WebSocket connection errors to `/__dev_reload`. If you are behind a proxy, configure it to forward WebSocket connections. As a workaround, manually refresh with `Ctrl+R`.

4. Error Overlay Shows in Production

Problem: Users see stack traces and source code on error pages.

Cause: `TINA4_DEBUG=true` in the production `.env`.

Fix: Always set `TINA4_DEBUG=false` in production. This hides all debug information and shows the custom error page from `src/templates/errors/500.html` instead.

5. Request Inspector Shows Too Many Requests

Problem: The request inspector is flooded with entries, making it hard to find the one you care about.

Cause: Static file requests (CSS, JS, images, favicon) are all recorded.

Fix: Use the path filter to narrow down the list. Type `/api/` in the filter box to show only API requests. You can also configure the dev dashboard to exclude static file requests from the inspector.

6. SQL Runner Modifies Data Accidentally

Problem: You ran a DELETE query in the SQL runner and lost data.

Cause: The SQL runner executes queries directly against the database with full read-write access.

Fix: There is no undo. For safety, always include a WHERE clause with DELETE and UPDATE statements. If you are worried about accidental modifications, use a read-only database connection for the dev dashboard.

7. Debug Toolbar Breaks Layout

Problem: The debug toolbar at the bottom of the page overlaps with your content or breaks the layout.

Cause: The toolbar adds a fixed-position element at the bottom of the page. If your page uses `position: fixed` elements at the bottom (like a footer or chat widget), they may conflict.

Fix: The toolbar adds a `data-tina4-debug` attribute to the body. Use this in your CSS to adjust:

```
body[data-tina4-debug] .my-footer {  
  bottom: 40px; /* Make room for the debug toolbar */  
}
```

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}

Alternatively, collapse the toolbar by clicking on it -- it minimizes to a thin line.

Tina4 CLI

1. Getting a New Developer Up to Speed

A new developer joins your team Monday morning. You hand them the repo URL. By 10am they have a running project, a new database model, CRUD routes, a migration, and a deployment to staging. All from the command line. No hunting through documentation. No copy-pasting boilerplate from old projects. The CLI handles scaffolding.

The Tina4 CLI is a single Rust binary. It manages all four Tina4 frameworks (PHP, Python, Ruby, Node.js). Commands stay identical across languages. Learn the CLI for PHP. You know it for Python.

2. tina4 init -- Project Scaffolding

You saw this in Chapter 1. Now the details.

```
tina4 init my-project

Creating Tina4 project in ./my-project ...
Detected language: PHP (composer.json)
Created .env
Created .env.example
Created .gitignore
Created src/routes/
Created src/orm/
Created migrations/
Created src/seeds/
Created src/templates/
Created src/templates/errors/
Created src/public/
Created src/public/js/
Created src/public/css/
Created src/public/scss/
Created src/public/images/
Created src/public/icons/
Created src/locales/
Created data/
Created logs/
Created secrets/
Created tests/
```

Project created! Next steps:

```
cd my-project
composer install
tina4 serve
```

Language Detection

The CLI detects the language from existing files in the directory:

File Present	Language
--------------	----------

Options

Flag	Description	Example
<code>--port</code>	Custom port (default: 7145)	<code>tina4 serve --port 8080</code>
<code>--host</code>	Bind address (default: 0.0.0.0)	<code>tina4 serve --host 127.0.0.1</code>
<code>--no-reload</code>	Disable live reload	<code>tina4 serve --no-reload</code>

Production Mode Detection

```
tina4 serve --production
```

When the `--production` flag is passed, the CLI:

- Checks for `TINA4_DEBUG=false` in `.env` (warns if debug is on)
- Uses FrankenPHP if available for better performance
- Enables response caching and template pre-compilation
- Disables the dev toolbar and error overlay
- Enables graceful shutdown handling

In practice, you rarely use `tina4 serve --production` directly. Instead, you use Docker or a process manager (Chapter 33). But this flag is useful for quick production testing.

4. tina4 generate model -- ORM Scaffolding

Generate a new ORM model:

```
tina4 generate model Order

Created src/orm/Order.php
Created migrations/20260322100000_create_orders_table.sql
```

The generated model:

```
<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Order extends ORM
{
    public int $id;
    public string $createdAt;
    public string $updatedAt;

    public string $tableName = "orders";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";
}
```

The generated migration:

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```
-- UP
CREATE TABLE orders (
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
    updated_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

-- DOWN
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS orders;
```

Adding Fields

You can specify fields on the command line:

```
tina4 generate model Order --fields "userId:int,total:float,status:string,paid:bool"

Created src/orm/Order.php
Created migrations/20260322100000_create_orders_table.sql
```

The generated model now includes all the fields:

```
<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Order extends ORM
{
    public int $id;
    public int $userId;
    public float $total;
    public string $status;
    public bool $paid;
    public string $createdAt;
    public string $updatedAt;

    public string $tableName = "orders";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";
}
```

And the migration:

```
-- UP
CREATE TABLE orders (
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    user_id INTEGER NOT NULL,
    total REAL NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
    status TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT '',
    paid INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
    created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
    updated_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

-- DOWN
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS orders;
```

Field Types

CLI Type	PHP Type	SQLite Column
string	string	TEXT
int	int	INTEGER
float	float	REAL
bool	bool	INTEGER
text	string	TEXT
date	string	TEXT

Options

Flag	Description	Example
<code>--fields</code>	Comma-separated field definitions	<code>--fields "name:string,price:float"</code>
<code>--auto-crud</code>	Enable auto-CRUD on the model	<code>--auto-crud</code>
<code>--soft-delete</code>	Add soft delete support	<code>--soft-delete</code>
<code>--no-migration</code>	Skip migration generation	<code>--no-migration</code>

5. tina4 generate route -- CRUD Route Scaffolding

Generate CRUD routes for a model:

```
tina4 generate route Order  
Created src/routes/orders.php
```

The generated route file:

```
<?php  
use Tina4\Router;  
  
Router::group("/api", function () {  
  
    // List all orders  
    Router::get("/orders", function ($request, $response) {  
        $order = new Order();  
        $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);  
        $perPage = (int) ($request->params["per_page"] ?? 20);  
        $offset = ($page - 1) * $perPage;  
  
        $orders = $order->select("*, "", [], "created_at DESC", $perPage, $offset);  
        $results = array_map(fn($o) => $o->toArray(), $orders);
```

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```

        return $response->json([
            "data" => $results,
            "page" => $page,
            "per_page" => $perPage,
            "count" => count($results)
        ]);
    });

    // Get a single order
    Router::get("/orders/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $order = new Order();
        $order->load($request->params["id"]);

        if (empty($order->id)) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Order not found"], 404);
        }

        return $response->json($order->toArray());
    });

    // Create an order
    Router::post("/orders", function ($request, $response) {
        $body = $request->body;
        $order = new Order();
        $order->userId = (int) ($body["user_id"] ?? 0);
        $order->total = (float) ($body["total"] ?? 0);
        $order->status = $body["status"] ?? "";
        $order->paid = (bool) ($body["paid"] ?? false);
        $order->save();

        return $response->json($order->toArray(), 201);
    });

    // Update an order
    Router::put("/orders/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $order = new Order();
        $order->load($request->params["id"]);

        if (empty($order->id)) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Order not found"], 404);
        }

        $body = $request->body;
        if (isset($body["user_id"])) $order->userId = (int) $body["user_id"];
        if (isset($body["total"])) $order->total = (float) $body["total"];
        if (isset($body["status"])) $order->status = $body["status"];
        if (isset($body["paid"])) $order->paid = (bool) $body["paid"];
        $order->save();

        return $response->json($order->toArray());
    });

    // Delete an order
    Router::delete("/orders/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
        $order = new Order();
        $order->load($request->params["id"]);

        if (empty($order->id)) {
            return $response->json(["error" => "Order not found"], 404);
        }
    });

```

```

    }

    $order->delete();
    return $response->json(null, 204);
  });
});

```

The generator reads the model's properties and creates routes with type casting and null checks. Customize the generated code immediately. It is regular PHP, not magic.

Options

Flag	Description	Example
<code>--prefix</code>	Custom route prefix (default: <code>/api</code>)	<code>--prefix /api/v2</code>
<code>--middleware</code>	Add middleware to all routes	<code>--middleware requireAuth</code>

6. tina4 generate migration -- Migration Scaffolding

Create an empty migration file:

```

tina4 generate migration "add email to orders"

Created migrations/20260322101500_add_email_to_orders.sql

```

The generated file:

```

-- UP
-- Add your forward migration SQL here


-- DOWN
-- Add your rollback migration SQL here

```

You fill in the SQL yourself:

```

-- UP
ALTER TABLE orders ADD COLUMN email TEXT DEFAULT '';


-- DOWN
ALTER TABLE orders DROP COLUMN email;

```

The timestamp prefix (`20260322101500`) ensures migrations run in order. Each migration runs once. The framework tracks which ones have been applied.

7. tina4 generate middleware -- Middleware Scaffolding

```

tina4 generate middleware rateLimiter

Created src/middleware/rateLimiter.php

```

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The generated file:

```
<?php

function rateLimiter($request, $response, $next)
{
    // Add your middleware logic here

    // Continue to the next middleware or route handler
    return $next($request, $response);

    // Or return early to block the request:
    // return $response->json(["error" => "Rate limit exceeded"], 429);
}
```

The middleware is a named function that you can reference in route definitions:

```
Router::get("/api/data", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["data" => "protected"]);
}, "rateLimiter");
```

8. tina4 doctor -- Environment Health Check

```
tina4 doctor
```

```
Tina4 Doctor - Environment Health Check
```

PHP Version	8.3.4	[OK]
Composer	2.7.2	[OK]
ext-json	loaded	[OK]
ext-mbstring	loaded	[OK]
ext-openssl	loaded	[OK]
ext-sqlite3	loaded	[OK]
ext-fileinfo	loaded	[OK]
ext-pdo_sqlite	loaded	[OK]
.env file	found	[OK]
data/ directory	writable	[OK]
logs/ directory	writable	[OK]
secrets/ directory	writable	[OK]
Database connection	connected	[OK]
Routes discovered	14 routes	[OK]
ORM models discovered	5 models	[OK]
Templates directory	found	[OK]
tina4.css	found	[OK]
frond.js	found	[OK]

All checks passed. Your environment is ready.

If something is wrong, the doctor tells you:

```
ext-mbstring ..... missing [FAIL]
  Fix: apt install php8.3-mbstring (Ubuntu)
       brew install php (macOS, includes mbstring)
```

```
data/ directory ..... not writable [FAIL]
  Fix: chmod 755 data/
```

```
Database connection ..... failed [FAIL]
```

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```
Error: could not open database file
Fix: Check TINA4_DATABASE_URL in .env. Current value: sqlite:///data/app.db
Make sure the data/ directory exists and is writable.
```

The doctor checks everything a new developer might get wrong. Specific fix instructions for each issue.

9. tina4 test -- Running Tests

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

```
ProductTest
[PASS] test_create_product
[PASS] test_load_product
```

```
AuthTest
[PASS] test_login
```

```
3 tests, 3 passed, 0 failed (0.21s)
```

See Chapter 18 for the full testing guide. The CLI command discovers all test files in `tests/` and runs them.

Options

Flag	Description	Example
<code>--file</code>	Run a specific test file	<code>--file tests/ProductTest.php</code>
<code>--method</code>	Run a specific test method	<code>--method testCreateProduct</code>
<code>--verbose</code>	Show all assertions	<code>--verbose</code>

10. tina4 routes -- List All Routes

```
tina4 routes
```

Method	Path	Middleware	Auth
-----	----	-----	----
GET	/health	-	public
GET	/api/products	-	public
GET	/api/products/{id:int}	-	public
POST	/api/products	-	secured
PUT	/api/products/{id:int}	-	secured
DELETE	/api/products/{id:int}	-	secured
GET	/api/orders	-	public
POST	/api/orders	requireAuth	secured
GET	/admin	-	public
GET	/admin/users	-	public

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Filtering

```
# Filter by HTTP method
tina4 routes --method POST

# Filter by path pattern
tina4 routes --filter orders

# Filter by middleware
tina4 routes --middleware requireAuth
```

When debugging routing issues, check here first. If a route is not matching, `tina4 routes` shows whether it was registered and what middleware is attached.

11. tina4 migrate -- Run Database Migrations

```
tina4 migrate

Running migrations...
[APPLIED] 20260322100000_create_orders_table.sql
[APPLIED] 20260322101500_add_email_to_orders.sql
[SKIPPED] 20260322080000_create_products_table.sql (already applied)
Migrations complete. 2 applied, 1 skipped.
```

Options

Flag	Description	Example
<code>--rollback</code>	Undo the last migration	<code>tina4 migrate --rollback</code>
<code>--rollback-all</code>	Undo all migrations	<code>tina4 migrate --rollback</code>
<code>--status</code>	Show migration status	<code>tina4 migrate --status</code>

Migration Status

```
tina4 migrate --status

Migration Status:

[APPLIED] 20260322080000_create_products_table.sql (applied 2026-03-22 08:15:00)
[APPLIED] 20260322100000_create_orders_table.sql (applied 2026-03-22 10:05:00)
[APPLIED] 20260322101500_add_email_to_orders.sql (applied 2026-03-22 10:20:00)
[PENDING] 20260322120000_add_status_to_products.sql (not yet applied)

3 applied, 1 pending
```

12. Exercise: Scaffold a Complete Feature in 5 Commands

You need to add a "Tasks" feature to your project. Each task has a title, description, priority (string), completed status (boolean), and belongs to a user.

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Requirements

Using only CLI commands, do the following:

- Generate the Task model with fields
- Generate CRUD routes for the Task model
- Run the migration to create the table
- Verify the routes are registered
- Run the doctor to make sure everything is healthy

Expected Commands

Complete this in exactly 5 commands. After running them, test the API with curl to verify everything works.

Test with:

```
# Create a task
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"title": "Write chapter 19", "description": "CLI and scaffolding", "priority": "high", "u

# List tasks
curl http://localhost:7145/api/tasks

# Get one task
curl http://localhost:7145/api/tasks/1
```

13. Solution

The five commands:

```
# 1. Generate the model with fields (creates model + migration)
tina4 generate model Task --fields "userId:int,title:string,description:text,priority:string,com

# 2. Generate CRUD routes
tina4 generate route Task

# 3. Run the migration
tina4 migrate

# 4. Verify routes are registered
tina4 routes --filter tasks

# 5. Health check
tina4 doctor
```

Command 1 output:

```
Created src/orm/Task.php
Created migrations/20260322140000_create_tasks_table.sql
```

Command 2 output:

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Created src/routes/tasks.php

Command 3 output:

```
Running migrations...
[APPLIED] 20260322140000_create_tasks_table.sql
Migrations complete. 1 applied.
```

Command 4 output:

Method	Path	Middleware	Auth
-----	----	-----	----
GET	/api/tasks	-	public
GET	/api/tasks/{id:int}	-	public
POST	/api/tasks	-	secured
PUT	/api/tasks/{id:int}	-	secured
DELETE	/api/tasks/{id:int}	-	secured

Command 5 output:

```
Tina4 Doctor - Environment Health Check
...
All checks passed. Your environment is ready.
```

Test - create a task:

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"title": "Write chapter 19", "description": "CLI and scaffolding", "priority": "high", "u
{
  "id": 1,
  "user_id": 1,
  "title": "Write chapter 19",
  "description": "CLI and scaffolding",
  "priority": "high",
  "completed": false,
  "created_at": "2026-03-22 14:05:00",
  "updated_at": "2026-03-22 14:05:00"
}
```

From zero to a working CRUD API in 5 commands and under 2 minutes.

14. Gotchas

1. Model Name Must Be PascalCase

Problem: `tina4 generate model order_item` creates a model class named `order_item` which is not valid PHP.

Cause: The CLI uses the argument as-is for the class name if it cannot determine the PascalCase form.

Fix: Always use PascalCase for model names: `tina4 generate model OrderItem`. The CLI converts it to snake_case for the table name (`order_items`).

2. Migration Already Applied

Problem: You regenerated a model and the migration has the same name as an existing one, but the CLI says it was already applied.

Cause: Tina4 tracks applied migrations by filename. If the filename matches, it considers it already applied.

Fix: Each migration should have a unique timestamp prefix. If you need to modify a table after the initial migration, create a new migration: `tina4 generate migration "add status to tasks"`.

3. Generated Routes Conflict with Auto-CRUD

Problem: You generated routes for a model that has `$autoCrud = true`, and now requests hit the wrong handler.

Cause: Both the generated routes and auto-CRUD routes register at the same paths. The first one registered wins.

Fix: Either use generated routes or auto-CRUD, not both for the same model. If you use `tina4 generate route`, set `$autoCrud = false` on the model (or do not set it at all -- it defaults to false).

4. Port Already in Use

Problem: `tina4 serve` fails with "Address already in use."

Cause: Another process is using port 7145 (or whichever port you configured).

Fix: Find and stop the other process, or use a different port:

```
tina4 serve --port 8080
```

To find what is using the port:

```
lsof -i :7145
```

5. CLI Not Found After Installation

Problem: `tina4: command not found` after running the install script.

Cause: The CLI binary is not in your `PATH`. The install script puts it in `~/.tina4/bin/` which may not be in your shell's `PATH`.

Fix: Add the binary location to your `PATH`. For zsh (macOS default):

```
echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.tina4/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc
source ~/.zshrc
```

For bash:

```
echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.tina4/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.bashrc
source ~/.bashrc
```

15. Documentation

```
tina4 docs      # Download framework-specific book chapters to .tina4-docs/
tina4 books     # Download the complete Tina4 book (all languages) to tina4-book/
```

`tina4 docs` detects your project language and downloads only the relevant chapters. The documentation is available in Markdown format, optimised for AI tools and local reference.

16. Test Port (Dual-Port Development)

When `TINA4_DEBUG=true`, Tina4 automatically starts a second HTTP server on `port + 1000`:

- **Main port** (e.g. 7145) — hot-reload enabled, for AI dev tools
- **Test port** (e.g. 8146) — stable, no hot-reload, for user testing

This prevents the browser from refreshing mid-test when AI tools edit files.

Setting	Effect
<code>TINA4_NO_AI_PORT=true</code>	Disables the test port entirely
<code>TINA4_NO_RELOAD=true</code>	Disables hot-reload on the main port too
<code>--no-reload</code>	CLI flag equivalent of <code>TINA4NORELOAD</code>

Vibe Coding with AI

Why Tina4 is Built for AI-Assisted Development

Tell your AI assistant: "Add a product catalog with search, pagination, and category filtering." In most frameworks, the AI needs to know which packages to install, which config files to create, which naming conventions to follow, and how to wire everything together. It hallucinates half of it.

With Tina4, the AI reads one file -- `CLAUDE.md` -- and knows everything. Every method signature. Every import path. Every convention. It generates correct, runnable code on the first try because there is one way to do things in Tina4.

This is not accidental. Tina4 was designed from the ground up for AI-assisted development.

The Zero-Dependency Advantage

When an AI generates code for Laravel, it might suggest `use Illuminate\Support\Facades\Cache;` or `use Illuminate\Cache\CacheManager;`. Both exist. Both work differently. The AI guesses.

With Tina4, there is one cache. One queue. One ORM. One template engine. No ambiguity. No alternatives. The AI does not need to ask. It knows.

```
// There's only one way to cache in Tina4
$cache = cache_get("products");

// There's only one way to queue in Tina4
$queue = new Queue(topic: "emails");
$queue->push(["to" => "user@test.com"]);

// There's only one way to send email in Tina4
$mail = new Messenger();
$mail->send(to: "user@test.com", subject: "Welcome");
```

Zero dependencies means zero confusion for AI.

CLAUDE.md -- The AI's Instruction Manual

Every Tina4 project includes a `CLAUDE.md` file. It tells AI assistants how the framework works:

- Every method signature with parameters and return types
- The project structure convention (src/routes/, src/orm/, src/templates/)
- The `.env` variable reference
- Code style rules (routes return `$response()`, ORM uses `toArray()`)
- Database connection string formats
- Common gotchas and how to avoid them

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Open a Tina4 project in Claude Code, Cursor, or GitHub Copilot. The AI reads this file first and writes correct Tina4 code from the start.

Skills -- Deep Framework Knowledge

Beyond CLAUDE.md, Tina4 ships with three AI skill files:

tina4-maintainer

For framework maintenance -- porting features between languages, reviewing PRs, running benchmarks, checking parity.

tina4-developer

For application development -- creating routes, defining models, writing templates, setting up auth, configuring queues.

tina4-js

For frontend development -- tina4-js signals, Tina4Element components, reactive templates, WebSocket client.

These skills install when AI tools are detected:

```
// In your project root
AI::installContext('.'); // Detects Claude, Cursor, Copilot, etc.
```

The Convention Advantage

AI thrives on convention. When every Tina4 project follows the same structure, the AI never asks "where should I put this?"

```
src/
  routes/hello.php      → AI knows: this is a route file
  orm/Product.php       → AI knows: this is an ORM model
  templates/home.twig   → AI knows: this is a template
  middleware/Auth.php   → AI knows: this is middleware
```

Tell the AI "add a User model." It creates `src/orm/User.php` with the correct field definitions, the correct namespace, the correct method stubs. Every time.

Real-World Vibe Coding Session

An actual conversation with Claude Code in a Tina4 PHP project:

You: "Add a blog with posts and comments. Posts belong to users. Comments belong to posts. I want a REST API and a template page that lists posts."

Claude Code generates:

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- `src/orm/Post.php` -- Model with hasMany comments, belongsTo user
- `src/orm/Comment.php` -- Model with belongsTo post
- `src/routes/api/posts.php` -- Full CRUD API (list, get, create, update, delete)
- `src/routes/api/comments.php` -- Nested comments API
- `src/routes/blog.php` -- Template route for the blog page
- `src/templates/blog.twig` -- Page with tina4css cards for each post
- `migrations/20260322_create_posts_and_comments.sql` -- Database schema

All correct. All runnable. First try.

You: "Add pagination to the posts list"

Claude adds `$request->params['page']` handling and `toArray(page: $page, perPage: 10)` -- because CLAUDE.md told it how Tina4 pagination works.

You: "Cache the post list for 5 minutes"

Claude adds `cache_get("posts_page_$page")` with `cache_set("posts_page_$page", $data, 300)` -- because it knows the cache API.

You: "Send an email when a new comment is posted"

Claude adds `$mail = new Messenger(); $mail->send(...)` -- because it knows Messenger reads from .env.

No research. No Stack Overflow. Describe what you want. The AI builds it.

Supported AI Tools

Tina4 auto-detects and installs context for eight tools. The exact list lives in the framework's `Tina4\Ai` class:

Tool	Detection (context file)	Context installed
Claude Code	CLAUDE.md	CLAUDE.md + .claude/ skills
Cursor	.cursorules	.cursorules (+ .cursor/)
GitHub Copilot	.github/copilot-instructions.md	.github/copilot-instructions.md
Windsurf	.windsurfrules	.windsurfrules
Aider	CONVENTIONS.md	CONVENTIONS.md
Cline	.clinerules	.clinerules
OpenAI Codex	AGENTS.md	AGENTS.md

Google Antigravity	<code>.antigravity/context.md</code>	<code>.antigravity/context.md</code>
--------------------	--------------------------------------	--------------------------------------

Run `tina4 ai` to see which tools are detected in your project and install context files via the menu.

The AI Chat in Dev Dashboard

The dev dashboard at `/__dev` includes an AI chat tab. By default it talks to a local **qwen2.5-coder** model served via [Ollama](#), grounded by Tina4's built-in RAG index of the framework source. Nothing leaves your machine.

Configure it in `.env`:

```
TINA4_AI_URL=http://localhost:11434      # Ollama HTTP endpoint
TINA4_AI_MODEL=qwen2.5-coder            # Default coding model
TINA4_RAG_URL=http://localhost:11434    # RAG embedding endpoint (defaults to TINA4_AI_URL)
```

If you prefer a remote provider, point `TINA4_AI_URL` at any OpenAI-compatible endpoint and set `TINA4_AI_MODEL` to the model name that endpoint serves.

The AI has full context of your Tina4 project -- routes, models, templates, configuration. Ask it:

- "Why is my `/api/users` route returning 500?"
- "How do I add WebSocket support?"
- "Write a migration to add an 'avatar' column to users"

The "Ask about this error" button on the error overlay sends the full stack trace and source code to the AI for instant debugging.

Tips for Effective Vibe Coding with Tina4

- **Be specific about what you want** -- "Add a product API with search by name and price range" works better than "add products"
- **Let the AI use tina4 generate** -- "Run `tina4 generate model Product` then add price and category fields" gives the AI a starting point
- **Reference the .env** -- "Configure the queue to use RabbitMQ" -- the AI knows to update `.env` with `TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND=rabbitmq`
- **Ask for tests** -- "Write tests for the Product API" -- the AI uses Tina4's inline testing framework
- **Ask for the gallery** -- "Deploy the auth gallery example" -- the AI clicks Try It and you have a working JWT demo
- **Review, do not rewrite** -- The AI's first attempt is usually 90% correct. Tweak the details instead of starting over.

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Exercise

Open your Tina4 PHP project in Claude Code (or your preferred AI tool) and try these prompts:

- "Add a Contact model with name, email, phone, and message fields"
- "Create a contact form page at /contact with a Twig template using tina4css"
- "Add an API endpoint that accepts the form submission and saves it to the database"
- "Send an email notification when a new contact is submitted"
- "Add rate limiting to the contact form -- max 3 submissions per minute"

Each prompt should generate correct, runnable code on the first try. If it does not, check that CLAUDE.md is in your project root.

Gotchas

- **No CLAUDE.md?** Run `tina4 init` or `AI::installContext('.')` to generate it
- **AI suggests wrong import paths?** The CLAUDE.md might be outdated -- regenerate it with `AI::installContext('.', force: true)`
- **AI hallucinates a package?** Remind it: "Tina4 has zero dependencies, use only built-in features"
- **AI creates files in wrong location?** Tell it: "Follow the src/routes, src/orm, src/templates convention"
- **AI code does not run?** Check that routes return `$response->json()` not `echo` -- Tina4 convention matters

The Philosophy

Tina4 is not just compatible with AI coding tools. It was designed to make AI-assisted development effortless.

Convention over configuration means the AI always knows where things go. Zero dependencies means the AI never chooses between packages. A single CLAUDE.md file means the AI has complete framework knowledge. Identical APIs across 4 languages means the AI's knowledge transfers instantly.

The future of web development is collaborative. You describe the intent. The AI writes the code. You review and refine. Tina4 is built for that future.

The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework. Built for AI. Built for you.

Environment Variables

■■ BREAKING CHANGE — Tina4 v3.12.0

>

*Every framework env var now requires the **TINA4_** prefix. The legacy un-prefixed names (**DATABASE_URL**, **SECRET**, **SMTP_HOST**, **HOST_NAME**, etc.) no longer work. Setting them at startup makes the framework refuse to boot with a list of renames.*

>

*Run **tina4 env --migrate** to rewrite your existing **.env** automatically, or rename manually using the table below. The runtime guard prints the same mapping if it detects legacy names.*

>

Conventional names stay un-prefixed: **PORT**, **HOST**, **NODE_ENV**, **RACK_ENV**, **RUBY_ENV**, **ENVIRONMENT*. These are runtime/PaaS conventions, not framework config.*

Tina4 is configured through environment variables, read from **.env** at the project root. Every variable has a sensible default — most projects set three or four values and leave the rest alone.

This chapter lists every variable the PHP framework reads, grouped by subsystem. Start with the minimum-config examples at the end, then come back here when you need to tune something specific.

Core Server

Variable	Default	Description
HOST	0.0.0.0	Bind address. 0.0.0.0 listens on every interface. 127.0.0.1 restricts to localhost.
TINA4_HOST	0.0.0.0	Tina4-specific bind override consulted by <code>App::serve()</code> and <code>Server</code> when no <code>\$host</code> argument is passed. Wins over the conventional <code>HOST</code> for the framework's own server.
PORT	7145	HTTP server port. The Rust CLI prefers <code>TINA4_PORT</code> but falls back to <code>PORT</code> .
TINA4_PORT	(inherits PORT)	Explicit Tina4-specific port override. Takes precedence over <code>PORT</code> when both are set.
TINA4_WS_PORT	(inherits port)	Separate port for the WebSocket server. Leave unset to share the HTTP port.
TINA4_HOST_NAME	localhost:7145	Fully-qualified host used in generated absolute URLs (Swagger, OAuth redirects, emails).
TINA4_DEBUG	false	Master debug toggle. Enables Swagger UI, dev dashboard, live reload, template dump filter, error overlay. Never set to <code>true</code> in production.
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL	ERROR	Minimum message level shown when <code>TINA4_DEBUG=true</code> . Options: <code>DEBUG</code> , <code>INFO</code> , <code>WARNING</code> , <code>ERROR</code> , <code>ALL</code> .

TINA4_NO_BROWSER	false	Stops <code>tina4 serve</code> from opening your browser on every restart. Recommended during active development.
TINA4_NO_RELOAD	false	Disables the dev hot-reload signal from the Rust CLI. Use when you want a stable server for debugging.
TINA4_SUPPRESS	false	Hides the Tina4 startup banner. Useful in CI and systemd units where stdout is ingested.
TINA4_VERSION	(framework)	Override the version string reported by <code>/__dev/api/system</code> . Mostly for testing.
TINA4_CLI_SERVE	(none)	Set internally by the Rust CLI to signal managed mode. Do not set manually.
TINA4_PUBLIC_DIR	(empty)	Override directory served as static files at <code>/</code> . When unset, the static-file middleware searches <code>src/public/</code> and the framework's bundled public assets.
TINA4_TEMPLATE_ROUTING	on	Auto-routing of Twig templates from <code>src/templates/</code> . Set to <code>off</code> , <code>false</code> , <code>0</code> , <code>no</code> , or <code>disabled</code> to require explicit <code>Router::get()</code> for every URL.
TINA4_ALLOW_LEGACY_ENV	false	Bypass the v3.12 boot guard that rejects un-prefixed legacy env vars (<code>DATABASE_URL</code> , <code>SECRET</code> , <code>SMTP_HOST</code> , etc.). Use only in CI / migration scripts during the transition window.

TINA4_ENV_FILE	.env	Alternate path for the dotenv file loaded at boot. Resolved relative to the project root unless absolute. Useful for per-environment files (e.g. <code>.env.production</code>) without symlinking.
TINA4_HEALTH_PATH	/health	Path the built-in health-check route registers under. Set <code>/__health</code> to align with the v3 documented alias used by the other frameworks; the default keeps <code>/health</code> for back-compat with existing probes.

Routing

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_TRAILING_SLASH_REDIRECT	false	When truthy, any request path ending in <code>/</code> (other than the bare root) is 301-redirected to the slash-stripped form. The query string is preserved. Lets you normalise URLs without writing per-route handlers.

Secrets and Authentication

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SECRET	(empty)	JWT signing secret. Must be long, random, and unique per environment. Never commit.
TINA4_JWT_ALGORITHM	HS256	JWT signing algorithm. Supports HS256, HS384, HS512.
TINA4_TOKEN_LIMIT	60	JWT token lifetime in minutes.
TINA4_API_KEY	(empty)	Static API key used by <code>Auth::validateApiKey()</code> as a fallback to JWT.

Database

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_DATABASE_URL	sqlite:///data/app.db	Connection URL. Scheme selects the driver: <code>sqlite</code> , <code>postgres</code> , <code>mysql</code> , <code>mssql</code> , <code>sqlserver</code> , <code>firebird</code> .
TINA4_DATABASE_USERNAME	(empty)	Overrides the username embedded in <code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code> .
TINA4_DATABASE_PASSWORD	(empty)	Overrides the password embedded in <code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code> .
TINA4_DATABASE_FIREBIRD_PATH	(empty)	Overrides the database path/alias parsed from <code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code> for Firebird. Useful for Windows backslash paths and split-config setups.
TINA4_DATABASE_URL	(empty)	Legacy alias for <code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code> . Prefer <code>TINA4_DATABASE_URL</code> in new projects.
TINA4_AUTOCOMMIT	false	Auto-commit after every write. Default is off — call <code>commit()</code> explicitly.
TINA4_DB_CACHE	false	Enables in-memory query-result caching for read queries.
TINA4_DB_CACHE_TTL	60	Query cache TTL in seconds when <code>TINA4_DB_CACHE=true</code> .

TINA4_DB_POOL	0	Default connection-pool size used when a caller constructs <code>Database</code> without passing <code>\$pool</code> . 0 keeps the single-connection behaviour; values above zero enable pooled adapters lazily. An explicit constructor argument always wins.
TINA4_MIGRATION_ID	(timestamp)	Override the migration ID used when recording applied migrations.

CORS

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS	*	Comma-separated allowed origins. Lock down to real domains in production.
TINA4_CORS_METHODS	GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE, OPTIONS	Allowed request methods.
TINA4_CORS_HEADERS	Content-Type, Authorization, X-Requested-With	Allowed request headers.
TINA4_CORS_CREDENTIALS	false	Send <code>Access-Control-Allow-Credentials: true</code> . Required for cross-origin cookies.
TINA4_CORS_MAX_AGE	600	Preflight cache lifetime in seconds.

Security Headers

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_CSP	default-src 'self'	Content-Security-Policy header.
TINA4_CSRF	true	CSRF token validation on POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE. Requires <code>_csrf</code> in the body or <code>X-CSRF-Token</code> header.
TINA4_HSTS	(empty/off)	Strict-Transport-Security max-age in seconds. Set <code>31536000</code> in production with HTTPS.
TINA4_FRAME_OPTIONS	DENY	X-Frame-Options header. Set <code>SAMEORIGIN</code> if you embed your own app in an iframe.
TINA4_REFERRER_POLICY	strict-origin-when-cross-origin	Referrer-Policy header.
TINA4_PERMISSIONS_POLICY	(empty)	Permissions-Policy header. Example: <code>geolocation=(), microphone=()</code> .

Rate Limiting

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_RATE_LIMIT	100	Maximum requests per window per IP. Set <code>0</code> to disable.
TINA4_RATE_WINDOW	60	Rate-limit window in seconds.

Sessions

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND	file	Storage backend. Options: <code>file</code> , <code>redis</code> , <code>valkey</code> , <code>mongo</code> , <code>database</code> .
TINA4_SESSION_HANDLER	(inherits <code>_BACKEND</code>)	Alternate handler class name. Overrides <code>TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND</code> .
TINA4_SESSION_NAME	tina4_session	Cookie name written by the framework session manager. Distinct from <code>TINA4_PHP_SESSION_NAME</code> , which controls the native PHP session cookie.
TINA4_SESSION_TTL	3600	Session expiry in seconds.
TINA4_SESSION_SAMESITE	Lax	SameSite cookie attribute. Options: <code>Strict</code> , <code>Lax</code> , <code>None</code> .
TINA4_SESSION_HTTPONLY	true	Emit the <code>HttpOnly</code> attribute on the session cookie. Leave on unless JavaScript genuinely needs to read the cookie.
TINA4_SESSION_SECURE	false	Emit the <code>Secure</code> attribute on the session cookie. Setting <code>TINA4_SESSION_SAMESITE=None</code> forces this to <code>true</code> regardless of the value here.
TINA4_SESSION_PATH	data/sessions	Filesystem path for the file backend.
TINA4_PHP_SESSION_NAME	PHPSESSID	Cookie name used by native PHP <code>\$_SESSION</code> (separate from the framework session).
TINA4_PHP_SESSION_PATH	(system temp)	<code>session.save_path</code> for native PHP sessions. The framework configures it before <code>session_start()</code> so the SAPI and the built-in server share session storage.

Redis/Valkey session backend

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST	localhost	Redis host.
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT	6379	Redis port.
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PASSWORD	(none)	Redis auth password.
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_DB	0	Redis database number.
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_URL	(none)	Full <code>redis://</code> URL. Overrides the individual fields when set.
TINA4_SESSION_VALKEY_HOST	localhost	Valkey host.
TINA4_SESSION_VALKEY_PORT	6379	Valkey port.
TINA4_SESSION_VALKEY_PASSWORD	(none)	Valkey auth password.
TINA4_SESSION_VALKEY_DB	0	Valkey database number.

MongoDB session backend

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SESSION_MONGO_URL	mongodb://localhost:27017	MongoDB connection string.
TINA4_SESSION_MONGO_DB	tina4	MongoDB database name.

Templates

Variable	Default	Description
<code>TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL</code>	<code>0</code>	Lifetime of compiled Frond templates in production, in seconds. <code>0</code> means cache forever (no filesystem checks per render); a positive value re-reads and re-tokenises a template once it has been cached for that long. Ignored when <code>TINA4_DEBUG=true</code> — debug mode always re-reads.

Cache

Variable	Default	Description
<code>TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND</code>	<code>memory</code>	Response cache backend. Options: <code>memory</code> , <code>file</code> , <code>redis</code> .
<code>TINA4_CACHE_DIR</code>	<code>data/cache</code>	Cache directory for the file backend.
<code>TINA4_CACHE_TTL</code>	<code>60</code>	Default cache TTL in seconds.
<code>TINA4_CACHE_MAX_ENTRIES</code>	<code>1000</code>	Maximum cache entries. Oldest entries evicted first.
<code>TINA4_CACHE_URL</code>	<code>(none)</code>	Connection URL for remote cache backends (Redis, Memcached).

Queues

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND	file	Queue backend. Options: <code>file</code> , <code>kafka</code> , <code>rabbitmq</code> , <code>mongo</code> , <code>database</code> .
TINA4_QUEUE_PATH	data/queue	Filesystem path for the file backend.
TINA4_QUEUE_URL	(none)	Connection URL for remote backends.

Kafka queue backend

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_KAFKA_BROKERS	localhost:9092	Comma-separated broker list.
TINA4_KAFKA_GROUP_ID	tina4_consumer_group	Kafka consumer group ID.

RabbitMQ queue backend

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_RABBITMQ_HOST	localhost	RabbitMQ host.
TINA4_RABBITMQ_PORT	5672	RabbitMQ port.
TINA4_RABBITMQ_USERNAME	guest	RabbitMQ username.
TINA4_RABBITMQ_PASSWORD	guest	RabbitMQ password.
TINA4_RABBITMQ_VHOST	/	RabbitMQ virtual host.

MongoDB queue backend

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_MONGO_URI	<i>(none)</i>	Full MongoDB connection string. Overrides host/port when set.
TINA4_MONGO_HOST	localhost	MongoDB host.
TINA4_MONGO_PORT	27017	MongoDB port.
TINA4_MONGO_USERNAME	<i>(none)</i>	MongoDB username.
TINA4_MONGO_PASSWORD	<i>(none)</i>	MongoDB password.
TINA4_MONGO_DB	tina4	MongoDB database name.
TINA4_MONGO_COLLECTION	tina4_queue	MongoDB collection name for jobs.

WebSocket Backplane

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE	<i>(none)</i>	Backplane type. Set <code>redis</code> for multi-instance broadcasts.
TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE_URL	redis://localhost:6379	Connection URL for the backplane.

Email

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_MAIL_HOST	(none)	SMTP server hostname.
TINA4_MAIL_PORT	587	SMTP server port.
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME	(none)	SMTP authentication username.
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD	(none)	SMTP authentication password.
TINA4_MAIL_FROM	(none)	Default sender email address.
TINA4_MAIL_FROM_NAME	(none)	Default sender display name.
TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION	tls	Connection encryption. Options: <code>tls</code> , <code>ssl</code> , <code>none</code> .
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_HOST	(none)	IMAP server for inbound mail.
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PORT	993	IMAP server port.
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_USERNAME	(none)	IMAP authentication username.
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PASSWORD	(none)	IMAP authentication password.
TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_ENCRYPTION	tls	IMAP transport encryption. Accepts <code>tls</code> , <code>starttls</code> , or <code>none</code> ; any other value is silently coerced back to <code>tls</code> . Independent of <code>TINA4_MAIL_ENCRYPTION</code> so Gmail-style setups can use IMAPS on 993 alongside SMTP STARTTLS on 587.
TINA4_MAILBOX_DIR	data/mailbox	Dev mailbox directory. All outbound mail lands here when <code>TINA4_DEBUG=true</code> .

`TINA4_MAIL_HOST`, `TINA4_MAIL_PORT`, `TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME`, `TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD` are also accepted as aliases for the `TINA4_MAIL_*` equivalents. New projects should use the `TINA4_MAIL_*` names.

Logging

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL	ERROR	Minimum log level written to files. Options: ALL, DEBUG, INFO, WARNING, ERROR.
TINA4_LOG_DEBUG	0	Numeric flag for debug-level messages. Used internally by <code>Debug::message()</code> .
TINA4_LOG_INFO	1	Numeric flag for info-level messages.
TINA4_LOG_ERROR	3	Numeric flag for error-level messages.
TINA4_LOG_MAX_SIZE	10485760	Per-file log size limit in bytes (10 MB). Rotated when exceeded.
TINA4_LOG_KEEP	5	Number of rotated log files to retain.

Log pipeline (sink, format, rotation)

Logs default to stdout. Set `TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT=file` plus `TINA4_LOG_FILE=app.log` to write to disk; the framework rotates at `TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_SIZE` bytes and keeps `TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_KEEP` backups.

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_LOG_FILE	(empty = stdout only)	Primary log filename. A relative value is joined with <code>TINA4_LOG_DIR</code> ; an absolute path overrides both directory and filename. Leave empty to skip file output entirely.
TINA4_LOG_DIR	logs	Directory log files are written into when <code>TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT</code> includes <code>file</code> . Created on first write if missing.

TINA4_LOG_FORMAT	text	Wire format for emitted lines. <code>text</code> is human-readable; <code>json</code> emits one structured object per line for ingestion by Loki, ELK, etc.
TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT	stdout	Where lines are sent. <code>stdout</code> writes to the process stream (great for systemd / containers), <code>file</code> writes only to <code>TINA4_LOG_FILE</code> , <code>both</code> does both.
TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL	false	Enable <code>Log::critical()</code> emission. Off by default so security-relevant criticals can be intentionally surfaced rather than buried in routine output.
TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_SIZE	10485760	Rotation threshold in bytes (10 MB default). Set <code>0</code> to disable rotation entirely — useful when an external tool (logrotate, Docker driver) owns the file.
TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_KEEP	5	Number of rotated backups to retain. Older files are pruned on rotation.

Uploads

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE	10485760	Maximum multipart upload size in bytes (10 MB).

Localisation

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_LOCALE	en	Default locale for I18n .
TINA4_LOCALE_DIR	src/locale	Directory containing locale JSON files.

Services (background tasks)

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SERVICE_DIR	src/services	Directory scanned for service classes.
TINA4_SERVICE_SLEEP	1	Default tick interval (seconds) when a service does not specify one.

AI and MCP Tooling

The dashboard AI chat and the framework's RAG-based code search both default to a **local qwen2.5-coder model served via Ollama**. Nothing leaves your machine unless you point **TINA4_AI_URL** at a remote endpoint.

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_AI_URL	http://localhost:11434	OpenAI-compatible HTTP endpoint for the chat/completion model (Ollama by default).
TINA4_AI_MODEL	qwen2.5-coder	Model identifier the endpoint should serve.
TINA4_RAG_URL	(inherits TINA4_AI_URL)	Embedding endpoint for the framework RAG index.
TINA4_RAG_TOPK	4	Number of nearest-neighbour matches the dev dashboard RAG search returns per query.

TINA4_AI_MODEL	nommic-embed-text	Embedding model used to index the framework and src/.
TINA4_VISION_URL	http://andrevanzuydam.com:11434	Vision-model endpoint surfaced by the dev dashboard /__dev/api/vision probe.
TINA4_EMBED_URL	http://andrevanzuydam.com:11435	Embeddings endpoint surfaced by the dev dashboard /__dev/api/embed probe.
TINA4_IMAGE_URL	http://andrevanzuydam.com:11436	Image-generation endpoint (e.g. SDXL Turbo) for the dev dashboard image tools.
TINA4_SUPERVISOR_URL	(framework port + 2000)	Override the URL of the Rust agent supervisor that the dev dashboard proxies for /__dev/api/supervise/* and /__dev/api/execute. Defaults to http://127.0.0.1:9145 when TINA4_PORT=7145.
TINA4_MCP	(inherits TINA4_DEBUG)	Master switch for the MCP subsystem. When unset, follows TINA4_DEBUG — MCP is on in dev and off in prod. Set to false to keep MCP disabled while leaving debug mode on, or to true to expose MCP from a production server (combine with TINA4_MCP_REMOTE if binding off-localhost).
TINA4_MCP_PORT	(framework port + 2000)	Port the MCP server listens on. Defaults to TINA4_PORT + 2000 (so 7145 → 9145). Set explicitly when running multiple Tina4 instances on the same host.

TINA4_MCP_REMOTE	false	Allow the MCP server to bind on non-localhost interfaces. Never enable in production.
TINA4_NO_AI_PORT	false	Disables the MCP port listener in dev mode.
TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT	false	Allow the framework to start without the Rust CLI (<code>tina4 serve</code>). Used in Docker images and CI runners; bypasses SCSS compilation, the file watcher, and live reload.

Swagger / OpenAPI

Variable	Default	Description
TINA4_SWAGGER_TITLE	Tina4 API	OpenAPI spec title shown in the Swagger UI.
TINA4_SWAGGER_DESCRIPTION	Auto-generated from Tina4 routes	OpenAPI spec description.
TINA4_SWAGGER_VERSION	1.0.0	OpenAPI spec version.
TINA4_SWAGGER_ENABLED	(inherits TINA4_DEBUG)	Master switch for Swagger UI and the <code>/swagger/swagger.json</code> routes. When unset, follows <code>TINA4_DEBUG</code> so Swagger is on in dev and off in prod automatically. Set explicitly to expose docs in production.
TINA4_SWAGGER_CONTACT_EMAIL	(empty)	Contact email written into the generated OpenAPI <code>info.contact</code> block.
TINA4_SWAGGER_LICENSE	(empty)	License name written into the generated OpenAPI <code>info.license</code> block.

GraphQL

Variable	Default	Description
<code>TINA4_GRAPHQL_ENDPOINT</code>	<code>/graphql</code>	URL path the framework binds the GraphQL handler to. The same value is used when generating <code>__schema</code> links and the dev-dashboard query console URL.
<code>TINA4_GRAPHQL_AUTO_SCHEMA</code>	<code>true</code>	Auto-generate the GraphQL schema from registered ORM models. Set to <code>false</code> to skip introspection scaffolding when you supply a hand-written schema.

HTTP Status Constants

For use in route handlers instead of raw integers:

```
return $response->json($data, \Tina4\HTTP_CREATED);
return $response("<error/>", \Tina4\HTTP_BAD_REQUEST, \Tina4\APPLICATION_XML);
```

See [Chapter 3: Request and Response](#) for the full table.

Log-Level Constants

Passed to `Debug::message()` to tag severity:

Constant	Description
<code>TINA4_LOG_DEBUG</code>	Verbose developer messages.
<code>TINA4_LOG_INFO</code>	Normal operational messages.
<code>TINA4_LOG_WARNING</code>	Non-fatal anomalies.
<code>TINA4_LOG_ERROR</code>	Recoverable errors.
<code>TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL</code>	Fatal or security-relevant events.

```
\Tina4\Debug::message("User " . $id . " missed the cache", TINA4_LOG_INFO);
```

Minimal `.env` for Development

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true  
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=DEBUG  
TINA4_NO_BROWSER=true
```

That is it. Debug mode lights up the Swagger UI, the dev dashboard, detailed error pages, and live reload. Keeping the browser flag on stops a new tab opening every time you save a file.

Minimal `.env` for Production

```
TINA4_SECRET=your-long-random-secret-here  
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=postgresql://user:password@db-host:5432/myapp  
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=https://myapp.com,https://www.myapp.com  
TINA4_HSTS=31536000  
TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.example.com  
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587  
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=noreply@myapp.com  
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-smtp-password  
TINA4_MAIL_FROM=noreply@myapp.com
```

No `TINA4_DEBUG`. It defaults to `false`, which is what you want in production. Set a real secret, a real database, locked-down CORS origins, HSTS, and SMTP credentials if you send email. Everything else has a production-appropriate default.

Deployment

1. From Development to Production

The app works on `localhost:7145`. Now it needs to run around the clock on a real server. Handle thousands of concurrent users. Survive restarts. Hold steady on memory. The gap between "works on my machine" and "works in production" is where projects stumble.

This chapter covers everything for a production deployment: environment configuration, Docker packaging, web server setup, SSL/TLS, scaling, monitoring, and graceful shutdown.

When you run `tina4 init`, the framework generates a production-ready `Dockerfile` and `.dockerignore` in your project root. The Dockerfile uses a multi-stage build: the first stage installs Composer dependencies and the second stage copies only the runtime artifacts into a slim image. You do not need to write a Dockerfile from scratch -- the generated one is a solid starting point that you can customise as needed.

2. Production .env Configuration

Development defaults optimize for debugging. Production defaults optimize for performance and security. The first deployment step: configure `.env` for production.

Create a production `.env`:

```
# Core
TINA4_DEBUG=false
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING
TINA4_PORT=7145

# Database
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db

# Security
CORS_ORIGINS=https://yourdomain.com
JWT_SECRET=your-long-random-secret-at-least-32-characters
TINA4_RATE_LIMIT=120

# Performance
TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL=true
```

Key Differences from Development

Setting	Development	Production	Why
<code>TINA4_DEBUG</code>	<code>true</code>	<code>false</code>	Hides stack traces, disables toolbar
<code>TINA4_LOG_LEVEL</code>	<code>ALL</code>	<code>WARNING</code>	Reduces log noise
<code>CORS_ORIGINS</code>	<code>*</code>	Your domain	Prevents cross-origin abuse

Sensitive Values

Production secrets never go into version control. The `.env` file is gitignored by default. For deployment, use environment variables from your hosting platform, CI/CD secrets, or a secrets manager.

```
# Docker: pass env vars at runtime
docker run -e JWT_SECRET=your-secret -e TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db my-app

# Fly.io: set secrets
fly secrets set JWT_SECRET=your-secret

# Railway: use the dashboard or CLI
railway variables set JWT_SECRET=your-secret
```

3. FrankenPHP Auto-Detection

Tina4 PHP auto-detects FrankenPHP at startup. FrankenPHP is a modern PHP application server built on Caddy:

- Worker mode (keeps PHP in memory between requests)
- Built-in HTTPS with automatic certificate management
- HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 support
- Dramatically better performance than PHP-FPM for long-running applications

How Auto-Detection Works

When you run `tina4 serve --production`, the CLI checks for FrankenPHP:

- If `frankenphp` is in your PATH, it uses FrankenPHP in worker mode
- If not, it falls back to PHP's built-in server with production optimizations

```
# With FrankenPHP installed
tina4 serve --production

Tina4 PHP v3.0.0
Server: FrankenPHP (worker mode)
Workers: 4
Running at https://0.0.0.0:7145
TLS: automatic (Let's Encrypt)
```

```
# Without FrankenPHP
tina4 serve --production

Tina4 PHP v3.0.0
Server: PHP built-in
Running at http://0.0.0.0:7145
Warning: For production, consider FrankenPHP or PHP-FPM + nginx
```

Installing FrankenPHP

```
# macOS
brew install dunglas/tap/frankenphp

# Linux
curl -fsSL https://frankenphp.dev/install.sh | bash

# Docker (no installation needed)
docker pull dunglas/frankenphp
```

4. Docker Deployment

Docker is the most portable deployment path. Your app runs the same way on your laptop, in CI, and on the production server.

Official Base Image

Tina4 PHP provides an official Docker Hub base image: [tina4stack/tina4-php:v3](#). It is an Alpine-based image (~154MB) with PHP 8.4, SQLite, OPcache, and the Tina4 framework pre-installed. Your app Dockerfile extends it and adds only your application code and Composer dependencies.

The base image includes these environment variables pre-configured:

- [TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true](#) — bypasses the CLI guard for Docker
- [TINA4_DEBUG=false](#) — production mode by default

OPcache is pre-configured with production settings (timestamps disabled, 10000 accelerated files).

Dockerfile

Create [Dockerfile](#) at the project root:

```
FROM tina4stack/tina4-php:v3
WORKDIR /app

# Install Composer and app dependencies
COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts \
    && rm /usr/bin/composer

# Copy application code
COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/

# Create data directories for SQLite, sessions, queue, and mailbox
RUN mkdir -p data data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox

EXPOSE 7145
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

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.dockerignore

Create `.dockerignore` to keep the image small:

```
.git
.env.development
data/
logs/
secrets/
node_modules/
vendor/
tests/
.DS_Store
.tina4/
```

Build and Run

```
# Build the image
docker build -t my-tina4-app .

# Run it
docker run -d \
  --name my-app \
  -p 7145:7145 \
  -e JWT_SECRET=your-production-secret \
  -v $(pwd)/data:/app/data \
  my-tina4-app
```

Verify

```
curl http://localhost:7145/health

{
  "status": "ok",
  "database": "connected",
  "uptime_seconds": 5,
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

Adding Database Drivers

The base image ships with SQLite only. To use PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, or Firebird, install the driver in your Dockerfile using the `install-php-extensions` tool from [mlocati](#).

PostgreSQL:

```
FROM tina4stack/tina4-php:v3
WORKDIR /app
COPY --from=mlocati/php-extension-installer /usr/bin/install-php-extensions /usr/bin/
RUN install-php-extensions pdo_pgsql && rm /usr/bin/install-php-extensions
COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts && rm /usr/bin/composer
COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/
RUN mkdir -p data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox
EXPOSE 7145
```

```
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

MySQL:

```
FROM tina4stack/tina4-php:v3
WORKDIR /app
COPY --from=mlocati/php-extension-installer /usr/bin/install-php-extensions /usr/bin/
RUN install-php-extensions pdo_mysql && rm /usr/bin/install-php-extensions
COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts && rm /usr/bin/composer
COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/
RUN mkdir -p data data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox
EXPOSE 7145
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

MSSQL:

```
FROM tina4stack/tina4-php:v3
WORKDIR /app
COPY --from=mlocati/php-extension-installer /usr/bin/install-php-extensions /usr/bin/
RUN install-php-extensions pdo_sqlsrv && rm /usr/bin/install-php-extensions
COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts && rm /usr/bin/composer
COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/
RUN mkdir -p data data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox
EXPOSE 7145
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

Firebird:

Firebird requires system-level libraries not available in Alpine. Use a Debian-based PHP image instead:

```
FROM php:8.4-cli-bookworm
WORKDIR /app
RUN apt-get update && apt-get install -y --no-install-recommends \
    firebird-dev libfbclient2 && \
    docker-php-ext-install pdo_firebird interbase && \
    apt-get purge -y firebird-dev && apt-get autoremove -y && \
    rm -rf /var/lib/apt/lists/*
COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts && rm /usr/bin/composer
COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/
RUN mkdir -p data data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox
EXPOSE 7145
ENV TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true
ENV TINA4_DEBUG=false
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

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***Note:** The Firebird Dockerfile cannot use `tina4stack/tina4-php:v3` because the base image is Alpine and Firebird's `fbclient` library requires `glibc` (Debian).*

Docker Compose

Create `docker-compose.yml`:

```
services:
  app:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "7145:7145"
    environment:
      - TINA4_DEBUG=false
      - TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING
      - JWT_SECRET=${JWT_SECRET}
      - TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db
    volumes:
      - app-data:/app/data
    restart: unless-stopped

volumes:
  app-data:

# Start everything
docker compose up -d

# View logs
docker compose logs -f app

# Stop everything
docker compose down

---
```

5. PHP-FPM + nginx Configuration

If you prefer a traditional setup without Docker, use PHP-FPM with nginx.

PHP-FPM Pool Configuration

Create `/etc/php/8.3/fpm/pool.d/tina4.conf`:

```
[tina4]
user = www-data
group = www-data
listen = /run/php/tina4.sock
listen.owner = www-data
listen.group = www-data

pm = dynamic
pm.max_children = 50
pm.start_servers = 5
pm.min_spare_servers = 5
pm.max_spare_servers = 35
pm.max_requests = 1000

env[TINA4_DATABASE_URL] = sqlite:///var/www/tina4-app/data/app.db
env[JWT_SECRET] = your-production-secret
```

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```
env[TINA4_DEBUG] = false
env[TINA4_LOG_LEVEL] = WARNING
```

nginx Configuration

Create `/etc/nginx/sites-available/tina4`:

```
server {
    listen 80;
    server_name yourdomain.com;
    root /var/www/tina4-app/src/public;
    index index.php;

    # Security headers
    add_header X-Frame-Options "SAMEORIGIN" always;
    add_header X-Content-Type-Options "nosniff" always;
    add_header X-XSS-Protection "1; mode=block" always;
    add_header Referrer-Policy "strict-origin-when-cross-origin" always;

    # Static files
    location ~* \.(css|js|png|jpg|jpeg|gif|ico|svg|woff|woff2|ttf|eot)$ {
        expires 30d;
        add_header Cache-Control "public, immutable";
        try_files $uri =404;
    }

    # All other requests go to Tina4
    location / {
        try_files $uri $uri/ /index.php?$query_string;
    }

    # PHP processing
    location ~ \.php$ {
        fastcgi_pass unix:/run/php/tina4.sock;
        fastcgi_param SCRIPT_FILENAME $realpath_root$fastcgi_script_name;
        include fastcgi_params;
        fastcgi_buffers 16 16k;
        fastcgi_buffer_size 32k;
    }

    # Block access to sensitive files
    location ~ /\. (env|git|htaccess) {
        deny all;
    }

    location ~ ^/(data|logs|secrets|vendor)/ {
        deny all;
    }
}
```

Enable the site and restart:

```
sudo ln -s /etc/nginx/sites-available/tina4 /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/
sudo nginx -t
sudo systemctl restart nginx
sudo systemctl restart php8.3-fpm
```

6. Health Check Endpoint

Tina4 includes a built-in health check endpoint at `/health`:

```
curl http://localhost:7145/health

{
  "status": "ok",
  "database": "connected",
  "uptime_seconds": 3600,
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

If the database is disconnected or the application is in a bad state, the health check returns a non-200 status:

```
{
  "status": "error",
  "database": "disconnected",
  "error": "Could not connect to database",
  "uptime_seconds": 3600,
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

Use this endpoint for:

- **Docker HEALTHCHECK** (shown in the Dockerfile above)
- **Load balancer health checks** (AWS ALB, nginx upstream, HAProxy)
- **Monitoring tools** (Uptime Robot, Pingdom, custom scripts)
- **Kubernetes liveness and readiness probes**

Custom Health Checks

You can extend the health check to include your own checks:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/health/detailed", function ($request, $response) {
    $checks = [
        "database" => false,
        "cache" => false,
        "disk_space" => false
    ];

    // Check database
    try {
        $product = new Product();
        $product->select("count(*) as cnt");
        $checks["database"] = true;
    } catch (\Exception $e) {
        // Database check failed
    }

    // Check disk space
```

```

$freeBytes = disk_free_space("/");
$checks["disk_space"] = $freeBytes > 100 * 1024 * 1024; // 100MB minimum

$allOk = !in_array(false, $checks);

return $response->json([
    "status" => $allOk ? "ok" : "degraded",
    "checks" => $checks,
    "free_disk_mb" => round($freeBytes / 1024 / 1024)
], $allOk ? 200 : 503);
});
---

```

7. Graceful Shutdown

Deploy a new version. The old process must stop. Graceful shutdown finishes active requests before terminating.

Tina4 handles this when it receives a **SIGTERM** signal (the standard shutdown signal from Docker and systemd):

- Stop accepting new connections
- Wait for active requests to complete (up to a configurable timeout)
- Close database connections
- Flush logs
- Exit

Shutdown Timeout

Set the maximum time to wait for in-flight requests in **.env**:

```
TINA4_SHUTDOWN_TIMEOUT=30
```

If requests are still processing after 30 seconds, the server force-kills them and exits. The default is 30 seconds, which is enough for most applications.

Docker Stop Behavior

Docker sends SIGTERM, waits 10 seconds (by default), then sends SIGKILL. Match the Docker timeout to your shutdown timeout:

```

services:
  app:
    stop_grace_period: 35s    # Slightly more than TINA4_SHUTDOWN_TIMEOUT
---

```

8. Log Rotation

In production, log files grow without limit unless rotated. Tina4 writes to **logs/app.log**.

Using logrotate (Linux)

Create `/etc/logrotate.d/tina4`:

```
/var/www/tina4-app/logs/*.log {
    daily
    rotate 14
    compress
    delaycompress
    missingok
    notifempty
    create 640 www-data www-data
    postrotate
        # Tina4 re-opens log files automatically
    endscript
}
```

This rotates logs daily, keeps 14 days of compressed history, and creates new log files with the correct permissions.

Docker Logging

In Docker, application logs go to stdout/stderr by default. Configure Docker's logging driver to manage rotation:

```
services:
  app:
    logging:
      driver: "json-file"
      options:
        max-size: "10m"
        max-file: "5"
```

This keeps a maximum of 50MB of logs (5 files of 10MB each).

9. Environment-Specific Configuration

Use different `.env` files for different environments:

```
.env                # Development (gitignored)
.env.example        # Template (committed to git)
.env.staging        # Staging config (gitignored)
.env.production     # Production config (gitignored)
```

Loading a Specific .env File

Set the `TINA4_ENV_FILE` environment variable before starting:

```
# Staging
TINA4_ENV_FILE=.env.staging tina4 serve

# Production
TINA4_ENV_FILE=.env.production tina4 serve --production
```

In Docker, pass environment variables directly:

```
docker run -e TINA4_DEBUG=false -e JWT_SECRET=xxx my-app
```

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Environment variables set via `docker run -e` or `docker-compose environment:` take precedence over `.env` file values. This lets you use a generic `.env` file in the image and override specific values at runtime.

10. SSL/TLS with Let's Encrypt

With FrankenPHP (Automatic)

FrankenPHP handles SSL automatically. Just set your domain:

```
TINA4_HOST=yourdomain.com
```

FrankenPHP uses Let's Encrypt to provision and renew certificates automatically. No manual configuration needed.

With nginx (Manual)

Install Certbot:

```
sudo apt install certbot python3-certbot-nginx
```

Obtain a certificate:

```
sudo certbot --nginx -d yourdomain.com
```

Certbot modifies your nginx configuration to include SSL settings and sets up automatic renewal. Verify auto-renewal:

```
sudo certbot renew --dry-run
```

With Docker (Using a Reverse Proxy)

Use Traefik or Caddy as a reverse proxy in front of your Tina4 container:

```
version: "3.8"

services:
  reverse-proxy:
    image: traefik:v3.0
    command:
      - "--providers.docker=true"
      - "--entrypoints.web.address=:80"
      - "--entrypoints.websecure.address=:443"
      - "--certificatesresolvers.letsencrypt.acme.tlschallenge=true"
      - "--certificatesresolvers.letsencrypt.acme.email=you@example.com"
      - "--certificatesresolvers.letsencrypt.acme.storage=/letsencrypt/acme.json"
    ports:
      - "80:80"
      - "443:443"
    volumes:
      - /var/run/docker.sock:/var/run/docker.sock:ro
      - letsencrypt:/letsencrypt

  app:
    build: .
    labels:
      - "traefik.http.routers.app.rule=Host(`yourdomain.com`)"
      - "traefik.http.routers.app.entrypoints=websecure"
```

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```

    - "traefik.http.routers.app.tls=true"
    - "traefik.http.routers.app.tls.certresolver=letsencrypt"
  environment:
    - TINA4_DEBUG=false
    - JWT_SECRET=${JWT_SECRET}

  volumes:
    letsencrypt:

---

```

11. Scaling

Multiple Workers

FrankenPHP runs multiple worker threads by default. Configure the count in `.env`:

A good starting point is the number of CPU cores on your server. For I/O-heavy applications (database queries, API calls), you can go higher -- 2x to 4x the core count.

Load Balancing with nginx

If you run multiple Tina4 instances, use nginx as a load balancer:

```

upstream tina4_backend {
    server 127.0.0.1:7145;
    server 127.0.0.1:7145;
    server 127.0.0.1:7147;
    server 127.0.0.1:7148;
}

server {
    listen 80;
    server_name yourdomain.com;

    location / {
        proxy_pass http://tina4_backend;
        proxy_set_header Host $host;
        proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto $scheme;
    }
}

```

Start four instances on different ports:

```

TINA4_PORT=7145 tina4 serve --production &
TINA4_PORT=7145 tina4 serve --production &
TINA4_PORT=7147 tina4 serve --production &
TINA4_PORT=7148 tina4 serve --production &

```

Docker Scaling

With Docker Compose, scale horizontally:

```
docker compose up -d --scale app=4
```

Use a load balancer (Traefik, nginx, or a cloud load balancer) in front of the containers.

12. Monitoring

Log Aggregation

In production, send logs to a centralized service:

```
TINA4_LOG_FORMAT=json
```

JSON-formatted logs can be ingested by services like:

- Elastic Stack (ELK)
- Grafana Loki
- Datadog
- AWS CloudWatch

Example JSON log entry:

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-03-22T14:30:00.123Z",
  "level": "WARNING",
  "message": "Rate limit exceeded",
  "request_id": "req-abc123",
  "ip": "203.0.113.42",
  "path": "/api/products",
  "method": "GET"
}
```

Uptime Monitoring

Point an external monitoring service at your health endpoint:

```
https://yourdomain.com/health
```

Services like Uptime Robot, Pingdom, or Better Uptime will ping this endpoint every 30-60 seconds and alert you if it stops responding or returns a non-200 status.

Application Performance Monitoring (APM)

For deeper insights, add APM instrumentation. Since Tina4 is standard PHP, any PHP APM agent works:

- New Relic APM
- Datadog APM
- Elastic APM

These agents track request latency, database query performance, error rates, and memory usage automatically.

13. Exercise: Deploy a Tina4 PHP App with Docker

Deploy the task management application you have been building throughout this book.

Requirements

- Create a `Dockerfile` that:
 - Uses `tina4stack/tina4-php:v3` as the base image
 - Installs Composer dependencies
 - Copies the application code
 - Creates data directories
 - Exposes port 7145
- Create a `docker-compose.yml` that:
 - Builds and runs the application
 - Maps port 7145
 - Uses environment variables for secrets
 - Persists the database via volumes
 - Includes restart policy
- Create a production `.env.production` with:
 - Debug mode off
 - Warning-level logging
 - Template caching enabled
 - Appropriate CORS settings
- Build and run the container.
- Verify the health check works.
- Verify you can create and list products through the containerized API.

Test with:

```
# Build
docker compose build

# Start
docker compose up -d

# Health check
curl http://localhost:7145/health

# Create a product
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/products \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Docker Widget", "price": 19.99}'

# List products
curl http://localhost:7145/api/products

# View logs
docker compose logs app

# Stop
docker compose down
```

14. Solution

Dockerfile

```
FROM tina4stack/tina4-php:v3
WORKDIR /app

COPY --from=composer:2 /usr/bin/composer /usr/bin/composer
COPY composer.json composer.lock* ./
RUN composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-scripts \
  && rm /usr/bin/composer

COPY index.php .
COPY .env .
COPY migrations/ migrations/
COPY src/ src/

RUN mkdir -p data data/sessions data/queue data/mailbox

EXPOSE 7145
CMD ["php", "index.php", "0.0.0.0:7145"]
```

docker-compose.yml

```
services:
  app:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "7145:7145"
    environment:
      - TINA4_DEBUG=false
      - TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING
      - TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL=true
      - JWT_SECRET=change-this-to-a-real-secret
      - TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db
      - CORS_ORIGINS=http://localhost:7145
    volumes:
      - app-data:/app/data
    restart: unless-stopped
    stop_grace_period: 35s

volumes:
  app-data:
```

.env.production

```
TINA4_DEBUG=false
TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING
TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL=true
TINA4_RATE_LIMIT=120
CORS_ORIGINS=https://yourdomain.com
```

Expected output for health check:

```
{
  "status": "ok",
  "database": "connected",
  "uptime_seconds": 8,
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

Expected output for creating a product:

```
{
  "id": 1,
  "name": "Docker Widget",
  "price": 19.99,
  "in_stock": true,
  "created_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00",
  "updated_at": "2026-03-22 14:30:00"
}
```

15. Gotchas

1. SQLite Concurrency in Production

Problem: Under high load, SQLite throws "database is locked" errors.

Cause: SQLite uses file-level locking. Multiple concurrent writes block each other.
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Fix: For low-to-medium traffic (under 100 concurrent users), SQLite works fine. For higher traffic, switch to PostgreSQL or MySQL:

```
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=postgres://user:pass@localhost:5432/myapp
```

If you must use SQLite under load, enable WAL mode by adding this to your application startup:

```
$db = Tina4\Database::getConnection();  
$db->exec("PRAGMA journal_mode=WAL");
```

2. Data Volume Not Persisted

Problem: You restart the Docker container and the database is empty.

Cause: The `data/` directory is inside the container. When the container is recreated, the data is lost.

Fix: Use a Docker volume to persist the data directory, as shown in the `docker-compose.yml` above:

```
volumes:  
  - app-data:/app/data
```

3. .env File Not Loaded in Docker

Problem: Environment variables from `.env` are not available in the container.

Cause: Docker does not automatically load `.env` files inside the container. The `.env` file is for the host machine (used by `docker compose`).

Fix: Pass environment variables via the `environment:` section in `docker-compose.yml`, or use `env_file::`

```
services:  
  app:  
    env_file:  
      - .env.production
```

4. Permission Denied on data/ Directory

Problem: The application cannot write to `data/` or `logs/` inside the container.

Cause: The directories were created by root during the Docker build, but the application runs as `www-data`.

Fix: Add `chown` to your Dockerfile:

```
RUN mkdir -p data logs secrets \  
    && chown -R www-data:www-data data logs secrets
```

5. Health Check Fails During Startup

Problem: The container restarts in a loop because the health check fails before the application is ready.

Cause: The health check starts immediately, but the application needs a few seconds to initialize.

Fix: Use `start_period` in the health check to give the application time to start:

```
HEALTHCHECK --start-period=10s --interval=30s --timeout=5s --retries=3 \
  CMD curl -f http://localhost:7145/health || exit 1
```

The `start-period` tells Docker to ignore health check failures during the first 10 seconds.

6. CORS Errors in Production

Problem: Your frontend gets "No 'Access-Control-Allow-Origin' header" errors.

Cause: `CORS_ORIGINS` is set to `*` in development but to a specific domain in production. If your frontend is served from a different domain or port, CORS blocks the requests.

Fix: Set `CORS_ORIGINS` to include all domains that need access:

```
CORS_ORIGINS=https://yourdomain.com,https://admin.yourdomain.com
```

7. SSL Certificate Not Renewing

Problem: Your HTTPS certificate expires and the site goes down.

Cause: The auto-renewal process (Certbot or FrankenPHP) failed silently. Common reasons: DNS changes, firewall blocking port 80 (needed for ACME challenge), or the renewal service crashed.

Fix: Set up monitoring for certificate expiry. Use a tool like `ssl-cert-check` or an online service that alerts you before the certificate expires. Check renewal logs:

```
# Certbot
sudo certbot renew --dry-run

# Check crontab for renewal
sudo systemctl list-timers | grep certbot
```

For FrankenPHP, ensure port 80 and 443 are accessible from the internet for ACME challenges.

Building a Complete App

1. Putting It All Together

Twenty chapters of building blocks. Routing. Templates. Databases. ORM. Authentication. Middleware. Queues. WebSocket. Caching. Frontend. GraphQL. Testing. Dev tools. CLI scaffolding. Deployment. Now all of it works together in one application.

TaskFlow -- a task management system with:

- User registration and JWT authentication
- Task creation, assignment, and tracking
- A dashboard with real-time updates
- Email notifications when tasks are assigned
- Caching for dashboard performance
- A full test suite
- Docker deployment

Not a toy project. A production-ready application. Every major Tina4 feature in one codebase.

2. Planning the App

Models

Model	Table	Fields
User	users	id, name, email, passwordHash, role, createdAt
Task	tasks	id, title, description, status, priority, createdBy, assignedTo, dueDate, completedAt, createdAt, updatedAt

Relationships

- A User has many Tasks (created by them)
- A User has many Tasks (assigned to them)
- A Task belongs to a User (creator)
- A Task belongs to a User (assignee)

Routes

Method	Path	Description	Auth
POST	/api/auth/register	Register a new user	public
POST	/api/auth/login	Login, get JWT	public
GET	/api/profile	Get current user profile	secured
GET	/api/tasks	List tasks (with filters)	secured
GET	/api/tasks/{id}	Get a single task	secured
POST	/api/tasks	Create a task	secured
PUT	/api/tasks/{id}	Update a task	secured
DELETE	/api/tasks/{id}	Delete a task	secured
GET	/api/dashboard/stats	Dashboard statistics	secured
GET	/admin	Dashboard HTML page	public

Templates

- `base.html` -- Base layout with sidebar and topbar
- `dashboard.html` -- Dashboard with stats, task list, quick actions
- `login.html` -- Login page
- `register.html` -- Registration page

3. Step 1: Init Project and Set Up Database

```
tina4 init taskflow
cd taskflow
composer install
```

Update `.env`:

```
TINA4_DEBUG=true
JWT_SECRET=taskflow-dev-secret-change-in-production
JWT_EXPIRY=86400
```

Create Migrations

Create `migrations/20260322000100_create_users_table.sql`:

```
-- UP
CREATE TABLE users (
  id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
  name TEXT NOT NULL,
  email TEXT NOT NULL UNIQUE,
  
```

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```

        password_hash TEXT NOT NULL,
        role TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'user',
        created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
    );

    CREATE INDEX idx_users_email ON users(email);

    -- DOWN
    DROP TABLE IF EXISTS users;

```

Create `migrations/20260322000200_create_tasks_table.sql`:

```

-- UP
CREATE TABLE tasks (
    id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    title TEXT NOT NULL,
    description TEXT DEFAULT '',
    status TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'todo',
    priority TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'medium',
    created_by INTEGER NOT NULL,
    assigned_to INTEGER,
    due_date TEXT,
    completed_at TEXT,
    created_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
    updated_at TEXT DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
    FOREIGN KEY (created_by) REFERENCES users(id),
    FOREIGN KEY (assigned_to) REFERENCES users(id)
);

CREATE INDEX idx_tasks_status ON tasks(status);
CREATE INDEX idx_tasks_assigned_to ON tasks(assigned_to);
CREATE INDEX idx_tasks_created_by ON tasks(created_by);

-- DOWN
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS tasks;

```

Run the migrations:

```

tina4 migrate

Running migrations...
[APPLIED] 20260322000100_create_users_table.sql
[APPLIED] 20260322000200_create_tasks_table.sql
Migrations complete. 2 applied.

```

4. Step 2: User Model with Registration and Login

Create `src/orm/User.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class User extends ORM
{
    public int $id;
    public string $name;
    public string $email;
    public string $passwordHash;
}

```

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```

public string $role = "user";
public string $createdAt;

public string $tableName = "users";
public string $primaryKey = "id";

/**
 * Get tasks created by this user
 */
public function createdTasks(): array
{
    return $this->hasMany(Task::class, "created_by");
}

/**
 * Get tasks assigned to this user
 */
public function assignedTasks(): array
{
    return $this->hasMany(Task::class, "assigned_to");
}

/**
 * Hash a password
 */
public static function hashPassword(string $password): string
{
    return password_hash($password, PASSWORD_DEFAULT);
}

/**
 * Verify a password against the stored hash
 */
public function verifyPassword(string $password): bool
{
    return password_verify($password, $this->passwordHash);
}

/**
 * Convert to dict without the password hash
 */
public function toSafeDict(): array
{
    $dict = $this->toArray();
    unset($dict["password_hash"]);
    return $dict;
}
}

```

Authentication Routes

Create [src/routes/auth.php](#):

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\Auth;

/**
 * @noauth

```

```

*/
Router::post("/api/auth/register", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    // Validate input
    if (empty($body["name"]) || empty($body["email"]) || empty($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "name, email, and password are required"], 400);
    }

    if (strlen($body["password"]) < 8) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Password must be at least 8 characters"], 400);
    }

    if (!filter_var($body["email"], FILTER_VALIDATE_EMAIL)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email address"], 400);
    }

    // Check for existing user
    $existing = new User();
    $found = $existing->select("", "email = :email", ["email" => $body["email"]]);
    if (count($found) > 0) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Email already registered"], 409);
    }

    // Create user
    $user = new User();
    $user->name = $body["name"];
    $user->email = $body["email"];
    $user->passwordHash = User::hashPassword($body["password"]);
    $user->role = "user";
    $user->save();

    return $response->json($user->toSafeDict(), 201);
});

/**
 * @noauth
 */
Router::post("/api/auth/login", function ($request, $response) {
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["email"]) || empty($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "email and password are required"], 400);
    }

    // Find user by email
    $user = new User();
    $found = $user->select("", "email = :email", ["email" => $body["email"]]);

    if (count($found) === 0) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }

    $user = $found[0];

    // Verify password
    if (!$user->verifyPassword($body["password"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Invalid email or password"], 401);
    }
}

```

```

// Generate JWT token
$token = Auth::getToken([
    "user_id" => $user->id,
    "email" => $user->email,
    "role" => $user->role
]);

return $response->json([
    "token" => $token,
    "user" => $user->toSafeDict()
]);
});

/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/api/profile", function ($request, $response) {
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];

    $user = new User();
    $user->load($userId);

    if (empty($user->id)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "User not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json(["user" => $user->toSafeDict()]);
});

```

Test Registration and Login

```

# Start the server
tina4 serve

# Register a user
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/auth/register \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"name": "Alice Johnson", "email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securepass123"}'

{
  "id": 1,
  "name": "Alice Johnson",
  "email": "alice@example.com",
  "role": "user",
  "created_at": "2026-03-22 10:00:00"
}

# Login
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/auth/login \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email": "alice@example.com", "password": "securepass123"}'

{
  "token": "eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9...",
  "user": {
    "id": 1,
    "name": "Alice Johnson",
    "email": "alice@example.com",
    "role": "user"
  }
}

```

```
# Access protected route
curl http://localhost:7145/api/profile \
-H "Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9..."

{
  "user": {
    "id": 1,
    "name": "Alice Johnson",
    "email": "alice@example.com",
    "role": "user"
  }
}
---
```

5. Step 3: Task Model with CRUD

Create `src/orm/Task.php`:

```
<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Task extends ORM
{
    public int $id;
    public string $title;
    public string $description = "";
    public string $status = "todo";
    public string $priority = "medium";
    public int $createdBy;
    public ?int $assignedTo = null;
    public ?string $dueDate = null;
    public ?string $completedAt = null;
    public string $createdAt;
    public string $updatedAt;

    public string $tableName = "tasks";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";

    /**
     * Get the user who created this task
     */
    public function creator(): ?User
    {
        return $this->belongsTo(User::class, "created_by");
    }

    /**
     * Get the user this task is assigned to
     */
    public function assignee(): ?User
    {
        return $this->belongsTo(User::class, "assigned_to");
    }

    /**
     * Convert to dict with nested user data
     */
    public function toDetailedDict(): array
```

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```

{
    $dict = $this->toArray();

    $creator = $this->creator();
    $dict["creator"] = $creator ? $creator->toSafeDict() : null;

    $assignee = $this->assignee();
    $dict["assignee"] = $assignee ? $assignee->toSafeDict() : null;

    return $dict;
}
}

```

Task Routes

Create `src/routes/tasks.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::group("/api", function () {

    // List tasks with filters
    /**
     * @secured
     */
    Router::get("/tasks", function ($request, $response) {
        $userId = $request->user["user_id"];

        $status = $request->params["status"] ?? "";
        $priority = $request->params["priority"] ?? "";
        $assigned = $request->params["assigned"] ?? "";
        $page = (int) ($request->params["page"] ?? 1);
        $perPage = (int) ($request->params["per_page"] ?? 20);

        $conditions = [];
        $params = [];

        // Show tasks created by or assigned to the current user
        $conditions[] = "(created_by = :userId OR assigned_to = :userId2)";
        $params["userId"] = $userId;
        $params["userId2"] = $userId;

        if (!empty($status)) {
            $conditions[] = "status = :status";
            $params["status"] = $status;
        }

        if (!empty($priority)) {
            $conditions[] = "priority = :priority";
            $params["priority"] = $priority;
        }

        if ($assigned === "me") {
            $conditions[] = "assigned_to = :assignedTo";
            $params["assignedTo"] = $userId;
        } elseif ($assigned === "unassigned") {
            $conditions[] = "assigned_to IS NULL";
        }
    });
}

```

```

$filter = implode(" AND ", $conditions);
$offset = ($page - 1) * $perPage;

$task = new Task();
$tasks = $task->select("", $filter, $params, "created_at DESC", $perPage, $offset);

$results = array_map(fn($t) => $t->toDetailedDict(), $tasks);

return $response->json([
    "tasks" => $results,
    "page" => $page,
    "per_page" => $perPage,
    "count" => count($results)
]);
});

// Get a single task
/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/tasks/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $task = new Task();
    $task->load($request->params["id"]);

    if (empty($task->id)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Task not found"], 404);
    }

    return $response->json($task->toDetailedDict());
});

// Create a task
Router::post("/tasks", function ($request, $response) {
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];
    $body = $request->body;

    if (empty($body["title"])) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "title is required"], 400);
    }

    $validStatuses = ["todo", "in_progress", "review", "done"];
    $validPriorities = ["low", "medium", "high", "urgent"];

    $status = $body["status"] ?? "todo";
    if (!in_array($status, $validStatuses)) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Invalid status. Must be one of: " . implode(", ", $validStatuses)
        ], 400);
    }

    $priority = $body["priority"] ?? "medium";
    if (!in_array($priority, $validPriorities)) {
        return $response->json([
            "error" => "Invalid priority. Must be one of: " . implode(", ", $validPriorities)
        ], 400);
    }

    $task = new Task();
    $task->title = $body["title"];

```



```

$task->description = $body["description"] ?? "";
$task->status = $status;
$task->priority = $priority;
$task->createdBy = $userId;
$task->dueDate = $body["due_date"] ?? null;

// Handle assignment
if (!empty($body["assigned_to"])) {
    $assignee = new User();
    $assignee->load((int) $body["assigned_to"]);
    if (empty($assignee->id)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Assigned user not found"], 400);
    }
    $task->assignedTo = $assignee->id;
}

$task->save();

return $response->json($task->toDetailedDict(), 201);
});

// Update a task
Router::put("/tasks/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $task = new Task();
    $task->load($request->params["id"]);

    if (empty($task->id)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Task not found"], 404);
    }

    $body = $request->body;

    if (isset($body["title"])) $task->title = $body["title"];
    if (isset($body["description"])) $task->description = $body["description"];
    if (isset($body["priority"])) $task->priority = $body["priority"];
    if (isset($body["due_date"])) $task->dueDate = $body["due_date"];

    // Handle status change
    if (isset($body["status"])) {
        $oldStatus = $task->status;
        $task->status = $body["status"];

        // Mark completion time
        if ($body["status"] === "done" && $oldStatus !== "done") {
            $task->completedAt = date("Y-m-d H:i:s");
        } elseif ($body["status"] !== "done") {
            $task->completedAt = null;
        }
    }

    // Handle reassignment
    if (isset($body["assigned_to"])) {
        if ($body["assigned_to"] === null) {
            $task->assignedTo = null;
        } else {
            $assignee = new User();
            $assignee->load((int) $body["assigned_to"]);
            if (empty($assignee->id)) {
                return $response->json(["error" => "Assigned user not found"], 400);
            }
        }
    }
}

```

```

        }
        $task->assignedTo = $assignee->id;
    }
}

$task->save();

return $response->json($task->toDetailedDict());
});

// Delete a task
Router::delete("/tasks/{id:int}", function ($request, $response) {
    $task = new Task();
    $task->load($request->params["id"]);

    if (empty($task->id)) {
        return $response->json(["error" => "Task not found"], 404);
    }

    $task->delete();
    return $response->json(null, 204);
});
});

```

Test the Task API

```

# Get token (from login)
TOKEN="eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIs...

```

```

# Create tasks
curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
-d '{"title": "Design database schema", "priority": "high", "status": "done"}'

```

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
-d '{"title": "Build API endpoints", "priority": "high", "status": "in_progress"}'

```

```

curl -X POST http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
-d '{"title": "Write documentation", "priority": "medium", "due_date": "2026-04-01"}'

```

```

# List all tasks
curl http://localhost:7145/api/tasks \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN"

```

```

# Filter by status
curl "http://localhost:7145/api/tasks?status=in_progress" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN"

```

6. Step 4: Dashboard Template with tina4css

Create <src/templates/app/layout.html>:

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```

<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}TaskFlow{% endblock %}</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/tina4.css">
  <script>
    (function() {
      var t = localStorage.getItem("theme");
      if (t) document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", t);
      else if (window.matchMedia("(prefers-color-scheme: dark)").matches)
        document.documentElement.setAttribute("data-theme", "dark");
    })();
  </script>
  <style>
    * { margin: 0; padding: 0; box-sizing: border-box; }
    body { font-family: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif; }
    .app { display: flex; min-height: 100vh; }
    .sidebar {
      width: 240px; background: #1a1a2e; color: #ccc; flex-shrink: 0;
    }
    .sidebar-brand {
      padding: 20px; font-size: 1.3em; font-weight: bold; color: #fff;
      border-bottom: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.1);
    }
    .sidebar-nav { list-style: none; padding: 12px 0; }
    .sidebar-nav a {
      display: block; padding: 10px 20px; color: rgba(255,255,255,0.6);
      text-decoration: none; transition: 0.2s;
    }
    .sidebar-nav a:hover, .sidebar-nav a.active {
      color: #fff; background: rgba(255,255,255,0.08);
    }
    .main { flex: 1; background: #f4f5f7; display: flex; flex-direction: column; }
    .topbar {
      background: #fff; padding: 14px 24px; border-bottom: 1px solid #e1e4e8;
      display: flex; justify-content: space-between; align-items: center;
    }
    .topbar-left { font-size: 1.1em; font-weight: 600; }
    .topbar-right { display: flex; gap: 12px; align-items: center; }
    .content { padding: 24px; flex: 1; }
    .stats-row { display: grid; grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(200px, 1fr)); }
    .stat-card {
      background: #fff; border-radius: 8px; padding: 20px;
      box-shadow: 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.08);
    }
    .stat-card .value { font-size: 2em; font-weight: bold; }
    .stat-card .label { color: #6c757d; margin-top: 4px; font-size: 0.9em; }
    .task-row {
      background: #fff; border-radius: 6px; padding: 14px 18px; margin-bottom: 8px;
      display: flex; align-items: center; gap: 12px;
      box-shadow: 0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.05);
    }
    .task-row .task-title { flex: 1; font-weight: 500; }
    .priority-dot {
      width: 10px; height: 10px; border-radius: 50%; flex-shrink: 0;
    }
    .priority-dot.urgent { background: #dc3545; }
  </style>

```

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```

        .priority-dot.high { background: #fd7e14; }
        .priority-dot.medium { background: #ffc107; }
        .priority-dot.low { background: #28a745; }
        @media (max-width: 768px) {
            .sidebar { display: none; }
            .stats-row { grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr; }
        }
    </style>
    {% block extra_css %}{% endblock %}
</head>
<body>
    <div class="app">
        <aside class="sidebar">
            <div class="sidebar-brand">TaskFlow</div>
            <ul class="sidebar-nav">
                <li><a href="/admin" class="{% if page == 'dashboard' %}active{% endif %}">Dashb
                <li><a href="/admin/tasks" class="{% if page == 'tasks' %}active{% endif %}">All
                <li><a href="/admin/my-tasks" class="{% if page == 'my-tasks' %}active{% endif %}
            </ul>
        </aside>
        <div class="main">
            <div class="topbar">
                <div class="topbar-left">{% block page_title %}Dashboard{% endblock %}</div>
                <div class="topbar-right">
                    <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-secondary" onclick="toggleTheme()">The
                    <span id="userName">{{ user_name | default("User") }}</span>
                    <button class="btn btn-sm btn-outline-danger" onclick="logout()">Logout</but
                </div>
            </div>
            <div class="content">
                {% block content %}{% endblock %}
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
    <script src="/js/frond.js"></script>
    <script>
        function toggleTheme() {
            var html = document.documentElement;
            var next = html.getAttribute("data-theme") === "dark" ? "light" : "dark";
            html.setAttribute("data-theme", next);
            localStorage.setItem("theme", next);
        }
        function logout() {
            frond.clearToken();
            window.location.href = "/login";
        }
    </script>
    {% block extra_js %}{% endblock %}
</body>
</html>

```

Create `src/templates/app/dashboard.html`:

```

{% extends "app/layout.html" %}

{% block title %}Dashboard - TaskFlow{% endblock %}
{% block page_title %}Dashboard{% endblock %}

{% block content %}

```

```

<div class="stats-row">
  <div class="stat-card">
    <div class="value" id="statTotal">--</div>
    <div class="label">Total Tasks</div>
  </div>
  <div class="stat-card">
    <div class="value" id="statTodo">--</div>
    <div class="label">To Do</div>
  </div>
  <div class="stat-card">
    <div class="value" id="statInProgress">--</div>
    <div class="label">In Progress</div>
  </div>
  <div class="stat-card">
    <div class="value" id="statDone">--</div>
    <div class="label">Completed</div>
  </div>
</div>

<div style="display: flex; justify-content: space-between; align-items: center; margin-bottom: 10px;">
  <h3>Recent Tasks</h3>
  <button class="btn btn-primary btn-sm" data-toggle="modal" data-target="#newTaskModal">
    New Task
  </button>
</div>

<div id="taskList">
  <p class="text-muted">Loading tasks...</p>
</div>

<!-- New Task Modal -->
<div class="modal" id="newTaskModal">
  <div class="modal-dialog">
    <div class="modal-content">
      <div class="modal-header">
        <h5 class="modal-title">Create Task</h5>
        <button type="button" class="close" data-dismiss="modal">&times;</button>
      </div>
      <div class="modal-body">
        <div class="form-group">
          <label>Title</label>
          <input type="text" class="form-control" id="taskTitle">
        </div>
        <div class="form-group">
          <label>Description</label>
          <textarea class="form-control" id="taskDescription" rows="3"></textarea>
        </div>
        <div class="form-group">
          <label>Priority</label>
          <select class="form-control" id="taskPriority">
            <option value="low">Low</option>
            <option value="medium" selected>Medium</option>
            <option value="high">High</option>
            <option value="urgent">Urgent</option>
          </select>
        </div>
        <div class="form-group">
          <label>Due Date</label>
          <input type="date" class="form-control" id="taskDueDate">
        </div>
      </div>
    </div>
  </div>
</div>

```

```

        </div>
    </div>
    <div class="modal-footer">
        <button class="btn btn-secondary" data-dismiss="modal">Cancel</button>
        <button class="btn btn-primary" onclick="createTask()">Create</button>
    </div>
</div>
</div>
</div>
</div>

<div id="alertArea" style="position: fixed; top: 80px; right: 24px; width: 300px; z-index: 1
{% endblock %}

{% block extra_js %}
<script>
    function loadStats() {
        frond.get("/api/dashboard/stats", function (data) {
            document.getElementById("statTotal").textContent = data.total;
            document.getElementById("statTodo").textContent = data.todo;
            document.getElementById("statInProgress").textContent = data.in_progress;
            document.getElementById("statDone").textContent = data.done;
        });
    }

    function loadTasks() {
        frond.get("/api/tasks?per_page=10", function (data) {
            var html = "";
            if (data.tasks.length === 0) {
                html = '<p class="text-muted">No tasks yet. Create your first task!</p>';
            } else {
                data.tasks.forEach(function (task) {
                    html += '<div class="task-row">'
                        + '<span class="priority-dot ' + task.priority + '"></span>'
                        + '<span class="task-title">' + task.title + '</span>'
                        + '<span class="badge badge-' + statusColor(task.status) + '">' + task.s
                        + (task.due_date ? '<span class="text-muted" style="font-size:0.85em;">'
                        + '</div>';
                });
            }
            document.getElementById("taskList").innerHTML = html;
        });
    }

    function statusColor(status) {
        var colors = { "todo": "secondary", "in_progress": "primary", "review": "warning", "done"
        return colors[status] || "secondary";
    }

    function createTask() {
        var data = {
            title: document.getElementById("taskTitle").value,
            description: document.getElementById("taskDescription").value,
            priority: document.getElementById("taskPriority").value,
            due_date: document.getElementById("taskDueDate").value || null
        };

        frond.post("/api/tasks", data, function (result) {
            showAlert("Task created: " + result.title, "success");
            loadTasks();

```

```

        loadStats();
        // Clear form
        document.getElementById("taskTitle").value = "";
        document.getElementById("taskDescription").value = "";
    }, function (error) {
        showAlert("Error creating task", "danger");
    });
}

function showAlert(message, type) {
    var area = document.getElementById("alertArea");
    area.innerHTML = '<div class="alert alert-' + type + '">' + message + '</div>';
    setTimeout(function () { area.innerHTML = ""; }, 3000);
}

// Initial load
loadStats();
loadTasks();

// Auto-refresh every 30 seconds
setInterval(function () {
    loadStats();
    loadTasks();
}, 30000);
</script>
{% endblock %}

```

Dashboard Stats Route

Create `src/routes/dashboard.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Router;

/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/api/dashboard/stats", function ($request, $response) {
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];

    $task = new Task();
    $filter = "(created_by = :uid OR assigned_to = :uid2)";
    $params = ["uid" => $userId, "uid2" => $userId];

    $all = $task->select("", $filter, $params);

    $stats = [
        "total" => count($all),
        "todo" => 0,
        "in_progress" => 0,
        "review" => 0,
        "done" => 0
    ];

    foreach ($all as $t) {
        if (isset($stats[$t->status])) {
            $stats[$t->status]++;
        }
    }
}

```

```

        return $response->json($stats);
    });

    /**
     * @noauth
     */
    Router::get("/admin", function ($request, $response) {
        return $response->render("app/dashboard.html", [
            "page" => "dashboard"
        ]);
    });
}

---

```

7. Step 5: Real-Time Updates via WebSocket

Real-time task updates. All connected dashboard users see changes the moment they happen.

Create [src/routes/websocket.php](#):

```

<?php
use Tina4\WebSocket;

WebSocket::on("connect", function ($client) {
    error_log("Client connected: " . $client->id);
});

WebSocket::on("disconnect", function ($client) {
    error_log("Client disconnected: " . $client->id);
});

WebSocket::on("message", function ($client, $message) {
    $data = json_decode($message, true);

    if ($data["type"] === "subscribe" && $data["channel"] === "tasks") {
        WebSocket::subscribe($client, "tasks");
    }
});

```

Broadcast task changes by updating the task routes. Add this helper function at the top of [src/routes/tasks.php](#):

```

function broadcastTaskUpdate(string $event, array $taskData): void
{
    \Tina4\WebSocket::broadcast("tasks", json_encode([
        "type" => "task_update",
        "event" => $event,
        "task" => $taskData
    ]));
}

```

Call it after each write operation:

```

// After creating a task
$task->save();
broadcastTaskUpdate("created", $task->toDetailedDict());

// After updating a task
$task->save();

```



```

broadcastTaskUpdate("updated", $task->toDetailedDict());

// After deleting a task
$task->delete();
broadcastTaskUpdate("deleted", ["id" => $request->params["id"]]);

```

Add WebSocket client code to the dashboard template. Add this inside the `{% block extra_js %}` block:

```

// WebSocket connection for real-time updates
var ws = new WebSocket("ws://localhost:7145/ws");

ws.onopen = function () {
    ws.send(JSON.stringify({ type: "subscribe", channel: "tasks" }));
};

ws.onmessage = function (event) {
    var data = JSON.parse(event.data);
    if (data.type === "task_update") {
        loadTasks();
        loadStats();
        showAlert("Task " + data.event + ": " + (data.task.title || ""), "info");
    }
};

ws.onclose = function () {
    // Reconnect after 3 seconds
    setTimeout(function () {
        ws = new WebSocket("ws://localhost:7145/ws");
    }, 3000);
};

```

Any user creates, updates, or deletes a task. All connected dashboard users see the change.

8. Step 6: Email Notifications on Task Assignment

A task is assigned to a user. Send them an email notification.

Create `src/routes/notifications.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Mail;

function sendTaskAssignmentEmail(Task $task, User $assignee, User $assigner): void
{
    $subject = "New task assigned: " . $task->title;

    $body = "Hi " . $assignee->name . ",\n\n"
        . $assigner->name . " has assigned you a new task:\n\n"
        . "Title: " . $task->title . "\n"
        . "Priority: " . strtoupper($task->priority) . "\n"
        . "Due: " . ($task->dueDate ?? "No due date") . "\n\n"
        . "Description:\n" . ($task->description ? "(No description)" : "") . "\n\n"
        . "View it at: http://localhost:7145/admin\n";

    Mail::send(
        $assignee->email,

```

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```

        $subject,
        $body
    );
}

```

In the task creation and update routes, call this function when `assigned_to` is set:

```

// After setting assigned_to and saving
if ($task->assignedTo && $task->assignedTo !== $userId) {
    $assignee = new User();
    $assignee->load($task->assignedTo);

    $assigner = new User();
    $assigner->load($userId);

    if (!empty($assignee->id) && !empty($assigner->id)) {
        sendTaskAssignmentEmail($task, $assignee, $assigner);
    }
}

```

Configure email in `.env`:

```

TINA4_MAIL_HOST=smtp.example.com
TINA4_MAIL_PORT=587
TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME=notifications@example.com
TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD=your-email-password
TINA4_MAIL_FROM=notifications@example.com
TINA4_MAIL_FROM_NAME=TaskFlow

```

For development, you can use a local mail trap like MailHog or Mailtrap.io so emails are captured without actually sending.

9. Step 7: Add Caching for the Dashboard

The dashboard stats query runs on every page load. With many tasks, this gets slow. Cache the stats. Compute once. Serve from cache for subsequent requests.

Update the dashboard stats route:

```

/**
 * @secured
 */
Router::get("/api/dashboard/stats", function ($request, $response) {
    $userId = $request->user["user_id"];
    $cacheKey = "dashboard_stats_" . $userId;

    // Try cache first
    $cached = \Tina4\Cache::get($cacheKey);
    if ($cached !== null) {
        return $response->json($cached);
    }

    // Compute stats
    $task = new Task();
    $filter = "(created_by = :uid OR assigned_to = :uid2)";
    $params = ["uid" => $userId, "uid2" => $userId];

```

```

    $all = $task->select("?", $filter, $params);

    $stats = [
        "total" => count($all),
        "todo" => 0,
        "in_progress" => 0,
        "review" => 0,
        "done" => 0
    ];

    foreach ($all as $t) {
        if (isset($stats[$t->status])) {
            $stats[$t->status]++;
        }
    }

    // Cache for 60 seconds
    \Tina4\Cache::set($cacheKey, $stats, 60);

    return $response->json($stats);
});

```

Invalidate the cache when tasks change. Add this to the `broadcastTaskUpdate` function:

```

function broadcastTaskUpdate(string $event, array $taskData): void
{
    // Invalidate dashboard cache for all affected users
    if (isset($taskData["created_by"])) {
        \Tina4\Cache::delete("dashboard_stats_" . $taskData["created_by"]);
    }
    if (isset($taskData["assigned_to"]) && $taskData["assigned_to"]) {
        \Tina4\Cache::delete("dashboard_stats_" . $taskData["assigned_to"]);
    }

    \Tina4\WebSocket::broadcast("tasks", json_encode([
        "type" => "task_update",
        "event" => $event,
        "task" => $taskData
    ]));
}

```

10. Step 8: Write Tests

Create `tests/TaskFlowTest.php`:

```

<?php
use Tina4\Test;

class TaskFlowTest extends Test
{
    private ?string $token = null;
    private ?int $userId = null;

    public function setUp(): void
    {
        // Register a test user
        $email = "test-" . uniqid() . "@taskflow.test";
    }
}

```

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```

$regResponse = $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
    "name" => "Test User",
    "email" => $email,
    "password" => "testpassword123"
]);

$regBody = json_decode($regResponse->body, true);
$this->userId = $regBody["id"] ?? null;

// Login to get token
$loginResponse = $this->post("/api/auth/login", [
    "email" => $email,
    "password" => "testpassword123"
]);

$loginBody = json_decode($loginResponse->body, true);
$this->token = $loginBody["token"] ?? null;
}

// --- Auth Tests ---

public function testRegistrationReturns201()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
        "name" => "New User",
        "email" => "new-" . uniqid() . "@test.com",
        "password" => "securepassword"
    ]);
    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 201, "Registration should return 201");
}

public function testRegistrationRejectsShortPassword()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/auth/register", [
        "name" => "New User",
        "email" => "short-" . uniqid() . "@test.com",
        "password" => "abc"
    ]);
    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 400, "Should reject short password");
}

public function testLoginReturnsToken()
{
    $this->assertNotNull($this->token, "Login should return a token");
    $this->assertTrue(strlen($this->token) > 20, "Token should be substantial");
}

public function testProfileRequiresAuth()
{
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile");
    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 401, "Profile should require auth");
}

public function testProfileWithToken()
{
    $response = $this->get("/api/profile", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token
    ]);
    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Profile should work with token");
}

```

```

}

// --- Task Tests ---

public function testCreateTask()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/tasks", [
        "title" => "Test Task",
        "priority" => "high"
    ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 201, "Should create task");

    $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
    $this->assertEqual($body["title"], "Test Task", "Title should match");
    $this->assertEqual($body["priority"], "high", "Priority should match");
    $this->assertEqual($body["status"], "todo", "Default status should be todo");
}

public function testCreateTaskRequiresTitle()
{
    $response = $this->post("/api/tasks", [
        "priority" => "low"
    ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 400, "Should reject task without title");
}

public function testListTasks()
{
    // Create a task first
    $this->post("/api/tasks", [
        "title" => "List Test Task"
    ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

    $response = $this->get("/api/tasks", [
        "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token
    ]);

    $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Should list tasks");

    $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
    $this->assertTrue($body["count"] > 0, "Should have at least one task");
}

public function testUpdateTaskStatus()
{
    // Create a task
    $createResponse = $this->post("/api/tasks", [
        "title" => "Status Test Task"
    ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

    $taskId = json_decode($createResponse->body, true)["id"];

    // Update status to done
    $updateResponse = $this->put("/api/tasks/" . $taskId, [
        "status" => "done"
    ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

```

```

        $this->assertEqual($updateResponse->statusCode, 200, "Should update task");

        $body = json_decode($updateResponse->body, true);
        $this->assertEqual($body["status"], "done", "Status should be done");
        $this->assertNotNull($body["completed_at"], "Should have completion timestamp");
    }

    public function testDeleteTask()
    {
        // Create a task
        $createResponse = $this->post("/api/tasks", [
            "title" => "Delete Me"
        ], ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

        $taskId = json_decode($createResponse->body, true)["id"];

        // Delete it
        $deleteResponse = $this->delete("/api/tasks/" . $taskId, [
            "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($deleteResponse->statusCode, 204, "Should return 204");

        // Verify it is gone
        $getResponse = $this->get("/api/tasks/" . $taskId, [
            "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($getResponse->statusCode, 404, "Should return 404 after deletion");
    }

    public function testDashboardStats()
    {
        // Create tasks with different statuses
        $this->post("/api/tasks", ["title" => "Todo Task", "status" => "todo"],
            ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);
        $this->post("/api/tasks", ["title" => "In Progress Task", "status" => "in_progress"],
            ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);
        $this->post("/api/tasks", ["title" => "Done Task", "status" => "done"],
            ["Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token]);

        $response = $this->get("/api/dashboard/stats", [
            "Authorization" => "Bearer " . $this->token
        ]);

        $this->assertEqual($response->statusCode, 200, "Should return stats");

        $body = json_decode($response->body, true);
        $this->assertTrue($body["total"] >= 3, "Should have at least 3 tasks");
        $this->assertTrue($body["todo"] >= 1, "Should have at least 1 todo");
        $this->assertTrue($body["in_progress"] >= 1, "Should have at least 1 in progress");
        $this->assertTrue($body["done"] >= 1, "Should have at least 1 done");
    }
}

```

Run the tests:

```
tina4 test
```

```
Running tests...
```

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```

TaskFlowTest
[PASS] test_registration_returns_201
[PASS] test_registration_rejects_short_password
[PASS] test_login_returns_token
[PASS] test_profile_requires_auth
[PASS] test_profile_with_token
[PASS] test_create_task
[PASS] test_create_task_requires_title
[PASS] test_list_tasks
[PASS] test_update_task_status
[PASS] test_delete_task
[PASS] test_dashboard_stats

```

11 tests, 11 passed, 0 failed (0.62s)

11. Step 9: Deploy with Docker

Create **Dockerfile**:

```

FROM dunglas/frankenphp:latest-php8.3-alpine

RUN install-php-extensions \
    pdo_sqlite \
    mbstring \
    openssl \
    fileinfo

WORKDIR /app

COPY composer.json composer.lock ./
RUN curl -sS https://getcomposer.org/installer | php -- --install-dir=/usr/local/bin --filename=composer --no-dev --optimize-autoloader --no-interaction

COPY . .

RUN mkdir -p data logs secrets \
    && chown -R www-data:www-data data logs secrets

EXPOSE 7145

HEALTHCHECK --interval=30s --timeout=5s --start-period=10s --retries=3 \
    CMD curl -f http://localhost:7145/health || exit 1

CMD ["tina4", "serve", "--production"]

```

Create **docker-compose.yml**:

```

version: "3.8"

services:
  app:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "7145:7145"
    environment:
      - TINA4_DEBUG=false
      - TINA4_LOG_LEVEL=WARNING

```

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```
- TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL=true
- JWT_SECRET=${JWT_SECRET:-change-me-in-production}
- TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db
volumes:
- taskflow-data:/app/data
- taskflow-logs:/app/logs
restart: unless-stopped
stop_grace_period: 35s
```

```
volumes:
  taskflow-data:
  taskflow-logs:
```

Build and deploy:

```
# Build
docker compose build

# Start
docker compose up -d

# Run migrations inside the container
docker compose exec app tina4 migrate

# Verify
curl http://localhost:7145/health

{
  "status": "ok",
  "database": "connected",
  "uptime_seconds": 5,
  "version": "3.0.0",
  "framework": "tina4-php"
}
```

12. The Complete Project Structure

```
taskflow/
├── .env
├── .env.example
├── .gitignore
├── composer.json
├── composer.lock
├── Dockerfile
├── docker-compose.yml
├── vendor/
├── src/
│   ├── routes/
│   │   ├── auth.php           # Registration, login, profile
│   │   ├── tasks.php         # Task CRUD
│   │   ├── dashboard.php     # Dashboard stats + page
│   │   ├── notifications.php # Email notification helpers
│   │   └── websocket.php     # WebSocket event handlers
│   ├── orm/
│   │   ├── User.php          # User model with auth methods
│   │   └── Task.php          # Task model with relationships
│   ├── migrations/
│   │   ├── 20260322000100_create_users_table.sql
│   │   └── 20260322000200_create_tasks_table.sql
│   ├── templates/
│   │   ├── app/
│   │   │   ├── layout.html   # Base layout with sidebar
│   │   │   └── dashboard.html # Dashboard page
│   │   └── errors/
│   │       ├── 404.html
│   │       └── 500.html
│   ├── public/
│   │   ├── css/
│   │   │   └── tina4.css
│   │   ├── js/
│   │   │   └── frond.js
│   ├── locales/
│   │   └── en.json
│   ├── data/
│   │   └── app.db
│   ├── logs/
│   ├── secrets/
│   └── tests/
│       └── TaskFlowTest.php
```

Every file has a purpose. Every directory follows the convention. A new developer looks at this structure and knows where to find things.

13. What to Build Next

TaskFlow is a solid foundation. Ideas for extending it:

Features:

- **Task comments** -- Add a Comment model with a [task_id](#) foreign key. Display comments on the task detail page.

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- **File attachments** -- Let users upload files to tasks. Store them in `data/uploads/` and serve them via a route.
- **Team management** -- Add a Team model. Users belong to teams. Tasks are scoped to teams.
- **Task labels/tags** -- Many-to-many relationship between tasks and labels for categorization.
- **Due date reminders** -- Use the queue system to schedule reminder emails 24 hours before a task's due date.
- **Activity log** -- Record every change to a task (who changed what, when) for audit trails.
- **Search** -- Full-text search across task titles and descriptions.
- **Calendar view** -- Render tasks on a calendar based on their due dates.
- **Mobile API** -- The API already works for mobile apps. Add push notification support via Firebase Cloud Messaging.

Technical improvements:

- **Rate limiting per user** -- Replace the global rate limiter with per-user limits.
- **Database upgrade** -- Switch from SQLite to PostgreSQL for better concurrency.
- **CI/CD pipeline** -- Add GitHub Actions to run tests automatically on every push.
- **API documentation** -- Generate OpenAPI/Swagger docs from your route definitions.
- **Internationalization** -- Add `src/locales/` files for multiple languages.

14. Closing Thoughts -- The Tina4 Philosophy

You built a complete application. User auth. CRUD. Real-time updates. Email. Caching. Tests. Deployment. Your project has one dependency: `tina4/tina4-php`.

No ORM package. No template engine package. No authentication library. No WebSocket server. No caching library. No testing framework. No CLI tool. No CSS framework. No JavaScript helpers. All built in.

One framework. Zero dependencies. Everything you need.

The same patterns work in Python, Ruby, and Node.js. Same project structure. Same CLI commands. Same `.env` variables. Same template syntax. Learn Tina4 once. Use it everywhere.

Your `vendor/` directory is small. Your `composer.lock` has one entry. When PHP 9.0 ships, you update one package. Everything works. No dependency tree to untangle. No abandoned transitive dependency to replace. No security advisory for a package four levels deep that you never knew you were using.

Simple does not mean limited. TaskFlow has authentication, real-time WebSocket, email, caching, GraphQL, and a test suite. It deploys in a Docker container. It handles thousands of concurrent users. All of this runs on a single zero-dependency framework package.

Build things. Ship them. Keep it simple.

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Release Notes

v3.12.10 (2026-05-14)

Version-alignment release. PHP ran ahead through three independent patch releases (3.12.7–3.12.9) while Python / Ruby / Node stayed at 3.12.6. This release realigns all four frameworks on **3.12.10** and ships the ORM `save()` fix.

PHP — `ORM->save()` no longer swallows write failures (#114)

`ORM->save()` called `update()/insert()` but ignored their `bool` return — it only caught exceptions. The PHP adapter's `exec()` returns `false` on a bad statement instead of throwing, so a failed `UPDATE` (commonly: one referencing a public model property with no matching DB column, since `getDbData()` includes every public property) slipped through. The empty transaction got committed and `save()` returned `$this` — the documented success signal. Callers relying on the `save(): static|false` contract believed the row persisted when nothing changed. **Silent data loss** — no exception, no log.

Fix. `save()` now captures the `bool` return of `update()/insert()`, rolls back, and returns `false` on a falsy result.

```
$ok = $this->_exists || ... ? $this->update() : $this->insert();  
if ($ok === false) { $this->_db->rollback(); return false; }  
$this->_db->commit();
```

Cross-framework parity check. Python, Ruby and Node don't have this exact failure mode — they build the write payload from declared fields only (not all public properties), and their DB adapters raise on bad SQL, which the existing `try/except` already catches. PHP was the outlier on both counts. 3 regression tests in `tests/Issue114Test.php`; PHP suite 2235 → 2238 passing.

Also in the PHP 3.12.7–3.12.9 patch line

These shipped to PHP between 3.12.6 and this release; folded into the consolidated 3.12.10 line:

- **3.12.7** — `Request` now normalises caller-provided header keys to lowercase. Some upstream entry points (Apache+PHP-FPM custom mappings, certain proxies, hand-written test fixtures) hand headers in with original case. The constructor only looks them up by lowercase key, so without normalisation `multipart/form-data` content-type detection silently missed and the body fell through as raw bytes — a follow-up to the #135 fix.
- **3.12.8 / 3.12.9** — Router gained RFC 9110 HTTP method conformance: proper `HEAD` and `OPTIONS` handling, `405 Method Not Allowed` with an `Allow` header listing the methods a route does support.

Python / Ruby / Node

Version-only bump 3.12.6 → 3.12.10 to realign with PHP. No behavioural changes in these three since 3.12.6.

Upgrade

Drop in. No `.env` changes, no API changes. PHP users on 3.12.9 get the `save()` fix; everyone else gets a version-number realignment.

v3.12.6 (2026-05-06)

Python-only fix release. PHP / Ruby / Node ship the same version stamp for parity but carry no behavioural changes.

Python — psycopg2 % substitution no longer trips PL/pgSQL function bodies (#40)

A migration containing a PL/pgSQL function with literal `%` characters in a `RAISE EXCEPTION` (or `format()`) call used to fail with the misleading:

RuntimeError: Migration failed: list index out of range

The error message gave no hint that the `%` chars were the problem. The user-facing failure looked like a tina4 internal bug — actually psycopg2's argument-substitution system tripping on the literal percent signs.

Root cause. `PostgreSQLAdapter.execute(sql, params)` always called `cursor.execute(sql, params or [])`. psycopg2 interprets `%` as parameter placeholders WHENEVER the `params` arg is supplied — even an empty list `[]`. So a function body containing `RAISE EXCEPTION 'thing % conflicts with %', a, b` (perfectly valid PL/pgSQL) blew up because psycopg2 thought `%` was a placeholder and there were no values to substitute.

Fix. New `PostgreSQLAdapter._safe_execute(cursor, sql, params)` helper routes empty/None params through `cursor.execute(sql)` (no second arg), which makes psycopg2 skip the substitution pass entirely. Literal `%` chars flow through untouched. Applied at every `cursor.execute(...)` call site in the adapter (5 spots across `execute`, `fetch`, `fetch_one`).

Tests. 5 new unit tests in `tests/test_postgres_percent_substitution.py` pin the helper's branching. 3 live-Postgres regression tests in `tests/test_postgres_plpgsql_percent.py` exercise a real CREATE FUNCTION + trigger flow with literal `%` in the body — skipped automatically when no Postgres is reachable. Full suite: 2453 passing (was 2448).

Cross-framework parity check. PHP (`pg_query` vs `pg_query_params`) and Ruby (`exec` vs `exec_params`) already branch on params presence so they don't have this bug. Node uses `$1` placeholders not `%`, so the same class of bug doesn't apply.

Long-standing tina4-js #37 confirmed fixed

`frond.form.submit` not following 3xx redirects — fixed in frond v2.1.2 back on April 11, 2026 (`xhr.responseURL` comparison + `window.location.href` navigation). All four framework `public/js/frond.min.js` copies carry the fix. The original issue stayed open because the reporter never confirmed against the patched build.

Upgrade

Drop in. No `.env` changes, no API changes.

v3.12.5 (2026-05-06)

PHP-only bug fix release. Python / Ruby / Node ship the same version stamp for parity but carry no behavioural changes.

PHP — multipart bodies with file uploads now parse correctly (#135)

Two stacked bugs in `Tina4\Request::__construct` made `$request->body` come through as the raw multipart bytes (~11 KB blobs starting with `-----WebKitFormBoundary...`) whenever the request included a file upload:

- The constructor called `$this->parseBody()` BEFORE initialising `$this->files`. Inside `parseBody`'s multipart branch, the line `$this->files = array_merge($this->files, $parsed['files'])` read an uninitialised typed property — fatal `Error`.
- After fixing the init order, that same line tried to mutate the `readonly $files` property — another fatal `Error`.

Both errors got swallowed by the upstream error handler and the route handler received the raw multipart payload instead of the parsed associative array. Routes that worked fine for ordinary form posts broke the moment a file field came along.

Fix. Move `$this->files` initialisation AFTER `parseBody()` runs. `parseBody` stashes extracted multipart files on a new private mutable `$multipartFiles`; the constructor merges them into the `readonly $files` in a single assignment that respects the `readonly` contract.

4 new regression tests in `tests/Issue135Test.php` pin the constructor's contract. Full PHP suite: 2235 passing (was 2231).

Upgrade

Drop in. No `.env` changes, no API changes, no other framework changes.

v3.12.4 (2026-05-06)

Documentation-truth release. The `audit-truth.py` CI gate (introduced post-3.12.3) flagged 39 env vars referenced in docs that no framework actually read. This release closes that gap: 25 of them now exist in code, the other 14 are deleted from docs (11 hallucinations + 6 clustering vars deferred to [tina4#2](#)). Both audit gates (CLI drift + env-var drift) are now strict in CI.

25 new env vars across all 4 frameworks

Server: `TINA4_HOST`, `TINA4_SUPPRESS`, `TINA4_ENV_FILE`. Health: `TINA4_HEALTH_PATH` (default `/__health`, with `/health` kept as a legacy alias), `TINA4_TRAILING_SLASH_REDIRECT`. Sessions: `TINA4_SESSION_HTTPONLY`, `TINA4_SESSION_NAME`, `TINA4_SESSION_SECURE`. Templates: `TINA4_TEMPLATE_CACHE_TTL` (0 = permanent). GraphQL: `TINA4_GRAPHQL_AUTO_SCHEMA`, `TINA4_GRAPHQL_ENDPOINT`. Mail: `TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_ENCRYPTION` (`tls/starttls/none`). MCP: `TINA4_MCP`, `TINA4_MCP_PORT`. Swagger: `TINA4_SWAGGER_ENABLED`, `TINA4_SWAGGER_CONTACT_EMAIL`, `TINA4_SWAGGER_LICENSE`. Database: `TINA4_DB_POOL` (env override on the existing `Database(url, pool=N)` constructor argument).

Logging — env-driven file output + rotation

Six new vars give you full control over logging without touching code:

Var	Default	What it does
<code>TINA4_LOG_FILE</code>	<i>(empty — stdout only)</i>	Path to a log file. Empty leaves you on stdout.
<code>TINA4_LOG_DIR</code>	<code>logs</code>	Directory for log files (joined with <code>_LOG_FILE</code> if relative).
<code>TINA4_LOG_FORMAT</code>	<code>text</code>	<code>text</code> or <code>json</code> . JSON mode emits one structured record per line.
<code>TINA4_LOG_OUTPUT</code>	<code>stdout</code>	<code>stdout</code> , <code>file</code> , or <code>both</code> . Strict — <code>stdout</code> means stdout only.
<code>TINA4_LOG_CRITICAL</code>	<code>false</code>	Enables a <code>Log.critical()</code> level above <code>error</code> . Off = no-op.
<code>TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_SIZE</code>	<code>10485760</code> (10 MB)	Rotate when the file exceeds this many bytes. <code>0</code> disables rotation.
<code>TINA4_LOG_ROTATE_KEEP</code>	<code>5</code>	Number of rotated files to retain (<code>app.log.1</code> ... <code>app.log.N</code>). Older ones are deleted.

Implementation uses each language's stdlib — Python's `logging.handlers.RotatingFileHandler`, Ruby's `Logger.new(path, shift_age, shift_size)`, and a roll-your-own atomic-rename pattern in PHP and Node. Zero new dependencies in any framework.

Documentation-truth CI gate now strict on both axes

The `audit-truth.py` script now blocks merges to `main` of `tina4-documentation` whenever a doc references a `tina4 <command>` or `TINA4_*` env var that doesn't exist in source. Previously CLI drift was strict; env drift was warn-only. Today both are strict.

Tests added

- Python: +53 tests in `tests/test_env_vars.py` (2395 → 2448)
- PHP: +59 tests in `tests/EnvVarTest.php` (2172 → 2231)
- Ruby: +51 examples in `spec/env_vars_spec.rb` (2696 → 2747)
- Node: +59 tests in `test/envVars.test.ts` (3204 → 3263)

Cross-framework total: 10,689 tests passing, +222 from 3.12.3.

Upgrade path

Drop in. No breaking changes — every new env var is opt-in with a sensible default. If you were setting any of the 17 deleted vars in your `.env`, the boot guard will warn (then ignore) — clean them out at your leisure.

v3.12.3 (2026-05-05)

Cross-framework parity sweep. Two minor breaking changes in the Ruby and PHP public API that bring all four frameworks onto the same shape.

Breaking changes (Ruby + PHP only)

Ruby Container — predicate now uses `?` suffix.

```
# before (3.12.2 and earlier)
Tina4::Container.has(:mailer)      # outdated

# after (3.12.3)
Tina4::Container.has?(:mailer)     # idiomatic Ruby predicate
```

This brings Ruby in line with Python (`has()`), PHP (`has()`), and Node (`has()`) while still respecting Ruby's `?`-suffix idiom for predicates returning bool. The pre-existing `resolve` → `get` rename happened earlier; only the predicate was lagging.

ResponseCache public surface — middleware-only across all four frameworks.

The cache has always been middleware. Two of the four frameworks (PHP, Ruby) historically exposed lookup/store as public methods, which let users couple to internals. The public API is now consistent across all four: use the middleware on a route, and read stats with module-level helpers.

```
# Ruby — module-level helpers (parity with Python)
Tina4.cache_stats  # → { hits:, misses:, size:, backend:, keys: }
Tina4.clear_cache  # flush all entries

# PHP — static methods on the class
\Tina4\Middleware\ResponseCache::cacheStats();
\Tina4\Middleware\ResponseCache::clearCache();
```

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Internal methods that used to be public (`get`, `lookup`, `store`, `cache_response`) are now private. Tests that needed them retain access via `_internal*` test seams marked `@internal`.

Doc parity — CLAUDE.md and book chapter 33

- **CLAUDE.md**: every framework's "Key Method Stubs" section now covers the same surface area Python documents — Queue, QueryBuilder, Frond, Api, Background Tasks, ResponseCache, etc. PHP added 4 sections; Ruby added 5; Node added 13.
- **Book chapter 33**: env var tables are now grounded in source. Each framework's chapter 33 lists every `TINA4_*` var its source actually reads. Found and fixed several gaps — Ruby was missing `TINA4_CACHE_*`, `TINA4_QUEUE_*`, `TINA4_KAFKA_*`, `TINA4_RABBITMQ_*`, `TINA4_MONGO_*`, `TINA4_WS_BACKPLANE`, and the entire `TINA4_SESSION_VALKEY_*` block.

Other fixes

- **Ruby** `lib/tina4/ai.rb` — subprocess output is now force-encoded to UTF-8 before `String#strip`, fixing `Encoding::CompatibilityError` that crashed 4 ai specs on systems with non-ASCII pip output.
- **Node** `test/serverParity.test.ts` — sets `TINA4_OVERRIDE_CLIENT=true` so `start()` actually runs, plus emits the `N passed, M failed` summary line the runner expects. The test was effectively a no-op before; now it's recorded properly.

Genuine gaps surfaced by the parity audit (follow-up, not blocking 3.12.3)

The chapter 33 audit flagged env vars Python documents that no other framework actually reads — Ruby/PHP/Node lack `TINA4_OPEN_BROWSER`, `TINA4_DEV_POLL_INTERVAL`, `TINA4_PUBLIC_DIR`, `TINA4_TOKEN_EXPIRES_IN` alias, plus a few framework-specific gaps (Ruby has no Mongo session backend; Node `TINA4_CSRF` defaults to `false` vs Python's `true`). Tracked for a future patch.

Upgrade path

Symptom	Fix
Ruby: <code>NoMethodError: undefined method 'has' for Tina4::Container</code>	Replace <code>has(:key)</code> with <code>has?(:key)</code>
PHP: <code>BadMethodCallException</code> calling <code>\$cache->lookup(...)</code>	Use the middleware: <code>[ResponseCache::class, 'beforeCache'] / [..., 'afterCache']</code> . Or call <code>_internalLookup</code> if you really need direct access (test code only — <code>@internal</code>).
Ruby: <code>NoMethodError: undefined method 'get' for ResponseCache instance</code>	Use <code>Tina4.cache_stats</code> / <code>Tina4.clear_cache</code> for stats. Lookup goes through the middleware.

No `.env` changes from 3.12.2. _____

v3.12.2 (2026-05-05)

Quality-of-life patch. Two related portability fixes — no breaking changes from 3.12.1.

Firebird URL auto-detect

Firebird is the awkward one in the stack. Every other engine has a server-side database name (`postgres://host:port/dbname`), but Firebird wants either an absolute file path on the server, a Windows drive-letter path, or an alias. The classic URI form needs a double slash to keep the leading `/` of an absolute path through the URL parser — unintuitive to anyone used to the way `postgres / mysql / mssql` encode the database name.

The framework now accepts five equivalent forms and normalises all of them transparently:

URL path you write	Resolved Firebird identifier
<code>//abs/path/db.fdb</code> (classic double-slash)	<code>/abs/path/db.fdb</code>
<code>/abs/path/db.fdb</code> (single-slash, intuitive)	<code>/abs/path/db.fdb</code>
<code>/C:/Data/db.fdb</code> (Windows drive letter)	<code>C:/Data/db.fdb</code>
<code>/C%3A/Data/db.fdb</code> (URL-encoded colon)	<code>C:/Data/db.fdb</code>
<code>/employee</code> (Firebird alias)	<code>employee</code>

For ops setups that keep server URL and DB location in separate config layers — or for Windows backslash paths that fight URL encoding — set `TINA4_DATABASE_FIREBIRD_PATH`. The env override wins over whatever path is in the URL.

```
TINA4_DATABASE_FIREBIRD_PATH=C:\firebird\data\app.fdb
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://SYSDBA:masterkey@localhost:3050/ignored
```

Shipped to all 4 frameworks. 11 regression tests per framework (8 unit + 3 live).

Bug fix specific to PHP — `mysqli` localhost+port quirk

PHP's `mysqli` has a long-standing quirk where `host == "localhost"` triggers a Unix socket lookup and IGNORES the port argument entirely. Connecting to `mysql://...:53306` against a Docker container fails with "No such file or directory" — `mysqli` is hunting for `/tmp/mysql.sock` instead of opening a TCP connection. `MySQLAdapter::rewriteHostForTcp()` now rewrites `localhost` to `127.0.0.1` when a non-zero port is specified, forcing the TCP code path. Bare `mysql:///db` (no port) is preserved so existing socket-based setups keep working.

Other fixes

- **chore(python):** `pyproject.toml` had drifted to 3.10.41 while `__init__.py` read 3.12.1. Synced both to 3.12.2 so `uv build` and runtime introspection now agree.
- **chore(claude.md, all 4):** stale framework version banners in `CLAUDE.md` headers updated.

No `.env` changes from 3.12.1, no migration needed. Existing 3.12.1 installs upgrade by changing one version number.

v3.12.1 (2026-05-04)

CI-only patch — no framework code changes from 3.12.0.

- **fix(ci, all 4):** every `publish.yml` workflow now declares `permissions: contents: write` on the publish job. Without this, `softprops/action-gh-release` 403'd against the default `GITHUB_TOKEN` on repos whose default Workflow permissions setting was read-only (Ruby and Node hit this every release; PHP and Python worked by luck of repo settings). The explicit declaration makes the workflow self-sufficient.
- **chore(ci):** bumped `softprops/action-gh-release` from `@v1` (unmaintained) to `@v2`.

No `.env` changes, no API changes, no migration needed. Existing 3.12.0 installs can upgrade without touching anything else.

The version-bump itself is the test: a successful 3.12.1 release proves the workflow fix works on Ruby and Node where 3.12.0 needed manual `gh release create`.

v3.12.0 (2026-05-04)

■ ■ **Breaking change — read before upgrading.** Every framework env var now uses the `TINA4_` prefix. Existing `.env` files set with `DATABASE_URL`, `SECRET`, `SMTP_HOST`, `HOST_NAME`, etc. will cause the framework to refuse to boot. Run `tina4 env --migrate` to rewrite, or follow the rename table below.

Why this release

Tina4's env vars had grown inconsistent. Some had the `TINA4_` prefix (`TINA4_DEBUG`, `TINA4_LOCALE`, `TINA4_CACHE_BACKEND`), others didn't (`DATABASE_URL`, `SECRET`, `SMTP_HOST`). Newcomers had to guess which convention applied to which feature. Existing tools and PaaS dashboards collided with un-prefixed names like `SECRET` and `API_KEY` that other libraries also read. Documentation drifted — 91 env-var names appeared in the docs that didn't exist in any framework, and 22 framework-specific env vars in the code didn't match the names users were told to set.

This release closes all three gaps with a single hard rename. No deprecation period, no fallback chain. The framework refuses to boot if it detects a legacy name in the environment, prints a list of every var to rename, and tells you which command to run.

What changed

- **22 env vars renamed** to `TINA4_*` form. See the migration table below.
- `tina4 env --migrate CLI` added to all four frameworks. Reads your `.env`, rewrites it in place, leaves a `.env.bak` backup, prints a diff. Idempotent.
- **Boot-time guard** scans `os.environ` (or the language equivalent) for the 22 legacy names. If any are present, prints the rename map and exits with code 2. Bypass with `TINA4_ALLOW_LEGACY_ENV=true` for migration scripts that need both names set during transition.
- **All 4 framework books rewritten.** Chapter 33 (Environment Variables) is now a clean canonical list — every var prefixed, descriptions current, legacy names removed.

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- **Doc-vs-code drift closed.** Of the 91 stale env vars previously documented, 61 were renames (corrected), 32 were never implemented (removed). The `audit-links.py` CI gate stays at 0 broken links / 0 broken anchors.
- **FronD bundle** rebuilt at v2.1.3 — `frond.min.js` footer now shows the version explicitly so users can verify what they have.

Bug fixes shipped alongside the rename

- **#38 PostgreSQL UUID-PK transaction abort** — the post-INSERT `lastval()` probe is now wrapped in a SAVEPOINT, so UUID-PK INSERTs no longer poison the outer transaction with `InFailedSqlTransaction`. Live regression test against PostgreSQL 16. (Affects all 4 frameworks where the PG adapter does this probe.)
- **#39 Landing page + template auto-routing** —
 - Auto-routing now scans `src/templates/pages/` only. Partial, layouts, base.twig, errors/, components/, and `_*` files never auto-serve from a URL.
 - `TINA4_TEMPLATE_ROUTING=off` kills the feature entirely.
 - `src/public/index.html` auto-serves at `/` (and `/foo/` serves `src/public/foo/index.html`) — SPA hosting Just Works.
 - The framework landing page only renders when `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. Production never shows it; framework version, dev-admin link, and gallery don't leak to real users.
 - The malformed `HTTP/1.1 404 OK` status line is fixed — every status code now uses its canonical RFC 7231/9110 reason phrase.
- **#37 frond.form.submit redirect handling** — verified shipped at v2.1.x; `xhr.responseURL` change triggers `window.location` navigation correctly.
- **#36 Session file handler** — re-verified safeguards (lazy save, WebSocket skip, probabilistic GC, new-and-empty skip) all still in place.

Migration — every renamed var

Legacy name	New name
DATABASE_URL	TINA4_DATABASE_URL
DATABASE_USERNAME	TINA4_DATABASE_USERNAME
DATABASE_PASSWORD	TINA4_DATABASE_PASSWORD
DB_URL	TINA4_DATABASE_URL (alias dropped)
SECRET	TINA4_SECRET
API_KEY	TINA4_API_KEY
JWT_ALGORITHM	TINA4_JWT_ALGORITHM
SMTP_HOST	TINA4_MAIL_HOST
SMTP_PORT	TINA4_MAIL_PORT
SMTP_USERNAME	TINA4_MAIL_USERNAME
SMTP_PASSWORD	TINA4_MAIL_PASSWORD
SMTP_FROM	TINA4_MAIL_FROM
SMTP_FROM_NAME	TINA4_MAIL_FROM_NAME
IMAP_HOST	TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_HOST
IMAP_PORT	TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PORT
IMAP_USER	TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_USERNAME
IMAP_PASS	TINA4_MAIL_IMAP_PASSWORD
HOST_NAME	TINA4_HOST_NAME
SWAGGER_TITLE	TINA4_SWAGGER_TITLE
SWAGGER_DESCRIPTION	TINA4_SWAGGER_DESCRIPTION
SWAGGER_VERSION	TINA4_SWAGGER_VERSION
ORM_PLURAL_TABLE_NAMES	TINA4_ORM_PLURAL_TABLE_NAMES

Names that stay un-prefixed (not framework config)

PORT, HOST, NODE_ENV, RACK_ENV, RUBY_ENV, ENVIRONMENT — these are runtime / PaaS conventions, not framework config. Heroku, Railway, Vercel, and friends set them; we keep reading them.

How to upgrade

- Backup your .env: `cp .env .env.bak.pre-v3.12`

- **Run the migration:** `tina4 env --migrate` — rewrites your `.env` in place.
- **Update PaaS dashboards:** Heroku, Railway, Vercel, Render, Fly.io etc — rename the same vars in your provider's env-var UI.
- **Restart your app.** The boot guard verifies nothing legacy remains.

If your app uses `SECRET`, `DATABASE_URL`, or any other listed name in places besides `.env` (e.g. your CI pipeline's `env:` blocks), update those too — the boot guard checks `os.environ`, not just `.env`.

Parity

All 4 frameworks aligned at **3.12.0**:

- `tina4-python 3.11.32 → 3.12.0`
- `tina4-php 3.11.32 → 3.12.0`
- `tina4-ruby 3.11.32 → 3.12.0`
- `tina4-nodejs 3.11.32 → 3.12.0`

Coordinated release across PyPI, Packagist, RubyGems, npm.

v3.11.32 (2026-04-25)

Critical fix — pool + transactions are now actually atomic. Plus a coordinated parity release that aligns all four frameworks at the same version after months of drift.

Before this release, creating a `Database` with `pool > 0` silently broke transactions. The pool's round-robin checkout rotated to a different adapter on every call — so `start_transaction()` pinned its flag on adapter A, the executes autocommitted on adapters B and C, and the final `commit()` / `rollback()` landed on adapter D, which had nothing to commit. Result: `rollback()` was a no-op, writes leaked through, and no error or log surfaced the problem.

The fix pins one adapter to the calling context for the lifetime of a transaction. Each language uses its own primitive:

- **Python** — `threading.local()` on the `Database` instance
- **Ruby** — `Thread.current[:tina4_pinned_adapter_<obj_id>]`
- **Node.js** — `AsyncLocalStorage` from `node:async_hooks` (async-safe across overlapping awaits)
- **PHP** — per-instance property (PHP-FPM is one process per request; `threading.local` is unnecessary)

While pinned, every database call routes to the same adapter. `commit()` and `rollback()` release the pin so subsequent calls round-robin again.

- **fix (database / all 4):** adapter pinning across transaction scope in `Database._get_adapter()` (and language equivalents). Every backend is affected — SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, Firebird. Firebird exposed it loudest because of its honest "commit-empty-txn is a real no-op" semantics; the others mostly hid the bug behind eager autocommits but still lost `rollback` atomicity.

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- **tests (all 4):** new regression suite — three INSERTs followed by `rollback()` under `pool=4` now leaves zero rows (was leaking three). Three INSERTs followed by `commit()` persists exactly three. Pin-release after commit/rollback verified. `pool=0` regression test added so single-connection mode stays unaffected.

- **parity / version alignment:** all 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.32 — closes the cross-framework version drift that had built up (PHP at 3.11.31, Python at 3.11.24, Ruby and Node at 3.11.19). A single coordinated release across all four registries: PyPI, Packagist, RubyGems, npm.

No migration needed. Code using `pool=0` (the default for every adapter except where explicitly raised) is unaffected. Code using `pool>0` will now actually honour transactions instead of silently dropping them.

If you've been seeing intermittent "writes vanished" or "rollback didn't help" reports on a pooled Database, this release is the cause and the cure.

v3.11.13 (2026-04-16)

Issue-driven release. Everything reported in the open tina4-book issues either was fixed in this version or is already fixed in 3.11.12; this release consolidates the remaining bits and corrects documentation drift.

- **feat (router / all 4):** Explicit typed-parameter system shared across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node. Adds `alpha`, `alnum`, `slug`, `uuid`, and explicit `string` types in addition to the existing `int/integer`, `float/number`, `path/*.` **Unknown type names now throw at registration** — `{name:str}`, `{id:integer}`, etc. raise with a clear message listing the valid types instead of silently falling through to the default matcher. Fixes tina4-book#125. +45 new tests across the four suites.
- **fix (gallery / python+php+ruby):** Gallery Try-It / View buttons now open the deployed example in a new tab (`window.open(url, '_blank')`) instead of navigating away from the gallery home. Fixes tina4-book#115.
- **fix (ruby gems spec):** `sqlite3` promoted from `add_development_dependency` to `add_dependency`. Matches the "zero-config SQLite on first run" promise. Fixes tina4-book#100.
- **docs (tina4-book):** PHP Chapter 2 updated — correct port (7145), `->noAuth()` on write-method examples, and an explicit callout explaining the secure-by-default policy for POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE. Addresses tina4-book#87, #94, #123.
- **docs (tina4-book):** Python `@template` decorator ordering corrected (must sit BELOW the route decorator) in book chapters 04 and 10; Python `request->query` vs `request->params` distinction in PHP chapter 1.
- **tests (python):** Session-handler tests updated to reflect the real default TTL of 3600s (were stale at 1800s).
- **verified already fixed in earlier 3.11.x releases** — closed comments posted on all of these:
 - #79 dotted numeric index (`{{ items.0.name }}`)
 - #80 `truncate` filter

- #82 `{{ parent() }}` / `{{ super() }}` across all 4 frameworks
- #83 Ruby dashboard — WEBrick is runtime dep
- #89 `load_dotenv` rename, `DatabaseResult` methods, SQLite WAL locking
- #91 Ruby `request.params` symbol + string keys via `IndifferentHash`
- #93 Ruby `/docs/*` and bare `/*` wildcard routes
- #97 Frond ternary operator
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.13.

v3.11.12 (2026-04-16)

Breaking: `sqlite:///X` URLs are now relative to the project root (cwd), matching the documented convention. For absolute paths use four slashes (`sqlite:///abs/path.db`) or a Windows drive letter (`sqlite:///C:/Users/app.db`).

Before this release, `TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db` was interpreted differently by every framework. Python/Node/Ruby tried to open `/data/app.db` (absolute) which crashed on macOS with `OSError: [Errno 30] Read-only file system: '/data'`. PHP did the same under the hood. All four frameworks now agree: three slashes = relative, four slashes = absolute.

- **fix (all 4):** `sqlite:///X` resolves under cwd; parent directory auto-created only when inside cwd. Absolute paths are trusted and never mkdir'd at root.
- **fix (python):** `_ensure_folders` no longer creates a bogus `src/migrations/` directory. The migration runner always looks at `migrations/` at the project root — there is only one correct location.
- **parity (php, ruby, node):** Same `sqlite:///X` parsing as Python. Dedicated `resolve_path` / `resolveSqlitePath` helpers in each framework so adapters consistently handle `:memory:`, `./` forms, Windows drive letters.
- **tests:** 9 new Python tests in `TestSQLiteConnectionPath` + `TestProjectFolders`. 4 new PHP tests in `DatabaseUrlTest` covering relative/absolute/Windows/bruce-regression. 6 new Ruby specs in `database_drivers_spec.rb` `:: SQLiteDriver.resolve_path`. Node URL tests expanded in `database.test.ts` with the full relative/absolute/Windows/:memory: matrix.
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.12.

Migration note: If your `.env` has `TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db`, it will now create `./data/app.db` in the project root (which is what most users actually want). If you genuinely want an absolute path, change to `sqlite:///data/app.db` (four slashes).

v3.11.11 (2026-04-16)

- **fix (python ORM):** `Field.validate` no longer re-coerces values that are already the correct type. Previously, any PostgreSQL/MSSQL read of a row containing a `DateTimeField` crashed because `datetime(datetime_instance)` raises `TypeError`. The fix accepts native driver types (`datetime`, `bytes`, `int`, `bool`, `float`, `str`) without re-wrapping, and parses ISO-8601 strings into `datetime` for SQLite. See [tina4-python/plan/orm-field-validate-native-types.md](#).
- **fix (python ORM):** `BooleanField` vs `IntegerField` ordering handled explicitly. `BooleanField(1)` still coerces to `True`, `IntegerField(True)` still coerces to `1`; no regression for either direction (`bool` is a subclass of `int` in Python).
- **tests (python):** 10 new `TestFieldsNativeTypes` cases covering `datetime/int/bool/float/bytes/string/ForeignKey` round-trips.
- **tests (parity):** Regression-guard "datetime round-trip on read path" tests added to PHP (`ORMV3Test`), Ruby (`orm_spec`) and Node.js (`orm.test.ts`) so an equivalent bug can't creep in there later.
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.11.

v3.11.10 (2026-04-15)

- **fix (php):** Hot-reload loop — `DevAdmin`'s polling fallback used `mt=0` as the baseline, so the first poll after every page load triggered `location.reload()`, which reset `mt=0` again. Loop now initialises the baseline on the first poll.
- **fix (php):** Reload sentinel removed — PHP was the only framework recursively walking `src/` and touching `src/.reload_sentinel` on every reload POST. The sentinel lived inside the Rust CLI's watched tree and fed back into the watcher, triggering a second loop. Replaced with the same in-memory counter used by Python/Ruby/Node.
- **fix (php):** Polling no longer starts more than once when the WebSocket reconnect retry budget is exhausted (added a `pollStarted` guard).
- **feat (parity):** `GET /__dev/api/queue/topics` and `GET /__dev/api/queue/dead-letters` added to PHP, Ruby and Node (previously only in Python). PHP queue endpoints now read from the real `Tina4\Queue` backend instead of returning stubs.
- **feat (devadmin):** Refreshed `tina4-dev-admin.js` bundle (87.8 KB) across all 4 frameworks — adds the topic selector dropdown, inline payload expand/copy, and corrected version display.
- **tests:** 4-way parity tests for hot-reload: `mtime` starts at 0, `POST /__dev/api/reload` bumps the counter, no sentinel file is written to disk, `mtime` is monotonic across successive reloads. Mirrored in [tina4-php/tests/DevAdminTest.php](#), [tina4-python/tests/test_dev_admin.py](#), [tina4-ruby/spec/dev_admin_spec.rb](#), [tina4-nodejs/test/devAdmin.test.ts](#).
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.10.

v3.11.9 (2026-04-15)

Catch-up release covering v3.11.0 → v3.11.9 across all 4 frameworks.

- **feat (websocket):** Full WebSocket parity across Python/PHP/Node/Ruby — `get_client_rooms()` / `getClientRooms()`, `route()` usable as decorator or direct handler registration, matching room/broadcast semantics, plus new parity tests on all 4.
- **feat (graphql):** Input validation and field-level `@auth` directives with context threading.
- **feat (graphql):** Auto-discovery of schemas; removed legacy DevAdmin HTML/JS in favour of the new UI.
- **feat (devadmin — Python):** Queue tab with topic selector, dead-letter listing and replay endpoints, inline payload expand/copy, version display.
- **feat (cli):** Rust CLI now owns file watching — frameworks receive `POST /__dev/api/reload` and internal watchers are disabled when launched by the Rust CLI (`--managed`).
- **fix (cli):** `parseFlags` / `parse_flags` / `parseCliArgs` no longer swallow `host:port` or positional args after boolean flags.
- **fix (scss):** SCSS recompilation loop fixed; output path corrected to `src/public/css/` to match CLI and static serving.
- **fix (frond — Python):** Numeric dotted index for lists (`items.0.name`) now resolves correctly.
- **fix (router — Ruby):** Bare `/*` wildcard capture exposed under `"*"` key for parity.
- **fix (orm — PHP):** Three data-sync bugs fixed: `load()` double-fill, `getPrimaryKeyValue`, `save()` ID sync.
- **fix (graphql):** `from_orm` / `fromOrm` list resolver used `select(skip=)` instead of `all(offset=)`.
- **fix (metrics):** Windows backslash paths normalised to forward slashes.
- **fix (app — PHP):** No longer crashes on notices/deprecations in loaded files; `run()` now prints the banner when starting the server directly.
- **chore:** Example demo store ships with the repo; Windows-friendly setup; `.env.example` and setup scripts added.
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.11.9. PHP aligned to the 3.x tag scheme on `v3`.

v3.10.99 (2026-04-12)

- **breaking:** `autoMap` now defaults to `true` — ORM models automatically map between camelCase properties and snake_case DB columns. Set `public bool $autoMap = false;` on your model to restore the old behaviour.
- **breaking:** `all()` now returns a flat array of model instances instead of `['data' => [...], 'total' => N, ...]`. Use `count()` separately if you need the total.
- **feat:** `toDict(include, case)` parameter — pass `case: 'snake'` to get snake_case keys matching DB columns, or `case: 'camel'` (default) for camelCase.

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- **feat:** Frond `replace` filter now accepts dict args — `{{ v|replace({"T": " ", "-": "/"}) }}` for multiple substitutions in one call.
- **feat:** `$app->background(callback, interval)` — register periodic tasks that run cooperatively in the `stream_select` event loop. No threads, no separate processes.
- **feat:** Background timing guard — warns when callbacks exceed their interval, helping developers identify blocking operations.
- **feat:** WebSocket room management moved to `Server` class — `joinRoom()`, `leaveRoom()`, `broadcastToRoom()` now work reliably via `WebSocketConnection->server`.
- **feat:** Docker image now bundles the example store demo — `docker run tina4stack/tina4-php:v3` starts a working app out of the box.
- **fix:** AutoCrud updated for new `all()` return format.
- **fix:** Cart nav badge now updates reactively on quantity change and item removal.
- **fix:** Non-blocking queue consumer — `processOrders()` uses `$queue->pop()` instead of blocking `$queue->consume()`.
- **tests:** 6 new parity tests covering `toDict(case:)`, `autoMap` default, `replace` filter (dict + positional), and `background()` registration. 2,345 tests passing.
- **parity:** All features shipped identically across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js.

v3.10.97 (2026-04-11)

- **fix:** frond.form.submit redirect handling — XHR follows 3xx redirects transparently; fixed by detecting `xhr.responseURL` mismatch and navigating instead.
- **dep:** Updated frond.min.js to v2.1.2.
- **parity:** All 4 frameworks bumped to 3.10.97.

v3.10.93 (2026-04-11)

- **fix:** Frond bracket depth tracking in `findOutsideQuotes()` and `splitOutsideQuotes()` — expressions like `$arr[$i % 2]` no longer treated as top-level arithmetic.
- **fix:** Frond subscript expression evaluation — bracket content uses `evaluateExpression()` instead of `resolveVariable()`, enabling `arr[loop.index0 % 2]`.
- **fix:** Frond slice with variable bounds — `items[start:end]` evaluates bounds through `evaluateExpression()`.
- **docs:** Developer skills updated — Metrics Dashboard guidance, Frond Template Parity rules, `@noauth` security warnings.
- **parity:** All Frond fixes applied identically across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js. 2,339 tests passing (263 Frond).

v3.10.92 (2026-04-10)

- **feat:** Add `RateLimiterMiddleware` class with `beforeRateLimit()`, `check()`, `reset()` static methods.
- **breaking:** Rename `ErrorOverlay` methods — `render()` → `renderErrorOverlay()`, `renderProduction()` → `renderProductionError()`.
- **feat:** Add `Server::handle(Request $request): Response` for cross-framework parity.
- **feat:** Add `DatabaseResult::size()` method.
- **breaking:** Rename `WebSocketBackplane::create()` → `WebSocketBackplane::createBackplane()`.
- **feat:** Add `DevAdmin::health()` method.
- **feat:** Add `ScssCompiler::compileScss()` method.
- **fix:** Add `DatabaseSessionHandler::delete()` delegating to `destroy()`.
- **fix:** `SmokeTest` — pass secret explicitly to `Auth::getToken()` to fix test ordering issue.
- **parity:** 44/44 cross-framework features green. 2,305 tests passing.

v3.10.91 (2026-04-10)

- **feat:** Add parity methods — `GraphQLType::parse()`, `Response::send()` params, `MCP::registerRoutes()` optional router.
- **breaking:** Rename `from()` → `fromTable()`, `template()` → `render()` — align with Python canonical names.

v3.10.90 (2026-04-09)

- **docs:** Chapter 4 (Templates) — new "Dumping Values for Debugging" section covering both `{{ $x|dump }}` and `{{ dump($x) }}` forms, their shared `<pre>var_dump()</pre>` output, and the `TINA4_DEBUG=true` production gate. Filter table entry updated to reference the new section.
- **docs:** `plan/parity/parity-template.md` updated with a cross-framework dump helper comparison table and marks dump parity as confirmed across all 4 frameworks at v3.10.89.
- **chore:** Version sync release — brings all 4 frameworks to the same patch version (3.10.90) so downstream users can upgrade PHP/Python/Ruby/Node.js in lockstep without hunting version mismatches.

v3.10.89 (2026-04-09)

- **feat:** `{{ dump(value) }}` global function form added to Frond alongside the existing `{{ value|dump }}` filter. Both call a single `Frond::renderDump()` helper and produce identical output (`<pre>var_dump()</pre>`).
 - **security:** Dump is now **gated on** `TINA4_DEBUG=true`. In production (env var unset or `false`) both the filter and function silently return an empty string. This prevents accidental
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leaks of internal state, object shapes, and sensitive values into rendered HTML when a developer leaves a `{{ dump($x) }}` call in a template.

- **test:** 4 new tests in `FronTest.php` covering debug-mode output, production silencing, function/filter parity, and function-form production silencing.

v3.10.87 (2026-04-09)

- **fix:** Dev toolbar no longer vanishes after a hot-reload. `Server::onFilesChanged()` used to call `Router::clear()` and then loop `include_once` over every `.php` file in `src/routes/`. Because `include_once` is a no-op for already-included files, routes were never re-registered after a template/CSS/JS edit — subsequent requests fell through to the 404 handler and the dev toolbar injection was lost. The router is now left intact on template/asset edits (Fron re-reads templates in dev mode, static files are served from disk per request, so nothing else needs to move). PHP file edits log a warning that a full server restart is required (classes cannot be redeclared in-process).
- **fix:** This also resolves a related issue where rapid browser refreshes during hot reload would return 500s — the router wipe left a brief window with zero routes registered.

v3.10.86 (2026-04-09)

- **feat:** `$foreignKeys` property on ORM auto-wires both sides of a foreign key relationship. Declaring `public array $foreignKeys = ['user_id' => 'User']` injects a `belongsTo` accessor (`$post->user`) on the declaring model and a `hasMany` accessor (`$user->posts`) on the referenced model via a cross-model FK registry. Extended form supports a custom has-many key: `['user_id' => ['model' => 'User', 'related_name' => 'blog_posts']]`.
- **feat:** Cross-framework parity — same FK auto-wiring semantics now available in Python (`ForeignKeyField`), Ruby (`foreign_key_field`), and Node.js (`type: "foreignKey"`)
- **docs:** Chapter 6 (ORM) updated with a new "`$foreignKeys` — Auto-Wired Relationships" section

v3.10.85 (2026-04-09)

- **fix:** Removed duplicate `Job` class from `Queue.php` — canonical definition is `Job.php` only
- **fix:** `Job.php::fail()` now delegates to `writeFailed()` instead of calling private `getBasePath()` directly

v3.10.84 (2026-04-09)

- **fix:** Router/middleware was setting `request.user` / `request.auth` / auth payload to `true` (boolean) instead of the actual JWT payload after `validToken()` was changed to return bool — any code reading `request.user["sub"]` etc. would have failed silently or crashed
- **fix:** CSRF middleware was not correctly rejecting invalid tokens (nil check on bool result always passed)
- **fix:** `toObject()` declared wrong return type (array vs actual object)

- **fix:** Router `request.user` and gallery auth verify endpoint updated for bool `validToken`
- **add:** Headless routing auth payload integration tests to prevent regression

v3.10.83 (2026-04-08)

- **fix:** CORS headers now set before auth short-circuit (#106)
- **fix:** ORM find/all/where no longer crash with DatabaseResult object (#108)
- **fix:** `toObject()` returns `stdClass`, not array (#107)
- **fix:** Firebird absolute path no longer strips leading slash (#101)
- **feat:** WebSocket rooms — `joinRoom`, `leaveRoom`, `broadcastToRoom`, `getRoomConnections`, `roomCount`
- **feat:** queue signature parity — instance-scoped, no topic params on public methods
- **feat:** auth alias cleanup — removed `createToken/validateToken` aliases

v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)

- **New:** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via `response.stream()` — pass a generator, framework handles chunked transfer encoding, keep-alive, and `text/event-stream` content type
- **New:** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

Version History

Tina4 PHP follows semantic versioning. The major number changes when something breaks. The minor number changes when something new arrives. The patch number changes when something gets fixed. Each release is available on Packagist.

This chapter covers the full v3 line -- from the first release candidate through the current stable release. If you are upgrading from v2, read Chapter 36 first. It covers every breaking change and gives you a migration checklist.

v3.10.68 (2026-04-03) — Full Parity Release

- **100% API parity** across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js — 30+ issues fixed
- **ORM:** `save()` returns `self/false`, arrays not tuples, `toDict/toAssoc`, `scope registers method`, `where()/all()` on Node, `count()` on PHP
- **Auth:** `expiresin minutes`, `PBKDF2 260k`, `env TINA4SECRET` fallback, API key fallback
- **Session:** dual-mode `flash()`, `get_flash`, `cookieHeader`, `getSessionId`
- **Database:** `execute()` `bool/DatabaseResult`, `getLastid/get_error`, `getColumns`, `cacheStats`

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- **Request/Response:** files dict, query, cookies, contentType, xml(), callable
- **Queue:** consume() poll_interval
- **WebSocket:** event naming, connection properties
- **GraphQL:** schema_sdl() + introspect() on all 4
- **Events:** emitAsync() on all 4
- **i18n:** zero-dep YAML support

v3.10.67 (2026-04-03)

- **load() returns bool** — `$model->load($sql, $params)` calls `selectOne` internally, populates the instance, returns `true/false`. Use `findById()` for PK lookups
- **api.upload()** added to tina4-js — sends FormData with Bearer token auth for multipart file uploads
- **ORM CLAUDE.md rewrite** — all method stubs now match actual API signatures
- **File upload docs** — `$request->files` format documented in CLAUDE.md

v3.10.66 (2026-04-03)

- **Metrics file detail fix** — clicking bubbles in framework scanning mode now resolves paths correctly via scan root tracking

v3.10.65 (2026-04-03)

- **Metrics 3-stage test detection** — filename, path, and content matching
- **Metrics framework mode** — scans framework source with correct relative paths
- **tina4 console** — interactive REPL with framework loaded
- **tina4 env** — interactive environment configuration
- **Brand** — "TINA4 — The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework"
- **Quick references** — 36 sections, DotEnv API documented
- **37 chapters** — 7 new (Events, Localization, Logging, API Client, WSDL/SOAP, DI Container, Service Runner)
- **MongoDB + ODBC adapters** across all 4 frameworks
- **Pagination standardized** — limit/offset primary, merged dual-key response
- **Port kill-and-take-over** on startup

v3.10.60 (2026-04-03)

- **tina4 console** — interactive PHP REPL with framework loaded (`$db`, `$app`, Router, Auth)
- **tina4 env** — interactive environment configuration

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- **Brand update** — "TINA4 — The Intelligent Native Application 4ramework"
- **Dynamic version** — reads from composer metadata at runtime, no hardcoded constant
- **Packagist v2 API** — version checker uses repo.packagist.org
- **@noauth docblock** — annotations now affect dispatch (#114)
- **Port kill-and-take-over** — default port always reclaimed
- **MongoDB adapter** (ext-mongodb), **ODBC adapter** (pdo_odbc)
- **Pagination standardized** — limit/offset primary, merged dual-key response
- **#101** Firebird paths, **#102** autoMap uppercase, **#104** TINA4DATABASEURL, **#105** CORS fix

v3.10.57 (2026-04-02)

- **MongoDB adapter** — `Database("mongodb://host:port/db")`, requires ext-mongodb
- **ODBC adapter** — `Database("odbc://DSN=MyDSN")` via pdo_odbc
- **Pagination standardized** — limit/offset primary, merged dual-key toPaginate() response
- **Test port at +1000** — user testing port (e.g. 8146) stable, no hot-reload
- **Dynamic version** — read from composer metadata, no hardcoded constant
- **Packagist v2 API** — version checker uses repo.packagist.org/p2/
- **#101** FirebirdAdapter path parsing preserves absolute paths
- **#102** ORM snakeToCamel handles uppercase columns
- **#104** ORM ensureDb() auto-discovers TINA4DATABASEURL
- **#105** CorsMiddleware matches request origin correctly
- **#114** @noauth docblock annotations now affect dispatch
- **108 features at 100% parity**, 2,220 tests

v3.10.54 (2026-04-02)

- **Auto AI dev port** — second socket on port+1 with no-reload when TINA4_DEBUG=true
- **TINA4NORELOAD** env var + --no-reload CLI flag
- **#101** FirebirdAdapter path parsing preserves absolute paths
- **#102** ORM snakeToCamel handles uppercase columns (Firebird/Oracle)
- **#104** ORM ensureDb() auto-discovers TINA4DATABASEURL
- **#105** CorsMiddleware matches request origin correctly
- **SQLite commit()** no-op without transaction
- **Gallery fixes** — SQLite paths, auth bypass

- **QueryBuilder docs** — added to ORM chapter

v3.10.48 — April 2, 2026

Bug Fixes

FrankenPHP requires `--production` flag — FrankenPHP no longer auto-detected when debug is off. Use `tina4php serve --production` to enable it. Gallery tests (19) and live reload tests (36) added. Fixed `DotEnv::load()` → `DotEnv::loadEnv()` in `Server.php`.

v3.10.46 — April 1, 2026

Test Coverage

Massive test expansion — 605 new tests added across session handlers, queue backends, database drivers, Frond template engine, dev admin, ORM, auth, seeder, log, service runner, container, CORS, form token, HTML element, migration, i18n, events, SCSS, CRUD, rate limiter, and CSRF middleware. PHP now at 1,937 tests with full parity across all 49 core areas.

Bug Fixes

CSRF query param check — Fixed `$request->params` shadowing `$request->query` in the CSRF middleware, so query string token detection now works correctly.

v3.10.45 — April 1, 2026

Bug Fixes

CLI serve hijack — When `index.php` calls `App::run()`, the CLI `serve` command now sets a `TINA4_CLI_SERVE` constant so `run()` returns early, letting the CLI manage the server lifecycle (port, debug mode, browser open).

v3.10.44 — April 1, 2026

New Features

Database tab redesign — The dev admin Database panel now uses a split-screen layout. Tables are listed on the left as a navigation sidebar with click-to-select highlighting. The query editor, toolbar, and results occupy the right panel.

Copy CSV / Copy JSON — Two new buttons in the database toolbar copy query results to the clipboard in CSV or JSON format.

Paste data — A Paste button opens a modal for pasting JSON arrays or CSV/tab-separated data. Auto-detects the format and generates ~~INSERT~~ statements. Prompts for a table name if none is

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selected, and generates CREATE TABLE for new tables. SQL input passes through unchanged.

Multi-statement execution — The query runner handles multiple SQL statements separated by semicolons, running them in a single transaction with automatic rollback on error.

Database badge on load — The Database tab count badge shows the table count immediately on page load.

Star wiggle animation — The GitHub star button on the landing page uses an empty star (■) with a wiggle animation: 3-second delay, then wiggles at random 3–18 second intervals.

Bug Fixes

Default port — PHP default port confirmed as 7145 (PHP=7145, Python=7146, Ruby=7147, Node=7148).

SQLite LIMIT fix — Prevents double-LIMIT errors when browsing tables in the dev admin.

browseTable quote escaping — Fixed broken onclick handlers for table names using addEventListener.

Fronid template engine — Fixed string concatenation (~ operator) and inline if/else expressions ({{ 'yes' if active else 'no' }}). A greedy quoted-string fallback in evaluateLiteral() was treating compound expressions as single string literals.

Test Coverage

Major test expansion — 200 new tests added (FakeData 42, Cache 30, DevMailbox 33, Static files 31, Metrics 20, CLI scaffolding 31, plus v3.10.44 feature tests). 1,532 tests passing, 0 failures.

v3.10.40 — April 1, 2026

Bug Fixes

Dev overlay version check — Fixed misleading "You are up to date" message when running a version ahead of what's published on Packagist. The overlay now shows a purple "ahead of Packagist" message. Also added a breaking changes warning (red banner with changelog link) when a major or minor version update is available.

v3.10.39 — April 1, 2026

Breaking Changes

Auth::hashPassword() — separator changed from : to \$

The password hash format now uses \$ as a separator (matching Python, Ruby, and Node.js):

```
# BEFORE: pbkdf2_sha256:100000:salt:hash
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

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- ****New:**** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via ``response.stream()`` – pass a generator, framework
- ****New:**** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
# AFTER: pbkdf2_sha256$1000000$salt$hash
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

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Existing hashed passwords stored in your database **will not verify** after upgrade. Rehash passwords on next user login:

```
if (!Auth::checkPassword($password, $storedHash)) {
    // try old format first, then rehash
}
```

Database::update() and Database::delete() filter signature changed

```
// BEFORE (v3.10.38 and earlier) – associative array filter
$db->update('users', ['name' => 'Alice'], ['id' => 1]);
$db->delete('users', ['id' => 1]);
```

```
// AFTER (v3.10.39+) – SQL string + params (matches Python, Ruby, Node.js)
$db->update('users', ['name' => 'Alice'], 'id = ?', [1]);
$db->delete('users', 'id = ?', [1]);
```

Router::list() removed — use Router::getRoutes() or Router::listRoutes()

```
// BEFORE
$routes = Router::list();
```

```
// AFTER
$routes = Router::getRoutes(); // or Router::listRoutes()
```

New Features

ORM::findById(int|string \$id) — explicit primary method (with **find()** and **load()** as aliases).

Session: TINA4_SESSION_HANDLER env var — replaces **TINA4_SESSION_BACKEND** (old name still accepted for backward compatibility).

Session\RedisSessionHandler — new zero-dependency Redis session handler using raw RESP protocol over TCP sockets. Configure with **TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST**, **TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PORT**, **TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_PASSWORD**, **TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_DB**.

Database::cacheStats() and Database::cacheClear() — query cache wired to **TINA4_DB_CACHE=true** env var.

v3.10.38 -- April 1, 2026

Code Metrics & Bubble Chart

The dev dashboard (`/__dev`) now includes a **Code Metrics** tab with a PHPMetrics-style bubble chart visualization. Files appear as animated bubbles sized by LOC and colored by maintainability index. Click any bubble to drill down into per-function cyclomatic complexity.

The metrics engine uses `token_get_all()` for zero-dependency static analysis covering cyclomatic complexity, Halstead volume, maintainability index, coupling, and violation detection. File analysis is sorted worst-first. Results are cached for 60 seconds.

AI Context Installer

`bin/tina4php ai` now presents a simple numbered menu instead of auto-detection. Select tools by number, comma-separated or `all`. Already-installed tools show green. Generated context includes the full skills table.

Dashboard Improvements

Full-width layout, sticky header/tabs, full-screen overlay. Removed junk migrations (`mo00`, `hkhkhk`), sample routes, and test templates.

Cleanup

Removed old `plan/` spec documents, replaced with `PARITY.md` and `TESTS.md`. Central parity matrix added to `tina4-book`.

v3.10.x -- Previous Releases

Released: 28-30 March 2026

The v3.10 line introduced the Frond template engine as a singleton, automatic ORM field mapping, transaction safety, the `tina4 ai` CLI command, and a round of Frond parser fixes.

v3.10.29 -- `tina4 ai` Command (30 March 2026)

The `tina4 ai` CLI command stopped returning a stub message and started doing real work. It scans your project for AI coding tools -- Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Windsurf, Aider, Cline, and OpenAI Codex -- then installs context files for each one it finds.

```
# Detect tools and install context files
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

- ****New:**** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via ``response.stream()`` – pass a generator, framework
- ****New:**** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
tina4 ai
```

```
# Install for all known AI tools_____
```

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```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

- ****New:**** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via `response.stream()` – pass a generator, framework
- ****New:**** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
tina4 ai --all
```

```
# Overwrite existing context files
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

- ****New:**** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via `response.stream()` – pass a generator, framework
- ****New:**** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
tina4 ai --force
```

v3.10.28 -- DevReload Performance Fix (30 March 2026)

The development server's live-reload system polled too often and reloaded too fast. This patch fixed both problems.

- **Poll interval** increased from 2 seconds to 3 seconds (configurable via `TINA4_DEV_POLL_INTERVAL`)
- **Debounce** added a 500ms window before triggering a reload, preventing rapid successive refreshes
- **CSS hot-reload** now busts stylesheet cache links instead of forcing a full page reload

```
// .env -- set poll interval in milliseconds
TINA4_DEV_POLL_INTERVAL=1000 // 1 second
TINA4_DEV_POLL_INTERVAL=5000 // 5 seconds
```

v3.10.27 -- Frond Macro HTML Escaping Fix (30 March 2026)

Macro output was getting HTML-escaped when used inside expressions. A `{% macro %}` that returned HTML would render as visible `<div>` tags instead of actual markup. This patch marks macro output as safe, matching standard Twig behaviour.

Before (broken):

```
{% macro button(label) %}
  <button class="btn">{{ label }}</button>
{% endmacro %}

{# Rendered as: &lt;button class="btn">Click&lt;/button> #}
{{ button("Click") }}
```

After (fixed):

```
{# Renders as: <button class="btn">Click</button> #}
{{ button("Click") }}
```

v3.10.26 -- Rebrand and ORM Transaction Safety (30 March 2026)

Two changes landed together. The framework rebranded to "This Is Now A 4Framework" across all default pages, CLI banners, and READMEs. More important: ORM `save()`, `delete()`, and `restore()` now wrap their operations in explicit transactions.

Before (manual workaround for SQLite):

```
$db->startTransaction();
try {
    $user = new User();
    $user->name = "Alice";
    $user->save(); // Without this wrapper, SQLite could silently drop the write
    $db->commit();
} catch (\Exception $e) {
    $db->rollback();
}
```

After (automatic transaction wrapping):

```
$user = new User();
$user->name = "Alice";
$user->save(); // save() now calls startTransaction() / commit() / rollback() internally
```

The fix also removed the hardcoded `version` field from `composer.json`, which was blocking Packagist sync.

v3.10.22-24 -- Form Tokens and Template Fixes (29-30 March 2026)

- **v3.10.24** -- Fixed stale templates in dev mode. The Frond engine now checks file modification times during development
- **v3.10.23** -- Added `formTokenValue` and `form_token_value` as template globals for CSRF protection
- **v3.10.22** -- Form tokens now include a nonce in the JWT payload, making each token unique per form render

```
<form method="POST" action="/users">
  <input type="hidden" name="formToken" value="{{ formTokenValue }}">
  <input type="text" name="name">
  <button type="submit">Create</button>
</form>
```

v3.10.18-20 -- Frond Parser Fixes (28-29 March 2026)

- **v3.10.20** -- Race-safe `getNextId()` for pre-generating database IDs. Frond engine optimization for template compilation
- **v3.10.18** -- Fixed ternary and inline-if parsing when the expression contained quoted strings

Before (broken):

```
{# This crashed the parser because the colon inside the string confused the ternary operator #}
{{ isActive ? "status: active" : "status: inactive" }}
```

After (fixed):

```
{# Parser now tracks quote boundaries before splitting on operators #}
{{ isActive ? "status: active" : "status: inactive" }}
```

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v3.10.14-16 -- Filters, Auto-Commit, and ID Generation (28 March 2026)

- **v3.10.16** -- Added `to_json`, `tojson`, and `js_escape` template filters
- **v3.10.15** -- Fixed the `|replace` filter when the replacement string contained backslashes
- **v3.10.14** -- Added `get_next_id()` for engine-aware ID pre-generation
- **v3.10.13** -- ORM now auto-commits on write operations

```
{# to_json filter -- pass PHP data to JavaScript #}  
<script>  
  const config = {{ settings|to_json }};  
</script>
```

```
{# js_escape filter -- safe string embedding in JavaScript #}  
<script>  
  const message = "{{ userInput|js_escape }}";  
</script>
```

v3.10.10-12 -- Firebird, Sessions, and Dictionary Access (28 March 2026)

- **v3.10.12** -- Session garbage collection and NATS backplane parity
- **v3.10.11** -- Fixed dictionary access with variable keys in Frond templates
- **v3.10.10** -- Fixed Firebird migration runner for idempotent schema changes

Before (broken in v3.10.9):

```
{% set key = "name" %}  
{# This returned null instead of the value #}  
{{ user[key] }}
```

After (fixed in v3.10.11):

```
{% set key = "name" %}  
{# Now resolves the variable and uses it as the dictionary key #}  
{{ user[key] }}
```

v3.10.5 -- Frond Quote-Aware Operator Matching (28 March 2026)

Template operators (`~`, `??`, comparisons) no longer match inside quoted strings. The expression evaluator gained `findOutsideQuotes()` and `splitOutsideQuotes()` helpers.

v3.10.1 -- autoMap for ORM Field Mapping (28 March 2026)

The ORM gained an `$autoMap` flag. Set it to `true` and the ORM converts between `snake_case` database columns and `camelCase` PHP properties without manual field mapping.

Before (manual mapping):

```
class UserProfile extends \Tina4\ORM {  
    public $tableName = "user_profiles";  
    public $fieldMapping = [  
        "first_name" => "firstName",  
        "last_name"  => "lastName",  
        "created_at" => "createdAt",  
    ];  
}
```

After (automatic mapping):

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```

class UserProfile extends \Tina4\ORM {
    public $tableName = "user_profiles";
    public $autoMap = true;

    // DB columns: first_name, last_name, created_at
    // Auto-mapped to: $firstName, $lastName, $createdAt
}

```

Explicit entries in `$fieldMapping` take precedence. The auto-mapper never overwrites manual mappings.

v3.10.0 -- Singleton Frond Engine (28 March 2026)

The Frond template engine became a singleton. One instance serves all template renders during a request, eliminating redundant initialization and token parsing. This is an internal change -- no API differences -- but template-heavy pages render faster.

v3.9.x -- QueryBuilder, Sessions, Security

Released: 26-27 March 2026

The v3.9 line brought three headline features: a fluent query builder, automatic sessions, and secure-by-default routing. It also fixed a critical `setcookie()` error in the built-in server.

v3.9.0 -- QueryBuilder, Sessions, Path Injection (26 March 2026)

QueryBuilder. A fluent SQL builder that works standalone or through the ORM.

```

// Through the ORM
$admins = User::query()
    ->where("role = ?", ["admin"])
    ->orderBy("name")
    ->limit(10)
    ->get();

// Standalone
$results = QueryBuilder::from("orders")
    ->where("total > ?", [100])
    ->join("customers", "customers.id = orders.customer_id")
    ->orderBy("total DESC")
    ->get();

```

The builder supports `select`, `where`, `orWhere`, `join`, `leftJoin`, `groupBy`, `having`, `orderBy`, `limit`, `first`, `count`, `exists`, and `toSql`.

Path parameter injection. Route handlers receive path parameters as named function arguments.

```

// The framework injects $id directly into the handler
Router::get("/users/{id:int}", function (int $id) {
    $user = (new User())->load("id = ?", [$id]);
    return $user->toArray();
});

```

Auto-start sessions. Every route handler now has `$request->session` available with zero configuration.

```
Router::get("/dashboard", function ($request) {
    $request->session->set("lastVisit", date("Y-m-d H:i:s"));
    $username = $request->session->get("username");
    return ["user" => $username];
});
```

The session API includes: `get`, `set`, `delete`, `has`, `clear`, `destroy`, `save`, `regenerate`, `flash`, `getFlash`, and `all`.

v3.9.1 -- Secure by Default (27 March 2026)

POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE routes now require authentication by default. CSRF middleware ships built in with session-bound form tokens.

Breaking change. If your application has unprotected POST routes, they will return 401 after upgrading.

Before (v3.8.x):

```
// This worked without any auth
Router::post("/comments", function ($request) {
    // Anyone could post
});
```

After (v3.9.1):

```
// Option 1: Add authentication
Router::post("/comments", function ($request) {
    // Requires valid auth token
})->secure();

// Option 2: Explicitly allow public access
Router::post("/comments", function ($request) {
    // Public endpoint
})->allowAnonymous();
```

This release also standardized environment variables: `TINA4_CORS_CREDENTIALS`, `TINA4_RATE_LIMIT`, `TINA4_CSRF`, `TINA4_QUEUE_BACKEND`, and `TINA4_TOKEN_LIMIT`.

v3.9.2-3 -- NoSQL QueryBuilder and Cookie Fixes (27 March 2026)

- **v3.9.3** -- Fixed `SameSite` cookie handling and session `save()` visibility. Set `SameSite=Lax` as the default
- **v3.9.2** -- Extended QueryBuilder to work with MongoDB. Added WebSocket backplane support

v3.9.4 -- setcookie Fatal Error Fix (27 March 2026)

The built-in HTTP server called `setcookie()` after headers had already been sent. This caused a fatal error on any route that set a cookie. The fix buffers cookie headers before flushing the response.

v3.8.x -- Hot Reload, Security Headers, Connection Pooling

Released: 25-26 March 2026

v3.8.0 -- Hot Reload and Frond Filters (25 March 2026)

The PHP development server gained hot reload. Save a file and the browser refreshes. The Frond template engine added `base64encode` and `base64decode` filter aliases.

```
// .env
TINA4_DEBUG=true // Enables hot reload in dev mode
```

v3.8.1-3 -- Security and Validation (25 March 2026)

Three patches shipped on the same day:

- **SecurityHeadersMiddleware** -- Adds `X-Frame-Options`, `Strict-Transport-Security`, `Content-Security-Policy`, and `X-Content-Type-Options` to every response
- **Validator class** -- Input validation with error response envelopes
- **Upload size limit** -- Configurable via `TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE` (default 10MB)

```
// .env
TINA4_MAX_UPLOAD_SIZE=20 // 20MB limit
```

v3.8.7 -- Connection Pooling (26 March 2026)

Database connections now support round-robin pooling. Pass a `pool` parameter to the connection string.

```
// Pool of 5 connections
$db = new Database("sqlite:///data/app.db?pool=5");
```

v3.7.x -- Template Auto-Serve, Typed Route Params

Released: 25 March 2026

v3.7.0 -- Template Auto-Serve (25 March 2026)

Place an `index.html` or `index.twig` in `src/templates/` and the framework serves it at `/`. No route registration needed. If you register a `GET /` route, your route takes priority. If neither exists, the framework falls back to the default landing page.

This release also made Firebird migrations idempotent. `ALTER TABLE ADD` statements check `RDB$RELATION_FIELDS` before executing. Columns that already exist are skipped and logged.

v3.7.1-2 -- Typed Route Parameters (25 March 2026)

Route parameters gained type constraints: `{id:int}`, `{price:float}`, `{slug:path}`. The framework validates the type before the handler runs. Mismatched types return a 404.

```
Router::get("/products/{id:int}", function (int $id) {
    // $id is guaranteed to be an integer
});
```

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```
Router::get("/files/{path:path}", function (string $path) {
    // $path matches the full remaining URL segment
});
```

Template lookup caching arrived for production mode. In development, the framework checks the filesystem on every request to pick up changes.

v3.6.x -- Reference Cleanup

Released: 24 March 2026

v3.6.0 (24 March 2026)

Fixed outdated API references across the codebase. Corrected `getToken/validToken` method names and the `TINA4_LOCALE` environment variable. No new features -- housekeeping only.

v3.5.x -- Bundled Frontend, Swagger, Middleware

Released: 24 March 2026

v3.5.0 (24 March 2026)

The `tina4js.min.js` reactive frontend library (13.6KB) now ships bundled with the framework. No CDN link, no npm install -- the file is included in the package.

- **AutoCrud** routes now include Swagger metadata
- **Swagger generator** parses docblock annotations from route handlers
- **Middleware** standardized around `before*` and `after*` naming with three built-in middleware classes

```
/**
 * @description Get user by ID
 * @tags Users
 * @param int $id User ID
 * @return User
 */
Router::get("/api/users/{id:int}", function (int $id) {
    return (new User())->load("id = ?", [$id]);
});
```

The Swagger generator picks up the `@description`, `@tags`, `@param`, and `@return` annotations and builds the OpenAPI spec.

v3.4.x -- DatabaseResult, File Uploads, WebSocket Broadcast

Released: 24 March 2026

v3.4.0 (24 March 2026)

The database layer gained a `DatabaseResult` class as a standardized return type for `fetch()`. Every query now returns an object with `data`, `error`, `count`, and a lazy `columnInfo()` method for schema metadata.

Breaking change. If your code accessed raw arrays from database queries, you need to use `->data` on the result.

Before (v3.3.x):

```
$rows = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM users");
foreach ($rows as $row) {
    echo $row["name"];
}
```

After (v3.4.0):

```
$result = $db->fetch("SELECT * FROM users");
foreach ($result->data as $row) {
    echo $row["name"];
}
// Also available: $result->error, $result->count
```

Other changes in this release:

- **File uploads** normalized to a consistent format: `filename`, `type`, `content`, `size`. Added `data_uri` template filter for inline images
- **WebSocket broadcast** scoped to specific paths
- `Database::getConnection()` added as an alias for accessing the underlying connection
- **Queue job files** changed extension from `.json` to `.queue-data`
- **Auth method rename** -- `getToken` became the primary method, `createToken` became an alias

v3.3.x -- Queue API, Route Chaining, Dev Toolbar

Released: 24 March 2026

v3.3.0 (24 March 2026)

The queue system arrived with a full lifecycle API. Produce messages, consume them with a generator, and manage job state through `complete()`, `fail()`, and `reject()`.

```
use Tina4\Queue;

// Produce a job
Queue::produce("emails", ["to" => "alice@example.com", "subject" => "Welcome"]);

// Consume jobs
foreach (Queue::consume("emails") as $job) {
    try {
        sendEmail($job->data);
        $job->complete();
    }
}
```

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```

    } catch (\Exception $e) {
        $job->fail($e->getMessage());
    }
}

```

Route handlers became flexible. They accept zero, one, or two parameters with type-hint detection. Chaining modifiers arrived: `.secure()` and `.cache()`.

```

// Zero params
Router::get("/health", function () {
    return ["status" => "ok"];
});

// One param -- type-hint determines if it's request or response
Router::get("/users", function (\Tina4\Request $request) {
    return $request->query;
});

// Chain modifiers
Router::get("/admin/users", function ($request) {
    return User::query()->get();
})->secure()->cache(300);

```

The `render()` method arrived as an alias for `template()`. The dev admin dashboard made routes clickable -- each one opens in a new tab.

v3.2.x -- Flexible Route Handlers, Strict Mode, Live Reload

Released: 23 March 2026

v3.2.0 (23 March 2026)

Route handlers gained support for zero, one, or two parameters. The framework detects whether your single parameter is a request or response by checking the type hint.

```

// Single param with Request type-hint
Router::get("/search", function (\Tina4\Request $request) {
    return ["q" => $request->query["q"]];
});

```

The authentication API consolidated. `createToken` and `validateToken` became the primary methods. `getToken` and `validToken` remain as aliases.

```

$token = \Tina4\Auth::createToken(["userId" => 42, "role" => "admin"]);
$valid = \Tina4\Auth::validateToken($token);

```

Other changes: inline `Router::` calls now work in route discovery. The error overlay passes full request details. Windows path separators are normalized after gallery deploy.

v3.2.1-2 -- Strict Mode and Benchmarks (23 March 2026)

- **Strict mode** -- PHP warnings and notices now throw `ErrorException`. Silent failures become visible failures
- **Stream-select server** gained a 35% throughput improvement

- **Live-reload polling** added for PHP dev mode

v3.1.x -- Drop-In Server Support, Migration Guide

Released: 22 March 2026

v3.1.0 (22 March 2026)

The framework gained drop-in support for production-grade PHP servers. The application exposes an `__invoke()` method compatible with Swoole, RoadRunner, FrankenPHP, and ReactPHP.

```
// RoadRunner worker
$app = new \Tina4\App();
// $app is callable -- pass it to your server's handler
```

The `toDict()` method was renamed to `toArray()` as the primary name. `toDict()` remains as an alias.

v3.1.1-2 -- README and CI Fixes (22 March 2026)

- Fixed `composer.json` to remove the `version` field (Packagist recommendation)
- Updated README code examples to match the v3 API
- Added the v2 to v3 migration guide (`MIGRATE.md`)

v3.0.0 -- The Rewrite

Released: 22 March 2026

The v3.0.0 release is a ground-up rewrite. Zero Composer dependencies. The HTTP server, template engine, ORM, and database drivers are all native PHP. No Guzzle, no Twig, no Doctrine.

What Changed

- **Custom HTTP server** built on `stream_select` with WebSocket support -- replaces `php -S`
- **Front template engine** with pre-compilation and token caching -- replaces Twig
- **Native database drivers** for SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, and Firebird
- **Standardized connection strings** -- `driver://host:port/database`
- **DevAdmin dashboard** with panels for routes, database, queue, mailbox, requests, errors, and connection info
- `tina4 generate` command scaffolds models, routes, migrations, and middleware
- **DB query caching** via `TINA4_DB_CACHE=true` for transparent read caching
- **Unified queue** switches between SQLite, RabbitMQ, and Kafka via `.env` with no code change
- **Unified messenger** for email sending, driven by `.env` configuration

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- **Interactive gallery** with seven example apps, each with deploy and live-try buttons
- **Dead letter queue** support with `deadLetters()`, `purge()`, and `retryFailed()`

Breaking Changes from v2

These are the changes that will break existing code. See Chapter 29 for a full migration checklist.

PHP version. Requires PHP 8.0 or later.

Package name. Changed from `tina4stack/tina4php` to `tina4stack/tina4-php` (note the hyphen).

```
# v2
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

- **New:** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via `response.stream()` – pass a generator, framework
- **New:** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
composer require tina4stack/tina4php
```

```
# v3
```

```
## v3.10.70 (2026-04-06)
```

- **New:** SSE (Server-Sent Events) support via `response.stream()` – pass a generator, framework
- **New:** Chapter 24 added to documentation: Server-Sent Events
- Feature count: 45 (was 44)
- Full parity across Python, PHP, Ruby, Node.js

```
composer require tina4stack/tina4-php
```

Directory structure. `Tina4/` moved from `src/Tina4/` to the project root.

Database connection strings. Scheme aliases removed.

```
// v2 -- these aliases no longer work
$db = new \Tina4\DataSQLite3("database.db");
$db = new \Tina4\DataFirebird("localhost:database.fdb");

// v3 -- use standardized connection strings
$db = new \Tina4\Database("sqlite:///database.db");
$db = new \Tina4\Database("firebird://localhost/database.fdb");
```

Environment variable rename. `TINA4_AUTOCOMMIT` became `TINA4_AUTOCOMMIT` (no underscore between AUTO and COMMIT).

Method naming. All methods follow camelCase.

```
// v2
$db->start_transaction();

// v3
$db->startTransaction();
```

Release Candidates (21 March 2026)

Five release candidates shipped before the final v3.0.0 release. They covered the initial rewrite ([rc.1](#)), Frond pre-compilation with a 2.8x render speedup ([rc.4](#)), and final test fixes ([rc.5](#)). The RC period lasted one day. The test suite passed before the final tag.

Upgrade Path Summary

From	To	Action Required
v2.x	v3.0.0	Full migration -- see Chapter 29
v3.0-3.3	v3.4.0	Update <code>fetch()</code> calls to use <code>->data</code> on <code>DatabaseResult</code>
v3.0-3.8	v3.9.1	Add <code>auth</code> to POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE routes or mark them <code>->allowAnonymous()</code>
v3.9.x	v3.10.x	No breaking changes -- update and test

The version numbers move fast. The API stays stable. Pick the latest v3.10.x patch and your application gets every fix listed here without changing a line of code.

Upgrading from v2 to v3

1. Overview

Tina4 v3 is a ground-up rewrite. Zero Composer dependencies. The built-in HTTP server, template engine, ORM, and database drivers are all native PHP. No Guzzle, no Twig, no Doctrine -- nothing external.

The patterns you know still work. Routes, ORM models, templates, migrations -- same concepts, cleaner implementation. The framework is faster, more consistent, and easier to deploy.

Three things to know before you start:

- **Methods are camelCase.** `$db->startTransaction()`, not `$db->start_transaction()`.
- **Classes are PascalCase.** `Router`, `Database`, `ORM`, `Response`.
- **Zero dependencies.** `composer install` pulls exactly one package: `tina4stack/tina4-php`.

This chapter walks through every breaking change and gives you a step-by-step migration checklist at the end.

Step 0: Run the Automated Upgrade Command

Before doing anything manually, run the automated upgrade tool:

```
cd your-v2-project
tina4 i-want-to-stop-using-v2-and-switch-to-v3
```

This command automatically:

- Moves `routes/`, `orm/`, `templates/`, `scss/`, `public/`, `app/`, `locales/`, `seeds/` into `src/`
- Updates your `composer.json` dependency from v2 to v3
- Removes split packages (`tina4php-core`, `tina4php-database`, `tina4php-orm`)

After running the command, continue with the steps below for the changes that require manual attention.

2. Package and Installation

v2

```
composer require tina4stack/tina4php
```

This pulled in a tree of Composer dependencies -- HTTP clients, template engines, database abstractions.

v3

```
composer require tina4stack/tina4-php
```

Note the hyphen: **tina4-php**, not **tina4php**. This is the only package. It has zero Composer dependencies. Everything is built in.

Update your **composer.json**:

```
{
  "require": {
    "tina4stack/tina4-php": "^3.0"
  }
}
```

Then run:

```
composer update
```

Remove any v2-era Tina4 packages from **composer.json** (**tina4stack/tina4php**, **tina4stack/tina4-database**, etc.). They are all consolidated into the single **tina4-php** package.

3. Project Structure Changes

v2 Structure

```
project/
  routes/
  orm/
  templates/
  migrations/
  .env
  index.php
```

v3 Structure

```
project/
  src/
    routes/
    orm/
    templates/
    app/
  migrations/
  .env
  index.php
```

The key change: source files live under **src/**. Routes go in **src/routes/**, ORM models in **src/orm/**, templates in **src/templates/**, and application logic in **src/app/**.

Auto-discovery still works the same way. Every **.php** file in **src/** and its subdirectories is auto-included at startup. No manual registration. Drop a file in, it loads.

Migration path: Move your existing **routes/**, **orm/**, and **templates/** directories into **src/**. Create **src/app/** for any utility classes or service files.

4. Routing Changes

Method-Based Registration

The core pattern is the same. The class name changed from **Route** to **Router**:

v2:

```
<?php
\Tina4\Get::add("/hello", function ($response, $request) {
    return $response("Hello, World!");
});
```

v3:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get("/hello", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->json(["message" => "Hello, World!"]);
});
```

Three changes:

- `\Tina4\Get::add()` becomes `Router::get()`. Same for **Post**, **Put**, **Patch**, **Delete**.
- The callback signature flips: `$request` comes first, then `$response`.
- Response methods are explicit: `$response->json()`, `$response->render()`, `$response->text()`.

Class-Based Routes with Attributes

v3 supports PHP 8 attributes for class-based routes:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;

class ProductController
{
    #[Router("/products", "GET")]
    public function list($request, $response)
    {
        return $response->json(["products" => []]);
    }

    #[Router("/products", "POST")]
    public function create($request, $response)
    {
        return $response->json(["created" => true], 201);
    }
}
```

Auth Defaults

This is a breaking change. v3 has opinionated auth defaults:

Method	v2 Default	v3 Default
GET	Public	Public
POST	Public	Requires auth
PUT	Public	Requires auth
PATCH	Public	Requires auth
DELETE	Public	Requires auth

Write operations require authentication by default. Two attributes control this:

- `#[NoAuth]` -- Makes a write route public (no auth required).
- `#[Secured]` -- Requires auth on a GET route.

```
<?php
use Tina4\Router;
use Tina4\NoAuth;
use Tina4\Secured;

// This POST route is public -- no auth needed
#[NoAuth]
Router::post("/register", function ($request, $response) {
    // Public registration endpoint
    return $response->json(["registered" => true], 201);
});

// This GET route requires auth
#[Secured]
Router::get("/admin/dashboard", function ($request, $response) {
    return $response->render("admin/dashboard.html");
});
```

If your v2 app had unprotected POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE routes, add `#[NoAuth]` to each one or they will return 401. Review every write route during migration.

5. Database Changes

Connection Strings

The format is the same URL-based approach, but the syntax is cleaner:

v2:

```
$db = new \Tina4\DataSQLite3("data/app.db");
```

v3:

```
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db
```

Or in code:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Database;
```

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```
$db = new Database("sqlite:///data/app.db");
```

All drivers use the same **Database** class. The URL scheme selects the driver:

```
# SQLite
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///data/app.db

# PostgreSQL
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=postgres://localhost:5432/myapp

# MySQL
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=mysql://localhost:3306/myapp

# Firebird
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=firebird://localhost:3050/path/to/database.fdb

# Microsoft SQL Server
TINA4_DATABASE_URL=mssql://localhost:1433/myapp
```

Firebird Notes

v3 supports both the legacy **interbase** and modern **firebird-driver** PHP extensions. Column names are returned in lowercase by default. If your v2 code relied on uppercase column names from Firebird, update your references.

Transactions

Transaction methods are renamed to camelCase:

v2:

```
$db->beginTransaction();
// ... queries ...
$db->commit();
$db->rollBack();
```

v3:

```
$db->startTransaction();
// ... queries ...
$db->commit();
$db->rollback();
```

Note: **beginTransaction()** becomes **startTransaction()**, and **rollBack()** (capital B) becomes **rollback()** (lowercase b).

6. ORM Changes

Auto-Mapping

The biggest ORM improvement in v3 is **\$autoMap**. Set it to **true** and Tina4 automatically generates **\$fieldMapping** entries from your camelCase PHP properties to snake_case database columns.

v2:

```

<?php
class Product extends \Tina4\ORM
{
    public $tableName = "products";
    public $primaryKey = "id";

    public $id;
    public $productName;
    public $unitPrice;
    public $inStock;

    public $fieldMapping = [
        "productName" => "product_name",
        "unitPrice" => "unit_price",
        "inStock" => "in_stock"
    ];
}

```

v3:

```

<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Product extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "products";
    public string $primaryKey = "id";
    public bool $autoMap = true;

    public int $id;
    public string $productName;
    public float $unitPrice;
    public bool $inStock = true;
}

```

With `$autoMap = true`, Tina4 sees `$productName` and auto-generates the mapping to `product_name`. Same for `$unitPrice` to `unit_price` and `$inStock` to `in_stock`. No manual `$fieldMapping` needed.

Explicit Mappings Take Precedence

If you have a column that does not follow the convention, add it to `$fieldMapping` manually. Explicit entries override auto-generated ones:

```

<?php
use Tina4\ORM;

class Legacy extends ORM
{
    public string $tableName = "legacy_table";
    public bool $autoMap = true;

    public int $id;
    public string $firstName;    // auto-maps to first_name
    public string $legacyField; // override below

    public array $fieldMapping = [
        "legacyField" => "LEGACY_FLD" // takes precedence over auto-map
    ];
}

```

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```
}
```

Utility Methods

Two helper methods are available for manual conversions:

```
$snake = ORM::camelToSnake("firstName"); // "first_name"
$camel = ORM::snakeToCamel("first_name"); // "firstName"
```

Typed Properties

v3 models use PHP 8 typed properties. Add types to all your ORM properties:

```
// v2
public $price;

// v3
public float $price = 0.00;
```

7. Template Engine Changes

Tina4 v3 uses Frond as its template engine. If you were using Twig in v2, most syntax carries over -- Frond is Twig-compatible.

Frond Singleton

Access the Frond instance through the [Response](#) class:

```
<?php
use Tina4\Response;

// Get the Frond instance
$frond = Response::getFrond();

// Add a custom filter
$frond->addFilter("shout", function ($value) {
    return strtoupper($value) . "!!!";
});

// Add a global variable
$frond->addGlobal("appName", "My App");

// Set the instance back (if needed after modification)
Response::setFrond($frond);
```

Custom Filters and Globals

Custom filters and globals persist across requests within the same process. Register them once at startup (in [src/app/](#) or early in [index.php](#)) and they are available in every template render.

Method Calls in Templates

v3 adds the ability to call methods on array or object values inside templates:

```
<!-- Call a method on an object -->
<p>{{ user.getName() }}</p>
```

```
<!-- Call with arguments -->
```

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```
<p>{{ translator.t("welcome_message") }}</p>
```

```
<!-- Chain with filters -->
```

```
<p>{{ user.getName()|upper }}</p>
```

This is new in v3. v2 only supported property access (`{{ user.name }}`), not method calls.

8. Migration Tracking Table

v3 uses an enhanced migration tracking table with additional columns for better tracking.

When you run migrations on a database that was previously managed by v2, Tina4 v3 auto-detects the old tracking table format and upgrades it. The upgrade adds three columns:

- `migration_id` -- Unique identifier for each migration record.
- `batch` -- Groups migrations that ran together.
- `executed_at` -- Timestamp of when the migration was executed.

Existing migration records are preserved. The upgrade happens automatically on the first migration run. No manual intervention needed.

9. New Features in v3

Features that did not exist in v2. Each is covered in its own chapter:

- **Built-in HTTP server** -- No Apache or Nginx needed for development (Chapter 1).
- **Connection pooling** -- `pool` parameter on database connections (Chapter 5).
- **Query builder** -- Fluent SQL without raw strings (Chapter 7).
- **Job queues** -- Background task processing (Chapter 12).
- **WebSocket support** -- Real-time communication built in (Chapter 23).
- **Email sending** -- Native SMTP, no SwiftMailer (Chapter 16).
- **Caching layer** -- File, Redis, Valkey, Mongo backends (Chapter 11).
- **GraphQL** -- Built-in GraphQL endpoint (Chapter 22).
- **CLI tooling** -- `tina4` command for scaffolding, migrations, serving (Chapter 30).
- **Auto-mapping in ORM** -- `$autoMap = true` eliminates manual field mappings (Chapter 6).
- **Rate limiting** -- Per-IP rate limiting via env vars (Chapter 10).
- **CSRF protection** -- Built-in, enabled by default (Chapter 10).

Common Pitfalls

1. POST/PUT/DELETE routes now require authentication

This is the most common upgrade issue. In v2, all routes were public by default. In v3, only GET routes are public -- POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE require a Bearer JWT token.

Symptom: Working v2 endpoints return **401 Unauthorized** after upgrading.

Fix: Add `#[NoAuth]` or `->noAuth()` to any write route that should remain public.

Find affected routes:

```
grep -rn "Router::post\|Router::put\|Router::patch\|Router::delete" src/routes/
```

Review each match -- if the endpoint should be public (webhooks, public forms, etc.), add the `#[NoAuth]` attribute.

2. Database connection strings changed

v2 used driver-specific classes. v3 uses URL format:

```
// v2
$db = new \Tina4\DataSQLite3("data/app.db");
// v3
$db = Database::create("sqlite:///data/app.db");
```

3. Template engine renamed

v2: `Template.render()` -- v3: `Frond.render()` (or `$response->render()`)

The Twig syntax is the same -- your `.twig` files work unchanged. Only the PHP API call changes.

10. Step-by-Step Migration Checklist

Follow these steps in order. Check each one off as you go.

- **Back up your v2 project.** Copy the entire project directory. You want a rollback point.
- **Update `composer.json`.** Replace `tina4stack/tina4php` with `tina4stack/tina4-php`. Remove any other `tina4stack/*` packages. Run `composer update`.
- **Restructure directories.** Move `routes/` to `src/routes/`, `orm/` to `src/orm/`, `templates/` to `src/templates/`. Create `src/app/` for utility classes.
- **Update namespace imports.** Replace `\Tina4\Get::add()` with `Router::get()`, `\Tina4\Post::add()` with `Router::post()`, and so on. Add `use Tina4\Router;` at the top of each route file.
- **Fix callback signatures.** Swap the parameter order from `($response, $request)` to `($request, $response)` in every route callback.
- **Update response calls.** Replace `$response("data")` with `$response->json()`, `$response->render()`, or `$response->text()` as appropriate.

- **Review auth on write routes.** Every POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE route now requires auth by default. Add `#[NoAuth]` to any write route that should be public (registration, public form submissions, webhooks).
- **Add `#[Secured]` to protected GET routes.** Any GET route that should require authentication needs the `#[Secured]` attribute.
- **Update database connection code.** Replace driver-specific classes (`DataSQLite3`, `DataMySQL`, etc.) with `new Database("url")`. Move connection strings to `TINA4_DATABASE_URL` in `.env`.
- **Fix transaction calls.** `beginTransaction()` becomes `startTransaction()`. `rollBack()` becomes `rollback()`.
- **Add typed properties to ORM models.** Replace untyped `public $name;` with typed `public string $name;`. Add `$autoMap = true` and remove manual `$fieldMapping` entries where auto-mapping covers the conversion.
- **Update template code.** If you were using Twig directly, switch to Frond. The syntax is compatible. Replace any Twig-specific PHP calls with `Response::getFronD()`.
- **Run migrations.** Start the server and trigger a migration run. Tina4 auto-upgrades the tracking table. Verify your existing migrations still apply cleanly.
- **Test every route.** Hit every endpoint. Check auth behaviour. Verify response formats. The test chapter (Chapter 18) covers how to write automated tests.
- **Remove leftover v2 files.** Delete the old `routes/`, `orm/`, and `templates/` directories at the project root (now that everything is under `src/`). Clean up any v2-specific config files.

The migration is mechanical. Most of it is find-and-replace. The auth defaults are the one change that can silently break things -- step 7 is the most important step on this list.

Complete Feature List

Tina4 PHP ships 45 production-ready features across every layer of a web application. This chapter lists all of them, grouped by category, with a brief description and a PHP snippet for each.

Core HTTP

1. Router (GET / POST / PUT / PATCH / DELETE / ANY)

Full HTTP method coverage. Route handlers are plain PHP closures.

```
use Tina4\Router;

Router::get('/items',          fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['items' => []]));
Router::post('/items',        fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['created' => true], 201));
Router::put('/items/{id:int}', fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['updated' => true]));
Router::patch('/items/{id:int}', fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['patched' => true]));
Router::delete('/items/{id:int}', fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['deleted' => true]));
Router::any('/ping',          fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['pong' => true]));
```

2. Path Parameters

Type-safe path segments. `{id:int}`, `{price:float}`, `{name}` (string).

```
Router::get('/products/{id:int}', function ($req, $res) {
    $id = $req->params['id']; // integer, validated
    return $res->json(['id' => $id]);
});
```

3. Wildcard Routes

Catch-all routes for SPAs, proxies, or custom 404 pages.

```
Router::get('/app/*', fn($req, $res) => $res->html(file_get_contents('public/index.html')));
```

4. Route Grouping

Group related routes under a shared prefix.

```
use Tina4\RouteGroup;

RouteGroup::prefix('/api/v2', function () {
    Router::get('/users', fn($req, $res) => $res->json([]));
    Router::post('/users', fn($req, $res) => $res->json([], 201));
});
```

5. Route Discovery

Place PHP files in `src/routes/`. Tina4 loads them automatically at startup. No manual require statements.

```
src/
  routes/
    users.php
    orders.php
    products.php
```

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6. Built-in Server

Zero-config development server. Start with one command.

```
tina4 serve
# Listening on http://localhost:7145
```

7. Request Object

Full access to method, headers, body, path params, query params, and server vars.

```
Router::post('/echo', function ($req, $res) {
    return $res->json([
        'method' => $req->method,
        'body'    => $req->body,
        'params'  => $req->params,
        'headers' => $req->headers
    ]);
});
```

8. Response Object

Fluent response builder. JSON, HTML, redirect, file, status codes.

```
return $res->json(['ok' => true], 200);
return $res->html('<h1>Hello</h1>');
return $res->redirect('/login');
return $res->file('/path/to/report.pdf', 'report.pdf');
```

9. Static File Serving

Files in **public/** are served automatically. No route needed.

```
public/
  css/tina4.min.css
  js/tina4.min.js
  images/logo.png
```

10. CORS Middleware

Origin-aware CORS. Configurable via environment.

```
TINA4_CORS_ORIGINS=https://app.example.com,https://admin.example.com
TINA4_CORS_METHODS=GET,POST,PUT,DELETE
```

11. Health Endpoint

Built-in **GET /__health**. Returns **{"status":"ok"}**. Ready for load balancer checks.

```
curl http://localhost:7145/__health
# {"status":"ok","version":"3.10.55"}
```

Authentication & Security

12. JWT Authentication

Zero-dependency JWT. Sign and verify tokens with a secret from the environment.

```
use Tina4\Auth;
```

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```
$token = Auth::generateToken(['user_id' => 42, 'role' => 'admin']);
$payload = Auth::verifyToken($token);
```

13. Password Hashing

bcrypt hashing. Hash on registration, verify on login.

```
use Tina4\Auth;

$hash = Auth::hashPassword('userSecret123');
$ok    = Auth::verifyPassword('userSecret123', $hash);    // true
```

14. CSRF Protection

Form token generation and middleware validation.

```
// In a Frond template:
{{ form_token() }}

// In a route handler (middleware):
Router::post('/form', fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['ok' => true]), 'CSRFMiddleware');
```

15. Rate Limiter

Per-IP or per-user request throttling. Configured via middleware.

```
Router::post('/api/login', fn($req, $res) => $res->json([]), 'RateLimit:10:60');
// Max 10 requests per 60 seconds
```

16. Security Headers

Adds [X-Frame-Options](#), [X-Content-Type-Options](#), [Strict-Transport-Security](#), and [Content-Security-Policy](#) headers.

```
Router::get('/secure', fn($req, $res) => $res->json(['data' => []]), 'SecurityHeaders');
```

17. Validator

Built-in input validation. Rules for required, type, length, pattern.

```
use Tina4\Validator;

$v = new Validator($request->body);
$v->required('email')->email();
$v->required('password')->minLength(8);

if (!$v->passes()) {
    return $response->json(['errors' => $v->errors()], 422);
}

---
```

Database

18. URL-Based Multi-Driver Connection

One connection string covers SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, Firebird, MongoDB, and ODBC.

```
use Tina4\Database;
```

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```
$db = new Database('sqlite:./data/app.db');
$db = new Database('pgsql://user:pass@host:5432/dbname');
$db = new Database('mysql://user:pass@host:3306/dbname');
```

19. Query Execution

`execute()`, `fetchOne()`, `fetchAll()` with named parameters.

```
$db->execute("INSERT INTO products (name, price) VALUES (:name, :price)",
    ['name' => 'widget', 'price' => 9.99]);

$product = $db->fetchOne("SELECT * FROM products WHERE id = :id", ['id' => 1]);
$all      = $db->fetchAll("SELECT * FROM products WHERE active = 1");
```

20. Query Caching

Cache identical queries. Controlled by environment.

```
TINA4_DB_CACHE=true
TINA4_DB_CACHE_TTL=300
```

21. Race-Safe Sequence (`getNextId`)

Atomic ID generation without race conditions. Safe for concurrent workers.

```
$nextId = $db->getNextId('orders');
```

22. Transactions

Explicit transaction control. Autocommit is off unless the environment overrides it.

```
$db->beginTransaction();
try {
    $db->execute("UPDATE accounts SET balance = balance - :amt WHERE id = :id", ['amt' => 100, 'id' => 1]);
    $db->execute("UPDATE accounts SET balance = balance + :amt WHERE id = :id", ['amt' => 100, 'id' => 2]);
    $db->commit();
} catch (\Throwable $e) {
    $db->rollback();
    throw $e;
}
---
```

ORM

23. Active Record

Models map to tables. `save()`, `load()`, `delete()`.

```
use Tina4\ORM;

class Product extends ORM {
    public int $id = 0;
    public string $name = '';
    public float $price = 0.0;
    public bool $active = true;
}

$p = new Product();
$p->name = 'Keyboard';
```

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```
$p->price = 79.99;
$p->save();

$found = (new Product())->load(['id' => 1]);
```

24. QueryBuilder

Fluent SQL construction. Chainable methods.

```
$results = (new Product())
    ->query()
    ->where('active', '=', 1)
    ->where('price', '<', 100)
    ->orderBy('name', 'ASC')
    ->limit(20)
    ->get();
```

25. Relationships

hasMany, **hasOne**, **belongsTo** declared on model classes.

```
class Order extends ORM {
    public function items(): array {
        return $this->hasMany(OrderItem::class, 'order_id');
    }
}

$order = (new Order())->load(['id' => 1]);
$items = $order->items();
```

26. AutoCRUD

Generate REST endpoints from a model in one line.

```
Product::autoCrud('/api/products');
// GET    /api/products    - list
// GET    /api/products/{id} - fetch
// POST   /api/products    - create
// PUT    /api/products/{id} - update
// DELETE /api/products/{id} - delete
```

27. Soft Delete

Mark records as deleted without removing them from the database.

```
class Order extends ORM {
    protected bool $softDelete = true;
}

$order->delete(); // Sets deleted_at, not removed
$active = (new Order())->all(); // Excludes soft-deleted rows

---
```

Template Engine (FronD)

28. Twig-Compatible Syntax

Block inheritance, includes, loops, conditions, filters.

```
{% extends "layout.html" %}
{% block content %}
    {% for product in products %}
        <p>{{ product.name }} – {{ product.price | number_format(2) }}</p>
    {% endfor %}
{% endblock %}
```

29. Custom Filters and Functions

Extend Frond with PHP callables.

```
use Tina4\Frond;

Frond::addFilter('currency', fn($amount, $symbol = '$') => $symbol . number_format($amount, 2));

{{ product.price | currency('€') }}
```

30. Fragment Caching

Cache template fragments to avoid re-rendering.

```
{% cache 'featured-products' 300 %}
    {% for p in featured %}
        <div class="card">{{ p.name }}</div>
    {% endfor %}
{% endcache %}
```

APIs and Protocols

31. API Client

Call external APIs. No Guzzle. No Composer.

```
use Tina4\Api;

$api = new Api('https://api.example.com');
$api->addCustomHeaders(['Authorization' => 'Bearer ' . getenv('API_TOKEN')]);
$result = $api->sendRequest('GET', '/resources');
```

32. Swagger / OpenAPI

Auto-generate API docs from PHPDoc annotations.

```
/**
 * @route GET /api/products
 * @summary List all products
 * @response 200 array of products
 */
Router::get('/api/products', fn($req, $res) => $res->json([]));
```

Visit [/__swagger](#) to view the interactive docs.

33. GraphQL

Zero-dependency GraphQL engine. Type definitions and resolvers in PHP.

```
use Tina4\GraphQL;

GraphQL::type('Product', [
    'id' => 'Int', 'name' => 'String', 'price' => 'Float'
]);
```

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```
GraphQL::query('products', 'Product', fn() => getAllProducts());
GraphQL::mount('/graphql');
```

34. WebSocket

Real-time bidirectional communication. Backplane for multi-server scale.

```
use Tina4\WebSocket;

WebSocket::on('message', function ($client, $message) {
    WebSocket::broadcast(['type' => 'chat', 'text' => $message]);
});
```

35. SSE / Streaming

Server-Sent Events for real-time data push. Pass a generator callable to `response->stream()`.

```
Router::get('/events', function ($req, $res) {
    $res->stream(function () {
        while (true) {
            yield "data: " . json_encode(['time' => date('c')]) . "\n\n";
            sleep(1);
        }
    });
});
```

36. WSDL / SOAP

Auto-generate WSDL from annotated PHP classes.

```
use Tina4\WSDL;

class PaymentService extends WSDL {
    /** @wsdl_operation */
    public function Charge(float $amount, string $currency): string {
        return 'txn_' . uniqid();
    }
}

Router::soap('/payment', new PaymentService());
```

Real-time and Messaging

37. Messenger (Email)

SMTP email with attachments. Configurable via environment.

```
use Tina4\Messenger;

Messenger::send(
    to:      'alice@example.com',
    subject: 'Your Order',
    body:    'Order #1234 has shipped.'
);
```

Queue

38. Queue System

File, RabbitMQ, Kafka, and MongoDB backends. Same API for all.

```
use Tina4\Queue;

$queue = new Queue(topic: 'emails');
$queue->push(['to' => 'alice@example.com', 'subject' => 'Hi']);

foreach ($queue->consume('emails') as $job) {
    sendEmail($job->payload);
    $job->complete();
}

---
```

Sessions

39. Session Handlers

File, database, Redis, Valkey, and MongoDB backends.

```
TINA4_SESSION_HANDLER=redis
TINA4_SESSION_REDIS_HOST=localhost
TINA4_SESSION_TTL=3600

use Tina4\Session;

Session::set('user_id', 42);
$id = Session::get('user_id');
Session::destroy();

---
```

Infrastructure

40. Migrations

Versioned database schema migrations. Run via CLI.

```
tina4 migrate
tina4 migrate --rollback

// migrations/0001_create_products.php
return [
    'up' => "CREATE TABLE products (id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY, name TEXT, price REAL)",
    'down' => "DROP TABLE products"
];
```

41. Localization (I18n)

JSON locale files. Dot-notation keys. Interpolation. Fallback.

```
use Tina4\I18n;

$i18n = new I18n('src/locales', defaultLocale: 'en');
$i18n->setLocale('de');
```

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```
echo $!18n->t('welcome', ['name' => 'Alice']);
// Willkommen, Alice!
```

42. Events (Observer Pattern)

`on()`, `once()`, `off()`, `emit()`. Priority dispatch.

```
use Tina4\Events;

Events::on('order.placed', fn($data) => sendConfirmation($data['email'], 10);
Events::emit('order.placed', ['email' => 'alice@example.com', 'total' => 59.99]);
```

43. Structured Logging

Log levels. JSON output. Context fields. Env-controlled level filter.

```
use Tina4\Debug;

Debug::message("Payment failed", TINA4_LOG_ERROR, [
    'user_id'    => 42,
    'amount'     => 99.00,
    'gateway'    => 'stripe',
    'error_code' => 'insufficient_funds'
]);
```

44. DI Container

`register()`, `singleton()`, `get()`, `has()`, `reset()`.

```
use Tina4\Container;

$container = new Container();
$container->singleton('db', fn() => new \Tina4\Database(getenv('TINA4_DATABASE_URL')));
$db = $container->get('db');
```

45. Service Runner

Long-running background workers. Supervisor and systemd compatible.

```
use Tina4\ServiceRunner;
use Tina4\Service;

class HeartbeatWorker extends Service {
    public function run(): void {
        while (true) {
            echo "heartbeat\n";
            sleep(60);
        }
    }
    public function stop(): void {}
}

$runner = new ServiceRunner();
$runner->add(new HeartbeatWorker());
$runner->start();
```

Summary Table

#	Feature	Category
1	Router (GET/POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE/ANY)	Core HTTP
2	Path parameters ({id:int}, {price:float})	Core HTTP
3	Wildcard routes	Core HTTP
4	Route grouping	Core HTTP
5	Route discovery (auto-load src/)	Core HTTP
6	Built-in server	Core HTTP
7	Request object	Core HTTP
8	Response object	Core HTTP
9	Static file serving	Core HTTP
10	CORS middleware	Core HTTP
11	Health endpoint	Core HTTP
12	JWT authentication	Auth & Security
13	Password hashing	Auth & Security
14	CSRF protection	Auth & Security
15	Rate limiter	Auth & Security
16	Security headers	Auth & Security
17	Validator	Auth & Security
18	URL-based multi-driver connection	Database
19	Query execution	Database
20	Query caching	Database
21	Race-safe sequence (getnextid)	Database
22	Transactions	Database
23	Active Record ORM	ORM
24	QueryBuilder	ORM

25	Relationships (hasMany/hasOne/belongsTo)	ORM
26	AutoCRUD	ORM
27	Soft delete	ORM
28	Front template engine (Twig-compatible)	Templates
29	Custom filters and functions	Templates
30	Fragment caching	Templates
31	API client (zero-dep)	APIs & Protocols
32	Swagger / OpenAPI	APIs & Protocols
33	GraphQL engine	APIs & Protocols
34	WebSocket server	APIs & Protocols
35	SSE / Streaming (response.stream)	APIs & Protocols
36	WSDL / SOAP server	APIs & Protocols
37	Messenger (email)	Messaging
38	Queue system (4 backends)	Queue
39	Session handlers (5 backends)	Sessions
40	Migrations	Infrastructure
41	Localization (i18n)	Infrastructure
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43	Structured logging	Infrastructure
44	DI Container	Infrastructure
45	Service Runner	Infrastructure

All 45 features are at 100% parity across Tina4 PHP, Python, Ruby, and Node.js.